

Materia Mundi



Fantasy Role-Playing Game

This is a complete compendium, containing six books. If you are new to “dungeon-crawling” (or if you are new to role-playing games in general) this introduction is for you. Once you feel that you understand the concepts presented here, each of the other books in this collection are organized to provide you with more details about various aspects of the game.

If you’re already familiar with these concepts, you can start creating a character on pg. 6.

Panoply

The Panoply chapter provides a list of weapons, armor, and other gear, including magic items and potions. Once you create a player character, read through the panoply together with your referee to pick out their starting equipment.

Magic

The Magic chapter also lists all the magical spells, miracles, and glamours that various magic-user characters can perform.

Bestiary

The Bestiary lists the mortal races, natural animals, fey beasts, monsters, fair folk, and infernal and undead threats that the referee can use to provide a sense of challenge and danger to the player characters. Players might also reference the bestiary themselves for the game statistics of allies, beast companions, or any magics that allow them to change forms.

History

The History chapter is an incomplete story of the default game world that these rules were written for. The referee is free to modify, fill in, expand, or even discard everything written in it; inasmuch as there is a “default setting”, though, the History handbook lays out the skeleton of it.

Referee’s Guide

The Referee’s Guide is the manual for running the game, if you want to be the referee. Each gaming group needs a referee to manage the environment and all the other creatures in it, while each other player controls their player character and reacts to the situations that the referee presents to them.

More Resources

This game is built on a foundation of “retroclone” RPGs, which means it is compatible with a wide range of products. This version of the game changes a few rules, which might necessitate a bit of work getting a specific supplement from a compatible game line to “line up” with the numbers presented here, but for the most part anything that is descended from Moldvay’s original B/X rules or its descendants (such as Mentzer’s BECMI or Allston’s Rules Companion) should be reasonably compatible.

(If you don’t know what those words mean, don’t worry about it.)

Adventures and resources created for the following systems are likely to be useful to you or your referee:

Adventurer, Conqueror, King

Basic Fantasy Roleplaying

Castles & Crusades

Dolmenwood

Labyrinth Lord

Lamentations of the Flame Princess

Old-School Essentials

This work includes material derived from the System Reference Document 5.2 (“SRD 5.2”) by Wizards of the Coast LLC, available at: <https://dnd.wizards.com/resources/systems-reference-document>

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Introduction

This book contains the rules for a role-playing game in the "old school" style of the first tabletop RPGs created in the 1970s.

What's a Role-Playing Game?

This is a *role-playing game*. In it, you play the role of an adventurer in a fantasy world, where magic is real and heroes venture forth on dangerous quests for fortune and fame. Characters gain experience by overcoming danger and recovering treasure, growing in power and ability as they do so.

You need at least two people to play this game, although it's far more enjoyable with a troupe of four or more people. You don't need a board or playing pieces to play (although many players find them useful) - all that you really need are these rules, some dice, a pencil and paper, and your imagination.

Definitions

When you set up to play this game, one person will be designated as the *referee*. Each of the other people plays the role of a fantasy character, designated a *player character*. The person assigned to play that player character is their *player*. You can think of a player as an actor in a partially improvisational theatre performance, and the referee as the director. The group of player characters adventuring together are called the *party*.

How to "Win"

"Winning" and "Losing" are not the right way to think about a fantasy adventure game. While the referee controls monsters and traps that might threaten the player characters, the referee should not see themselves as playing "against" the players - they are a guide and a judge, whose primary job is to keep the action flowing and present the adventure to the party in a neutral manner. They are not "on the players' side", but they are equally not "on the monsters' side"; their job is to create and present an exciting adventure.

Keep in mind that the referee's primary job is to maintain the sense that the party exists within a world. If the rules in this book result in an obviously absurd situation, it is the referee's job to ignore them, and figure out what happens instead.

Setting Up

It's the referee's job to prepare the setting for each adventure before it begins. They will create maps, monsters, and mortal non-player characters (NPCs) for the party to interact with. Traditionally, the destination for an adventure is often called a "dungeon", because most early games were set exploring vast underground caverns or stone rooms beneath ancient castles. Adventures might be set in the wilderness, at sea, or in a bustling city, but the term 'dungeon' remains as a legacy of those first days. Dungeons might be purchased or designed by the referee from scratch, but in either case the referee can expect to spend a lot more time preparing than the players. The referee's job takes the most time, but is also the most creative and rewarding.

The next few pages will explain character creation, which is the process each player uses to create the details of their character. Your character will have abilities that define their core talents and weaknesses, an origin (such as human, dwarf, elf, or gnome) that makes them part of the setting, and a character class (essentially a profession) that gives them the skills and competencies that they will rely on to survive the adventure.

When the referee has created their dungeon and all the players have created characters, the game is ready to begin! Each session of the game is called an adventure, and might last only an hour or might stretch to fill an entire weekend. An adventure begins when the party sets out for the dungeon, and ends when they return home and divide up their treasure. The amount of time that this takes depends on the players and the referee.

Several related adventures (one leading to another, often with the same players and characters) are called a campaign. Campaigns can last a very long time indeed, with some going on for several years.

Dice

For ease of play, this game only uses two kinds of dice: the d20 and the d6. Each player generally needs two d20's, and between three and six d6's.



Medieval Setting

This game's default setting is a fantasy version of our own world's medieval Europe, where magic is real and heroes venture forth on dangerous quests for fortune and fame. In this world, the Old Empire was a magically-powered, high-tech, and brutally dystopian society, until the coming of a new Faith led to its slow collapse – a period of history called the Successor Wars. For nearly a millennium, medieval Successor Kingdoms fought to claim the Emperor's empty throne, either by winning the approval of the Faith's stewards or through direct military conquest.

Meanwhile, the barbarian tribes to the North of the Successor Kingdoms have slowly begun to join the Faith, while to the South and East the Sultanate maintains an uneasy truce with the Successor Kings over control of the vital silk-and-spice trade routes to the far Orient.

The brutality of the Successor Wars have recently come to an end, due to the even more brutal horror of the Great Plague – a sorcerous pestilence unleashed during the wars between the Successor Kingdoms and the Sultanate that slowly killed its victims, then rose them again as hordes of mindless undead.

Now that the Plague has mostly run its course, the Successor Kings are enjoying a Renaissance of discovery and opportunity, gradually re-discovering the technological wonders of the Old Empire, re-claiming and re-settling territories lost during the plague, and occasionally fanning or dousing the embers of the last Succession War.

Beyond the safe walls of civilization's keeps and cities, the wilds churn with dangerous magical energies. Two adjacent magical realms – called Faerie and Shadow by mortals – leak energy into the familiar material world, creating fey and undead menaces that must be defended against.

The style of this setting could be called a post-apocalyptic fantasy, but the focus should be on the hope and possibility of a brighter future. The goal is to strike out into the world, find lost wonders, restore them to their former glory, and use them to rebuild civilization.

For Those Familiar With Other Systems

This edition uses a familiar “old-school” edition of the first published roleplaying game as its base rules, but makes some changes to those rules in order to both simplify play, and better reflect the nature of the setting. If you're familiar with “B/X” or “OSR” style play, you should probably read the following section to get used to the changes.

Simplified Dice

For ease of play, this game only uses d20s and d6s; you'll generally need two d20s and four d6s. If you're familiar with similar games that use a wider range of dice, don't worry: hit dice, weapon and magic damage, and other effects that would normally use different dice, have been adjusted to fit neatly into these two probability ranges. Determining success or failure has also been simplified, with fewer situations needing mathematical “modifiers” to a player character's dice rolls.

Simplified Classes

The character class system for this game is vastly simplified: each class only has 9 levels, with all attack and saving throw thresholds always increasing at +1 per level. Characters gain a base of one experience per adventure, and gain a new class level whenever their experience equals their new class level. Defeating monsters and gaining treasure are worth additional experience, so it is possible to level up faster if you are smart and brave.

Simplified Abilities

Abilities do not have a separate “ability score” and “ability modifier”; what B/X calls the “ability modifier” is simply your ability.

These rules include six saving throws – vs. Doom, vs. Hold, vs. Blast, vs. Trick, vs. Curse, and vs. Fear – where each saving throw is associated with a different ability. Thus, each of your abilities will be important in different circumstances.

Simplified Skills

In addition to saving throws, these rules also include a unified “skill system”, with twelve “n-in-6” talents split evenly between four abilities (Dexterity, Intelligence, Wisdom, and Charisma). Each of those four abilities will affect a player character's starting proficiency in up to three of those talents.

Player Characters

Origin

Every character has an origin, representing their cultural and ethnic background. This is much broader than our world's ethnicities - this is a world with dwarves, elves, and even stranger creatures! Some origins even have a few abilities that tend to be higher or lower, on average, than a human's.

Your origin will determine which character classes you can take. Each origin always has one martial class, one expert class, and one magic-user class to choose from, and any origin can choose to become a Priest. Within those choices, your abilities determine which classes you would be better or worse at.

Abilities

Your character has six primary abilities, which define how tough, strong, nimble, smart, perceptive, and outgoing they are compared to the average person. Each of these abilities ranges from -3 (severely disabled) to +3 (world-class prodigy), with most humans typically having abilities of +0. An ability of -1 or lower is noticeably worse than the average human's, while an ability of +1 or higher is noticeably better.

Rolling Abilities

When you create a character, you will roll 3d6 and add the dice together for each of these abilities, generating a number from 3 to 18 which will then convert into a -3 to +3 ability value. Certain origins will provide you with enhanced or deficient abilities; you roll 4d6 for those abilities, then ignore either the highest or lowest die and add the rest together to determine that ability.

You always roll your abilities in order; this might result in a character with exceptionally high intelligence but abysmally low wisdom, but such is the way of things sometimes. As an option, the referee might decide to allow anyone playing a human character to choose and swap a single pair of abilities after rolling.

Barring serious injury or miraculous blessing, these numbers will be your character's innate abilities throughout your career - you can increase your skill at anything with sufficient training and effort, but raw inborn ability will always be what it is.

What Abilities Do

Here are each of the six abilities, in order, along with a brief description:

Strength is your character's raw physical power, including their muscle strength and speed. It determines how well (and how hard) they can hit with melee weapons, how much they can lift and carry, and their general athleticism.

Constitution is your character's toughness, endurance, and health. It determines how long they can stay in a fight, as well as how well they resist poisons and diseases.

Dexterity is your character's hand-eye coordination, balance, and agility (although some facets of agility are a matter of strength rather than dexterity). It determines how well you can avoid getting hit, and gives you an edge with various trainable physical talents.

Intelligence is your character's logical thinking and deduction capability. It determines how well you notice out-of-place details, and gives you an edge with various mental talents.

Wisdom is your character's intuitive awareness and common sense. It determines how well you resist various magical or mind-controlling effects, and gives you an edge with various trainable intuitive talents.

Charisma is your character's courage, spirit, and likeability. It determines how well you resist being frightened or discouraged, and gives you an edge with various social talents.

Character Class

This game tracks your character's talents and experience through a concept called a *character class*. Your character class is an abstraction that represents the general focus of your character's talents as an adventurer; each class focuses on a different aspect of the game - fighter classes focus on combat prowess, expert classes focus on skills and tricks, and magic-user classes focus on magic and the supernatural. As you advance, your character will gradually get better at the talents that your character class focuses on, while also improving their general ability to survive hardship and danger.

Holly

Origin

Human

Level

1

Class

Scout

14+

Attacks

12+

1

Armor

5

Hit Points

-1

CONSTITUTION

Save vs.

Doom

15+

+0

STRENGTH

Save vs.

Hold

14+

+2

DEXTERITY

Save vs.

Blast

12+

+0

INTELLIGENCE

Save vs.

Trick

14+

+0

WISDOM

Save vs.

Curse

14+

+1

CHARISMA

Save vs.

Fear

13+

Hit Die

d6 -1

Proficiencies

Weapons

☒

Shields

☐

Armor

☐

Talents (D6)

Agility

4+

Finesse

4+

Stealth

5+

Lore

5+

Medicine

5+

Science

5+

Alertness

5+

Intuition

5+

Survival

5+

Bearing

5+

Charm

5+

Wit

4+

Portrait

Arms

Right Hand:

d6

Dagger

piercing

Left Hand:

d6

Hand Crossbow

piercing

Armor:

Light

Weight:

2

Threshold

3

Limit

6

Gear

Crown:

Amulet:

Ring (R):

Ring (L):

Belt:

Boots:

Creating a Character

STEP 1: Roll Origin

Roll a d6 to determine your origin: human, dwarf, or fey. If you roll a fey origin, you then roll another d6 to determine which kind of fey you are. The referee might instead decide to allow each player to choose their origin.

Most non-humans have two enhanced abilities and one deficient ability (at least, enhanced or deficient compared to humans). Note these; you'll use them in the next step.

STEP 2: Roll Abilities

Roll 3d6 for each of your Abilities, starting with Constitution, then Strength, then Dexterity, then Intelligence, then Wisdom, then Charisma. The chart on the next page will convert this roll into a number between -3 and +3, which measures how good (or bad) you are at actions related to that ability.

Characters with a non-human origin will have one or two enhanced abilities, and possibly one deficient ability. If the ability you are rolling is an enhanced ability for your origin, reroll the lowest die and choose the better roll before adding the dice together. If the ability you are rolling is a deficient ability for your origin, reroll the highest die and choose the worse roll. Human characters do not have any enhanced or deficient abilities, but the referee might decide to allow the players of a human character to swap one pair of abilities.

Step 2a: Attack and Saving Throws

Your character has two attack throw thresholds and six saving throw thresholds. Your melee attack throw is adjusted based on your Strength, while your ranged attack throw is adjusted based on your Dexterity. Each of your six saving throw thresholds is adjusted based on a different ability.

Each attack throw or saving throw threshold starts at 14+ if your ability is average (+0). Otherwise, adjust the relevant threshold, starting at 14 — a positive ability lowers your threshold, while a negative ability increases the threshold. The result is your starting attack throw threshold or saving throw threshold, which you will compare to a d20 roll whenever you make an attack throw or saving throw.

Step 2b: Adjust Talents

Each character has various talents, each of which relates to different adventuring tasks. Each talent has a "threshold" from 6+ to 2+; whenever you perform a task related to that talent, you will roll a d6 and compare it to your threshold for that talent.

By default, you have a 5+ threshold in each talent. If you have any abilities above or below +0, some talents will begin at a 6+ or 4+ threshold instead. Each talent is linked to a different ability; for each ability that is below or above +0, determine which of those talents will begin better or worse than normal.

STEP 3: Choose Your Class

Each origin has a number of character classes to choose from - at least one warrior class, one expert class, and one magic-user class.

Each class relies on their abilities in different ways. Warriors will benefit from higher Strength and Constitution, while experts will benefit from higher Dexterity and Wisdom, and magic-users might benefit from higher Intelligence, Wisdom, or Charisma depending on the nature of the magic that they wield.

Step 3a: Set Hit Points

Your starting maximum hit points are equal to 6 + your Constitution, plus any bonuses to your hit die from your class. Fighter classes gain a +2 class bonus to each hit die, while expert or magic-user classes might get a +1 bonus or no hit die bonus at all.

Step 3b: Note Martial Proficiencies

Some classes gain some amount of weapon and armor training. Note whether you are trained in the use of non-simple weapons, armors, or shields.

Step 3c: Note Expertise

Some classes gain expertise in some talents. Note any expertise talents with an asterisk.

STEP 4: Choose Starting Equipment

(See the Panoply chapter for options)

Choose any starting equipment that is reasonable for your character to have. Each class will have a list of recommended starting equipment, or the referee might give you a list of options to choose from.

Character Details

Origin

Start creating a new character by rolling a d6 to determine your origin. If you roll a 6 (fey origin), roll another d6 to determine which type of fey you are (elf, gnome, or beastfolk).

D6	Origin	Height	Adjusted Abilities
1-3	Human	4d6+55 in	none
4	Human Barbarian (choose from Fey class list)		
5	Dwarf	2d6+30 in	+Con, +Str, -Dex
6	Fey (roll another d6 to determine which type)		
D6	Fey Type	Height	Adjusted Abilities
1-3	Elf	3d6+50 in	+Dex, +Wis, -Con
4-5	Gnome	1d6+30 in	+Dex, +Cha, -Str
6	Beastfolk	5d6+50 in	+Str, +Dex, -Int

The dice results presented here are meant to represent population demographics typical for the Successor Kingdoms; the referee is encouraged to adjust them to reflect the nature of their own campaign setting. For example, a campaign set entirely within civilization might extend the 1-3 'human' roll to 1-4 and replace the 6 'fey' roll with 'gnome', ignoring the d6 fey type roll altogether.

Abilities

Once you have determined your origin, roll 3d6 in order to determine each of your abilities, or roll 4d6 (dropping the highest or lowest) for any of your origin's adjusted abilities. Abilities with a [+] drop the lowest die, while abilities with a [-] drop the highest die. Add all three dice together and consult the following chart, writing the ability referenced (-3 to +3) on your character sheet.

3d6	Ability	Description	Talent Adjustments
3	-3	Disabled	3 linked talents are 6+
4-5	-2	Impaired	2 linked talents are 6+
6-8	-1	Below Average	1 linked talent is 6+
9-12	+0	Average	All talents are 5+
13-15	+1	Above Average	1 linked talent is 4+
16-17	+2	Exceptional	2 linked talents are 4+
18	+3	Prodigy	3 linked talents are 4+

Each ability adjusts any saving throws, attack throws, weapon damage, or other rolls that are based on that ability. It also determines the number of talents linked to that ability that are adjusted, either to 6+ or to 4+.

Saving Throws

Each ability has an associated saving throw. A saving throw is made by rolling a d20 and comparing it to a threshold, which is the number you need to match or beat on the d20 to successfully save vs. a threat of that nature.

Constitution vs. Doom (*i.e. disease or poison*)

Strength vs. Hold (*i.e. knockdown or paralysis*)

Dexterity vs. Blast (*i.e. a cone, ray, or explosion*)

Intelligence vs. Trick (*i.e. illusion or beguilement*)

Wisdom vs. Curse (*i.e. a magic spell*)

Charisma vs. Fear (*i.e. morale checks*)

Each saving throw threshold depends on the sum of your ability + your class level:

-2	-1	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
17+	16+	15+	14+	13+	12+	11+	10+	9+	8+	7+	6+	5+

Attack Throws

You also have two attack throws - one for ranged attacks, and one for melee attacks. Your melee attack throw threshold is always equal to your Strength saving throw, and your ranged attack throw threshold is always equal to your Dexterity saving throw. You must match or beat this value on a d20 roll to hit an enemy with that kind of attack.

Hit Dice and Carrying Capacity

In addition to saving throws and attack throws, there are two more traits linked directly to your abilities:

Hit Die

Your hit die is used to determine your maximum hit points, as well as your rate of healing. Whenever you are asked to roll a hit die, you roll a d6 and add your Constitution; if you have a negative Constitution and your hit die total would be less than 1, treat the roll result as a 1 instead. Fighter classes and dwarves gain a bonus to their hit die.

Carrying Capacity

Your character can only carry so much before the weight slows them down. Each character has a carrying capacity of 6 + their Strength ability, and an encumbrance threshold of half that amount (round down). Carrying gear in excess of your encumbrance threshold halves your dash speed, up to a maximum practical burden equal to your carrying capacity.

Talents

There are 12 talents, each linked to a different ability. Each talent determines the threshold for various d6 task checks, which are made by rolling a d6 and comparing it to that talent's threshold. Talents begin at a threshold of 5+ if your linked ability is +0; if your linked ability is better or worse, that many talents linked to that ability begin at 4+ or +6 instead. You may choose which talents to assign your 6+, 5+, or 4+ thresholds to from each ability.

Your **Dexterity** talents are Agility, Finesse, and Stealth. **Agility** is your full-body athleticism, and is used for climbing and other athletic feats. **Finesse** is your hand-eye coordination, and is used for detailed work like picking a lock or assembling a clockwork contraption. **Stealth** is your ability to move your body within an environment, to avoid making noise or being seen.

Your **Intelligence** talents are Lore, Medicine, and Science. **Lore** is your linguistic ability, "book learning" and capacity to remember trivia, while **Medicine** is your understanding of living bodies and how to maintain or restore their health, and **Science** is your grasp of physical and magical phenomena and the rules that govern them.

Your **Wisdom** talents are Alertness, Intuition, and Survival. Your **Alertness** measures your ability to pick up details and clues from your environment, determine which ones are important, and know how to respond to them. **Intuition** is your "common sense" and how well you can listen to your gut, both in social situations and in more unusual circumstances. **Survival** is your ability to navigate the wilds and survive within them, including finding or creating shelter, food, water, and other necessities..

Your **Charisma** talents are Bearing, Charm, and Wit. **Bearing** is your ability to project authority, command respect, and maintain your composure in tense situations. **Charm** is your ability to project trust, warmth, or anything else that could influence another creature's long-term attitude towards you. Finally, **Wit** is your ability to be persuasive, whether you are trying to change another creature's beliefs or just convince them to perform some task or action.

Ability Checks

Sometimes, the result of an action will be determined purely by your character's ability, regardless of any training or experience they might have. An Ability check rolls a d6 and adds the appropriate ability. (In a sense, Hit Dice are a kind of ability check.) The referee determines the threshold for success based on the circumstances.

Easier and Harder Rolls

Any attack throw, saving throw, task check, or ability check that your character might roll can be made easier or harder by various circumstances. When circumstances combine to make a roll easy, you roll two dice and use the better roll. When circumstances combine to make a roll hard, you roll two dice and must use the worse roll. If a roll is neither hard nor easy, you roll a single die.

If multiple circumstances make a situation easier while other circumstances make the same situation harder, each circumstance making the situation easier cancels out one circumstance making the situation harder, unless the referee decides that a particular circumstance overwhelms all the others.

If there are multiple circumstances all making a situation easier or harder, the referee might declare that it is now impossible to succeed or fail at that task, and not call for a roll at all.

Difficulty	Roll
Automatic	No roll necessary
Easy	roll 2 dice (choose better)
Normal	roll 1 die
Hard	roll 2 dice (choose worse)
Impossible	No roll possible

Multiple Attempts

Unless the referee decides otherwise, each subsequent attempt of the same action is one difficulty step harder than the last, as you run out of things to try.

Rewarding Ingenuity

A large part of a fantasy adventure game is coming up with clever solutions to problems. If the party's approach to a particular task is particularly clever or effective, the referee should lower the difficulty of that task check accordingly.

Choosing a Character Class

Once you have an origin and your six abilities, you can choose a character class. Each origin has its own set of three classes to choose from: one fighter class, one expert class, and one magic-user class.

Class and Origin

Human characters that are from advanced "civilized" societies can choose between the Warrior, Scout, or Wizard classes, while fey and humans from "barbarian" societies can choose between the Champion, Hunter, or Druid. All Dwarves choose from the Stalwart, Delver, or Dweomersmith. Any origin can choose the Priest class, although human priests are by far the most common.

Hit Points

Each class has a "hit die", which is a d6 + your Constitution + a bonus based on your class (not all classes will give a bonus). Once you've picked your class, your character's maximum hit points are the maximum possible roll of your hit die (as if the d6 had rolled a '6').

Martial Training

Your class might also provide you training in various military weapons and armors. Martial training allows you to use all weapons, armor, or shields without difficulty; without it, many weapons are harder to use, and you become easier to hit while wearing inappropriate armor. Even with training, medium or heavy armors still make all stealth checks harder.

Talent Training

Expert classes train a talent of their choice each time they gain a class level, including level one. Each expert class has a different list of talents that they can train.

Expertise

Some classes provide expertise in various actions; expertise makes all actions under its purview easier, allowing almost-impossible feats of skill. The referee is the final arbiter of what actions are or aren't physically possible for an expert to attempt with their expertise.

Other Class Feats

Each class also gives you one or more class feats, such as a sneak attack or some kind of magic ability. The rules for each class feat will be explained with that class.

Experience

You begin play at level 1; as you survive each adventure, you will gain experience that will eventually advance your class level. Each adventure that you successfully return home from grants you one experience, although a particularly clever solution to an adventure's challenges might gain you an additional experience for that adventure. Whenever your experience equals your next class level, reset your experience to zero and gain that level.

Prime Ability

If you have exceptionally high or low abilities in your class's prime ability, you will gain class levels faster or slower than normal. If your prime ability is +1 or better, you reset your experience to one, rather than zero, after you gain a new level. On the other hand, if your prime ability is -1 or lower, you must earn that much additional experience before you can gain a new level.

Gaining a Level

Each time you gain a class level, you lower your thresholds for each of your attack and saving throws by 1. Then, you roll a hit die and add it to your maximum hit points.

Talent and Feat Training

Expert classes train one talent of their choice each time they gain a class level, while magic-user classes gain training in specific talents at each even class level, and fighters choose a new fighter feat at each even class level.

Attack & Saving Throws

As you level up, remember that each of your attack and saving throw thresholds depends on the sum of your ability + your level:

-2	-1	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
17+	16+	15+	14+	13+	12+	11+	10+	9+	8+	7+	6+	5+

Classes and Themes

The class names presented here are generic "catch-all" categories for various kinds of proficiency - for example, a "Scout" might represent a thief, treasure-hunter, diplomat, spy, assassin, wandering noble dilettante, or a number of other professions. If you have a particular background in mind, work with your referee to determine which class best fits your idea.



Human Classes

Warrior

(Human Fighter)



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Strength*

Hit Die: *d6+Con+2*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Longsword, heavy armor, shield, dungeoneer's kit

Martial Training

Warriors are familiar with every kind of weapon, armor, and shield.

Improved Critical Hit

If your attack throw threshold is 9+ or better, you achieve a critical hit whenever your attack throw beats your threshold by 10 or more.

Fighter Feats

At levels 2, 4, 6, and 8, choose one of the following fighter feats:

Fighter Feats

Cleave

Whenever your melee attack action reduces a creature to zero hit points, you can apply any excess damage to another creature within reach that isn't harder to hit. The new target applies its armor to the attack as normal.

Defender

Any creature within reach of your melee weapon that attacks a target other than you provokes an opportunity attack from you.

Deflect Blows

When you guard or evade, you also double your armor rating.

Leadership

When an ally within 5 paces fails a save vs. Fear, you can make a Bearing skill check at the same difficulty to turn it into a success.

Mounted Combat

When you ride a properly-trained mount, the bond between rider and mount is sufficiently strong that you operate effectively as a single unit, using your mount's movement as if it was your own and allowing you to perform your own action as normal.

Riposte

When you successfully parry an attack, you may immediately counter-attack as part of your parry. Additionally, whenever an attacker misses you while you are guarding, they provoke an opportunity attack from you.

Talent Training

You may train **Agility**, **Stealth**, **Alertness**, **Survival**, or **Bearing**. Each of these choices counts as a separate feat, so you can choose a different talent to train at a future class level.

Weapon Expertise

You may choose a particular type of weapon to gain expertise in: **blades**, **axes**, **bludgeons**, **flails**, **spears**, **polearms**, **bows**, or **crossbows**. Your attack throws with armaments of that type are easier.

Scout

(Human Expert)



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Dexterity*

Hit Die: *d6+Con*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Light crossbow, two daggers, light armor, lockpicking tools, dungeoneer's kit

Martial Training

Scouts are familiar with every kind of weapon, but only simple (non-heavy) armor.

Talent Training

Each time you gain a level, you gain training in your choice of **Agility**, **Finesse**, **Stealth**, or **Alertness**. At levels 5 and 9, you may instead gain training in any one talent of your choice.

Scout's Expertise

Climbing (**Agility**) and hiding (**Stealth**) are particularly easy for you. You automatically succeed at any hiding or climbing action that another class would attempt at a normal difficulty, while tasks that are impossible for other classes, such as climbing a sheer wall or hiding in mere shadows, are rolled at normal difficulty for you. You cannot apply this expertise if you are encumbered, wearing medium or heavy armor, or using a shield.

Sneak Attack

You use your ranged attack threshold when you attack a target that is not aware of you, and the attack is a critical hit if each of its damage dice exceeds your Stealth threshold.

Talents

Your Dexterity, Intelligence, Wisdom, and Charisma each determine your starting threshold for three different talents; if your ability is +0, then all three of those talents will start at a threshold of 5+. A negative ability adjusts that many talents to a starting threshold of 6+, while a positive ability adjusts that many to 4+.

Agility (*Dexterity*) to climb surfaces, maintain balance, and perform precise athletic actions.

Finesse (*Dexterity*) to pick locks, disarm traps, operate machinery, or craft or repair items.

Stealth (*Dexterity*) to move silently without being noticed, hide from view, surprise or ambush an enemy, or pick pockets.

Lore (*Intelligence*) to understand a language, decipher a code, or recall any knowledge involving history, religion, or culture.

Medicine (*Intelligence*) to brew an elixir or toxin, or to diagnose or treat injury or disease.

Science (*Intelligence*) to brew a potion, enchant or identify a scroll or magic item, notice the presence of supernatural forces, or recall any knowledge involving math or engineering.

Alertness (*Wisdom*) to detect a hidden trap or secret door, to listen or watch for enemies, and avoid being surprised by ambushes.

Intuition (*Wisdom*) to read the emotions and intentions of living creatures, or to get a "gut sense" of danger or extreme foolishness.

Survival (*Wisdom*) to navigate the wilderness, hunt or forage for food, follow others' tracks or hide your own, or set up camp.

Bearing (*Charisma*) to maintain composure, manage hirelings and followers, or improve your allies' morale.

Charm (*Charisma*) to sway another intelligent creature's attitude towards you.

Wit (*Charisma*) to influence another intelligent creature's immediate behavior or beliefs.

Wizard

(Human Magic-User)



Class Features
Prime Ability: Intelligence
Hit Die: d6+Con

Recommended Starting Equipment
Spellbook, dagger, quarterstaff, robes, potion belt, dungeoneer’s kit

Martial Training
Wizards are not familiar with any non-simple weapons or armor. Additionally, wearing any armor at all interferes with their ability to prepare and cast arcane magic.

Talent Training
At levels 2 and 6, you gain training in **Lore**; at levels 4 and 8, you gain training in **Science**.

Arcane Spellcasting
You begin play with a spellbook, which holds a number of different spells of various circles determined by the referee. As you find other spellbooks or spell scrolls in the dungeon, you may copy them into your own spellbook.

Each sunrise or sunset, you can prepare a number of arcane spells from your spellbook based on your level, which you can cast during the day. Once a spell is cast, it becomes un-prepared. You can prepare spells of a lower circle than indicated.

Preparing During Exploration
You can prepare spells during exploration, if you have an empty preparation of a suitable circle. This takes a number of Science checks equal to the spell’s circle; each roll takes one turn spent studying a spellbook with the chosen spell and applying its arcana.

Cantrips
Each spell also gives you a cantrip, which is a smaller version of the spell that can be cast at-will without un-preparing the spell.

Arcane Rituals
You can also cast arcane spells from your spellbook as rituals; each ritual takes one turn per circle. You may perform any spell up to a circle of half your level (round up) as a ritual. Each round that you perform a ritual requires a Science check, or the ritual fails. If each roll succeeds, a ritual's effect happens on the next turn after it is completed.

Arcane Magic and Armor
If you wear light armor, you can maintain one fewer preparation of each circle that you can prepare. If you wear medium or heavy armor, you cannot cast prepared spells at all.

Arcane Spell Preparations					
Level	First	Second	Third	Fourth	Fifth Circle
1	1	-	-	-	-
2	2	-	-	-	-
3	2	1	-	-	-
4	2	2	-	-	-
5	2	2	1	-	-
6	2	2	2	-	-
7		3	2	1	-
8		2	2	2	-
9			3	2	1

Priest

(Human Magic-User)



Class Features

Prime Ability: Charisma
Hit Die: d6+Con

Recommended Starting Equipment

Quarterstaff, medium armor, prayer book, holy symbol, dungeoneer’s kit

Martial Training

Priests are not familiar with any non-simple weapons or armor.

Talent Training

At levels 2 and 6, you gain training in **Intuition**; at levels 4 and 8, you gain training in **Bearing**.

Prayer Strip Preparations					
Level	First	Second	Third	Fourth	Fifth Circle
1	1	-	-	-	-
2	2	-	-	-	-
3	2	1	-	-	-
4	2	2	-	-	-
5	2	2	1	-	-
6	2	2	2	-	-
7		3	2	1	-
8		2	2	2	-
9			3	2	1

Divine Miracles

Each sunrise and sunset, you can prepare a number of divine miracles into prayer strips based on your level, which you can use to during the day perform their associated miracles. Once a miracle is performed, its prayer strip burns to ash.

Choose a domain of faith. You may perform miracles of the associated domain, as well as common miracles, using any prayer strip of the same or higher circle - regardless of what miracle was prepared into it.

Preparing During Exploration

You can prepare during exploration, if you have an empty preparation of a suitable circle. This takes a number of Bearing checks equal to the miracle’s circle; each roll takes one turn spent in intense prayer.

Rebuking the Unholy

You can flourish a holy symbol and make a Bearing check to attempt to drive back every unholy creature within a 5-pace cone with fewer hit dice than your own. Each affected target functionally becomes panicked for as long as you focus, even if it is normally immune to fear-based effects. If you are fifth level or higher, any affected targets with only one hit die are destroyed or banished, instead of driven back. At ninth level, affected targets with two hit dice are destroyed as well.

Divine Rituals

You can also perform miracles from your prayerbook as divine rituals; each ritual takes one turn per circle. You may perform any miracle up to a circle of half your level (round up) as a ritual. Each round that you perform a ritual requires a Bearing check, or the ritual fails. If each roll succeeds, a ritual's effect happens on the next turn after it is completed.

Sworn Oaths

Divine blessings can bestow semi-permanent effects on anyone who swears and upholds a particular oath as the ritual is performed. Any blessing requiring focus to maintain can be maintained instead via sworn oath. Violating that oath will immediately reverse the effects of the blessing into a curse that can only be removed once you have atoned.

Dwarven Classes

Stalwart

(Dwarf Fighter)



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Constitution*

Hit Die: *d6+Con+2*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Ax, crossbow, heavy armor, shield, dungeoneer's kit

Martial Training

Stalwarts are familiar with every kind of weapon, armor, and shield. Additionally, you may wield medium and heavy weapons as if you were a medium-sized creature.

Improved Critical Hit

If your attack throw threshold is 9+ or better, you achieve a critical hit whenever your attack throw beats your threshold by 10 or more.

Indefatigable

Your saving throws vs. Doom, Hold, and Fear are easier.

Fighter's Feats

At level 2, you gain the Deflect Blows fighter feat, and at level 4, you gain the Defender fighter feat. At levels 6 and 8, choose one of the fighter feats from page 13 that you have not already gained.

Delver

(Dwarf Expert)



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Wisdom*

Hit Die: *d6+Con+1*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Pickaxe, light crossbow, medium armor, potion belt, dungeoneer's kit

Martial Training

Delvers are familiar with every kind of weapon, armor, and shield.

Talent Training

Each time you gain a level, you gain training in your choice of **Finesse**, **Science**, **Alertness**, or **Survival**. At levels 5 and 9, you may instead gain training in any one talent of your choice.

Armored Stealth

Your **Stealth** checks are not penalized when you wear medium armor which has been properly fitted and prepared to not reflect light or make noise. You can prepare armor with a **Finesse** check as an exploration action.

Stonesense

When in a natural cave, or any other structure comprised primarily of stone, you may spend one turn tapping the walls with a hard object and listening carefully, then make a **Survival** check to map out the area for 5 paces in all directions. You can even detect passageways on the other side of solid walls. If there are any mechanisms built into the walls of this area, a hard **Alertness** check will detect them all.

Dweomersmith (Dwarf Magic-User)



Class Features

Prime Ability: Intelligence

Hit Die: d6+Con+1

Recommended Starting Equipment

Hammer, crossbow, heavy armor, potion belt, smith's tools, artisan's tools, dungeoneer's kit

Martial Training

Dweomersmiths are familiar with every kind of weapon, armor, and shield.

Talent Training

At levels 2 and 6, you gain training in **Finesse**; at levels 4 and 8, you gain training in **Science**.

Dweomercraft

You begin play with a craftbook, which holds two common alchemical formulae and two common magic item blueprints. As you find other formulae or blueprints in the dungeon, you may copy them into your own craftbook.

Each sunrise or sunset, you can prepare dweomers from your craftbook, which are volatile alchemical formulae or magic item enchantments. You can choose to prepare dweomers of a lower rarity than indicated.

Preparing During Exploration

You can prepare alchemy dweomers during exploration, if you have fewer than your maximum number of dweomers prepared; or you may use this feat to recharge a dweomer magic item of the appropriate rarity that has expended its charge. This takes a number of successful Science checks equal to the item or dweomer's rarity; each roll is one turn spent studying your craftbook while you enchant the dweomer.

Dweomersmith Rituals

You can also perform certain dweomers from your craftbook as rituals; each first-circle ritual takes one turn. At third level, you can also perform second-circle rituals, each of which takes two turns; at fifth level, you can perform third-circle rituals, which take three turns. Each round that you perform a ritual requires a Science check, or the ritual fails. If each roll succeeds, a ritual's effect happens on the next turn after it is completed.

Dweomer Preparations			
Level	Common	Uncommon	Rare
1	1	-	-
2	2	-	-
3	2	1	-
4	2	2	-
5	2	2	1
6	2	2	2
7		4	2
8		3	3
9			6

Fey and Barbarian Classes

Champion [Fey Fighter]



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Strength*

Hit Die: *d6+Con+2*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Greatsword, light armor

Martial Training

Champions are familiar with all weapons and shields, but only light armor.

Improved Critical Hit

If your attack throw threshold is 9+ or better, you achieve a critical hit whenever your attack throw beats your threshold by 10 or more.

Battle-Trance

Beginning at level 2, as you attack another creature with a melee weapon, you can enter a battle-trance that lasts until the end of combat. If you hit with that attack, anyone within 10 paces that can see you must save vs. fear or be frightened of you until the end of combat.

While in a battle-trance, you cannot evade or perform task actions, but your saving throws vs. Fear automatically succeed, and you add your level to your melee attack damage rolls.

Fighter Feats

At levels 4, 6, and 8, choose one of the fighter feats from page 13.

Champion Initiations

At level 2, choose one of the following Champion initiations, gaining all of its effects whenever you enter a battle-trance. Elves always choose the Mystic initiation, while beastfolk always choose an animal initiation appropriate to their form.

Mystic

A mystic champion may roll Agility while guarding in battle-trance to deflect a melee or ranged attack with their bare hands, if that attack passes within reach. If they succeed, they may immediately make an attack throw to redirect the attack to any target within the original attacker's reach if they deflect a melee attack, or to any target within 5 paces of the champion if they deflect a ranged attack.

Bear

A Bear champion halves all damage received while frenzying if they are not wearing armor.

Boar

A Boar champion achieves a critical hit on a charge attack while frenzying if any of their damage dice match or beat their Agility.

Panther

A Panther champion who frenzies while unarmored and wielding only light melee weapons may make two attacks per round - one fast attack, and one slow attack.

Raven

A Raven champion doubles their movement speed while in frenzy if unencumbered and unarmored, and adds their level to their ranged weapon attack damage rolls.

Serpent

A Serpent champion can sneak and hide while in frenzy, can perform a sneak attack while hidden, and can charge from hiding.

Shark

A frenzying Shark champion doubles their swimming speed, and their melee attacks against injured creatures are easier.

Wolf

When a frenzying Wolf champion declares a melee attack, all other attacks made against the champion's target this round are easier.

Hunter

(Fey Expert)



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Dexterity*

Hit Die: *d6+Con*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Shortbow, two daggers, light armor

Martial Training

Hunters are familiar with every kind of weapon, but only simple (non-heavy) armor.

Talent Training

Each time you gain a level, you gain training in your choice of **Agility**, **Stealth**, **Alertness**, or **Survival**. At levels 5 and 9, you may instead gain training in any one talent of your choice.

Hunter's Expertise

Tracking and navigating (**Survival**) are particularly easy for you. You automatically succeed at any tracking or navigation task that another class could attempt at a normal difficulty, while tasks that are impossible for other classes, such as retracing the actions and condition of a creature merely by studying its tracks, navigating merely by the patterns of the local terrain and wildlife, or befriending and training an undomesticated wild animal, are rolled at normal difficulty for you.

Sneak Attack

You use your ranged attack threshold when you attack a target that is not aware of you, and the attack is a critical hit if each of its damage dice exceeds your Stealth threshold.

Bard

(Fey Expert)



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Charisma*

Hit Die: *d6+Con*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Two daggers, quarterstaff, medium armor, musical instrument

Martial Training

Bards are not familiar with any non-simple weapons or armor.

Talent Training

Each time you gain a level, you gain training in your choice of **Finesse**, **Lore**, **Charm**, or **Wit**. At levels 5 and 9, you may instead gain training in any one talent of your choice.

Bardsong

Starting at second level, whenever you focus entirely on singing or playing music, you can weave any Dream or Song glamour effect into the performance with a circle up to half your level (round down). Playing a bardsong requires a number of successful **Charm** checks equal to the glamour's circle; each check takes one round.

Magical Intuition

You may make a **Lore** check to attempt to activate any magic item or prepared magic, regardless of origin. Common items are easy to activate, while rare items are hard; prepared magic of a circle less than half your level is at normal difficulty, while prepared magic of a circle up to your level is at hard difficulty.

Druid

(Fey Magic-User)



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Wisdom*

Hit Die: *d6+Con*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Quarterstaff, dagger, light armor, potion belt

Martial Training

Druids are not familiar with any non-simple weapons or armor. Additionally, wearing steel armor or wielding a steel weapon will interfere with their ability to prepare and cast primal magic.

Talent Training

At levels 2 and 6, you gain training in **Medicine**; at levels 4 and 8, you gain training in **Survival**.

Primal Druidcraft

You begin play having learned four first-circle druid glamours or wild shapes. Unlike a wizard, you do not need a spellbook to prepare glamours; once you learn a glamour, you know how to prepare it from memory.

You may learn new glamours from druids, wisps, fair folk, or intelligent fey beasts willing to teach them to you, and may learn new wild shape glamours by communing with the natural animals or fey beasts that you wish to transform into. If your total glamours known exceeds the limit based on your level, you must forget one known glamour or wild shape whenever you learn a new one.

Each sunrise or sunset, you can prepare a number of primal glamours into talismans based on your level, which you can cast during the day. Once a glamour is cast, its talisman becomes un-prepared. You can prepare glamours of a lower circle than indicated.

Preparing During Exploration

You can prepare primal glamours during exploration, if you have an empty talisman of a suitable circle and element. This takes a number of Survival checks equal to the chosen glamour's circle; each roll takes one turn spent preparing the talisman.

Wisps

You may also befriend tiny elemental fey spirits, called wisps. By investing preparation into a wisp, you enable it to perform any one elemental glamour on your behalf, up to that preparation's circle.

Primal Rituals

You can also perform primal glamours as rituals; each ritual takes one turn per circle. You may perform any glamour that you know as a ritual. Each turn that you perform a ritual requires a Survival check, or the ritual fails. If each roll succeeds, a ritual's effect happens on the next turn after it is completed.

Primal Magic and Iron

If are touching iron or steel, or if you have any iron or steel items on your person, you cannot prepare or cast any primal glamours.

Glamour Preparations					
Level	First	Second	Third	Fourth	Known
1	1	-	-	-	4
2	2	-	-	-	6
3	2	1	-	-	8
4	2	2	-	-	10
5	2	2	1	-	12
6	2	2	2	-	15
7		3	2	1	20
8		2	2	2	30
9			3	3	All



Beginning An Adventure

The first step in any adventure story is getting there. The world in a fantasy adventure game is a vast and dangerous place which must be navigated carefully; although ancient roads built by long-forgotten empires may cross the landscape, often no one has maintained them for generations, and any that are well-traveled enough to be clear of debris and animal predators often hide bandits and cutthroats instead.

Overland Travel

Overland travel happens in four-hour shifts. Each day of travel has a budget of about 8 hours of labor that can be reasonably expected of the party, split into two such shifts; any more than that and the party can expect to become fatigued in short order.

A typical day of travel looks like this: the party wakes up about an hour before dawn, and begins the normal daily preparation - including donning armor, preparing spells or prayers, or any other relevant pre-adventuring activities. After two hours of preparation and breakfast, camp is broken down over another hour, and the party readies for travel. The party then travels steadily for four hours, then breaks for two hours to eat, rest, and consult their maps. Then a second shift of travel, and then the party spends an hour setting up camp before retiring for the evening.

Marches and Leagues

Maps copied from the Old Empire's survey records are typically divided into hexes for convenience, with each large hex measuring a twenty-four mile march, subdivided into eight three-mile leagues; on a well-traveled road with no hazards or interruptions, a well-stocked adventuring party can expect to cross a single league in about an hour, and a single march in one day.

Difficult terrain, heavy burdens, or bad weather might cause the party to become bogged down within a hex, requiring an Agility or Survival check to make any further progress. Each member of the party must succeed for the group to be able to advance; the group may attempt clever solutions to make the roll easier or aid the rolls of the less athletically-inclined members.

Navigating

Before each four-hour shift of travel, the party should declare who is navigating, who is keeping watch, and who is attending to other duties. The referee makes a secret Survival test on behalf of each navigator at the start of the shift, to determine whether the party becomes lost.

Stealth - The party may choose to employ stealth while traveling, halving their speed. For each league of travel that the party moves through stealthily, each character rolls a Stealth check with difficulty determined by the terrain and each character's armor and encumbrance. If everyone in the party succeeds at their Stealth checks, then they surprise any random encounter that they stumble across.

Forced March - The party can attempt to force-march through a league, allowing them to attempt two league-crossings in one hour; each time they do so, each member of the party must succeed at a Survival check or suffer 1d6 damage. Terrain and the encumbrance of each party member might make this test easier or harder; it gets consecutively harder for each additional shift of travel without a full day of rest, or each further hour of forced march.

Third Shift - In addition to forced march, a party may decide to attempt a third shift of travel, granting them an additional 4 hours of travel in a day. A third shift also requires a Survival check to avoid damage.

Random Encounters

Each league of travel comes with the chance of a random encounter. The nature of those potential encounters, and the probability that they occur, is different from one league to another. The referee will typically have a random encounter table that lists the chance of encounter for a given area, and will roll one or two d6's for each league of travel; if an encounter occurs, travel stops as the party deals with the situation.

If either party succeeded at moving stealthily, then each member of the other party who was keeping watch rolls Alertness. If they all fail, they are surprised by the encounter.

Line of Sight

Line of sight on perfectly flat terrain and on a clear day only extends for about a league. This means that, barring terrain or weather, the party can usually see midway into the next hex when standing in the middle of a hex, and can fully survey an adjacent hex when standing at its border.

Of course, perfectly flat terrain and perfectly fair weather are almost unheard of deep in the wilds. Fog and precipitation will obscure line of sight, preventing the party from seeing out of their hex; vegetation and various terrain features will also be noted as blocking line of sight across a hex boundary.

Surveying an adjacent hex will likely make the party's Survival check to cross that league easier; the referee is encouraged to be descriptive when detailing the landscape, and the party is encouraged to be descriptive in how they intend to overcome the challenges that they see.

Lookouts

Various points on the map will be designated as lookouts. A lookout is an elevated vantage point that the party could reasonably get to and survey the local landscape.

Weather permitting, a lookout allows the party to see one or even two leagues away in certain directions. A lookout will note both what directions it provides a view in, and the difficulty of any Agility check needed for a creature to ascend it (easy, average, or hard). Detouring onto a lookout typically costs about an hour of travel.

Artificial structures such as watchtowers also dot the landscape, which provide stairs or ladders to easily scale them, and serve as lookouts in all directions when the weather is clear. If a member of the party has a device such as a spyglass, then using it while atop a watchtower might allow them to thoroughly survey an adjacent hex, automatically noticing any terrain features or points of interest that aren't expressly hidden without the need for a task check.

Exploring a Hex

Sometimes, a particular one-league hex merits closer attention paid to it. The next section, Exploration, describes the process primarily as it pertains to a dungeon setting, but any exploration action can also be taken in the wilds. Generally, the referee will subdivide a one-league hex map into half-mile "sub-hexes" and again into 100-pace "exploration zones"; the party can cross five exploration zones (one sub-hex) of clear terrain in one ten-minute exploration turn at a walking pace, or they can spend an entire ten minutes thoroughly investigating a single exploration zone (rolling Alertness, Survival, or any other necessary talents as described in the next section). Many adventures expect the party to explore various hexes, in order to discover hidden lookouts or dungeon entrances.

Tracking, Foraging, and Hunting

Within an exploration zone, characters can forage for food or other resources, or can search for tracks or other clues that another creature has passed through the area. Each of these activities is an exploration action that requires a Survival check, with a difficulty based on the circumstances and the terrain being searched. For example, finding tracks on otherwise untouched snow or similar soft ground is easy, while finding tracks on bare rock with no other clues is hard. Fresh tracks that were laid within the last hour are easier to find, while tracks laid a day or more ago are harder.

Once tracks are found, gathering information from them is another exploration action and Survival check, at a difficulty one level harder than finding the tracks. If the character who finds the tracks has expertise in Survival, that expertise allows them to identify and gather all relevant information from a set of tracks in the same exploration action that they find them. The information that can be gathered includes the kind of creature or object that made the track, how old the tracks are, what direction they went in, as well as any other information the referee deems discoverable.

Foraging and hunting within an exploration zone is also an exploration action requiring a Survival check, with a difficulty that depends on both the terrain and the abundance of the resource being gathered.

Exploring the Dungeon

A party of adventurers explores a dungeon in ten-minute intervals, called turns. During an exploration turn, each player describes to the referee the action that their character is performing, and then the referee dialogs with them until both sides agree about what is being attempted. The referee then has each character roll whichever of their character's talents the referee deems most appropriate for that action, against a difficulty determined by the nature of the task being attempted. This continues until each player character has performed their action, and then the referee describes the results of the party's actions and a new turn begins.

As mentioned previously, exploration is not limited to the dungeon; the party is welcome to explore areas of open wilderness as well. When they do, the "dungeon" referred to in this chapter refers to an "exploration zone" about a hundred paces across in any direction.

Exploration Actions

Players should be encouraged to describe their characters' actions as creatively and thoroughly as possible. The majority of an exploration turn should happen in a freeform fashion, with the referee describing the basics of what the party immediately sees, hears, smells, and so on as the result of their last actions, and the party then deciding what to do about that information.

Whenever possible, the referee's descriptions will be everything that the player characters can directly perceive, mediated by their Alertness and the limitations of their senses; the players' descriptions will be what their characters do for the next 10 minutes, described in free-form. The referee will then determine for each character's action whether a proficiency test is called for, and direct their players to make any required rolls. Then the next round of exploration begins with the referee's next set of descriptions, which the players respond to with their next set of actions, and so on.

Torchlight and Visibility

A typical lantern will provide enough light to illuminate 10 paces in every direction reasonably well, and illuminate out to 20 paces dimly. This sets a natural movement speed for dungeon exploration at about 100' (20 paces) per exploration turn, limited more by safety and visibility than actual speed. In daylight in the wilderness, the party can reasonably move through up to a half mile (500 paces) per turn.

Torches will typically last 1d6+1 turns, but might require a Finesse check to stay lit if the party is moving quickly or performing complex and risky activities like climbing cliff faces or dodging traps. Lanterns will usually last a full day on one flask of oil, and are easier to keep lit during activities.

Entering a New Area

When the party first enters a new area of the dungeon, the referee should describe to them what they experience at first glance. No rolls are made at this time, but the referee will adjust the level of detail of their description based on the lighting and the characters' Alertness; better Alertness will mean more small details are noticed immediately. Anything "important-looking" within 50 feet (10 paces) or so should be described in moderate detail, with brief descriptions of anything further away, depending on the lighting conditions.

Moving Around

Within an area, the characters can move relatively freely during a turn. A character can move 20 paces and still perform an action, or move 100 times their dash speed as their full exploration action. Areas of difficult terrain, or areas that require extensive climbing, swimming, or jumping to get to, might require an Agility check to navigate.

If the player characters' movements activate a trap, a hazard, or a random encounter with monsters, the referee will stop the action mid-round and describe what is happening, then switch to a combat encounter.

Stealth

The party may choose to move at half speed in order to employ stealth. Each member of the party rolls Stealth, and each monster that is on watch that might notice them rolls Alertness. Medium or heavy armor and being encumbered each make Stealth harder, while intervening walls and distracting background noises make Alertness harder. The party will manage to evade alerting nearby monsters with the sound of their movements either if everyone's Stealth check succeeds, or if each monsters' Alertness check fails. If at least one Stealth roll fails and at least one Alertness check succeeds, though, the monsters are alerted and will move to investigate.

Torchlight and other sources of illumination are another matter. Wandering monsters that can see will obviously be alerted to the party's presence if they can see the party's lights and shadows flickering along the walls; choosing between seeing and being seen is a problem that the party will have to figure out as they explore the dungeon.

Watching for Trouble

It's a good idea to have at least one member of the party "on watch" during each round of exploration. Each character on watch rolls an Alertness check to spot any approaching trouble — posting a watch means that if a random encounter occurs, at least someone in the party is likely to be able to act without being surprised. Monster groups will also typically have a few creatures designated as "on watch", which the referee will manage.

Random Encounters

Encounters can happen randomly, either while navigating the wilderness or exploring the dungeon. The referee should make a random encounter roll after the party declares their actions. The referee secretly rolls a single d6, or possibly two d6s and chooses the higher or lower die based on the amount of noise, smell, light, and so on that the party is making. If no event is rolled, then the party continues on with their next round of exploration.

D6 Encounter Check	
1-4	No Event
5	Approaching Encounter (within 10 minutes)
6	Random Encounter!

Starting an Encounter

If an encounter or approaching encounter is rolled, the referee rolls on the appropriate Random Encounter table for the party's current location to determine the encounter group, then determines which members of the encounter group were on watch, and whether that group was moving stealthily. The referee then makes Alertness and Stealth checks for the encounter group and compares them with the Alertness and Stealth checks of the party during the exploration turn, to see whether either group notices the other.

If an approaching encounter result is rolled, any party that has been alerted to the other has a full exploration turn to prepare for the upcoming encounter, and the Alertness checks of anyone "on watch" at this time will be easier. If neither party was alerted to the other (due to everyone succeeding at Stealth checks and failing at Alertness checks), then both parties stumble into each other as if the random encounter result had been rolled instead.

If the random encounter result is rolled, the referee announces the encounter to the party, adjusting the level of detail based on the net results of the Stealth and Alertness checks made immediately prior. Creatures whose Stealth or Alertness checks succeed get to act in an additional first round of combat, called the "surprise round", while everyone else is effectively stunned. After the surprise round, everyone on both sides can act during each subsequent round.

Random encounters don't just mean monsters; some are environmental, such as a storm or cave-in. Regardless of the nature of the event, a hazardous encounter switches the party from tracking time in 10-minute exploration turns into 6-second combat rounds.

Also keep in mind that random encounters that are monsters do not necessarily have to end in a fight — depending on the monsters' reactions to the players, a social encounter might unfold instead. Of course, there is nothing keeping the player characters, or the monsters, from turning that social encounter into a combat encounter mid-conversation.

Searching for Traps, Hazards, and Secrets

One of the more common actions during exploration is searching for, and disabling or otherwise overcoming, traps and hazards within the dungeon. A hazard is a natural difficulty within the dungeon that must be overcome, such as a crumbling stone bridge or a deep chasm with sheer walls, while a trap is a deliberately constructed hazard, usually with some mechanism of activation.

Traps and hazards may be obvious or hidden. An obvious trap or hazard is noticeable as soon as the party has line of sight to it; any hidden traps or hazards must be detected with Alertness checks.

Generally, the process of searching for hidden features should be spelled out in detail (if a player declares "I search for traps" as their action, the proper response from the referee should be "okay, how?"), with those details interacting with the nature of the trap to determine difficulty. A well-hidden trap might be naturally hard to search for, but might be easy instead if the player notices the right details from the room's description and focuses their attention in the right place.

Properly described searches might very well set a difficulty of automatic, with no roll necessary; if the players figure out a particular puzzle simply from the initial description given to them, the referee should simply reward them for their ingenuity and move on. Likewise, if they are simply not searching in the right area or using the right methods at all, the difficulty is impossible and no d6 task check is required. It's only when a search action has some degree of risk or chance involved that a player should roll their character's Alertness (or possibly another talent, such as Finesse or Science) to see if they succeed.

An Alertness check to search for traps also searches for hidden doors or passages; if a door is discovered, it may turn out to be open, locked, barred, or blocked. Finding a hidden door is much like finding a hidden trap; there is a default difficulty for noticing it during any search, while a search that focuses on the right area and uses the right methods should be easier or even automatic.

Overcoming Natural Hazards

Most natural hazards can be avoided or overcome with an Agility check or a strength check. Clever solutions might instead involve "dungeoneering" something clever out of available materials and resources; the referee will assign d6 task checks and difficulties appropriate to the players' descriptions.

Kicking In Doors and Moving Obstacles

Barred doors, blocked hallways, and the like often do not have any way to 'pick' them; instead, they must be overcome with strength checks, in a fashion similar to overcoming a hazard. Unlike a hazard, failing to overcome a barred door or blocked hallway will usually not trigger an attack or inflict damage, unless there is a hidden hazard or trap built into the blockage. The threshold for the strength check depends on the obstruction; breaking down a thin wooden door might be a 3+, while clearing a massive boulder wedged into a cave passage could be as high as 7+. Applying leverage might make a strength check easier or harder depending on the method used, based on the referee's judgment. Multiple creatures can apply their strength at once to such a task; each creature's attempt might be easy or hard based on their technique and positioning, and then their check results all add together vs. the obstacle's threshold.

Disarming Traps

Traps with at least some physical parts can usually be disabled with a Finesse check. The difficulty of this test is determined by the complexity of the hazard or trap, and by how much effort the trap-maker went to conceal its inner workings.

If the party stops to examine the trap in detail first, a successful Science check might reveal some clues as to its principle of operations, which might suggest specific approaches to disarming it that might make the Finesse check to do so easier.

If the party fails to disable a trap, or simply chooses not to, the trap will usually make some kind of attack. This attack will usually be easier (or the saving throw against it harder) if the trap was undiscovered, or vice-versa if the trap was both discovered and successfully inspected before being triggered.

Picking Locks

A locked door, whether hidden or obvious, must either be unlocked with the proper key, picked, or bashed in. Unlocking a lock with the proper key is usually a simple task, but might occasionally require a Finesse test to get the sequence right. Picking a lock operates identically to disarming a trap – mechanical locks are first inspected, then picked with a Finesse roll. Obvious locks will sometimes have hidden traps, which activate and attack anyone trying to inspect or pick them. If no one explicitly searches the lock for hidden traps, then they activate them automatically when they first attempt to pick the lock. Otherwise, disabling the trap before picking the lock proceeds normally, after which the lock may be safely picked.

Dungeoneering

The party may create obstructions and traps, rather than removing them. Barring doors or blocking passages with heavy objects are typically feats of strength, while locking doors is often as simple as turning a latch – although some locks may need to be ‘unpicked’ back into a locking position if the key isn’t found. Glamours such as shape earth can make the creation and clearing of hazards trivial, and spells such as forceful hand can be used to perform necessary feats of strength.

Whenever the party adjusts the layout of the dungeon, either by opening new passageways or blocking them off, the referee should note the changes on their map and adjust the behavior of any patrolling or wandering monsters as necessary. Wise adventurers will be careful about leaving a trail through the dungeon, which hostile monsters might use to track them down and ambush them.

Hiding the results of dungeoneering is itself a dungeoneering task, creating a situation where the monsters now need to be as weary of hidden traps as the players. Of course, if the players don’t bother to mark on their maps where they placed hidden traps, or don’t bother to check those maps when re-entering a room, it is certainly not the referee’s job to remind them.

Crafting Traps and Hazards

Players can, of course, construct traps as well as disabling them. Constructing a mechanical trap begins with the player describing the kind of trap they wish to construct, followed by a Science check to design the mechanisms, followed by a series of Finesse checks to construct each component. Feats of strength might also be required to dig out areas or haul large components into place.

Once the trap is set up, the referee determines the base difficulties to detect, inspect, and disable the trap, and the nature of the attack that the trap will perform, based on the results of the designer’s Science check and the builders’ Finesse checks. If the designer stays to inspect the work as it progresses, the referee should give them feedback about the detect, inspect, and disable difficulties, and the details of the trap’s attack, to allow them to make adjustments to the design or focus more attention on specific sections to improve.

Repairing Ruined Wonders

One of the primary tasks for an adventuring team will be appraising the condition of ruined wonders, and – if possible – restoring them to their former glory. Understanding the purpose of a ruined wonder is a Lore check; inspecting it for damage, once its purpose is understood, is a Science check. Succeeding at both gives the party some idea of what repairs will be necessary, and what level of functionality can be expected if they succeed.

Repairs will usually involve constructing multiple special-purpose magic artifacts of varying rarity; each such artifact will likely require its own material sub-components, leading to a series of quests to locate, acquire, and refine those sub-components before forging each component artifact. Then, each of those component artifacts must be properly installed into the facility, after which the party must learn to activate and operate that facility.

Default Mechanism Difficulty and Finesse Expertise

Scouts, Delvers and Dweamersmiths are the three classes with expertise in Finesse; picking locks and disabling traps is part of their basic class training. The difficulty for picking a lock or disabling a trap is assumed to be the difficulty for a Finesse expert to attempt it; anyone without this expertise will at least have a harder time with their Finesse check.

Social Encounters

During an adventure, the party should engage with other creatures. Not all of these interactions need to resort to violence; in fact, most of them probably shouldn't.

Non-Player Characters

Each non-player character has its own goals, motivations, and needs, and the party can choose to leverage those in service to its own. Non-player characters track abilities, saving throws, talents, and hit points as if they were player characters.

Attitude

One of the more important aspects of a non-player character is their attitude towards the party. Attitude is a spectrum that typically ranges from hostile to helpful - a hostile NPC will attack or attempt to harm the player characters on sight if at all possible, while a helpful NPC will try to help the party in any way they can, if doing so isn't directly harmful to themselves or their other interests. The player characters generally don't need to make social tests for any creature that is hostile or helpful; it's the attitudes in between that are most relevant in a social encounter.

An NPC that is neither hostile nor helpful can be unfriendly, indifferent, or friendly. Unfriendly NPCs will be "disinclined to acquiesce" to any request made of them, while friendly NPCs will tend to help if they can do so without any particular inconvenience on their part. Honest bargaining with unfriendly NPCs is usually harder, while honest bargaining with friendly NPCs is usually easier. Deception, coercion, and bribery can mitigate an unfriendly NPC's attitude, of course, just as clear disrespect or a bad deal can negate the advantages of bargaining with friendly creatures.

Unless otherwise specified, the referee will roll a 2d6 to determine a creature's attitude, modified by its nature and circumstances.

2d6 Attitude	Effects
2-3 Hostile	Likely to attack on sight
4-5 Unfriendly	Likely to hinder the party
6-8 Indifferent	Pursues their own goals
9-10 Friendly	Likely to help the party
11-12 Helpful	Helps if not too dangerous

Influencing NPCs

If a player character has a chance to greet an NPC in a non-hostile manner, the player and referee should roleplay out the first few minutes of engagement before having the player make their first Charm check, with a difficulty based on their performance. The result will determine that NPC's "first impression", which will adjust that NPC's 2d6 Attitude roll up or down accordingly. From that point forward, whenever you interact with that NPC during an exploration turn, you can focus your attention on a goal (getting the NPC to perform some task for you) or you can focus your attention on the relationship (cultivating the NPC's attitude to be more friendly to you).

Focusing on the relationship means you'll make a Charm test as your exploration action, while focusing on the goal means you'll make a Wit check. If the NPC is suspicious, they might make a saving throw vs. Trick or Fear to resist your Charm or Wit, negating your attempt if they succeed. Each side's roll will be made harder or easier by the actual words and actions exchanged.

A successful Charm action won't influence the NPC's actions directly, but will temporarily improve their attitude by one step - and if this leads to them choosing to act in your interest and doing so turns out well for them, that improvement in attitude might become permanent if cultivated further.

A successful Wit action, on the other hand, will convince the NPC to do or believe what you want them to, but won't influence their attitude - and if the result of their subsequent actions turns out badly for them, it's likely to worsen their attitude towards you in the future unless you repair the broken trust. The NPC's current attitude corresponds directly to the difficulty of a Wit test needed to convince them of anything, absent other circumstances.

In certain circumstances, where you are simply coercing an NPC through threats and stubbornness, you might make a Bearing check instead of a Wit check to force their action, but doing so is almost guaranteed to worsen their attitude; in other situations, an already friendly NPC might be convinced to help you of their own accord through sheer Charm and friendliness.

Recruiting Followers

Each player character can collect a retinue of followers, limited by their Bearing.

Bearing	Maximum Followers
6+	1
5+	2
4+	3
3+	4
2+	5

if gaining a new follower causes a player character's retinue to exceed their Bearing, that character finds it harder to manage all their followers until they let enough of them go to fall under the limit.

To recruit a new follower, the player character first presents their case; if the referee deems it sufficiently convincing for that particular creature, the player makes a Charm check at a difficulty based on the appeal of the offer and the prospective recruit's current attitude; on a success, the NPC decides to join the retinue. Demonstrated loyalty and offered incentives make this check easier, while extenuating circumstances may make it harder.

Keep a few personality notes about each follower NPC in your party's retinues; giving each of the party's followers a distinct voice and personality goes a long way towards fostering immersion and engagement.

Hirelings

The simplest way to gain followers is to pay them. The minimum pay that any civilized follower will expect for their services is one silver dinar per day; most will also expect at least a half-share of any treasure found.

Follower Loyalty

Each member of the party's retinue is an NPC under the control of the referee. Helpful followers will obey orders to the best of their ability, while merely friendly followers might weigh the potential risks and rewards before jumping into a dangerous situation. Followers whose attitudes fall to indifferent have become unhappy with their lot, and are likely to abandon the group at the first opportunity; a follower whose temperament falls all the way to unfriendly or hostile will most likely actively mutiny, possibly violently, as soon as they see a good opportunity to do so.

Follower Morale

Followers need to make morale checks at various times, such as when placed in direct danger or asked to perform a task that goes against their own nature or judgment. Morale checks are saving throws vs. Fear, with a difficulty based on the follower's loyalty.

A disgruntled follower will typically bring the mood of the entire party down, sowing dissension and distrust among the ranks. The player character leading the retinue finds all tests managing any followers with an attitude other than Helpful harder as long as at least one follower is actively Unfriendly or Hostile, and all morale checks for each of their followers are similarly affected.

Directing Followers

Bearing is also used to determine whether followers obey orders when under duress, in dangerous or stressful situations, or when the orders are unclear or complex. A Bearing check can be made in most situations to quickly determine if plans go awry due to lack of coordination or failures in morale; this check will be normal difficulty for naturally Friendly followers, easy for Helpful followers, or hard for Indifferent followers.

Beast Companions

In addition to followers, player characters with expertise in Survival can gain a second retinue of beast companions - using their Survival rather than Bearing to determine the total hit dice worth of trained animals that they can manage. Other player characters who do not have expertise in Survival might gain a trained domesticated animal as a companion at the referee's discretion (usually a riding mount or trained hunting dogs).

Beast companions are under the referee's control, acting on their own initiative and using their own movement and action as normal. They will usually obey the commands of their handler to the best of their understanding, training, and temperament.

Riding mounts can usually be commanded by the rider as part of their action in combat, if the mount has sufficient temperament and training to take direction well. Controlling a less compliant mount requires the rider's full action, if it is even possible.

Combat Encounters

When combat begins, each creature that isn't surprised gets to act in the first round, which is also called the *surprise round*. After the surprise round is over, all creatures in the encounter who are capable of action may do so.

Combat Actions

Each creature that can act declares their action at the start of the round. Possible actions are:

Attack (speed: per weapon) – move up to 5 paces and make a weapon attack. Making a ranged weapon attack or attempting to move out of melee will provoke attacks of opportunity.

Dash (speed: normal) – move up to 20 paces if unencumbered, or up to 10 paces if encumbered.

Evade (speed: fast) – move up to 5 paces, and it is harder to hit you for the rest of this round. You must be unencumbered and have a Dexterity of +1 or better to evade.

Guard (speed: fast) – You can perform one opportunity attack each phase, and you may move up to 2 paces between each phase. Only fighter classes can guard.

Magic (speed: slow) – Attempt to cast a spell, glamour, or miracle, or use a magic item. You must declare what you are attempting to cast, and you cannot move while casting.

Task (speed: normal) – perform some other action (such as attempting to hide, or interacting with the environment in some way). The referee will determine whether you can also move.

Order of Actions

After each creature declares their action, combat proceeds in three phases. First, all fast actions occur; then, all normal actions occur, and finally, all slow actions occur. Actions will normally happen simultaneously; if the order of two actions in a single phase matters, each acting creature can make a Dexterity check, with the winner choosing whether to act first or last.

Evading and Guarding are special actions, in that they focus more on reacting to other creatures and events rather than performing a single action. Evading lets you move during the fast phase, and then you are harder to hit for the round. Guarding skips your action, but lets you move 2 paces and make an opportunity attack during each phase of the round.

Action and Movement

When it's your turn to act, you creature may move as part of your action. Each character has a natural movement rate of 5 paces (25 feet) over even ground; difficult terrain or a heavy burden halves this movement speed, to three paces per round. Dashing increases your movement to 20 paces per round while you are unencumbered, at the cost of not being able to do anything else that round. If you are within reach of another creature's melee attacks, you provoke an opportunity attack from it if you attempt to move out of its reach.

Encumbrance

You are encumbered if you are wearing too much gear or carrying too heavy a load. Your maximum carrying capacity is equal to 6 + your Strength ability. In addition to armor and weapons, each 25 lb of carried gear or treasure adds +1 to encumbrance. An oversized weapon or gear such as a polearm will also add an additional +1.

As long as your carried armor and gear isn't more than half your carrying capacity, you can move and act normally. Past this, up to your carrying capacity, you are encumbered; the dash rate of an encumbered character is halved to 5 paces per phase, and you can't evade. Past your full carrying capacity, you are burdened – your speed is halved (to 3 paces per combat round), your actions are always slow, and you can't dash or evade.

Magic in Combat

Casting in a combat encounter is slower and riskier than other combat actions. You must declare to the referee what effect you intend to cast. If another creature hits you with an attack after you declare your effect but before you can cast it, you must save vs. Doom or your magic is disrupted.

Fast Magics

Some magics are fast to perform. A fast magic can be performed in reaction to another action in combat, even if the caster hadn't originally declared that they were casting magic this round. They simply switch their action to casting the magic, then do so.

Reacting to Other Creatures

Each creature that can act can also react to other creature's actions even if it isn't their turn to act yet, as long as the acting creature's action affects the reacting creature.

Usually, you only get to either act or react to one thing in a round; once you've reacted, you can't perform any more actions or reactions for the rest of the round. This means that if you react to something before it's your turn to act, you will lose your action.

The most straightforward reaction is the **opportunity attack**. If you've declared the attack or guard action and haven't made your attack yet, you can immediately make your attack against it if it attempts to perform a **provoking** action while within reach of your melee weapon. Since you're attacking before your attack would normally happen, you don't also get to move.

Your own attack interrupts its action; if you hit, the creature you hit loses the rest of its action. The most common provoking actions that a creature can make are attempting to step away from you, attempting to make a ranged attack, or attempting to cast magic.

If you're a fighter class (Warrior, Stalwart or Champion), the **guard** action lets a you give up your own attack action to allow you to make multiple opportunity attacks in a round instead. You can make an opportunity attack in response to one fast action, one normal action, and one slow action, and you can move up to 2 paces in between the fast and normal phases of the round, and again in between the normal and slow phases.

Whenever you successfully save vs. Blast against an area effect that might harm you, you can perform another reaction, called a **dodge**. To dodge, you make a hard Dexterity check, then move that many paces before the blast goes off. If you manage to get out of the blast area, it doesn't affect you at all.

Another kind of reaction that you can make is a **parry**, in response to an attack that's about to hit you. You need to be wielding a weapon that has the parry property in order to parry; if you are wielding such a weapon, you can give up your own attack to force the attacker to re-roll their attack.

Stunts and Maneuvers

The following options are a common, but by no means exhaustive, list of combat maneuvers that may be performed if the circumstances favor them. The referee and players are also welcome to come up with new maneuvers to add to their own game.

Brace

If you are wielding a polearm with the piercing property, you may brace it into the ground as you choose the guard action. You choose a direction as you brace your weapon; if a creature charges you from that direction, you may make an opportunity attack against it which gains +1d6 damage for each 5 full paces the target moved towards you, and which ignores even heavy armor.

Charge

A charge combines a dash and attack into a single action. Charging is always a slow action, happening in the last phase of the round. For every 5 full paces that you move directly towards your target, your attack gains +1d6 damage. If you hit, your target is shoved backwards, and you end your movement in the target's space.

Disarm or Pilfer

You can attempt to disarm a target with your attack, but doing so makes your attack throw harder. If you hit, and one or more damage dice exceed your Finesse threshold, your opponent must make a save vs. Hold or drop their weapon. A Scout can attempt to disarm or pick a pocket by making a Finesse check instead of a weapon damage roll after hitting with a melee attack. If you succeed, you pilfer or plant one reachable item of your choice.

Grab or Shove

You can attempt to shove or grab a target by making a melee attack roll with a difficulty based on the relative size of the target. A grab attack must be made with a free hand or a flail weapon, while a shove can be made with any melee attack. If you hit, the target makes a save vs. Hold to halve the damage and avoid being grabbed, moved, or knocked prone.

Waiting

If you want to wait for a specific event to occur before performing your action, you can do so. For example, you might want to attack an enemy as it moves past you.

Combat Conditions

Concealed – a creature can be partially or totally concealed by cover. A partially concealed creature is harder to hit, while a fully concealed creature cannot be attacked unless the attacker has some way of knowing where they are.

Hobbled / Prone – Various attacks or other circumstances might hobble a creature. A hobbled creature can only move 2 paces per round in an encounter, and can't dash or evade. A creature might sometimes be able to end this condition with a successful save vs. Hold. Being knocked prone is similar to being hobbled, but can stand up during their next action unless they're somehow restrained from doing so.

Panicked – A panicked creature can't attack, and must attempt to move as far away from the source of its fear (dashing if possible). If it can't move, it cowers in place as far away as it can get.

Stunned – A stunned creature loses its action for the rest of the combat round, causing it to be unable to act, react, or move. However, it isn't considered helpless.

Unconscious / Helpless – A helpless creature can't move, act, or react, and all attacks against it are easy. An unconscious creature is helpless, and also completely unaware of its surroundings. At the end of the round, an unconscious creature makes a Alertness check to attempt to wake up.

Injured – A creature that has lost half of its hit points is injured, and will need either magic, or time and medical attention, in order to heal.

Dying – A creature with zero hp is dying. A dying creature is also unconscious, and whenever it suffers further damage, it must save vs. Doom or die.

At the end of each round, after all other creatures have acted, each dying creature must save vs. Doom or die. If its saving throw rolls a '20', it stabilizes to one hit point and is no longer dying, but it's still unconscious and helpless until it wakes up.

Critical Hits

If an attack throw rolls a '20', it's a critical hit. Scouts and hunters can also sneak attack to cause a critical hit if the damage dice roll high enough, and all fighters achieve a critical hit whenever their attack roll beats its threshold by 10 or more.

When a creature suffers a critical hit, it immediately saves vs. Doom after the main attack damage is applied. If it successfully saves, it loses half its current hit points (round the loss down, so a successful save will never drop a creature to zero hit points); if it fails, its hit points drop to zero and it is dying.

Damage and Ongoing Conditions

Whenever you inflict damage with an attack, if any of the damage dice roll a '6', an additional effect is inflicted on the target. This effect depends on the type of damage inflicted.

The attacker can also force the affected target to make a save vs. Hold to avoid being knocked down or pushed back (attacker's choice) by the force of the blow, if they wish. This saving throw is easy if only one '6' was rolled in the damage roll, or hard if two or more '6's were rolled.

Weapon Damage

Physical attacks that roll a '6' usually inflict ongoing **bleeding**. A bleeding creature loses hit points equal to half its level (round up) at the end of each round until it saves vs. Doom to stop bleeding; it or an ally can use its action to make a Medicine check to attempt to staunch the flow.

Physical attacks with the **blunt** property stun instead of dealing ongoing damage, causing the target to lose their next action when any damage die rolls a '6'.

Physical attacks with the **piercing** property ignore light or medium armor when inflicting their damage.

Attacks with the **sundering** property reduce the quality of the target's armor by 1 per '6' rolled until repaired. If the target has a shield, each '6' rolled affects the shield instead.

Elemental Damage

Elemental damage effects depend on the element. Many elemental attacks, such as acid, poison, or fire, can inflict ongoing damage. Many others, such as psychic, cold, thunder, lightning, or radiant, might stun the target.

Thunder and radiant damage can also affect the target's senses, deafening or blinding them for a round. Cold or petrification might hobble or restrain the target until they break free, and acid can sunder armor or weapons. Psychic damage might frighten or confuse the target for a round.

Resting and Healing

Player characters who are injured or fatigued can choose to rest in the dungeon, although doing so is hazardous. Resting requires relative safety, peace, and quiet; an encounter always interrupts a rest.

Crafting, Repair, and Preparation

Some magic-users can attempt to re-prepare magics during an exploration turn, while other characters can roll Finesse checks to attempt to craft ammunition, make simple repairs to damaged equipment, or perform other tasks of similar complexity.

Tending to the Injured

Fatigue

Characters and other creatures who have lost less than half of their hit points are merely fatigued, rather than actually injured. Each turn of rest allows a fatigued creature to roll one hit die, then regain that many hit points. A resting creature can perform no other actions that turn.

Injury

A creature is injured if it has lost half or more of its hit points. Without magic, healing actual injury is a slow and arduous process, which cannot be done in the dungeon. A character can use Medicine attempt to treat an injured character immediately after an injury, if both of them spend an exploration action tending to the wounds. On a success, the injured character rolls one hit die and recovers that many hit points. If this heals them above half their hit points, they are no longer injured; otherwise, no further non-magical healing will be possible until they return home from the dungeon, or find another suitable hospice.

This first-aid attempt can only be made once, in the hour immediately after the injury is sustained; once this opportunity has passed, non-magical healing is no longer possible in the dungeon for that character.

Healing Magic and Potions

Magic can also heal injury or fatigue, and can even be used during exploration or in combat. Priests have access to healing magic directly, while wizards, dwarves, and druids may brew up healing elixirs to aid the injured.

Interrupted Rests

Resting in the dungeon is risky and leaves the party somewhat vulnerable to attack, prompting the referee to roll for a random encounter. If the party is interrupted by a random encounter while resting, they do not regain any resources or hit points, and are automatically surprised by the encounter. Most parties will post a watch while the rest of the party rests, guaranteeing that at least one character will be ready to respond to any threats should they arise.

Camping Overnight

If the party must camp in the dungeon overnight, their sleep must be uninterrupted for at least six hours, and they must not be excessively hungry or thirsty. Each uninjured character rolls all their hit dice and adds them together, then regains up to that many hp if the result is higher than their current hp total. Magic-users may then begin preparing any daily magics at the next dawn or dusk.

Preparing Magic

Wizards and dweomersmiths can prepare their full set of magics at dawn or dusk after a six hour rest in the dungeon. This process takes one hour (six exploration turns), but does not require any task checks or saving throws. If a magic-user is interrupted while preparing their daily magic, they are automatically surprised.

Deprivation

Each day that a character cannot get a clean drink, a full meal, and at least 6 hours of sleep without being interrupted, they do not regain hit points. Until they have gained enough food, water, and sleep, all their rolls will be harder, and they cannot prepare spells, prayers, or other magics. If they go more than three days without rest or water, they begin suffering 1d6 hit points of damage per day until they die.

Magic

Some classes are "magic-users", allowing them to cast spells, miracles, or incantations depending on their class and origin. Each type of magic-user is a unique class, with its own list of magics that it can perform, and each of these magics describes how it is cast. In an encounter, most magics require your action to perform, but a few can be performed in reaction to other events or actions. Some effects require that you touch a target, while others have a range listed in five-foot paces.

Some monsters and fey beasts also have access to magic, either as part of their innate biology or as trained class abilities. The rules for monsters performing magic are usually the same as the rules for player characters.

Preparation

Most magic requires preparation to perform at a speed faster than a ritual; each type of magic-user prepares their magics in different ways, but they share certain core features.

The most effective time to prepare spells or attunements is within an hour of sunrise or sunset. The liminality of dawn and dusk thins the Veil which separates Faerie and Shadow from the Material, allowing Aetheric energies an easier conduit into a magic-user's tools. Some minor amount of re-preparation is possible outside of this time, depending on one's character class, but a magic-user's basic daily preparation allotment must be attended to during this time. Daily preparation requires focus, concentration, and a clear head, so a magic-user typically begins their preparation immediately upon waking up – and schedules their sleep and waking accordingly.

Preparation During Exploration

Some classes can attempt to prepare or regain some of their magics during a 10 minute turn. You will need to either roll a d6 task check or a d20 saving throw to do so, depending on your character class. If this roll fails, the magic is not yet prepared; you can choose to either immediately make another attempt to prepare the same magic during the next exploration turn, or abandon the attempt and waste the resources required to prepare the magic. If you are interrupted, you automatically fail and waste resources.

Casting

Casting in Combat

Casting in a combat encounter is slower and riskier than other combat actions. You must declare to the referee what effect you intend to cast. If another creature hits you with an attack after you have declared your effect but before you can perform your action, you must save vs. Doom or the magic is disrupted.

Fast Magics

Some magics are fast to perform. A fast magic can be performed in reaction to another action in combat, even if the caster hadn't originally declared that they were casting magic this round. They simply switch their action to casting the magic, then do so.

Touching a Target

Some spellcasting requires that you touch a target to affect it. Touching an unwilling creature requires a melee attack throw.

Focus

Some magics require your active attention to maintain; while you are focusing on a magical effect, you cannot perform any other magic, but can perform weapon attacks and any other task that does not also require focus to maintain. If you suffer any hit point damage while you are casting or focusing on a magical effect other than a battle-frenzy, you must save vs. Doom or your focus is broken and the effect ends.

Certain magical items and allies, such as dragon pearls or wisp companions, can maintain focus on behalf of a magic-user; if you are injured while an item or wisp is maintaining focus for you, you still need to make the saving throw to avoid the effect ending, although you are not technically focusing on it yourself.

Rituals

Most magics can also be performed as rituals; ritual magic takes too long to perform during an encounter, but may be performed without the need for preparation if you have the time and access to the correct prayer or spellbook for the duration of the ritual. (Primal rituals do not require a book.)

Performing a Ritual

Most magics may be performed either in an encounter or as a ritual, while certain other magics may only be performed as rituals. A ritual might take several exploration turns to perform, depending on the ritual's circle and your character's class and level – during which time your character can perform no other actions.

Ritual magic takes effect at the beginning of the next exploration turn after its casting is complete; once the ritual is finished, the resulting effect is identical to a prepared casting of that magic unless that magic specifies a difference between prepared and ritual casting effects.

A ritual that is interrupted or fails mid-casting might have no effect, or it might cause some kind of wildly unpredictable magical mishap, at the discretion of the referee. Generally, more powerful magics are more likely to go awry; the referee should allow the caster to make a saving throw to channel the built-up energies of an interrupted or aborted ritual, with a difficulty based on the ritual's circle.

Ritual Materials

All ritual magic requires the same arcana, materia, and soma as a prepared casting of the same magic; any resources that would be consumed when casting a prepared magic are also consumed when casting that ritual.

Sworn Oaths

Any divine ritual blessing that requires focus to maintain can instead be maintained by the recipient of that blessing, if they swear an appropriate oath during the ritual. Violating such an oath will reverse the blessing, turning it into a curse until they atone (if atonement is even possible).

Group Rituals

Multiple magic-users of the same type may come together to participate in a group ritual. Wizards may combine their efforts to cast an arcane spell as a group ritual, druids can perform a group ritual incantations, and priests can even lead a group divine ritual that includes non-priests, so long as each member of the ritual is currently in faithful communion with the church and has not committed any unatoned cardinal sins.

To perform a group ritual, one magic-user must be designated as the leader of the ritual. Then, each member of the ritual must make a task check or saving throw to align their energies with those of the group. Wizards and dweomersmiths roll Science, druids roll Survival, and priests roll Bearing. If the ritual's leader fails, then the entire ritual fails regardless of how many other participants succeeded. Each participant in the ritual who contributes to its power must maintain focus throughout the ritual; if any of them lose focus, the ritual fails.

If the ritual has a voluntary target, they are considered a participant in the ritual even if they are not the correct kind of magic-user; they must also succeed in the appropriate task check or saving throw, or the entire ritual fails. A voluntary target's roll is easier than the other participants, since they are merely receiving the ritual's energies rather than channeling and shaping them.

Rituals such that affect an area can have its area of effect amplified by the number of participants, increasing the radius of effect by 50% at 2 participants, by 75% at 3, or doubling it at 4. Each additional participants increases it by 10% up to 8 (two and a half times the base effect radius); each participant past 8 increases the area of effect by another 5% of its base radius.

Other rituals can have their effects amplified in other ways – a ritual intended to do damage might add an additional die of damage per extra participant, a ritual effect with a duration might have its duration extended, or an effect that requires a saving throw to resist might become harder to resist if a large enough group contributes to it.

Returning Home

Experience

Whenever you complete an experience milestone and then arrive safely home, your character gains one experience. Once you've gained as many experiences as your next class level, reset your experience total to zero and advance your class level by 1. Thus, if you're starting as a first level character with no experience, you will gain your second class level as soon as you achieve two experiences.

Prime Abilities

Each class has a prime ability, which adjusts the rate at which experience levels in that class are gained. If your prime ability is -1 or lower, you will require additional experience each level to advance.

Hit Dice, Attacks, and Saves

Once you gain a class level, you immediately gain a hit die and any other features from your new class level, up to a maximum of nine hit dice. Roll all your hit dice and add them together; if the result is higher than your character's maximum hit points, set your new maximum hit points to the rolled result.

Gaining a class level reduces each of your saving throw and attack throw thresholds by one, to a minimum threshold of 5+.

Expertise Training

Expert classes gain training in a talent of their choice each time they gain a class level, while magic-user classes gain training in a specific talent at each even class level. Fighters instead choose and gain a new fighter feat that they do not already possess at each even level.

For experts, which talents were used in the last set of adventures should have some bearing on which gets trained; if there is no clear talent that a character focused on during the last few adventures, then training whichever talent has the worst threshold is usually a safe bet. Referees and players might maintain a tradition of declaring which talents they intend to train at their next level, before they even earn the experience to do so.

Class-Based Experience

In addition to surviving adventures, each class gains additional experience based on its actions during the adventure. Members of the party split their accomplishments between all members of the same class group once they have successfully returned home; if an individual's share of the tally reaches the appropriate milestone for their level, they gain one bonus experience for that adventure. The referee might also award specific player characters extra experience for exceptional cleverness or bravery during an adventure.

Fighters

Fighters gain additional experience through combat. Each level of foe defeated, whether through death, surrender, or fleeing, is added to their tally. Large and huge monsters count as 2x and 5x their level, respectively.

Experts

Experts gain additional experience through recovering treasure. The gold cost of all mundane (non-magical) treasure brought back from the adventure is tallied.

Magic-Users

Each class of magic-user has their own goals, which determine what accomplishments gain them additional experience.

Priests gain additional experience through accomplishing the goals of their faith. They track enemies defeated in the same manner as fighters, but if the party willingly kills a mortal that could have reasonably been redeemed instead, no priest that participated in the murder gains experience for the entire adventure. Priests also count the levels of any allies that they save from mortal peril towards their accomplishments, as well as the levels of any creatures willingly converted to the Faith.

Wizards and dweomersmiths gain additional experience through studying magic. The circle or rarity of each new magic item or arcane spell discovered counts towards their tally.

Druids gain experience by studying fey creatures in their natural habitat; each new kind of fey creature observed for a full hour counts its level towards the druid's tally. Restoring the balance of a damaged ecosystem might automatically grant all druids in the party an extra experience.

Class-Based Experience Milestones

Level	Foes	Treasure	Magic
1	2 levels	750 gold	1 circle
2	3 levels	1,000 gold	1 circle
3	4 levels	1,500 gold	1 circle
4	6 levels	2,000 gold	2 circles
5	9 levels	3,000 gold	3 circles
6	15 levels	5,000 gold	5 circles
7	25 levels	10,000 gold	10 circles
8	40 levels	15,000 gold	15 circles

Dual-Classing

A player may choose for their character to gain a second character class during play, becoming a "dual-class" adventurer. Each character's origin limits their new class just like it limited their first class, and a character may never have two base classes of the same type (i.e., magic-users cannot choose a second magic-user base class, experts cannot choose a second expert base class, and warriors cannot choose a second warrior base class).

In order to dual-class, a character must have a +1 or better in both their current base class's prime ability and their new class's prime ability. Gaining their new class costs one experience; they gain all their class's first-level feats, but do not improve their attack throws or saving throws. If their new class has a better hit die bonus than their old class, their hit die becomes their new class's; re-roll the character's maximum hit points accordingly.

Whenever they reach enough experience to gain a class level in their new class, they do so. They do not gain a hit die or adjust their attack or saving throws, but any of their class feats that depend on their new class's level will increase in effectiveness as normal.

Once their new class's level matches that of their old class, they may choose which class to train next; when they gain sufficient experience to gain that class's next level, they also gain a new hit die and improve their attack and saving throw thresholds as normal. They then continue alternating leveling up each class until both classes reach level nine.

Beyond Ninth Level

The rules presented here deliberately limit character progression to nine class levels. This helps keep player characters within the bounds of human capabilities, while still allowing growth and progress. Rewards beyond level 9 involve creating and maintaining domains, managing reputation and renown, or researching powerful magics.

Fighters typically take on a leadership role for a small band of warriors, and begin using their martial prowess to gain control of a geographical area - either through outright violence and intimidation, or by offering their protection from the violence and intimidation of other marauding brigands.

Experts typically take on a role appropriate to a master of their craft. They might gather together a band of fellows, coordinating activities across a wide area.

Magic-users become powers unto themselves, integrating into the world around them in a manner befitting their power and goals.

Noble Titles

The default world presented in the History handbook is dominated by feudal societies. In feudalism, the land of a kingdom is held by a king or queen, who grants noble titles to those who pledge to defend it. A noble title always corresponds to a portion of land, called a fief, which that noble is expected to defend with their life if called upon — so a county is given to a count, a barony to a baron, a duchy to a duke, a bordermarch to a marquis, and so on.

Keeps and Domains

Eventually, an adventurer will have made enough of a name for themselves that they might plausibly be granted a title of nobility, royally recognized coat-of-arms for heraldry, and a small fiefdom to rule. Alternatively, barbarians or outlaws might have amassed enough power that they can simply take control of an area by force, acting as its de facto rulers even if not recognized de jure by the king. Maintaining control of a fief, and administering to its prosperity, often becomes the primary focus of a high-level campaign.

Treasure

One of the main lures of adventuring in dungeons is the lucrative trade in looted treasures. Dungeon treasure that the player does not have a use for can be converted into gold, silver, and copper coins, which can be used to purchase other goods and services. Sometimes, dungeon treasure will even come in the form of chests or bags of loose coins, ready to be spent. Otherwise, selling treasure requires finding a buyer and haggling.

Experience for Treasure

Defeating challenges and gaining treasure are how adventurers increase in level. If the party survives an adventure, makes it back into town, and cashes in their acquired loot, they gain experience if the referee determines that they have met the criteria for an experience milestone.

Currency

Most kingdoms coin currency based on a standard inherited from the Old Empire. The standard large denomination is a one-ounce gold coin, called the drakhma or drac. A drac typically has a serpentine celestial dragon on one side, wound around a polearm bundled with staves; most merchants will abbreviate this symbol as an 'S' with a vertical line driven through it. The obverse side will usually be stamped with a profile portrait of the monarch that commissioned the coinage.

The next smaller unit of currency is the half-ounce silver denarius or dime, with ten dimes equaling one drac. A dime typically has a cornucopia on one side, and a stamped three-quarters profile of a baron or duke who happened to have the monarch's favor at the time of printing. One dime is traditionally equal to one day's wages for an unskilled laborer, and in fact the Church sets the minimum wage for any daily laborer at one denarius, whether free or slave.

Finally, the smallest unit of currency is the half-ounce copper penny, with ten pennies equaling one dime. A penny usually has a laurel wreath on one side, and the portrait of a victorious knight on the other. The knight's heraldry will usually be stamped within the circle of the laurel wreath. Many knights aspire to earn their laurels, and have their deeds commemorated on the face of a coin.

Weight and Purity

The drac, dime, and penny are all typically stamped to be exactly one inch in diameter, with the thickness varying to achieve the correct precious metal weight. A proper drac will typically contain 90% gold by weight, alloyed with silver to harden the metal so that it can remain in circulation for longer. Dimes are likewise typically 90% silver and 10% copper, while pennies are 95% copper alloyed with a variable mixture of tin and zinc.

Alternate Currencies

Dwarves mint their own currency, which they pragmatically named the copper, nickel, and quarter for their component metals (quarters are 25% gold and 75% silver). One copper is equivalent to a penny, while a nickel is worth five coppers and a quarter is worth five nickels. Dwarven mints are honest to a fault, so merchants in the Successor Kingdoms typically accept dwarven currency without much hassle.

While larger denominations than the drac exist, they are typically only used to transfer wealth between kingdoms or principalities. Most such wealth is transferred directly using bullion bars of gold, gemstones, or even feysilver or orichalc.

Merchants and Artisans

Many civilized settlements and traveling merchants will offer goods and services that the party can purchase. Each purveyor of fine goods exists within a community, and has their own sense of the local market. As such, the price of goods can vary wildly from region to region, based on supply and demand.

A good rule of thumb is that a skilled merchant or artisan expects to be paid for the time and skill put into the objects they are creating or transporting. Above that, merchants will sell their goods at prevailing market price, which can be quite different than the price of the materials and time needed to create those goods. Taxes and safety also take their cut, driving merchants' prices up higher - a merchant must either pay the local government to protect their wares, pay mercenaries to protect them directly, or protect those wares themselves with their own time and martial prowess, all of which cut into the bottom line.

Lifestyle Costs

The price of shelter, food, and safety can vary significantly based on their quality, from the meager to the extravagant. The average adventure ranges the gamut of highs and lows, based on their fortune from day to day.

A typically healthy and well-cooked but not extravagant meal will often range from 2 to 3 copper at a traveler's inn, while a night's stay might cost a dime or more. Ingredients for a home-cooked meal will typically cost about a copper, and a month's rent of a cottage in a reasonably safe town or village might cost between two to five gold.

These prices will fluctuate wildly depending on economic conditions, of course; a boom town that grows around a newly-discovered goldmine might have prices up to a hundred times more expensive, while a famine-starved region might well treat grain as more precious than gold.

Adventurers who are lucky enough to own their own property still have to contend with taxes, repair and maintenance on their homes, and other cost-sinks. Almost every property worth owning will exist under the protection of a feudal lord, who will expect to be paid the halftithe for the service of keeping the lands free of bandits (regardless of how well or poorly they do that job). Properties that are not under the aegis of a feudal protector will need their own protection from brigands, burglars and bugbears that might want to raid the larder or even move in and declare the place their own.

Minions and hirelings also add to lifestyle costs, since they expect to be paid in exchange for the services they provide. Minions and hirelings that are "on retainer" will need to be paid whether or not they are accompanying an adventure (although they will obviously expect to be paid more when in the line of danger); a retainer of trained warriors is a useful way to keep the party's home turf secure and protected while they are away on their adventures.

Charity and Reputation

Treasure can also simply be given away. If the party is noticeably generous in a particular region, they might develop a reputation for their wealth and generosity. This comes with both upsides and downsides; commoners and merchants are likely to be friendlier and more willing to render aid, but bandits and tax-collectors will likely see generous adventurers as particularly rich targets for theft, extortion, or other forms of harassment.

Priests who give their treasure away towards divinely-sanctioned charity will quickly gain the attention of the Church, and might be fast-tracked into leadership roles as a result. The Church values competence in its leadership, so a player character cannot simply "buy their way" into a cushy Cardinalship without being able to actually attend to all the duties that the position will entail. Still, generosity and luck go a long way towards gaining the Church's favor, especially when that generosity clearly results in improving the lives of the people.

Another way to use treasure to cultivate a reputation is to spend it on ostentatious displays of upper-class finery. Often, a status-minded party will split its spending evenly between lavish displays of personal wealth, and genuine public works that improve the lives of the citizenry. Money spent on display is not truly wasted; a kingdom that proudly flaunts its prosperity with beautiful public art and architecture is also telling its neighbors that it is well-funded enough to be able to easily defend itself from invasion.

Domain Construction and Management

The party can also spend their treasure on creating a domain for themselves, building a keep (or more likely, hiring architects and masons to build it for them) and cultivating the surrounding land. The full rules for domain construction and management are in the Referee's Guide, as appendix F.

Player characters who come to rule a domain will also need to defend it, which will entail hiring and training an army. Taxation and military armament are detailed in appendix F, while the rules for actually deploying armies, siege engines, and other weapons of war into mass combat are detailed in appendix G.

Crafting

In addition to purchasing items, adventurers can also spend their time crafting their own. Any player character familiar with the correct crafting tools can use those tools within a suitable workshop to craft an item out of available raw materials.

Crafting Weapons

Crafting a decent metal weapon typically takes about a day. A skilled artisan can produce one high-quality weapon with a day's labor and quality materials and a successful easy Finesse roll, or one adequate weapon per hour with an average Finesse roll if they have adequate materials and facilities.

If a crafter spends an entire day's labor on a single weapon with the intent to produce a masterwork, they succeed with a hard Finesse roll. A masterwork weapon adds a +1 bonus to either its to-hit throw or its damage roll.

Producing ammunition for ranged weapons is much simpler; a crafter may produce 1d6 arrows or crossbow bolts after one hour of effort with an easy Finesse roll.

Crafting Armor

Crafting decent armor typically takes about a week, and the armor must be tailored to its intended wearer. At the end of the process, the craftsman makes an easy Finesse test to determine whether the armor is adequate; on a double success, they manage to produce a masterwork armor with a +1 bonus to its damage reduction if the armor's raw materials were of sufficiently high quality. Mastercraft armor is always fitted to a particular creature, and must be re-tailored for any other being to gain its masterwork bonus.

Repairing sundered armor, or modifying an existing piece of armor to fit a new wearer, is a simpler task which takes approximately a day. Repairs require materials of the same quality as those used in the original crafting of the armor, or the armor will lose any masterwork bonus that it has.

A craftsman can typically sell a weapon or armor at prevailing market rates, but must then pay local taxes (or equivalents) or risk trouble. Masterwork weapons and armors can usually be sold for many times the cost of a merely adequate item.

Crafting Other Gear

The referee is the ultimate arbiter of what kinds of equipment can be crafted, how long the process should take, and what tools, facilities and materials are required. Various tools and supplies can be manufactured with sufficient time and effort; many will require a Finesse check to successfully assemble, while others succeed automatically as long as the proper time and attention are paid. Medical supplies, non-perishable meals, and the like might require a Medicine or Survival check instead of a Finesse check.

Equipment can be manufactured that makes particular tasks easier, such as rappelling gear to assist with climbing actions (making Agility checks related to climbing easier). The referee's common sense should guide what kinds of gear to allow in their campaign, and at what costs.

Selling Crafted Items

An adventurer talented in crafting useful items can make a decent living selling them to other adventurers, nobles, or other buyers of questionable provenance. The process is the same as finding a merchant or artisan, but in reverse – the player characters must find a buyer that wishes to acquire the goods, then haggle until a deal agreeable to both sides has been reached.

Feudal lords might expressly commission a particularly talented craftsman to make an extravagant custom work, often providing the materials and paying handsomely for the labor. If the desired item requires rare alchemical supplies, the noble might expect the player character's party to go questing for them as part of the commission. Such a request might form the basis of an entire adventure or series of adventures.

Once an adventurer has a reputation for selling high-quality wares, other buyers will likely seek them out more regularly, eventually providing a steady side income to supplement an adventuring party's primary activities.

Research

Adventurers spend a good deal of their down-time activities researching ancient maps and tomes, either in search of arcane knowledge or the ideal location for their next adventure. A research project will involve a series of task checks, with difficulties determined by the available research material. Science, Lore, Medicine, and Survival are all appropriate talents to use during a research montage, each covering their own domains of knowledge.

Of course, gathering that material from musty libraries or private collectors will also require adventuring or bargaining; during the course of a research project, the party might uncover references to documents not yet in their possession, leading to a pause in the research while they attempt to acquire them.

Players and referees are encouraged to role-play out as much of the research as they can, so long as it does not slow down the flow of play. Clever ideas or unusual interpretations of facts might open up new directions for the campaign, even if they turn out to be wildly off-base once tested in the field.

Above all else, the game should never devolve into a monotonous series of dice rolls! As with every other aspect of play, the referee should describe the situation in free-form, and then the players should describe their characters' ideas, hunches, and research directions – also in free-form. Only then should the Referee determine a talent and difficulty, with the result filtering the players' ideas into the correct facts (or into the more wildly incorrect parts of their ideas, in the case of failures).

Magic and Engineering

One common avenue of research is the design of new magic item enchantments, arcane spells, or alchemical formulae. Basic rules for spell design and magic item creation are included in these rules, but players are encouraged to be as creative and innovative as possible, with the referee ultimately deciding what is or isn't possible within the confines of their own campaign.

Recuperating From Injuries

Injured creatures that are not poisoned or diseased will regain hit points slowly, over several days (or even weeks) of rest. Roll one hit die, then consult the following chart based on the result and the character's level to determine the total number of days of rest needed to heal the next hit point:

Hit Die Result:	1	2	3	4	5	6+
Level 1	14	7	5	4	3	2
Level 2	7	5	3	2	2	1
Level 3	5	3	2	2	1	1
Level 4	4	2	2	1	1	½
Level 5	3	2	1	1	½	½
Level 6+	2	1	1	½	½	⅓

Any strenuous activity will completely undo the current recuperation, requiring a new hit die roll. Another character may make a Medicine roll once per day to attempt to help tend to their wounds; the difficulty of this roll is based on the available medical supplies and facilities. Success reduces their recuperation time by one day, or automatically heals an additional hit point if the recuperation time is already less than one day. Once the injured character has rested the necessary number of days, they heal one hit point and roll again.

Recovering from Poison or Disease

A poisoned or diseased character must first shake off their condition before they can heal any hit points. Different poisons and diseases have different rates of progression; some progress over the course of hours, others days, weeks, or even months. These rules are for truly debilitating lingering infections or toxins; anything that can be more-or-less "lived with" might impart penalties, but will not prevent normal rest and healing.

A lingering disease or toxin will list its progression rate, saving throw difficulty, and the number of successful saves necessary to fully shake it off, as well as its symptoms. For the duration that a character is seriously sick or poisoned, they must make a saving throw every span of time based on the progression rate of the disease or toxin (days, weeks, or months). Failure means they suffer 1d6 damage and worsen; success means they make progress towards recovery.

Panoply

Purchasing Gear

Player characters have to get their stuff from somewhere.

A player character is assumed to have purchased their starting equipment before play begins; if the referee desires, they may instead give each player $2d6 \times 10$ silver to purchase all their equipment with.

Prices and Markets

The costs listed here are simply a rough estimate of what an average adventurer could expect to be charged by an average shopkeep. Prices should vary according to the local economy and the availability of specific goods. A good rule of thumb is to look at the modern cost of an equivalent good or service in US dollars or Euros, and then multiply by 100 to roughly gauge its cost in drakhs.

These costs are listed in silver pieces; across the Successor Kingdoms, 1 silver piece equals 10 copper, and 1 gold piece is 10 silver. These costs are roughly standard, but might adjust up or down by a factor of 2 depending on the local economic conditions. Custom-made gear will be, on average, two to five times more expensive than something bought "off the shelf", but will be higher quality. If in doubt, use a multiplier of $(2d6+3) \times 10\%$ for an off-the-shelf item, or $(3d6 \times 25\%)$ for a piece of custom work. If the player wants to haggle, you can apply a price adjustment in the winner's favor after a Wit or Charm contest of somewhere between 10% and 25%, depending on how the haggling plays out.

For basic weapons and armor, the prices listed here are for a common version; masterwork items can fetch up to ten times the listed price. Such weapons may be readily available for sale at market, or they may need to be commissioned in advance from the local blacksmith. The availability of most other items and services, especially magic items, will depend greatly on the size and prosperity of the city; small hamlets are unlikely to have rare magic items for sale, and if they do, there will undoubtedly be an interesting story behind why.

Selling Gear

Player characters can also attempt to sell their gear to interested parties. The selling price will usually start at around half the listed buying price; the potential buyer's attitude will adjust this up or down by up to 25%. From that point, it's up to the players to haggle, with the referee playing the part of the buyer. Intuition, Bearing, Charm, and Wit task checks will all come into play.

If the referee is rewarding extra experience from treasure accumulated, selling gear or treasure to an interested buyer does not count towards experience gained from finding treasure. Any gear found in the dungeon will award experience based on its full purchase price, at which point the party can choose to convert it into more liquid assets if they wish.

Stealing from Shops

It's inevitable that someone is going to want to steal from the local shopkeep. Try to remind the players that this isn't generally that kind of game; if there is a priest among the player characters, they should be given the first chance to handle the situation before the referee steps in. That said, sometimes extenuating circumstances do prevail.

Attempting to shoplift is a Stealth roll, while the shopkeep and any nearby guards make an Alertness check. Only if the Stealth check succeeds and everyone's Alertness check fails does the thief get away with it. Most local baronies do not look kindly on thieves, and stealing anything of value is likely to bring an adventurer's career to an abrupt end.

Weapons

Club	1
Dagger	10
Quarterstaff	5
Other light weapon	15
Other medium weapon	25
Other heavy weapon	50

Armor

Light	15
Medium	50
Heavy	500
Light Barding	200
Medium Barding	500
Heavy Barding	2000

Other Gear

Expensive Clothes	50
Dungeoneer's Kit	5
Notebook (100 blank pages)	5

Services

Basic meal at an inn or stall	1
Fancy meal at an inn	5
Night's stay at an inn	20
Horses fed and stalled at an inn	2

Livestock and Mounts

Pack Mule	100
Draft Horse (nag)	50
Draft Horse (good quality)	250
War Horse	1000
1 day's food & maintenance	0.5
Cow	50
Ox	500
1 day's food & maintenance	0.2

Alchemical Potions

Bottle of magic ink	1
Common elixir of health	25
Uncommon elixir of health	100
Other common potion	50
Other uncommon potion	250
Rare potion	1000
Legendary potion	5000

Magic Items

Common weapon or shield	2500
Uncommon weapon or shield	10,000
Rare weapon or shield	50,000
Legendary weapon or shield	250,000
Common armor	10,000
Uncommon armor	50,000
Rare armor	250,000
Legendary armor	1,000,000
Common amulet, belt, or boots	1000
Uncommon amulet, belt, or boots	5000
Rare amulet, belt, or boots	25,000
Legendary amulet, belt, or boots	100,000
Common other item	5000
Uncommon other item	25,000
Rare other item	100,000
Legendary other item	500,000
Common blueprint or formula	1000
Uncommon blueprint or formula	5000
Rare blueprint or formula	25,000
Legendary blueprint or formula	100,000
First-circle arcane spell	2000
Second-circle arcane spell	10,000
Third-circle arcane spell	50,000

Armor and Weapons

Adventurers can be expected to get into combat with other creatures with alarming frequency. Wearing armor and having a trusty weapon by your side in such situations can mean the difference between life and death.

Armor

Armor provides creatures with a Defense value, which reduces the damage of weapon attacks. If armor would completely negate the damage from a weapon attack, the attack instead deals 1 blunt damage. Armor provides no protection against any elemental, aetheric, or psychic damage. Light and medium armors cannot protect against piercing attacks, but heavy armor can.

Wearing any kind of medium or heavy armor makes all Agility and Stealth checks harder, and wearing heavy armor if your class isn't familiar with it makes all weapon attacks and saving throws vs Blast harder as well. Fey classes who wear steel armor, or wizards who wear any armor, lose access to their magic until they take that armor off.

Armor Type	Defense	Evasion	Other Properties
Light	1	Fast	
Medium	2	Normal	Steel
Heavy	3	Slow	Steel, Hardened

These numbers are for normal, quickly manufactured armors; a skilled craftsman with access to high-quality raw material can choose to dedicate their time and skill towards making a masterwork piece of armor, which grants a +1 to its Defense. Such armor will often be listed with a +1 after the name, such as "Heavy +1", indicating that their defense is higher. Masterwork armor must be custom-built and fitted to the person it was designed for; it does not provide its +1 bonus for anyone but its intended wearer.

Materials and Manufacture

Light armors are made from leather or other soft materials, while medium and heavy armors are typically steel. Medium armor weaves small rings or scales of steel together into a flexible mail; heavy armor uses solid bands or plates of metal contoured to the body of the wearer. This means that heavy armor made for one creature cannot usually be worn comfortably by another without some degree of modification by a smith.

Magical metal armor is forged from feysilver or orichalc. Feysilver is a silvery-blue metal with extraordinary lightness and hardness, while orichalc is a deep golden-red metal that is much denser than steel. Armors made from feysilver reduce their encumbrance by one step (medium armor becomes light and heavy armor becomes medium), while armors made from orichalc increase their encumbrance for their weight but have +1 higher defense.

Druids and champions lose access to their magics if they wear steel armors, but champions can still access their battle-frenzy while wielding steel weapons or using a steel shield. Feysilver and orichalc don't interfere with primal magics the way iron and steel do.

Donning Armor

Putting on or taking off armor is too involved to happen in combat. In a 10-minute turn, a character can don light armor and still perform an action, or don medium or heavy armor as their full action. If someone assists them in donning their armor, both characters can make a Finesse test to attempt to don medium armor more quickly; on a success, both characters can perform an exploration action in addition to putting on the armor.

Heavy armor is complex and heavy enough that it requires assistance to properly don, and can only be donned as a full action. A character who attempts to don heavy armor alone must succeed at a hard Finesse test.

Removing any armor is much simpler, but still too involved to do in combat. A character can remove their armor during an exploration turn and still perform an action, but removing one set of armor and donning another takes their full action - even if both are light armor.

Shields

Using a shield makes you harder to hit with attacks, essentially by providing you with partial cover that you can carry around with you on your arm. Shields can only be used by warriors who are trained with them; without this training, all attack throws and physical saving throws are harder.

Heraldry

Shields and armor are often emblazoned with identifying ornamentation called heraldry. A paladin's heraldry will usually incorporate a holy symbol of some kind, while a warrior's heraldry simply serves to identify them on the battlefield. Heraldry typically interferes with stealth, which is why it is usually only incorporated into medium and heavy armor or emblazoned on a shield.

Properly designed heraldry can benefit a warrior on the field of battle, if they have sufficient renown that their allies and enemies recognize the symbols and colors. This might make the saves vs. Fear of allies easier and enemies harder, make Bearing and Charm checks easier, or have other effects determined by the referee.

Warriors and priests that come from a noble family will typically inherit their heraldry from their ancestors, while newly-knighted warriors will typically earn sufficient renown to warrant developing unique heraldry by level 5. Dwarves do not typically display individual heraldry, instead opting to display the heraldry of their ancestral clan. The sight of a regimented formation of identically-outfitted dwarves is intimidating in its own right, providing the same basic effects as an individual warrior's coat of arms.

Champion heraldry typically takes the form of tribal paint patterns, tattoos, and runes describing their past feats in battle. These typically have the same effect as warrior heraldry once the champion has accumulated enough of them to imply a real threat (around level 5, as above).

Non-fighter individuals that adopt heraldry will usually be seen as somewhat pretentious, since these classes are not known for their courage and prowess in melee combat. Scouts and hunters also tend to forgo heraldry for more practical reasons, since it interferes with stealth.



Weapons

While mortals continue to devise endless variety of ways to kill each other, most weapons fall into a few simple categories. Any unusual or improvised weapon should be treated as if it was the closest logical equivalent to a weapon on this list.

Simple vs Martial Weapons

Simple weapons may be wielded by most creatures; any weapon without the "simple" tag is harder for a character class who is not trained in its use to effectively attack with it, and untrained creatures cannot use a non-simple weapon to make opportunity attacks or special attack stunts.

Fighter and expert classes are usually trained in non-simple weapons; most magic-user classes are effectively limited to using simple weapons without significant difficulty.

Ranged Weapons

Bows	Size	Other Properties
Shortbow	Medium ¹	Range 10
Longbow	Heavy	Range 15
Greatbow	Heavy ²	Range 20
¹ A shortbow must still be fired two-handed, even though it counts as a Medium weapon in other respects.		
² A greatbow encumbers as if had the Polearm property.		
Crossbows	Size	Other Properties
Hand Crossbow	Light	Simple, Range 5
Light Crossbow	Light	Simple, Range 10
Crossbow	Medium	Simple, Range 15
Heavy Crossbow	Heavy	Simple, Range 20
After firing a crossbow, you must reload it with an action. You cannot move while reloading a heavy crossbow.		
Arrows and Bolts		
An arrow or bolt fired from a bow or crossbow normally has the Piercing property; broadhead arrows can be used instead, which do not have the Piercing property but instead give any bow or crossbow +1d6 to damage against non-steel armors.		

Melee Weapons

Blades	Size	Other Properties
Dagger	Light	Simple, Piercing, Thrown 2
Shortsword	Light	Simple, Parry
Rapier	Light	Parry, Piercing
Longsword	Medium	Parry
Greatsword	Heavy	Parry
Glaive	Heavy	Polearm, Reach
Axes	Size	Other Properties
Chakram	Light	Sundering, Thrown 2
Handaxe	Light	Sundering, Simple, Thrown 1
Pickaxe	Medium	Sundering, Piercing
Ax	Medium	Sundering, Simple
Battleaxe	Heavy	Sundering
Halberd	Heavy	Sundering, Polearm, Reach
Bludgeons	Size	Other Properties
Unarmed	Light	Blunt, Simple, Unarmed
Sap	Light	Blunt, Simple, Thrown 1
Hammer	Light	Blunt, Simple
Quarterstaff	Medium	Blunt, Simple, Parry, Reach
Club	Medium	Blunt, Simple
Maul	Heavy	Blunt, Simple, Piercing
Flails	Size	Other Properties
Whip	Light	Entangling, Reach 2
Flail	Light	Entangling, Blunt
Threshall	Medium	Entangling
Chain Whip	Heavy	Reach 2
Spears	Size	Other Properties
Javelin	Medium	Simple, Piercing, Thrown 5
Spear	Medium	Piercing, Polearm, Reach
Pike	Heavy	Piercing, Polearm, Reach 2
Lance	Heavy*	Piercing, Polearm, Reach*
*When riding a mount, a lance may be wielded one-handed as if it were a Medium weapon, and it gains the Sundering property.		

Masterwork Weapons

Masterwork weapons may be commissioned, which grant a +1 bonus to their damage rolls. Unlike armor, a masterwork weapon does not need to be made for a particular individual. Masterwork ranged weapons instead grant a +1 bonus to their attack throws.

Weapon Sizes

All weapons have a Size, which represents the weapon's weight, length, and heft. If you are not wielding any medium or heavy melee weapons, you can choose whether to use your melee or ranged attack throw threshold to determine if your melee attack hits or misses.

Light weapons always deal 1d6 damage. A light weapon may be wielded in your off hand, if your main hand is wielding a light or medium weapon. If you do, you add both weapons' damage rolls together to determine the attack's total damage.

Medium weapons may be wielded in one or both hands by medium creatures, giving you the option to leave your other hand free to wield an off-hand light weapon, a shield, or to perform other tasks. Small creatures must wield medium weapons two-handed, and so cannot pair them with a shield or an off-hand weapon.

Medium melee weapons deal 1d6 damage + your Strength if wielded one-handed, or 2d6 damage (with no Strength modifier) if wielded two-handed.

Medium ranged weapons always deal 1d6 damage; wielding a medium ranged weapon two-handed steadies it and makes its attack throws easier.

Heavy ranged weapons always deal 2d6 damage, while heavy melee weapons always deal damage equal to 2d6 + your Strength. All heavy weapons require both your hands to wield, so they cannot be used with an off-hand weapon or a shield. Small creatures cannot wield Heavy weapons easily, finding all attacks and parries with them harder.

A medium creature can hold a two-handed weapon with one hand to perform actions that require a free hand, but attacking requires that you have both hands on the weapon.

Weapon Properties

Parry - Some melee weapons allow you to parry incoming melee attacks with them. Parrying with a weapon gives up your attack for the round to force an incoming melee attack to be re-rolled. If the attack still hits and would sunder your armor, it breaks your weapon instead.

Blunt weapons stun instead of bleeding whenever any damage die rolls a '6'.

Entangling weapons can ensnare an opponent whenever they roll a '6' on a damage die. The attacker can choose to trip or disarm the target unless they save vs. Hold.

Piercing weapons penetrate light or medium armor, ignoring its damage reduction; their damage is still reduced by heavy armor.

Polearm weapons may be braced against a charge from a particular direction as a combat action. A braced polearm immobilizes its wielder until they un-brace, but allows its wielder to make an easy opportunity attack against any creature that charges them in the braced direction, and adds the charger's own charge damage bonus to the damage of the wielder's opportunity attack against it.

Ranged weapons have a range or thrown value, which is measured in paces. When attacking out to this distance, all attacks with the weapon are easy. Out to twice this range, attacks are at normal difficulty; out to 3x this range, weapon attacks are hard. Making a ranged or thrown attack provokes an attack of opportunity from anyone whose melee weapon can reach you.

Reach - Some melee weapons allow you to attack creatures further away than normal. A weapon with Reach can attack creatures up to an additional pace away, while a weapon with Reach 2 can attack creatures up to 2 paces away. You may also use Reach weapons to make opportunity attacks at the same distance.

Sundering weapons reduce the target's armor by 1 for each damage die that rolls a '6'. If the target has a shield or successfully parries with a weapon, the target's shield or weapon is damaged instead. A damaged shield or weapon can't be used until it is repaired.

Adventuring Gear

Potion Belt

A potion belt is a simple leather belt or sash with six padded pockets sewn into it. It allows the wearer to hold up to six small items in a protected fashion, leaving each item readily available to be drawn and used as a single action.

As the name implies, potion belts are most often used by alchemists to store brewed alchemy bottles or small tools and supplies, but magic-users and scouts also find them extremely useful for holding bottles of magic ink, unprepared raw materia, prayer strips and brushes, lockpicking tools, throwing knives, and so on.

Rucksack

A rucksack is a heavy canvas and leather bag with shoulder straps, designed to evenly distribute weight. It allows a medium-sized mortal to carry up to 50 lbs of gear with minimal encumbrance (1 encumbrance point), or 100 lbs of gear with moderate encumbrance (2 encumbrance points). Any more weight risks damaging the bag.

Small rucksacks can also be made, which allow a small mortals to carry up to 25 lbs of gear with minimal encumbrance, or 50 lbs of gear with moderate encumbrance.

Toolkit

Many different kinds of craftsman's and tradesman's tools exist. Each type of tool requires familiarity to use properly. Some toolkits, such as jeweler's tools or lockpicking tools, are small enough to fit into a single pouch of a potion belt, while others, such as blacksmith's tools or carpenter's tools, are each the size of a medium weapon, and might even be serviceable as such in a pinch.

Survival Gear

While armor is primarily designed to protect from violence, other clothing is designed to protect from the elements. Different kinds of survival clothing protect against cold, heat, sun, rain, and so on; an unprepared adventurer will find various saving throws and Survival tests harder in hostile environments.

Fine Clothes

Well-tailored clothing that is appropriate to an occasion can mean the difference between a good impression and a disastrous one in a social setting. Without the right attire, most Charm and Wit actions in social situations that expect proper dress are much harder.

Decanter

Most mortals require around 32 ounces of fresh water per day to stay healthy. A proper canister for drinking water will hold around this amount, and will be designed to not break or tear in rough situations. Some decanters are lined to help safely hold fluids other than water.

Rations

Dried meat and fruit, nuts, biscuits, and seasoned preservatives make for a hearty - if dry - meal that won't spoil on the road. Each day's worth of rations for a medium mortal weighs approximately one pound.

Ammunition

A quiver of 20 arrows or crossbow bolts fits into a single container approximately the size of a medium weapon, with a strap that allows it to sling over a character's back.

Dungeoneer's Kit

Various items have become traditional "required gear" for seasoned explorers. A typical dungeoneer's kit contains a 10 ft pole of hardened wood with an iron ring on one end that doubles as a quarterstaff, 100 feet of hemp rope, a small oilcloth tent, a lantern with a clasp that can affix to the ring on the end of the pole, a flask of lamp oil (enough to keep the lantern lit for 8 hours), two pairs of climbing spikes (one pair for the boots and one pair for the hands), two palm-sized silver mirrors, and a 5-lb lead plumb weight with a loop to thread a rope through. The whole package weighs around 20 lb, and (other than the pole) fits neatly into a rucksack with some room to spare for treasure and rations.

Finding absurd new ways to use these items has become a tradition among adventurers, who swap tavern stories of their exploits in exchange for drinks and renown.

Carrying Capacity

A character can only carry so much gear before they begin to be slowed and fatigued by it. A character's maximum carrying capacity is equal to 6 + their Strength ability. Weight is tracked through "encumbrance" units, which measure approximately how much someone is burdened by a particular piece of equipment. One encumbrance unit is usually about 15 lbs, but large or unwieldy items might encumber more than their weight would suggest.

When a character's total carried weight exceeds half their carrying capacity, they are encumbered. This reduces their dash speed from 20 total paces per round to 10.

If a character's total carried weight exceeds their capacity, they are burdened. A burdened creature cannot dash, and their actions are always slow; if they try to carry more weight than their carrying capacity for more consecutive exploration turns than their Constitution, they will suffer 1d6 damage per subsequent exploration turn until they rest or lighten the load.

Armor

Light armor adds 1 to encumbrance, medium armor adds 2, and heavy armor adds 3.

Weapons

Light or medium weapons, tools, or potions at the ready do not count against encumbrance. A heavy weapon counts as one encumbrance point, as does a shield or a similarly-sized tool. A particularly large heavy weapon or tool such as a greatbow, polearm, or ladder counts as two encumbrance points.

Other Gear

A properly-worn and packed backpack counts as 1 encumbrance point for every 25 lb that it carries, while a similarly-sized sack roughly carried or slung over the back counts double. Large creatures only gain one encumbrance point per 100 lbs, and huge creatures only gain one encumbrance point per 500 lbs. A quadrupedal creature, such as a horse, doubles the pack weight that it can carry per encumbrance point for its size.

Damage and Repair

Sundering weapons can damage armor, shields, and weapons; the referee might also decide that a particularly brutal critical hit causes similar damage. Damage to armor reduces its defense, while damage to a shield or weapon renders it useless until repaired. Armor reduces its effectiveness by 1 per '6' rolled by the sundering weapon. Magical armor and weapons are typically made from feysilver or orichalc, and are much harder to damage — magical gear can only be damaged by a weapon of higher rarity.

Sundering damage might reduce an armor or weapon badly enough that it becomes useless, in which case the wearer is advised to drop it or take it off at the earliest convenience. Weapons can simply be dropped, while shields take a combat action to remove. Removing armor in combat requires a number of successful Finesse checks equal to the armor's type — one for light armor, two for medium, and three for heavy — with each Finesse check taking a full action.

Damaged metal armor or weapons must be repaired by a blacksmith with access to a forge. Preparing a forge for work takes an hour of effort (six exploration turns), plus fuel for the fire; a trained blacksmith can attempt to halve this time (to 3 turns) with a Finesse roll — success readies the forge, while failure waists the half hour of effort. Once the forge is hot and the workspace is prepared, each -1 reduction in defense requires one turn of effort and a Finesse test. Success repairs 1 point of defense, up to the armor's original integrity. A weapon or shield usually only takes one turn of effort to repair.

Other damaged gear might be repairable or not, depending on the item. If the referee decides that an item is repairable, someone with suitable skill and tools can make a Finesse roll as their exploration action to attempt to repair one -1 reduction. Conditions and quality of tools will make this roll easier or harder, based on the referee's judgment.

Vehicles and Mounts

Wagons and horses make overland travel much more convenient in some ways, and less so in others. A wagon pulled by horses or oxen travels at one league per two hours, and restricts the party's movements to maintained roads, but gives the party a mobile 'base of operations' to rest, store supplies, and use as makeshift cover during an encounter.

A well-built wagon pulled by an ox or two horses can typically carry up to a thousand pounds of supplies while still leaving room for up to four medium-sized passengers. A smaller cart, usually pulled by a mule, can carry up to 500 pounds of supplies, or half that while also comfortably carrying a single passenger.

A good quality mount, on the other hand, will often both be faster than walking and able to manage some amount of off-road travel; a set of good unencumbered horses might double the party's travel speed along the road, while more exotic mounts might negate specific kinds of difficult terrain if the mount is native to that terrain. Mounts tend to need more frequent rest than humans walking on foot, and obviously their food and water needs must be taken into account.

Mounts

A good riding mount allows a party to carry more gear without encumbrance and ignore some kinds of rough terrain, but does not otherwise increase travel speed. A fast horse might be able to double its overland speed for up to an hour – traveling up to 2 leagues at a full gallop - but would then need a full hour of rest. Pushing a horse past this limit is likely to wound or even kill it.

Carts

The simplest option for a land-vehicle is a cart: a driver's seat, a box, two wheels, and a hitch for a horse or a pair of mules. A cart will generally have one to six structure points, depending on materials and craftsmanship, and can generally carry up to 500 lb worth of gear. Room can be made for up to two medium-sized passengers or five small passengers; each medium passenger reduces its load capacity by 250 lbs, while each small passenger reduces its load capacity by 100 lb.

Wagons

The next step up is a wagon, with four wheels and a covered box, an extra seat next to the driver's, and a hitch for four horses or a pair of oxen. A wagon will have between two and twelve structure points, and can carry up to 2,000 lbs worth of gear, with passengers taking up room as above.

Carriages

Carriages are essentially fancy wagons designed for passenger comfort. A carriage is usually hitched to four horses; it has between five and fifteen structure points, and has room for 500 lbs worth of gear plus six dedicated seats for medium passengers.

Mounts and Beasts of Burden

Domesticated animals can be acquired by the party and used for various purposes. Genuine animal companions, such as a trusty warhorse or a mastiff, can be trained to obey commands and even fight alongside their master in battle.

Other animals will behave, or not, according to their nature. Survival can be used both to predict how an animal is about to behave, and to try to get it to do what you want from moment to moment.

When an animal is acquired, the referee might make a few D6 rolls to give it a rudimentary personality. These traits will influence how easy, or hard, it is to get the animal to perform specific actions.

D6	Trait 1	Trait 2
1	Cowardly	Ornery
2	Fearful	Unreliable
3	Wary	Indifferent
4	Reserved	Reliable
5	Brave	Loyal
6	Aggressive	Protective
D6	Trait 3	Trait 4
1	Jumpy	Unfriendly
2	Excitable	Shy
3	Nervous	Discerning
4	Playful	Curious
5	Calm	Outgoing
6	Steady	Gregarious

Donkey / Mule (2 HD)

Doom 11+ Hold 10+ Blast 13+ Trick 17+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+					
Armor:		0		HP: 2d6+4	
Movement:		Normal		Size: Medium	
Attacks (10+):		bite (d6 piercing), hooves (2d6 blunt)			
Con +2 Str +3		Dex +0 Int -4		Wis +0 Cha +0	
Talents (4+):		Agility, Alertness, Survival			

Cow (3 HD, Large)

Doom 8+ Hold 9+ Blast 14+ Trick 16+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+					
Armor:		0		HP: (3d6+12)x2	
Movement:		Normal		Size: Large	
Attacks (7+):		hooves (2d6), horns (2d6+3 piercing)			
Con +4 Str +3		Dex -2 Int -4		Wis +0 Cha +0	

Draft Horse (3 HD, Large)

Doom 10+ Hold 9+ Blast 12+ Trick 16+ Curse 11+ Fear 13+					
Armor:		0		HP: (3d6+6)x2	
Movement:		Fast		Size: Large	
Attacks (9+):		hooves (2d6 blunt)			
Con +2 Str +3		Dex +0 Int -4		Wis +1 Cha -1	
Talents (3+):		Alertness, Survival			

Mastiff (3 HD)

Doom 11+ Hold 10+ Blast 12+ Trick 15+ Curse 11+ Fear 11+					
Armor:		0		HP: 3d6+3	
Movement:		Fast		Size: Medium	
Attacks (11+):		bite (d6+2 piercing), grapple (2d6)			
Con +1		Str +2		Dex +0 Int -3 Wis +1 Cha +1	
Talents (4+):		Stealth, Alertness, Survival			
Senses:		Smell (superior)			

Ox (4 HD, Large)

Doom 7+ Hold 7+ Blast 13+ Trick 15+ Curse 10+ Fear 11+					
Armor:	1 (0)		HP: (4d6+16)x2		
Movement:	Normal		Size: Large		
Attacks (7+):	hooves (2d6), horns (2d6+4 piercing)				
Con +4 Str +4	Dex -2	Int -4	Wis +1	Cha +0	
Talents (4+):	Survival				

War Horse (4 HD, Large)

Doom 8+ Hold 8+ Blast 11+ Trick 15+ Curse 10+ Fear 10+					
Armor:		1 (0)		HP: (4d6+12)x2	
Movement:		Fast		Size: Large	
Attacks (9+):		hooves (2d6 blunt)			
Con +3 Str +3		Dex -2 Int -4		Wis +1 Cha +0	
Talents (4+):		Alertness, Survival			

Alchemy

Alchemy is the science of transmuting physical substances by combining or distilling them into their components. Wizards, druids, and dwarf dweomersmiths can all become highly skilled in alchemy, although their practices and ingredients might be somewhat different. At core, though, the principles of elixir and potion design are based on the alchemical interactions of the ingredients; thus a druid who examines a wizard's methods or products is likely to be able to duplicate them with little effort.

Elixirs and poisons are alchemical brews that are meant to be imbibed, and tinctures are meant to be rubbed onto or into their target, while potions are meant to be thrown, poured, or otherwise externally applied.

Brewing

Brewing an alchemical formula is an arcane or primal ritual. Wizards and dwarves require a separate formula from a spellbook for each formula that they wish to brew, while druids can improvise from whatever is on-hand.

A single common alchemical formula requires one materia charge, an uncommon formula requires two materia charges, and a rare formula requires three. Brewing is an arcane or primal ritual of the same circle as the resulting formula's rarity, which must be repeated once per hour until the formula is finished; common formulae take two hours to brew, while uncommon formulae take four hours, and rare formulae take six. Legendary potions must be nursed for an entire week, and require a common dragon pearl of the appropriate element dissolved into the formula.

An attending alchemist must make a Science or Medicine test once an hour to keep the formula from spoiling. When brewing legendary potions, alchemists often work in shifts so that the process can be monitored around the clock.

Ingredients

Most elixirs and potions are recipes handed down over generations. Other than the Materia, each ingredient has a hundred different possible substitutions or variations. If you can't find enough "eye of newt" for your brew, the referee can have you make a Science or Medicine test to figure out what substitutes might be more readily available that will still produce the same effect.

Regardless of the non-magical ingredients, each Common potion requires one "charge" worth of materia; an uncommon potion requires two charges, a rare potion requires three charges, and a legendary potion requires an entire common dragon pearl. A "charge" of materia may be as small as a pinch or drop or as large as a fist-sized stone; more potent materia will require less physical matter to amount to one "charge". A Science check can determine how much elemental or aetheric energy a particular piece of materia contains.

Gathering materia is a Survival or Science test that takes approximately an hour, against a difficulty based on the local environment; success nets 1d6 charges of types determined by the referee. Druids tend to be picky about their materia, only gathering it carefully and sustainably in a ritual context, but they also tend to be much better at gleaning useful scraps out of nearly any natural environment.

Ingredient Substitution

As long as the brewer has the correct element and amount of materia, the rest of a potion's ingredients can be substituted by a clever alchemist. Substituting ingredients will make the Science or Medicine check harder, unless the alchemist performs all the work to create a new formula that properly uses the new ingredients. Deciding which ingredients can substitute for each other is up to your referee, but should follow common sense, along with a passing nod to science and folklore.

Harvesting Ingredients

All alchemical formulae, magic items, spells, and talismans require materia to power them.

Characters can gather their materia as an exploration action by making a Survival check and a Science check, each with a difficulty based on how much natural material is in the local environment; if both checks succeeds, they gather one charge worth of materia. The referee can randomly determine the types of materia gathered based on the area searched:

Terrain Type	D6	Materia Type
Cavern, Mountains	1	Stone
River, Swamp	2	Water
Forest, Jungle	3	Wood
Plains, Hilltops	4	Air
Desert, Volcano	5	Fire
Eldritch	6	Psychic / Aetheric

The referee rolls 2d6; if both dice roll the same number, the materia found is the type indicated by that number. If the dice roll different numbers, the materia found is the type indicated by the terrain type searched. On double sixes, a rarer psychic or aetheric materia charge is found; the referee will roll an additional die to determine which, with a 50% chance of either type.

Harvesting from Monsters

The bodies of various supernatural creatures are also rich sources of materia and other ingredients; cleaning a carcass and harvesting it for resources is also a Survival test that can be performed as an exploration action in the wilds or the dungeon.

Harvesting in Faerie

The desperate or adventurous might even choose to venture directly across the veil into Faerie to harvest materia; while incredibly dangerous, gathering materia from Faerie is as simple as plucking the nearest brightly-colored berries, leaves or rocks. Survival rolls in Faerie to harvest materia are less about determining whether materia is found, and more about avoiding random encounters against fey beasts or the Fair Folk.

Consuming Elixirs and Poisons

When an elixir or poison is consumed, it immediately begins producing its effects. These effects will often have a duration, before it begins to wear off. Some elixirs will wear off gradually, with their beneficial effect lessening until it dissipates, or even reverses into a harmful aftereffect.

Elixir Aftereffects

After an elixir's beneficial effects wear off, its aftereffects begin. An elixir's aftereffects are treated exactly like a poison. The imbiber always gets a save vs. Doom to resist the aftereffects; this saving throw is easy for common elixirs, and hard for legendary elixirs. On a success, any damage inflicted by the aftereffects is halved, and any duration that would normally last until the imbiber sleeps 6 hours instead only lasts one hour.

Tailored Elixirs

A brewer can attempt to make an elixir easier for a particular creature to imbibe; this requires an exploration action spent making a Medicine check, while the brewer studies the intended imbiber's metabolism and health to optimize the brew for them. On a success, it will be easier for that imbiber (and only that imbiber) to resist the aftereffects of that brewed elixir, if consumed within the same day that it was brewed. The brewer must perform this action each time they wish to brew an elixir for a specific imbiber, since each creature's health, metabolism, and diet changes from day to day.

Consuming Multiple Elixirs

If a creature imbibes a second Elixir while still under the ongoing effects of a previous elixir or poison (including aftereffects), it must immediately save vs. Doom, and cannot gain any benefit from temporary Constitution bonuses (but still suffers from any penalties).

If the imbiber succeeds, it gains the bonus of each elixir it has imbibed, but also suffers all aftereffect penalties from all such formulae. On failure, the imbiber suffers 1d6 damage per rarity of potion imbibed since it last slept, all such potions drop to their maximum penalty aftereffect, and the imbiber cannot gain any positive effects from further potions until all damage has healed.

Elixirs

Elixirs invariably have a positive effect when imbibed. A particular elixir can be identified by a hard Medicine roll.

Elixir of Antivenin Uncommon Elixir

Ingredients - giant spider venom, ephedra stalk, Wood materia

An Elixir of Antivenin immediately neutralizes any poisons affecting the imbiber, then halves all poison damage they receive and makes all saves vs. poison effects easy for the next 2d6 combat rounds. When the effect wears off, the imbiber suffers 2d6 damage.

Barkskin Elixir Uncommon Elixir

Ingredients - ironwood bark, Wood materia

An Elixir of Barkskin hardens the imbiber's skin to the consistency of wooden bark. For the next hour, they gain an Armor of 2, but all Alertness checks and saving throws that involve touch become harder. After the elixir wears off, the imbiber continues to suffer this disadvantage, and is mildly distracted by the bark itching and flaking off of their skin, causing all their actions to be slower. This aftereffect remains until they complete a full night's sleep.

Elixir of Darkvision Uncommon Elixir

Ingredients - Giant spider eyes, Flame materia

An Elixir of Darkvision grants the imbiber natural darkvision for its duration. Roll 1d6 to determine the number of hours the effect lasts.

When the effect wears off, the imbiber must save or be blinded until they sleep for at least 6 hours. Even if they succeed, all Alertness tests and saving throws vs. illusion involving vision are harder until they complete a full night's sleep.

Elixir of Enhanced Ability Elixir

Ingredients - Wood materia, and various ingredients that depend on the ability to be enhanced.

An Elixir of Enhanced Ability significantly increases one of the imbiber's ability scores. The imbiber gains a temporary static bonus to the ability chosen when brewing the potion, which is based on the elixir's rarity:

Rarity	Bonus
Uncommon	+1
Rare	+2
Legendary	+3

A character may not have two static bonuses to the same ability; if any other effect other than natural ability score or species would grant that creature a bonus to the same ability as this elixir, only the higher bonus applies. If you gain a full +3 bonus to an ability above its natural value, all task tests using talents linked to that ability also become easier.

This bonus decreases by 1 per exploration turn until it becomes a -1 penalty, which remains until the imbiber sleeps for at least 6 hours. While you have any penalty to an ability, all task tests using talents linked to that ability are harder.

Elixir of Giant Growth Rare Elixir

Ingredients - Acorn, Wood materia

An Elixir of Giant Growth increases the imbiber's size by one size level - small creatures become medium, medium creatures become large, large creatures become huge, and so on. This grants them all the normal benefits and drawbacks of being one size class larger. The imbiber also gains a +3 bonus to Strength and Constitution, and suffers -1 to their Dexterity. Clothing and gear are unfortunately unaffected; any worn clothing or armor will need to be salvaged and repaired. The imbiber must immediately save or become stunned as they readjust to their new size.

The effect lasts 2d6 combat rounds; the referee will roll the duration in secret. After the effect wears off, the imbiber suffers a critical hit.

Elixir of Haste*Rare Elixir*

Ingredients - Coca leaves, coffee beans, cacao beans, cinnamon bark, ephedra stalk, Wood materia, Air materia, Flame materia

An Elixir of Haste grants the imbiber an additional action per round for as long as it lasts, makes one of their actions faster, doubles their movement speed, and allows them to ignore all effects of the hobbled or stunned conditions until the elixir wears off. The effect lasts 1d6 combat rounds; the imbiber then suffers a critical hit.

Elixir of Health*Elixir*

Ingredients - Ginseng root, giant bee honey, orange blossoms, Wood materia

A common elixir of health allows a character to roll half of their hit dice (round up) and recover half that many hit points (round up again), with no negative aftereffects. An uncommon elixir of health allows a character to roll all their hit dice, then recover that many hit points.

Longstrider Elixir*Common Elixir*

Ingredients - Coca leaves, snake oil, Wood materia

A Longstrider Elixir infuses the imbiber with vital energy, invigorating their leg muscles and tendons. For 2d6 combat rounds, their base speed and dash speed are doubled and their jumping distance is tripled. The imbiber then suffers 1d6 damage and is hobbled until they heal if they fail their saving throw.

Elixir of Prophylaxis*Uncommon Elixir*

Ingredients - Blue bread mold, willow bark, Wood materia

An Elixir of Prophylaxis immediately grants the imbiber one saving throw against any disease condition affecting them, while also making all such saving throws easier until the next sunrise or sunset. However, all attack throws, ability checks, and task checks become harder for the same duration.

Elixir of Regeneration*Rare Elixir*

Ingredients - Axolotl blood, gecko tail, bamboo shoots, Wood materia

An Elixir of Regeneration drastically increases the imbiber's natural healing abilities, allowing wounds to close and heal before their very eyes. The effect lasts 2d6 combat rounds; at the end of each of those rounds, the imbiber heals one hit die worth of damage. As damage heals, the imbiber may make a reflexive Constitution save each round for one of their lasting injury effects chosen at random; on a success, that effect is downgraded to its lower version if it was a serious lasting injury, or removed altogether if it was a minor lasting injury.

This potion can even regrow lost limbs or sensory organs, if given enough time. If poured into the mouth or wounds of a corpse that has been dead for fewer hours than one roll of its hit die, it makes a saving throw vs. Doom. On success, it returns to life and immediately begins regenerating. If the corpse is in pieces, the head must be attached to or adjacent to the neck, and the upper body must contain enough heart tissue to begin beating.

Once the effects of the potion wear off, the imbiber is incapable of healing by any means until they sleep for at least 6 hours.

Elixir of Water Breathing *Uncommon Elixir*

Ingredients - lungfish bladder, Water materia, Air materia

The Elixir of Water Breathing allows the imbiber to breathe both in air and underwater. The potion lasts a number of exploration turns equal to 1d6 + the imbiber's Constitution. After the effect wears off, the imbiber suffers 2d6 damage.

Poisons

These poisons are usually given to unwilling or unaware targets, either by force-feeding or injection via a specially-designed piercing weapon (treat as a dagger). Force-feeding an unwilling target requires that they first be restrained, while injection requires a successful attack throw that deals at least 1 hp of non-blunt damage. They can also be ingested willingly, if for some reason the poison's effect is desired.

Delirium Poison

Rare Poison

Ingredients- animascaria mushrooms, blue-wood seeds, Wood materia

Delirium poison causes the imbiber to suffer violent hallucinations and mental confusion. It must roll a d6 at the start of each round to determine its behavior:

1 - The creature uses all its movement to move in a random direction. Roll a d8 and assign a direction to each die face. The creature is then stunned for the rest of the round.

2 to 3 - the creature is stunned, and does not move or act.

4 to 5 - the creature uses its action to make a melee attack against a randomly determined creature within its reach, and then is stunned for the rest of the round. If there is no creature within reach, it does nothing this round.

6 - the creature can act and move normally. At the end of the round, it can save vs. Doom to attempt to end the effect.

Death Poison

Any Rarity Poison

Ingredients - Nightshade, Belladonna, Almonds, Wood materia

One of the most deadly poisons known to man, death poison immediately forces a save, inflicting a critical hit on a failure. On a success, it still inflicts ongoing poison damage. If brewed as a common poison, the saving throw is easy; if brewed as a rare potion, the saving throw is hard.

Disability Poison

Uncommon+ Poison

Ingredients - Wood materia, and natural materia that depends on the ability to be poisoned.

Ability-sapping poison is indistinguishable at first glance from a potion of enhanced ability, but if imbibed, it instead decreases one of the imbiber's abilities. The imbiber suffers a temporary static penalty to the ability chosen when brewing the potion; this penalty decreases by 1 per exploration turn until it becomes a -1 penalty, which remains until the imbiber sleeps for at least 6 hours.

Rarity	Penalty
Uncommon	-1
Rare	-2
Legendary	-3

While you have a penalty to an ability, all task tests linked to that ability are harder.

Love Potion

Uncommon Poison

Ingredients - Sassafras root, vanilla extract, rose petals, Wood materia, Illusion or Fey materia

This brew appears to be a normal elixir of some kind, but when imbibed, its imbiber immediately becomes stunned, wandering about until they find another creature. They immediately lose the stunned condition and become beguiled by the first creature that they see, hear, or touch.

Roll the 2d6 x 10 to determine the number of hours that the effect lasts. Whenever the beguiled imbiber could normally deny or snap out of the beguiled condition, they instead subtract one hour from the number of hours remaining on the potion instead of automatically breaking the effect. Once the potion wears off, the imbiber finds all Intuition tests and Wisdom saving throws harder as an aftereffect until they get a full night's sleep.

Polymorph Potion*Rare Poison*

Ingredients - a drop of blood, a tooth or bone, and a hair, feather or scale from the animal to transform into, Wood materia

A Polymorph Potion transforms the imbiber into a specific kind of natural beast for a number of exploration turns equal to its potency. The beast to be transformed into is chosen when the poison is brewed, and some tissue from a creature of that type must be incorporated into the ingredients.

The imbiber must immediately save or be stunned as they readjust to their new shape. If they critically fail, the potion's effects become permanent.

While transformed, the imbiber's hit point, features and abilities become those of the species chosen. This includes mental abilities; a transformed creature with an Intelligence of -4 or lower is no longer considered intelligent. The imbiber cannot transform into any other shape while under the effects of the potion, and cannot transform back into their natural shape until the effects wear off.

Potion of Sleeping Death*Rare Poison*

Ingredients - pufferfish liver, pomegranate seeds, Wood materia

A potion of sleeping death places its imbiber in a state of suspended animation for a number of hours equal to the poison's potency. If the brewer knows who the imbiber will be and can examine them thoroughly, and succeeds on a Medicine test when brewing the poison, they may precisely time its duration down to the hour by adjusting the dose. For the duration, the target appears to be dead to all mundane inspection.

Upon waking, the imbiber must make a hard save or suffer a critical hit.

An unusual and extremely controversial use of this potion is to allow the living to briefly enter the realm of the dead. If the Lay to Rest miracle is performed on someone while under the influence of this poison, the imbiber must save or die; if they succeed, they leave their body as a ghost for the duration of the poison, returning when they awaken.

Sleeping Powder*Any Rarity Poison*

Ingredients - dream poppy sap, violet hempweed pollen, Wood materia

The poison is made into a fine powder, which can be blown into an adjacent creature's face. A creature that breathes in the powder must save or fall unconscious for 2d6 turns.

The imbiber falls into a deep slumber that cannot be shaken until they sleep off the effects. One dose of Common sleeping powder affects a single adjacent creature, while one dose of Uncommon sleeping powder can affect all creatures in a 3-space cone when blown from the hand, or within a 3-space diameter sphere when thrown.

If mixed with water and ingested, the powder becomes much more potent, lasting 2d6 hours. Saving vs. an uncommon or rare ingested sleeping potion is hard.

Even if they succeed in their saving throw, a creature poisoned by sleeping powder will be groggy, making all rolls harder for one turn.

Truth Serum*Rare Poison*

Ingredients - dream poppy sap, rye ergot, magic mushrooms, Illusion or Fey materia

A creature that imbibes truth serum must make a hard Wit test whenever they attempt to speak. On a failure, they blurt out the most truthful version of whatever they intended to say, regardless of their intent to deceive. While the effects last, any Wit tests that they make to influence another creature are hard, and Wit tests made by other creatures to get them to divulge information are easy.

Roll 2d6 to determine the number of turns that the effects last. After the effect wears off, the imbiber must make an easy save vs. Doom or suffer a critical hit.

Potions and Tinctures

Alchemical potions and tinctures are not meant to be ingested; instead, they are either thrown like bombs, or applied to an object or surface.

Earth-Binding Potion *Uncommon Potion*

Ingredients - Mimic mucous, Earth materia

When thrown at a creature capable of flight, this potion entangles and fouls whatever apparatus they use to stay airborne, pulling them to the ground. A creature affected by this spell immediately loses their flying speed, and if flying, plummets to the ground.

Potion of Elemental Fury *Common Potion*

Ingredients - saltpetre, charcoal, Any Elemental materia

This potion may be thrown or shattered at your feet. When released, it unleashes a blast area attack with a radius of 2 paces, dealing 2d6 elemental damage.

When brewed as an Uncommon or Rare potion, the blast radius extends by 1 pace per rarity level, and the damage increases by 2d6 per rarity level.

Tincture of Elemental Essence *Rare Potion*

Ingredients - olive oil, any Elemental materia

This potion produces a thick gel that is catalyzed by a small spark or a sharp blow to release a burst of elemental energy.

When coated onto an arrow or other projectile, the missile deals an additional +1d6 elemental damage on a hit the first time it is fired. If it misses, the elemental damage is unleashed onto the environment wherever the missile comes to rest.

When coated onto a melee weapon, the weapon deals +1d6 elemental damage each time it hits. A weapon coated with this tincture is protected from the effects of the imbued element, even if it would normally be vulnerable to that damage type. It will continue to inflict this extra damage until its elemental damage die rolls a '1', at which time the effects end.

Potion of Entanglement *Common Potion*

Ingredients - crawling Creeper seed pods, Wood materia

Grasping vines sprout from the ground, centered where this potion is poured or shattered. A circle 5 paces in diameter becomes difficult terrain, and any creature passing through the zone must make a Strength saving throw to avoid being restrained by the entangling plants until the effect ends. The vines last 1d6 combat rounds before withering into brittle, dry dust.

When brewed as an Uncommon potion, the vines grow sharp, hidden thorns, inflicting 1d6 piercing damage per pace of movement to each creature that attempts to move into or through the area, and the effect's duration extends to minutes instead of rounds. A Rare potion lasts hours, or can produce a permanent hedge of thorny vines if the potion used to create it was imbued with sufficient Materia to preserve indefinitely.

Potion of Faerie Fire *Common Potion*

Ingredients - firefly viscera, Flame materia

When this potion shatters, the splashing liquid reacts with the air to begin glowing, coating everything within a 2 pace radius of the point of impact that fails a save vs. Blast. The effect lasts 1d6 combat rounds; all affected objects and creatures are easier to hit with attack throws, can't benefit from invisibility, and emit dim light out to 10 feet.

Potion of Bottled Fog *Common Potion*

Ingredients - saltpetre, sugar, Water materia, Air Materia

Thick whitish-grey fog pours from this potion as it bubbles and evaporates, heavily obscuring everything it reaches. A circle 5 paces in diameter becomes heavily obscured. The fog lasts 2d6 combat rounds unless blown away by a strong wind or heavy rain.

When brewed as an Uncommon potion, the area of effect increases to a circle 7 paces in diameter, and lasts 2d6 exploration turns.

At Rare, the area increases to 10 paces in diameter and lasts 1d6 hours.

Bottle of Illusory Visions *Common Potion*

Ingredients - morning glory seeds, magic mushrooms, rye ergot, Illusion or Fey materia

A Vision in a Bottle is a Silent Image spell dissolved into an alchemical solution. Upon uncorking the bottle and pouring out the potion, it immediately evaporates into mist, forming the illusion crafted while brewing. The illusion lasts 1d6 hours. Unlike a normal Silent Image spell, neither the brewer nor the un-corker may alter or control the image once it is formed.

An Uncommon Bottle of Illusory Visions instead casts the Major Image spell, and a Rare bottle instead casts the Mirage spell.

Magic Ink *Common Potion*

Ingredients - Oak galls, orichalc dust, feysilver dust, materia (each makes a different Ink)

Magic Ink is the basic formula for the inks and dyes used to prepare arcane spells and scrolls, as well as divine prayer strips. While they all use the same formula, each different element requires its own mixture of magic ink, made with the proper materia to resonate with the appropriate element. There are seven distinct 'colors' of magic ink, each determined by the type of raw materia used and the specific process used to refine it:

- Aetheric ink is a deep, vibrant purple.
- Illusion ink is milky and opalescent
- Earth ink is rich bronze with flakes of silver
- Water ink is deep blue, flecked with turquoise and sea-green.
- Wood ink is a vivid green, with flashes of gold and magenta.
- Air ink is a cloudy grey, occasionally shot through with gold or light blue.
- Flame ink is a vibrant red-orange, with flakes of gold and silver.

When a wizard brews magic ink, they roll 1d6 to determine the number of bottles of ink that are produced from the materia. Each bottle can prepare six total circles of Arcane magic spells, or three circles worth of spell scrolls.

Salve of Slipperiness *Common Potion*

Ingredients - hagfish slime, mineral oil, Water materia

This potion can cover approximately 100 square feet of surface. If poured out onto the ground, it covers a square or circle roughly 2 paces on a side. This patch lasts 1d6 combat rounds.

Each creature within the affected area must succeed on a hard Agility check or fall prone. The entire area becomes difficult terrain for the duration of the effect; any creature that enters or leaves the patch must also immediately roll Agility or fall prone.

Sovereign Glue *Uncommon Potion*

Ingredients - Mimic mucous, almonds, cotton, aqua fortis, Earth and Wood materia

Sovereign glue is an intensely sticky and fast-drying substance that can instantly and permanently weld any two surfaces together. One brew is sufficient to stick together approximately one square foot of surface. Once bonded, only a Salve of Slipperiness can undo the effect.

Artificial Dragon Pearl *Common+ Potion*

Ingredients - Elemental materia, aqua regia

Creating a dream pearl or dragon pearl from harvested materia is an alchemical process that takes one day for a common pearl, one week for an uncommon pearl, one lunar month for a rare pearl, or one year for a legendary pearl. 50 charges of raw materia must be fed into the process each day, while the solution itself is kept at precise temperatures and pressures. At the end of the process, a large raw crystal of purified materia is extracted from the solution and painstakingly carved into a shape suitable for conducting the elemental, aetheric, or psychic energies.

Each day of brewing requires a Science check with a difficulty determined by the quality of the workshop and raw materials, and carving the final gem requires a Finesse test with a difficulty based on the pearl's rarity - easy for a common pearl, normal for an uncommon pearl, or hard for a rare or legendary pearl. A single failure in this process ruins the entire attempt, wasting all time and materia consumed up to that point.

Magic Items

Magic Item Traits

During the course of the game, a character might find or craft various magically enhanced items. Magic Items, or the materials necessary for crafting them, are some of the more rewarding forms of treasure that an adventurer might find in a dungeon.

Rarity

Rarity represents the general potency of the artifact's components and ingredients. There are four levels of rarity: common, uncommon, rare, and legendary. A common artifact can typically produce a single first-circle effect, an uncommon artifact can generate a single second-circle effect or two first-circle effects, and a rare artifact can generate a third-circle effect, or more rarely might hold multiple spells at first- or second-circle. Each legendary item is unique, often with a number of effects at different levels. Many magic items power their magic by incorporating dragon pearls, which allows them to recharge each sunrise and sunset (or faster, if a more powerful pearl is used to power weaker magics). Other items incorporate materia depletable charges.

Origin

Magic items can have an Arcane, Primal, or Divine origin. Wizards and dweomersmiths craft Arcane magic items, while druids craft Primal magic items; Divine magic items are not crafted, but instead occur spontaneously but rarely in the presence of truly heroic actions. Certain magic items have both an Arcane and a Primal version; the design and construction methods of each are recognizably different, but studying an item from one origin might still give a magic-user of a different class some clues or inspiration for their own designs. Magic-users may craft common items at third level, uncommon items at fifth level, rare items at seventh level, and legendary items at ninth level.

A magic item can be automatically used by any magic-user whose magic corresponds to its origin, and magic weapons and armor may be used without a check. Non-magic-users can attempt to use other magic items with a task check (Science for arcane items or Survival for primal items); this check is easy for common items and hard for rare items.

Item Type

A character has several places on their body where a magic item might be worn. Each item is designed to be worn in a specific area, and does not work unless it is worn there.

Weapons are simply held in the hand like normal weapons. A character may wield two different one-handed magical weapons at once, or a magical weapon in one hand and a focus in the other.

Armor is worn on the entire body; a character can only wear one suit of armor at a time.

Amulets are designed to be worn around the neck. Some amulets are designed as jewelry, while others are full-sized capes or cloaks. A character may only wear one amulet at a time.

Belts are also designed to be worn over the body, usually around the waist. A character may wear one belt at a time, and may wear a magical belt and magical armor simultaneously.

Boots are designed to be worn on the feet, and always come in pairs (or sets of four, for four-legged creatures). A character gains no benefit from wearing less than a full set.

Crowns are designed to be worn on the head. Some crowns are incorporated into full helms, meant to be worn with a matching suit of armor. The helm's effect will be separate from the armor's.

Rings are designed to be worn over the fingers, although some "rings" are actually shaped as full-hand gloves or gauntlets. A character may wear at most one ring on each hand. Certain ring items are paired; wearing only one ring of a pair might impart a lesser effect, or no effect at all, depending on the referee's judgment.

Finally, **Wondrous Items** are a catch-all category for magic items that are neither worn nor wielded, but are used in some other fashion.

Creating New Magic Items

Most magic items are relics of the Old Empire, passed down from generation to generation due to their utility. Some can be duplicated by modern alchemists, while others are priceless heirlooms worth a kingdom.

Wizards, druids, and dweomersmiths may attempt to craft new magic items. The crafter must have the desired item's blueprints, as well as all the necessary ingredients. Dweomersmiths may also construct rapid prototypes of arcane magic items called enchantments in a matter of minutes and from mere scrap; these items operate identically to normal magic items, but require their creator's constant maintenance to continue to function.

In order to hold a permanent enchantment, a weapon, armor, or other device must be a masterwork item, with an innate +1 bonus to its damage (if a weapon) or defense (if an armor or shield) before it is enchanted; any enchantment bonuses will replace this innate bonus with their own effect. The object must also be made with some kind of compartment or gemstone-like setting, which will hold the materia that will power its magic.

Almost any arcane spell or primal talisman can be woven into a magic item by including materia that corresponds to the effect's element; this materia may be refined and perfected into a dragon pearl, which is a nugget of condensed and purified materia that resembles a small bead or gem, to allow the item to recharge without expending fresh materia. Without a dragon pearl, magic items have a fixed number of charges, which must be replenished with fresh materia by a skilled alchemist once they run out.

In addition, orichalc and feysilver alloys must be incorporated into the design - these are woven into the sigils and runes of the effect's arcana, which channel the materia's energy into the item's effect. Approximately $\frac{1}{8}$ oz worth of orichalc and feysilver must be woven into a common artifact, about $\frac{1}{4}$ oz into an uncommon artifact, or $\frac{1}{2}$ oz into a rare artifact.

Finally, the physical substance of the item must be made from high-quality materials capable of withstanding the spell's energies, which usually means hides, woods, or other materials harvested from creatures with

magic-like elemental powers that match the elemental aspect of the channeled forces.

The crafting process itself takes an amount of time depending on the rarity of the object being constructed. Each day, the crafter and each assistant make a Finesse check, with a difficulty based on the item's rarity. Each success on the part of the crafter accumulates +1d6 build point towards the construction, +1 additional build point per successful assistant. A common item requires 5 build points to complete, an uncommon item requires 25, a rare item requires 100, and a legendary item might require a thousand or more.

At the end of the project, the referee makes a Science check on behalf of the crafter vs. a difficulty based on the item's rarity. If this roll succeeds, the item works as intended; if it fails, on the other hand, the item appears to function normally but bears a curse.

Cursed Items

Cursed items tend to activate their powers at the least convenient times and use them in ways that hinder rather than help the creature using them. Some cursed items bind to the user and cannot be removed without Remove Curse or Dispel Magic; successfully casting either on such an item detaches it from the wearer and deactivates it, but does not uncurse the item — it must be disassembled and rebuilt from scratch to remove its flaws.

Magic Item Maintenance

Arcane magic items must be maintained, or their performance will begin to degrade. An arcane magic item that has been actively used needs approximately ten minutes of active maintenance per day from a dweomersmith or wizard, or its quality will reduce from good to fair. An arcane item in fair quality requires an easy Science check for a magic-user to properly activate or maintain it; activating it also becomes one step harder for non-magic-users. An arcane item in poor quality requires a normal Science check for a magic-user to properly activate or maintain it, and cannot be activated by a non-magic-user; on a failure, the item becomes cursed.

Primal magic items do not track quality, but instead have rudimentary personalities of their own, tracking their attitude in a similar manner as henchmen or animal companions.

Magic Armor

Enchanted armor typically adds its rarity level to its Armor rating, including vs. piercing effects, to a maximum Armor rating of 5.

Some enchanted shields can be used to block area effects or effects that don't use an attack throw, making your saving throw easier.

Bracer of Shielding *Any Rarity (Arcane)*

Ingredients: Aether Pearl, feysilver

When deactivated, a bracer of shielding looks like a fine bluish-silver bracer inlaid with ornate runes and a clear stone against the back of the wrist. Activating it causes the stone to glow softly in the dark, pulsing brighter when touched or tapped with any force.

A bracer of shielding acts as a shield that can defend against ranged, elemental, and aetheric attacks as well as physical melee attacks, without any weight and without occupying the wearer's shield hand. The bracer also subtracts twice its rarity level from any aetheric damage that the wearer receives. The shield only becomes visible and solid when blocking a potentially damaging shot, appearing as a glowing, translucent disc made of crackling geometric hexagons with a brightness based on the force of the impact.

Dwarven Apron *Common (Arcane)*

Ingredients: Flame Pearl, orichalc, firebat leather

A dwarven apron appears to be a thick padded leather suit and blacksmith's apron. Upon closer inspection, thick plates of a fibrous black mineral are woven into the leather, and dark gold filigree patterns are woven along its edge.

As +1 light armor, a dwarven apron grants a Defense of 2. It additionally protects from heat and cold, and reduces all fire damage that the wearer receives as if it was weapon damage.

Feysilver Armor

Rare (Arcane or Primal)

Ingredients: feysilver

When used for armor, feysilver appears as a shimmering white metal with a mirror finish.

Feysilver can be used to make any masterwork armor or shield that would normally be made from steel. Any feysilver armor counts as one category lighter, both for purposes of stealth and encumbrance - feysilver chainmail counts as light armor while providing the protection of masterwork medium armor (3), while feysilver plate counts as medium armor while providing the protection of masterwork heavy armor (4). Additionally, armor made from feysilver doesn't interfere with primal magics the way iron or steel do.

Feysilver will need to be hidden under clothing to be stealthy. A feysilver shield lowers its encumbrance by one, but still impedes stealth due to its bulk.

Flying Shield

Rare (Arcane or Primal)

Ingredients: feysilver, pegasus feathers, Air Pearl

A flying shield appears to be a fine bluish-silver medium round shield mounted on a bracer of similar metal. When activated, the shield detaches from the bracer and hovers in mid-air, protecting the wearer while leaving their shield arm free to hold a weapon or item. The shield floats back into place and re-attaches to the bracer after 1d6 minutes. Once activated, this effect cannot be used again for one hour.

Living Armor

Uncommon (Primal)

Ingredients: ironwood, jade, strangler vine, Wood Pearl, Earth Pearl, Water Pearl

Living armor is a suit of leather armor made from interlocking segments of living oak and green jade stone, woven together with strips of strangler vine. As +1 light armor, it grants a Defense of 2.

Living armor's most unique feature is its ability to self-repair. If living armor is sundered, it can be planted in fertile soil, where it will slowly knit itself back together at the rate of 1 point of lost Defense per day.

Mage Robes*Any Rarity (Arcane)**Ingredients: duskworm silk, feysilver, Aether Pearl*

Mage robes are finely-woven silk robes with a gemstone clasp, and metallic threads woven throughout in arcane patterns. The robes are enchanted to grant a Defense equal to their rarity without interfering with a wizard's spellcasting ability, so a wizard can wear them as if unarmored.

The robes' enchantment also adds its bonus to any saving throw to maintain focus or to resist any elemental or magical attack, or to any saving throw or task check made as part of casting an arcane spell.

Mirror Shield*Rare (Arcane)**Ingredients: feysilver, Aether Pearl*

A mirror shield appears to be a large shield with a mirror-like finish on its outer surface, and an inlaid opalescent gem on its wrist strap. The shield can be used once per round with a successful Finesse check to block any attack, including a ranged or magical attack, and can even block a blast or cone.

If you successfully block a magic ranged or area attack, you may activate the shield to reflect that attack back onto the attacker, or onto another creature or space of the shield-bearer's choice within 5 paces of the shield-bearer. The shield-bearer makes a new ranged attack throw for the reflected attack. Once this power is activated, it cannot be used again until the next sunrise or sunset.

Orichalc Plate*Uncommon (Arcane)**Ingredients: orichalc, Earth Pearl*

Orichalc plate appears to be a finely wrought suit of heavy armor made of a bronze metal. It grants a total Defense of 5, but is noticeably heavier than an equivalent suit made from steel, adding +1 to its encumbrance (for a total encumbrance of 4). When also wearing the suit's helm (which has an Earth Pearl inset above the visor's forehead), all saves vs. critical hits from weapon attacks are easier.

Robes of Disguise*Rarer (Arcane)**Ingredients: duskworm silk, feysilver, Dream Pearl*

Robes of disguise are finely-woven grey linen robes with dark silver metallic threads woven throughout in hypnotic spirals. As cloth, robes of disguise do not grant any innate Defense.

The wearer of these robes may activate them to change their appearance and voice to match another person that they have interacted with in person for at least an hour with roughly the same size and body shape as the observer (no more than 25% larger or smaller).

As an illusion effect, an observer that inspects the wearer's appearance closely may make a hard save vs. Trick to notice the illusion; this save is easy if the inspector also touches the wearer while inspecting them.

Robes of Splendour*Any Rarity (Arcane)**Ingredients: duskworm silk, orichalc, Dream Pearl*

Robes of splendour are expensive, finely-woven silk robes with metallic threads woven throughout in ornamental patterns. Upon closer inspection, arcane sigils and runes are incorporated into the robe's ornamentation at key points. As cloth, robes of splendour do not grant any innate Defense.

The wearer of these robes gains a bonus to their d6 Charm checks. This bonus is equal to the robes' rarity: +1 rank for Common robes, +2 for Uncommon robes, or +3 for Rare robes. If another magical effect also increases the wearer's Charm check rolls, only the highest effect takes hold.

Thornweave Hide*Any Rarity (Primal)**Ingredients: owlbear pelt, lasher thorns, Wood Pearl*

A Thornweave Hide appears to be a bearskin pelt with fine owl feather trim and a clasp made from a bright golden-green gem. On closer inspection, thick wooden spines are embedded deep in the fur. As +1 light armor, it grants a Defense of 2.

When hit by a melee attack, the armor's thorns retaliate against the attacker, automatically inflicting piercing damage equal to twice the armor's rarity bonus.

Magic Weapons

Enchanted weapons are by far the most straightforward of magic items to use. Since all weapon enchantments require that the base weapon be a masterwork, a magic weapon always provides a +1 to its attack throw, unless its enchantment provides a better bonus. Most magic weapons add an additional die of damage per rarity level, although some weapons provide a more complex attack enhancement instead.

Aetheric Blade

Rare (Divine or Primal)

Ingredients: Aether Pearl, feysilver, silver

An aetheric blade appears to be a finely crafted silver dagger. Upon closer inspection, thin runes and sigils are etched along the blade and the hilt, and inlaid with a metal of a slightly different color.

An aetheric blade completely bypasses armor when it strikes, and inflicts the wielder's choice of piercing or aetheric damage.

Additionally, as their action the wielder may make a slash in midair, rending open a "hole" in reality that opens into faerie or shadow. The hole remains open until the end of its wielder's next turn, and the dagger becomes inert until the next sunrise or sunset.

Placing an aetheric blade into a bag of holding is an infamous and absurdly stupid way to improvise a weapon of mass destruction. The magics of both systems prove instantly and fatally incompatible, tearing a hole into the deep aether that sucks in all objects and creatures within 10 paces of the rip. Both magic items, and everything else that falls into the hole, are permanently lost. Creatures may attempt save vs. Hold to avoid being sucked in, which is hard if adjacent to the tear, at normal difficulty 2-5 paces away, and easy if 6 or more paces away. Anyone holding either the bag or the blade as the two items touch automatically fails this saving throw.

Cannon

Rare (Arcane)

Ingredients: orichalc, iron

A cannon is a siege weapon similar to a giant firearm, which typically uses an alchemical reaction to propel an iron ball at extreme velocities. These cannon deal structure damage on a hit, and an equal amount of thunder hit point damage to all creatures within 10 feet of the point of impact.

Cannon are typically mounted on a large carriage mount, which is pulled by horses or mules until it is detached and readied for fire. Aiming, firing, and reloading a cannon each take the combined actions of a full crew of engineers. The minimum crew size depends on the size of the cannon – light cannon require 2 crew, medium cannon require 4, and heavy cannon require 6.

Cannon Type	Damage	Range	Ammo
Light Cannon	[1D6+2]	100	20
Medium Cannon	[2D6+1]	100	15
Heavy Cannon	[3D6]	100	10

Legendary cannon use a dragon pearl instead of alchemical ammunition; sunlance cannon use flame pearls to inflict radiant structure damage on a hit and flame hit point damage to anything within 10 feet of the point of impact, while stormlance cannon use air pearls to inflict lightning damage on a hit and thunder hit point damage within 10 feet.

Earthbreaker

Any Rarity (Arcane or Primal)

Ingredients: Earth Pearl, orichalc, iron

An earthbreaker is an oversized bludgeon enchanted with elemental Earth energy, adding +1d6 per rarity level to its blunt damage whenever a melee attack with it hits. Additionally, whenever you hit or miss with a melee attack with the weapon, the area in the target's space becomes difficult terrain.

Against a target with structure points, an earthbreaker deals [1D6 + rarity] structure damage, and inflicts a critical hit on a damage die roll of '6'.

Firearm*Uncommon+ (Arcane)**Ingredients: orichalc, iron*

Firearms are ranged crossbow-class weapons which use alchemical charges to fire small pellets of iron or lead at extreme velocities. They are considered simple weapons, usable by anyone that could fire a crossbow of the same size. Each type of firearm is a different level of arcane artifact:

Firearm	Rarity	Range	Size & Properties
Pistol	U	15	Light
Musket	U	25	Medium
Blunderbuss	U	Cone 3	Heavy
Revolver	R	15	Light, Magazine 6
Rifle	R	50	Medium
Hand Mortar	R	Cone 3	Heavy (fire damage)
Thunderlance	L	50	Heavy, Polearm
Thunder Rattler	L	Line 20	Heavy, Magazine 10

Firearms are a new and volatile technology, and as such bring their own unique set of weapon properties.

Improved Damage - All firearms deal full piercing damage for a ranged weapon of their size, plus an equal amount of thunder elemental damage. (Hand mortars deal fire damage + thunder damage, instead of piercing + thunder). Heavy firearms deal [1D6-1] structure damage when aimed at a target with structure points.

Improved Critical Hit Chance - All firearms achieve a critical hit whenever any damage die rolls a '6'.

Misfire - A firearm misfires and jams when the unmodified d20 attack throw is less than the firearm's artifact Rarity level. Thus, a pistol or musket jams when the d20 roll is '1', while a revolver or rifle jams on a '1' or '2', and a thunderlance or thunder rattler jams if the d20 roll is '3' or less. You may attempt to un-jam a misfired firearm as an action by making a successful Finesse test with tinker's tools vs. a difficulty based on the firearm's artifact rarity level - easy for a common firearm, average for an uncommon firearm, or hard for a rare or legendary firearm. On success, the weapon is ready to be used again; on failure, the firearm is broken and must be repaired as an exploration action outside of combat.

Line / Cone - A firearm with a range of line or cone does not make an attack roll, instead creating an area of effect that many paces long. Each creature within the area of effect saves vs. Blast.

Reloading - A firearm requires an action and an easy Finesse test to reload when empty. Most firearms are single-shot, and must be reloaded each time they are fired.

Magazine - If a firearm has the magazine property, it has an internal store of multiple rounds; one action can refill the entire magazine. A wielder with a Dexterity of +1 or better can fire a firearm with the magazine property a total number of times in one round up to their Dexterity.

Ammunition*Common (Arcane)**Ingredients: Flame and Earth materia residue, lead and copper*

Firearm ammunition is crafted from lead, brass, and an alchemical formula composed of Flame, Air, and Earth materia residue. The brass 'jacket' holds the alchemical charge and the lead 'bullet', which is fired out of the barrel at extreme velocity when the charge is ignited. Typically, a firearm uses some kind of striking force to impact a sliver of Flame materia on the back of the jacket to ignite the charge. The 'jacket' is typically left inside the firearm, and must be carefully extracted when the firearm is reloaded. A jacket from an expended round will typically be extremely hot during the round immediately after it is fired; failing the Finesse test to reload during this time will inflict 1d6 fire damage to the wielder.

Crafting ammunition for a firearm involves stamping a new brass jacket, mixing the alchemical charge, and casting a new lead bullet. Treat this process as brewing a single alchemical formula at the same rarity as the firearm; when finished, the alchemist rolls 2d6 to determine how many usable rounds are produced.

Flametongue *Any Rarity (Arcane or Primal)**Ingredients: Flame Pearl, orichalc, iron*

A flametongue is a longsword or greatsword enchanted with elemental Fire energy. It adds 1d6 worth of fire damage per rarity level whenever a melee attack with it hits, inflicting ongoing fire damage if any damage die rolls a '6'. A flametongue may also be used to parry any elemental (cold) attack, including ranged or area attacks; when used to parry an area attack, your saving throw is easier.

Flying Blade *Any Rarity (Arcane or Primal)**Ingredients: Air Pearl, feysilver, iron*

A flying blade is a dagger, chakram, or other light throwing weapon enchanted with elemental Air energy. Any light throwing weapon may be made into a flying blade.

A flying blade adds its Rarity level as a static bonus to its to-hit and damage rolls when used to make a ranged attack. Additionally, the blade will return to its thrower's hand from up to 50 paces away at the end of each combat round. If the blade is being actively restrained from returning by another creature, that creature must make a Strength check to hold onto it, vs. a threshold equal to twice the blade's rarity.

Legendary flying blades may be guided to attack when not in the wielder's hands, so long as the wielder has psychically claimed the blade and bonded themselves to it with their blood. Attacking with a blade without throwing it makes the attack throw harder, but might allow the attacker to catch the target unaware.

Frostbrand *Any Rarity (Arcane or Primal)**Ingredients: Water Pearl, orichalc, iron*

A frostbrand is a longsword or greatsword enchanted with elemental Water energy. It adds 1d6 worth of cold damage per rarity level whenever a melee attack with it hits, stunning and hobbling the target if any damage die rolls a '6'. A frostbrand may also be used to parry any elemental (fire) attack, including ranged or area attacks; when used to parry an area attack, your saving throw is easier.

Keen Blade*Any Rarity (Arcane)**Ingredients: Earth Pearl, feysilver, iron*

A keen blade is a magically sharpened and balanced edged weapon, engraved with runes and sigils along the blade and pommel. Any non-blunt weapon may be made into a keen blade, with a rarity based on the size of the blade; light keen blades are common magic items, medium keen blades are uncommon, and heavy keen blades are rare.

A keen blade deals 1d6 weapon damage per rarity level regardless of its wielder's strength, and always inflicts a critical hit if any damage dice roll a '6'. The save vs. Doom difficulty to resist a keen blade's critical hit is based on the number of dice that roll a '6', and critical hits always inflict maiming injuries.

Luckcatcher*Legendary (Primal)**Ingredients: Aether Pearl, feysilver, iron, silver*

A luckcatcher is a dagger with a cage in the pommel fashioned from cold-wrought iron and silver filigree, and silver runes along the blade's edge.

Each sunrise and sunset, roll a d20 and record the result. Until the next sunrise or sunset, whenever you attack with this weapon, make a saving throw, or force another creature to make a saving throw, you may swap one d20 result from that throw with the stored d20 result, storing the replaced roll in the luckcatcher.

Moonblade*Rare (Primal)**Ingredients: Dream Pearl, feysilver, iron, silver*

A moonblade is a blade or axe fashioned from cold-wrought iron and silver filigree, with silver runes along the blade's edge.

When you inflict damage with a moonblade, any illusion or shape-changing magics that alter the target's form or appearance are immediately dispelled. If a magic-user is actively maintaining an effect, they may save vs. Curse to attempt to prevent one such effect from being dispelled by the moonblade.

Relic Weapon*Legendary (Divine)**cannot be forged*

Each relic weapon is unique, being the weapon used in life by a martyred saint. When wielded by the righteous, a relic weapon erupts with a ghostly white nimbus of flame – attacks with it become easier and inflict an additional +3d6 radiant or aetheric damage (attacker's choice). This damage is maximized against unholy creatures. Each relic weapon manifests the will of the saint who wielded it in life; actions which go against that saint's personal convictions will withdraw the weapon's bonuses.

Sparkwhip*Any Rarity (Arcane or Primal)**Ingredients: Air Pearl, feysilver, copper*

A sparkwhip is a silvery chain whip enchanted with elemental Air energy. It adds 1d6 worth of lightning damage per rarity level, and attacks against targets wearing metal armor are easier.

Any damage die that rolls a '6' – whether a weapon damage die or a lightning damage die – entangles and restrains the target, allowing the attacker to automatically inflict the weapon's lightning damage at the end of each combat round until the target saves vs. Hold to break free of the restraint.

Sunlance*Rare (Arcane or Primal)**Ingredients: Flame Pearl, orichalc, iron, ruby*

A sunlance is a polearm enchanted with Elemental Flame energy, which adds two bonus dice of radiant damage whenever a melee attack with it hits. As an action, the wielder can aim the sunlance and make a ranged attack against any target within line of sight, with a base range of 25 paces. The sunlance fires a beam of searing golden light that inflicts 4d6 radiant damage on a hit, and blinds and stuns the target on a critical hit.

A sunlance holds up to three charges of aetheric energy, and requires an hour to recharge each charge.

Thunderhammer *Any Rarity (Arcane or Primal)**Ingredients: Thunder Pearl, orichalc, iron*

A thunderhammer is a bludgeon enhanced with elemental thunder energy. It adds 1d6 worth of thunder damage per rarity level whenever a melee attack with it hits, and its fire damage ignores armor.

If any damage die rolls a '6', the target is stunned, and must also save vs. Hold or be knocked prone and thrown backwards a number of paces equal to the wielder's Strength + twice the weapon's rarity level.

Venom Scythe*Any Rarity (Arcane or Primal)**Ingredients: Wood Pearl, orichalc, iron*

A venom scythe is a glaive enchanted with elemental Wood energy. It adds 1d6 additional poison damage per rarity level whenever a melee attack with it deals weapon damage, then forces a save vs. Doom or the target suffers ongoing poison damage.

Windbow*Any Rarity (Arcane or Primal)**Ingredients: Wood Pearl, Air Pearl, feysilver, giant spider silk, exotic wood*

A windbow is a shortbow, longbow or greatbow enchanted with elemental Air and Wood energy. It grants its rarity level as a bonus to to-hit and damage, and adds 10 paces per rarity level to its base range.

Amulets

An amulet is any magic item worn on the neck or shoulders, such as a cloak or pendant.

Amulet of Dedication *Uncommon (Divine)*

Ingredients: Dream Pearl, feysilver, duskworm silk

Amulets of dedication are small worn pendants that may be affixed to a necklace, earring or similar position. While worn, the amulet protects the user from psychic harm and influence. If the wearer would be beguiled, panicked, or injured by a source of psychic damage, any saving throw made to deny or snap out of those effects are easier. The wearer also halves all psychic damage that they would receive. They are usually carved in the shape of holy symbols.

An amulet of dedication can also be used to protect the wearer against violating a sworn oath. If the wearer whispers an oath to the amulet at dawn or sunrise, any effects that might compel them to act against that oath are harder, and any save to deny such effects is easier. However, if they willingly choose to violate an oath that has been whispered to the amulet, it immediately and violently shatters, inflicting 3d6 psychic damage to the wearer.

Amulets of Friendship

Uncommon+ (Arcane or Primal)

Ingredients: Dream Pearl, feysilver, orichalc, silver, gold, jade, amethyst

Amulets of friendship are paired lockets, one silver and one gold. When worn by two different creatures who are not hostile to each other, the wearers can communicate telepathically across any distance.

Rarer amulets exist in identical sets of three to eight. These amulets allow an entire group to communicate telepathically with each other, and additionally allow any magic-user in the group to touch their amulet and cast a spell on another member of the group as if they were touching, as long as they are within 20 paces of each other. Amulet sets require both a dream pearl and an aether pearl in the construction of each amulet.

Amulet of Protection *Uncommon (Arcane)*

Ingredients: Aether Pearl, orichalc, gold or silver

Amulets of protection are small worn pendants that may be affixed to a necklace, earring or similar position. While worn, the amulet protects the user from physical or magical harm. If the wearer would be injured by any source of damage, it immediately casts shield to protect the wearer.

This shield does not require the wearer's focus to maintain, and lasts 2d6 combat rounds. Unfortunately, it also grants the user far less control than if they had cast it themselves; the protection cannot be dismissed until it has worn off, and if the shield's temporary hp are reduced to zero, the amulet shatters.

Once an amulet has been activated, it requires one sunrise or sunset to recharge.

Amulet of Water Breathing

Uncommon+ (Arcane or Primal)

Ingredients: Water Pearl, Air Pearl, feysilver

Amulets of water breathing are small worn chokers that clasp onto the neck. While worn, the amulet allows any creature that breathes air to breathe underwater without difficulty, or allows any creature that breathes water to breathe air without difficulty.

Dolphin centaurs called 'merfolk' also create rarer amulets, which have the additional effect of transforming a merfolk wearer's lower half into a pair of human-like legs when dry, or a non-merfolk wearer's lower half into a merfolk's dolphin tail when wet.

Cloak of Invisibility*Rare (Arcane)**Ingredients: Dream Pearl, feysilver, duskworm silk*

A cloak of invisibility appears to be a finely made silk cloak with a cloudy quartz clasp, and thin silver-threaded runes woven along its inner lining. A keen observer might notice that its colors subtly shift to match the wearer's surroundings. While worn, a cloak of invisibility makes all Stealth tests to hide or pass unseen easy. As an action, the wearer can pull the cloak around themselves, casting the Blur or Invisibility spell upon themselves until dismissed. This spell does not require focus to maintain, but taking damage has a chance (1-4 on 1d6 for an uncommon amulet, 1-2 on 1d6 for a rare amulet) of disrupting the spell.

Once used, the cloak's invisibility requires one hour to recharge.

Cloak of Shadows *Common (Arcane or Primal)**Ingredients: Dream Pearl, feysilver, duskworm silk*

A cloak of shadows appears to be a finely made dark grey silk cloak with an obsidian clasp, and thin silver-threaded runes woven along its inner lining. While worn, a cloak of shadows makes all Stealth tests to hide or pass unseen easy, so long as the wearer is not in bright light. As an action, the wearer can pull the cloak around themselves while standing in shadows, casting the Invisibility spell upon themselves while they remain stationary. This spell does not require focus to maintain, but taking damage has a 50% chance of disrupting the spell, and any bright light shone upon the wearer will automatically break the effect.

Once used, the cloak's concealment requires an hour to recharge.

Foreigner's Amulet*Uncommon (Arcane)**Ingredients: Dream Pearl, feysilver, silver*

A foreigner's amulet appears to be a silver choker with an inlaid pearl at the throat. Upon closer inspection, the inside of the choker is engraved with small, intricate runes and sigils inlaid in a darker bluish-silver metal.

When worn, the amulet allows the wearer to listen to a foreign language that they do not understand for at least ten minutes (one exploration turn), after which they may understand and speak that language until they stop focusing or remove the amulet. The amulet only grants understanding of one language at a time; once used, it cannot be used again until the next sunrise or sunset.

Gull-Wing Cloak*Rare (Arcane or Primal)**Ingredients: Air Pearl, feysilver, giant spider silk, thunderbird feathers*

A gull-wing cloak appears to be a light bluish-grey satin cloak with a ruffle of white and grey feathers woven into the shoulders and collar. While worn, a gull-wing cloak will buffet your fall using the feather fall cantrip, always allowing you to land on your feet without injury.

You may activate the cloak to cause it to unfurl into a pair of 15-foot wingspan wings, granting you a Flying speed and flying dash speed of double your current speed and dash speed. Any acrobatic maneuvers use Agility to maintain control while airborne.

Roll 1d6+3 level to determine the maximum number of combat rounds that the cloak can sustain its flight speed. Once you use this effect, the cloak requires one sunrise or sunset to recharge. Its feather fall effect continues to work while the cloak is recharging.

Iron-Will Amulet*Uncommon (Arcane)**Ingredients: Dream pearl, orichalc, iron*

An iron-will amulet appears to be a cloudy translucent stone set in an iron cage. Upon closer inspection, tiny golden runes are inscribed upon the insides of the iron wires, inlaid in a dark golden metal.

While worn, all saving throws that the wearer would roll vs. any effect that would alter their thoughts, emotions, or behavior are easier.

Magic Pendant*Common+ (Primal or Arcane)**Ingredients: Dragon pearl, feysilver, orichalc*

A magic pendant appears to be a precious gemstone set into a gold and silver backing, on a gold and silver chain. On closer inspection, the back of the setting contains tiny sigils and runes, filled with metal of a slightly different color. The pendant functions identically to a dragon pearl of the same rarity, but the wearer can hold other items in their hand while using it.

Pendant of Recall*Rare (Primal or Arcane)**Ingredients: Two aether pearls, feysilver*

A Pendant of Recall appears to be a clear gemstone pendant in a silver wire cage, set on a silver chain. Upon closer inspection, peering through the pendant appears to reveal a different location altogether.

When a pendant of recall is constructed, it uses two aether pearls, which must be carved from the same materia or created together in the same alchemical process. These two pearls are 'bound' together, with one set into the pendant and the other left free. When used, the pendant and its wearer disappear in a flash of light, reappearing within five feet of the free gem. If there is no available space to appear, the user takes 5d6 aetheric damage and fails to teleport.

Once used, a pendant of recall cannot be used again until the next sunrise or sunset.

Soulcage Amulet*Rare (Arcane)**Ingredients: aether pearl, feysilver*

A Soulcage Amulet appears to be a dark, nearly black gemstone pendant in a silver wire cage, set on a silver chain. The gem itself appears cool to the touch, regardless of the ambient temperature.

When the wearer of a soulcage amulet fails a saving throw vs. Doom, the amulet rips their soul from their body. This immediately reduces the wearer to zero hit points and kills them, without any saving throw. However, so long as the amulet is not removed from their body, their body will be preserved against decay and corruption, and cannot be used to create a corporeal undead. Their soul remains bound to the amulet, allowing them to manifest as a wraith while within 5 paces of it and not in direct sunlight.

So long as the amulet has not been removed, the revive miracle, the reincarnate glamour, and potions of regeneration treat the wearer as if they had just died moments ago. If the amulet is removed from the body, normal decay begins to set in immediately, but it stops immediately if the amulet is returned. If the body is destroyed or too much decay sets in, the wearer's soul becomes trapped within it, unable to move on to the hereafter until a priest performs the lay to rest miracle on the amulet. Priests of the death domain tend to find the soulcage amulet troubling, and consider its use to be questionable at best.

Wild Shape Talisman *Common+ (Primal)*

Ingredients: Dragon pearl, (optional) animal pelt

Druids can perform a primal ritual to craft wild shape talismans, which can be used to transform into natural animals or fey beasts. Each wild shape talisman holds the form of a specific creature. At level 7, a champion with an animal patron may also perform this ritual, but only to create or use a pelt talisman that corresponds to your patron animal.

First, you must carve a dragon pearl into a talisman that represents the animal that you wish to transform into. A common dragon pearl can hold the shape of any 1 to 2 hd animal or beast, while an uncommon dragon pearl can hold the shape of any 3 to 4 hd animal or beast, and a rare pearl can hold the shape of a 5 hd animal or beast. Beasts with elemental powers, such as a thunderbird or a phoenix, require dragon pearls of an element appropriate to their powers; natural animals instead use wood pearls, and beasts with stranger powers use dream or aether pearls.

Once the talisman is carved, you must wear it in the hour before sunrise or sunset, and find a living example of the creature you wish to become. You run with the herd, pack, or individual of that species until next sunset or sunrise – at which time, you have transformed into that animal, and the talisman is complete. Each talisman is attuned to the mortal that crafted it, and cannot be used by anyone else.

Pelt Talismans

A druid can craft a wild shape talisman out of the pelt of the animal to be transformed into, with an appropriate dragon pearl incorporated somewhere into the pelt; this is safer than an amulet talisman, since the pelt transforms along with the druid, but the druid cannot wear any armor or other gear as they don the pelt. A pelt is destroyed if the druid is reduced to zero hit points while in wild shape.

Amulet Talismans

Amulet talismans are easier to craft, but more dangerous to use, since your natural form is "stored" within the talisman while you take the shape of the beast; losing the talisman traps you within your new form. Any creature holding or wearing the talisman while you are transformed can understand you as if under the effects of the Speak with Animals glamour.

Transforming

Once you have crafted a wild shape talisman, you may put it on to transform into a typical member of that species. Anything you are carrying or wearing doesn't transform with you, unless you perform the dedicate object ritual on it prior to changing. Your new limbs and body shape will likely make wearing armor, wielding weapons, or using tools difficult; any items in your possession will be dropped, or possibly damaged during the transformation. An amulet talisman will fall off as you transform, and must be stored in a safe place until you wish to transform back; a pelt talisman will transform with you, so that you can revert to your original form at will.

While Transformed

When you transform, your abilities and saving throws are replaced with those of the animal you transform into, and you gain its size, speed, armor, and any special movement types that it has. You immediately roll the creature's hit dice to determine your new maximum hit points; you begin at full hit points if you had at least half your hit points before you transformed; otherwise, you begin at half your new maximum hit points (round up). You also gain the animal's attack throws when attacking with any of its natural weapons, such as fangs or claws, as well as each of its natural talent thresholds if they are superior to your own.

While you retain your own intelligence, personality, and memories, they are filtered through the animal's brain and instincts, making complex thought more difficult unless you devote your full attention to it.

Transforming Back

Reverting to your natural form requires you to touch the talisman that you originally used to transform and will yourself to change back. As you revert to your original form, you roll each of your hit dice to determine your new current hit points (up to your original form's maximum), halving the roll result if you were below half your maximum hit points before you transformed. If you revert to your natural form due to being reduced to zero hit points, you still have zero hit points when you return to your original shape.

Belts

A belt is any magic item worn around the torso. Many enchanted satchels and backpacks are designed to be worn as belts.

Bag of Holding *Uncommon+ (Arcane)*

Ingredients: Aether Pearl, feysilver, giant spider silk

A bag of holding appears to be a fine leather pouch from the outside, roughly twelve inches wide, three inches thick and six inches deep. When opened, however, runes of metallic thread are stitched around the rim of the pocket, and the pouch itself appears bottomless.

An uncommon bag of holding can store up to 15 cubic feet of objects. When you attempt to place an object in the bag, as long as its smallest dimension is less than 5 feet wide, the bag's opening expands to accommodate the item, returning to its normal size once the object is fully inside. A rare bag of holding can store up to 125 cubic feet of objects, while some Legendary bags of holding can store 1,000 cubic feet or more.

As your action, you may reach into the bag and mentally choose an item. If that object is in the bag, it summons to your hand and can be pulled out, feeling nearly weightless until the last inch of it clears the lip of the bag.

Bags of holding are notoriously vulnerable to Aetheric magic. If a keen blade or other sharp Aetheric item is placed into the bag unsheathed, or if any Aetheric magic item that produces teleportation, size-changing, or other effects is placed into the bag, the referee will make a hidden saving throw to determine if the bag's aetheric pocket is pierced. The results of a torn bag can range from all the items spilling out at once around the wearer, to a rip in the veil that sucks the wearer - and anyone else within several paces - into the deep aether. For the same reason, placing a portable hole into a bag of holding (even when closed), or wearing a bag of holding while passing through a portable hole, is an immensely stupid idea.

Belt of Feral Might

Any Rarity (Primal)

Ingredients: Wood Pearl, exotic leather

A belt of feral might adds its rarity bonus to the wearer's Strength and Constitution while worn, adjusting their melee damage, hit points, attack and saving throws, and raw ability checks. If another magical effect also increases the wearer's abilities, only the highest effect takes hold.

Quiver of Elemental Bolts

Any Rarity (Arcane or Primal)

Ingredients: Dragon Pearl, feysilver, orichalc, exotic leather

A quiver of elemental bolts looks like a finely crafted arrow or crossbow quiver from the outside, holding up to a dozen arrows or two dozen crossbow bolts. Inside the pocket, inlaid metal-woven threads are stitched in arcane patterns, slowly gathering and focusing elemental energies into any arrows or crossbow bolts placed inside.

When you place a cluster of arrows or bolts into the quiver, on the next sunrise or sunset the inlaid arcana will infuse those arrows with sufficient arcane energy from the dragon pearl to grant each of them +1d6 elemental damage per rarity level.

You may also charge one arrow or bolt as you draw it, infusing it with a much larger amount of elemental energy. That missile will detonate when fired at a range you specify, unleashing a blast area attack with a radius of 2 paces. Any creature caught within the blast must save or suffer 3d6 elemental damage. If you make an attack throw against a creature with a charged arrow, it suffers 6d6 of elemental damage and a critical hit effect on a hit, and the area of is halved to 1 pace. If you miss, the arrow still detonates in the target's space, unleashing the full 2-pace radius 3d6 blast.

Once you use this charge, a common quiver requires one sunrise or sunset to recharge, while an uncommon quiver requires only an hour to recharge, and a rare quiver requires ten minutes.

Boots

Boots are any magic item designed to be worn around the lower legs or feet. Creatures with unusual anatomy may require that boot-like magic items be custom made for their body shape.

Boots of Stability

Common (Arcane)

Ingredients: Earth Pearl, orichalc, roper leather

Boots of stability appear to be a pair of fine leather boots from the outside. The inside of the boots are lined with runes and sigils in metallic thread. While wearing boots of stability, all saving throws vs. Hold to avoid being knocked down are easy, and difficult terrain does not cost you extra movement or risk tripping you. You may react when you would be moved or knocked prone to anchor yourself firmly to whatever surface you are standing on; until you release yourself as a combat action, you cannot be knocked prone or moved from that spot. Once used, this anchoring ability requires an hour to recharge.

Boots of Swiftess

Uncommon (Arcane or Primal)

Ingredients: Air Pearl, feysilver, bloodwing leather

Boots of Swiftess appear to be a pair of fine leather boots from the outside. The inside of the boots are lined with runes and sigils in metallic thread. While wearing Boots of Swiftess, you can move each round as if you had performed the dash action.

Boots of Traceless Passage

Common (Arcane or Primal)

Ingredients: Dream Pearl, feysilver, exotic leather

Boots of traceless passage appear to be a pair of fine leather boots from the outside. The inside of the boots are lined with runes and sigils in metallic thread. While wearing Boots of Traceless Passage, your footsteps make no sound, even if wearing heavy armor, and you leave no footprints or other marks of your passage.

Grip Boots

Rare (Arcane or Primal)

Ingredients: giant gecko hide, orichalc, Earth Pearl

Grip boots appear to be a pair of lizard-skin boots with ridged soles. Closer inspection will reveal small metallic runes woven within the sole ridges. While wearing grip boots, you can walk on any surface, even upside-down.

Golem Prosthesis

Uncommon+ (Arcane)

Ingredients: ironwood, devil creeper, jade, hippogriff leather, Wood Pearl

A golem prosthesis is an artificial leg, designed to replace a maimed or amputated limb. A single replaced leg is an uncommon item, and operates nearly identically to the wearer's original limb, while also granting a +1 to Armor when not wearing medium or heavy armor. A pair of matched legs count as a single rare boots item, grant +2 to Armor when not wearing medium or heavy armor, and may have another common or uncommon boots enchantment incorporated into their design, while a legendary pair of leg prostheses can incorporate a rare boots enchantment.

Seven-League Boots

Legendary (Arcane)

Ingredients: Aether Pearl, orichalc, exotic leather

Seven-league boots appear to be a pair of fine leather boots from the outside. The inside of the boots are lined with runes and sigils in metallic thread. Once per hour while wearing seven-league boots, you may roll a Science or Survival check to teleport yourself seven leagues along a current direction of travel. The difficulty is determined by the terrain of the area you are teleporting into; success lands you on a road or clearing, while failure lands you lost and in difficult terrain. A critical failure results in 3d6 aetheric damage, as you teleport into a space occupied by an object. Any damage die that rolls a '6' results in a critical hit and maiming.

Crowns

A crown is any magic item that is worn on the head or upper face, such as a hat or spectacles.

Crown of Command

Rare (Arcane)

Ingredients: Dream Pearl, orichalc, gold

A Crown of Command appears to be a finely made golden crown with a polished red gem. On closer inspection, the inside of the crown contains tiny sigils and runes, filled with a metal of a slightly different color.

The wearer may use their action to cast the friends cantrip at-will, or to cast the beguile, suggestion, or dominate spell from the crown. If beguile is cast, the crown may be used again ten minutes after the spell is released; if suggestion is cast, the crown requires one hour to recharge; if dominate is cast, it recharges at the next sunrise or sunset.

Darkvision Goggles

Uncommon (Arcane)

Ingredients: Flame Pearl, orichalc, gold

Darkvision goggles appear to be finely made gold spectacles with faintly glowing lenses. On closer inspection, the lenses and frames contain tiny sigils and runes, filled with a bright gold metal.

Once activated, the wearer of these spectacles can see 10 paces in total darkness for 1d6 turns. While completely undetectable to mundane sight, while active the goggles appear as a bright beacon to anything that can see magic. The spectacles recharge after the next sunrise or sunset.

Diadem of Splendour

Uncommon (Arcane)

Ingredients: Dream Pearl, feysilver, silver

A diadem of splendour appears to be a finely made silver crown with a polished green gem. The inside of the crown contains tiny sigils and runes, filled with a metal of a slightly different color.

The wearer gains a bonus to their Bearing based on the crown's rarity: +1 for an uncommon crown, +2 for a rare crown, or +3 for a legendary crown. If another magical effect also increases the wearer's Bearing, only the highest effect takes hold.

Golem Eye

Uncommon+ (Arcane)

Ingredients: ironwood, devil creeper, jade, hippogriff leather, Wood Pearl

A golem eye is an artificial sensor, designed to replace a maimed or missing eye. One or both eyes may be replaced as a single uncommon item, which operates nearly identically to the wearer's original eyes. A rare or legendary prosthesis will have some arcane divination effect - usually identical to the enchantment in a 'goggles' or 'spectacles' type magic item - incorporated into its design.

Puppeteer's Crowns

Rare (Arcane)

Ingredients: Two Dream Pearls, orichalc, feysilver, gold, silver

Puppeteer's crowns appear to be a pair of finely made royal circlets, one silver and one gold, each inlaid with opal and mother-of-pearl. On closer inspection, the inside of each crown contains tiny sigils and runes, filled with a metal of a slightly different color.

The wearer of the gold crown uses their action to place the silver crown on a willing or restrained creature's head, where it immediately magically resizes to fit them and fades from view. Once both creatures are wearing their crowns, the wearer of the silver crown makes a saving throw vs. curses. If they succeed, both crowns fall off, and neither may be used until the next sunrise or sunset.

If the wearer of the silver crown fails their saving throw, the wearer of the golden crown may direct their actions and perceive through their senses for as long as they maintain focus. Any damage that either creature receives is immediately also inflicted on the other wearer, forcing a save vs. Doom to maintain focus. Once the effect ends, both crowns fall off and can't be used again until after the next sunrise or sunset.

Radiant Diadem*Common (Arcane)**Ingredients: Flame Pearl, feysilver, silver*

A radiant diadem appears to be a thin silver circlet with a highly polished silver disc at the forehead, upon which is mounted a flat, clear stone. On closer inspection, the back of the disc and the metal frame contain tiny sigils and runes, filled with a darker silvery metal.

When activated, the crown emits bright light in a cone out to 5 paces, and dim light out to 10 paces.

Spectacles of Arcane Sight*Uncommon (Arcane)**Ingredients: Aether Pearl, feysilver, silver*

Spectacles of arcane sight appear to be finely made silver spectacles with faintly darkened lenses. On closer inspection, the lenses and frames contain tiny sigils and runes, filled with a dark silvery metal.

The wearer of these spectacles gains the detect magic cantrip at-will, and may use the spectacles' charge to cast identify magic or arcane sight.

Roll 1d6 to determine the number of turns each effect lasts; once used, the spectacles require one hour to recharge after casting identify magic, or one sunrise or sunset to recharge after casting arcane sight.

Spectacles of Distant Vision *Rare (Arcane)**Ingredients: Flame Pearl, orichalc, gold*

Spectacles of distant vision appear to be finely made gold spectacles with faintly glowing lenses, and a clear gemstone affixed between them. On closer inspection, the lenses and frames contain tiny sigils and runes, filled with a bright gold metal.

The wearer of these spectacles may use them to cast the arcane eye spell. Once used, these spectacles recharge after the next sunrise or sunset.

Spectacles of True Seeing*Rare (Arcane)**Ingredients: Dream Pearl, feysilver, silver*

Spectacles of true seeing appear to be finely made silver spectacles with a slight opalescent sheen to the lenses. On closer inspection, the lenses and frames contain tiny sigils and runes, filled with a dark silvery metal.

The wearer of these spectacles finds all saving throws to disbelieve illusion effects easier, and can attempt to disbelieve an illusion once per combat round on their turn without using their action.

As their action, the wearer can immediately see one creature or object as it truly is, piercing all illusions placed upon it. If the object or creature is under the effect of some kind of transforming magic, the wearer can see both its current true form, and what its true form would be without that magic. Once used in this manner, the spectacles recharge on the next sunrise or sunset.

Stone of Aioun*Legendary (Arcane)**Ingredients: Aether Pearl, feysilver*

An aioun stone is a legendary Atlantean aether pearl the size of a pea, woven with almost imperceptibly thin feysilver circuitry. A wizard in possession of an aioun stone may prepare one additional arcane spell of any school and circle into the stone when they prepare their spells at sunrise or sunset. Once the spell is prepared into the stone, it begins glowing softly and floats into the air, orbiting rapidly around the wearer's head.

Once the spell is cast, the stone begins glowing brightly, and may be used to sustain the spell without focus if the spell normally requires focus. After the spell is finished, the stone falls inert, and may not hold another spell until the next sunrise or sunset.

Rings

Any magic item which is worn on the hand without needing to be held is considered a ring.

Aetheric Glove

Rare (Arcane)

Ingredients: Aether Pearl, feysilver, giant spider silk

An aetheric glove resembles an expensive silk or leather glove with arcane runes and sigils stitched into it in metallic threads. When worn, the glove grants the wearer at-will use of the mage hand cantrip as long as it is charged.

As an action, the wearer can make a particular gesture with their hand to cast the forceful hand spell. Once used, the glove recharges after the next sunrise or sunset.

Golem Prosthesis

Uncommon+ (Arcane)

Ingredients: ironwood, devil creeper, jade, hippogriff leather, Wood Pearl

A golem prosthesis is an artificial arm, designed to replace a maimed or amputated limb. A single replaced arm or hand is an Uncommon item, and operates nearly identically to the wearer's original limb, while also granting a +1 to Armor when not wearing medium or heavy armor or a shield, and allowing you to parry melee attacks. A rare prosthesis may incorporate another common or uncommon ring enchantment into its design, while a legendary prosthesis may incorporate a rare enchantment.

Grip Gloves

Rare (Arcane or Primal)

Ingredients: giant gecko hide, orichalc, Earth Pearl

Grip gloves appear to be a pair of lizard-skin gloves with ridged palms. Closer inspection will reveal small metallic runes woven within the sole ridges. While wearing grip gloves, you can use your hands to climb any surface, even upside-down, as if under the effects of the spider climb spell. Wearing grip gloves and grip boots together make rolls to maintain your grip against being dislodged from a surface automatically succeed.

Rings of Companionship

Rare (Arcane or Primal)

Ingredients: Wood Pearl, Aetheric materia, feysilver, orichalc, silver, gold

Rings of Companionship are paired rings, one silver and one gold. When worn by two different creatures who are not hostile to each other, the wearers can communicate telepathically across any distance.

Additionally, while they are within 20 paces of each other, all damage that either would take is split evenly between both of them, and each may help the other as a free action on any check or saving throw that the referee deems appropriate.

Ring of Disguise

Any Rarity (Arcane)

Ingredients: Dream Pearl, feysilver, silver

A ring of disguise appears to be a finely made silver ring with a polished opal gem. On closer inspection, the inside of the ring contains tiny sigils and runes, filled with a metal of a slightly different color.

As their action, the wearer may transform their appearance into any similarly sized and shaped creature, casting the disguise self spell on the wearer. Roll 1d6 per rarity level; the effect lasts for a number of exploration turns equal to the result. Once used, a common ring cannot be used again until after the next sunrise or sunset, while an uncommon ring requires an hour to recharge, and a rare ring requires ten minutes to recharge.

Ring of Elemental Power

Any Rarity (Arcane or Primal)

Ingredients: Dragon Pearl, orichalc, gold or silver

A ring of elemental power appears to be a finely made gold or silver ring with a large, brightly colored gemstone. On closer inspection, the inside of the ring contains tiny sigils and runes, filled with metal of a slightly different color. The ring functions identically to a dragon pearl of the same rarity, but the wearer can hold other items in their hand while using it.

Ring of Guidance *Uncommon (Arcane or Primal)**Ingredients: Earth Pearl, orichalc, gold*

A ring of guidance appears to be a heavy gold ring with a polished dark gem. On closer inspection, the inside of the ring contains tiny sigils and runes, filled with a metal of a slightly different color.

To activate the gem, the wearer must kiss it while thinking of an object, creature, or place that is personally important to them. Once activated, a small six-pointed star of light appears within the gem, which points in the direction towards the desired target. This effect lasts until the next sunrise or sunset, at which point the ring cannot be activated again until the next sunrise or sunset.

If the target no longer exists, or is not on the same plane of existence as the wearer, the ring will flash brightly, and then the gemstone will crack. Repairing the physical damage will not restore the ring's magic without a new earth pearl gemstone.

Ring of Protection *Uncommon (Arcane)**Ingredients: Aether Pearl, feysilver, silver*

A ring of protection appears to be a finely made silver ring with a polished clear gem. On closer inspection, the inside of the ring contains tiny sigils and runes, filled with a metal of a slightly different color. If the wearer would be injured by any physical weapon or aetheric damage attack, the ring immediately casts the shield spell. This spell lasts 1d6 rounds without requiring the wearer's focus to maintain. Once the ring has been activated, it can't activate again until it has spent an hour recharging.

If a creature is wearing two rings of protection, or a ring of protection and an amulet of protection, all will activate together whenever their activation conditions are met, but only the highest die result will take effect.

Ring of Regeneration*Legendary (Arcane or Primal)**Ingredients: Wood Pearl, orichalc, gold, phoenix down feathers, giant axolotl blood*

A ring of regeneration appears to be a finely made gold ring with a polished jade gem. On closer inspection, the inside of the ring contains tiny sigils and runes, filled with a metal of a slightly different color.

The ring contains incredibly powerful healing magic. While worn, you automatically recover 1 hp at the end of each round of combat, and all saving throws vs. Doom that you make are easy. Additionally, whenever you use any healing ability that requires touching the injured character, any dice rolled to determine hit points recovered are considered to have rolled their maximum possible value.

You automatically roll one hit die during each exploration turn. Once all hp damage has been healed, you make a saving throw vs. Doom to heal one lasting injury that has not yet become permanent. During each night of sleep, you automatically heal all hp damage and one lasting injury, starting with those injuries that have not yet become permanent.

Ring of Warding*Rare (Arcane)**Ingredients: Aether Pearl, orichalc, gold, silver*

A ring of warding appears to be a finely made gold and silver ring with a diamond gem. On closer inspection, the outside and inside of the ring contains tiny sigils and runes, filled with metals of a slightly different color.

The wearer may use a gesture to cast dispel magic from the ring. Once used, it may not be used again until the next sunrise or sunset.

Wondrous Items

Wondrous Items are magic items which are neither worn, nor wielded in the hand. Some wondrous items are autonomous constructs, operating as creatures on the battlefield; others are devices that must be interacted with to perform their functions.

Many wondrous items must be held in the hand to use or activate; while using such a wondrous item, a creature may not hold any weapon or other item in the same hand.

Dragon Pearl *Any Rarity (Arcane or Primal)*

Ingredients: Elemental materia

A dragon pearl is a sphere of flawless elemental or aetheric materia, called such because the first dragon pearls taken from the skull of recently slain dragons. Common dragon pearls are approximately pea-sized gemstones, while uncommon gemstones are the size of a grape or cherry, rare gemstones are usually the size of a plum, and legendary gemstones can be the size of an apple or larger. An unusually flawless dragon pearl might be smaller than normal given its power and rarity, while one with inclusions or other flaws will likely be larger. Dragon pearls can be harvested from magical creatures that produce them naturally, or they can be grown artificially from harvested raw materia by any sufficiently skilled alchemist.

A dragon pearl acts as an additional spell, dweomer, or talisman preparation for a magic-user that is not destroyed when used. Any elemental spell or talisman of the same type as the pearl can be prepared into it, with a circle up to the pearl's rarity; legendary dragon pearls can power effects of any circle.

Once the spell or talisman is cast, the pearl cannot be used again until it has recharged. This takes ten minutes if the effect is two circles less than the pearl's rarity level, one hour if the effect's circle is one less than the pearl's rarity level, or until the next sunrise or sunset if the effect's circle is equal to the pearl's rarity level. A first-circle effect can be cast once per combat round from a legendary dragon pearl.

The pearl sustains any spell or talisman cast through it directly without requiring the caster's focus, although if it leaves their hand

the spell's focus is considered automatically broken. The spell must be maintained by the caster's focus for a number of rounds equal to the spell's circle, before the pearl can sustain it. Once the pearl begins sustaining the spell, it can maintain the spell without further contact or interaction from the caster. A pearl can sustain a spell at its own rarity level until the next sunrise or sunset, or below its own rarity indefinitely.

Aether Pearl *Any Rarity (Arcane or Primal)*

Ingredients: Aetheric materia

An aether pearl is identical to a dragon pearl, except that it empowers aetheric arcane spells instead of elemental magics.

Dream Pearl *Any Rarity (Arcane or Primal)*

Ingredients: Illusion materia

A dream pearl is identical to a dragon or aether pearl, except that it empowers psychic arcane spells and fey glamours, instead of elemental magics.

Crafting With Dragon Pearls

Dragon pearls are also used as permanent power sources for many magic items. A common item requires a common dragon pearl, while an uncommon item needs an uncommon dragon pearl, and so on.

Crafting Without Dragon Pearls

Magic items can be crafted without a dragon pearl, if they incorporate sufficient materia to power their magic. This results in a magic item with a set number of "charges", which are depleted as the item is used. Primal items of any rarity may also be created using a wisp instead of a dragon pearl, so long as the wisp consents to the process. This always results in an intelligent item with a will of its own, which is treated as a retainer (tracking loyalty and counting against the user's retinue limit).

Clockwork Servitor *Legendary (Arcane)*

Ingredients: Aether Pearl, Air Pearl, orichalc, feysilver, brass, steel

A clockwork servitor is a golem automaton from the height of the Old Empire. Servitors were often built to resemble small, medium, or large mortals, beasts, or monsters and could be directed to perform various simple tasks autonomously. A servitor has the following base abilities, with its physical abilities adjusted based on the abilities of the creature that it was built to resemble:

Strength	+2 (adjusted)
Constitution	+3 (adjusted)
Dexterity	+0 (adjusted)
Intelligence	-2
Wisdom	-1
Charisma	-3

Most servitors in the Old Empire were built with modular “cognition engines”, which could be removed and replaced to give the servitor various arrays of expertise. Each cognition engine resembles a translucent crystal cylinder etched with intricate geometric patterns of dark gold and silver, with a gold ‘plug’ on one end covered in long silver tabs. Cognition engines for bipedal servitors typically hold a Guardian program (3rd Warrior), a Scout program (3rd Scout), or an Engineer program (3rd Wizard), while cognition engines for quadrupedal servitors generally only hold enough programming for locomotion, navigation, self-defense, and basic verbal command recognition (treat as a 2nd Champion).

Enchanted Crockery *Common (Primal)*

Ingredients: Wood Pearl, Water Pearl, orichalc, copper, gold, jade, bamboo

Enchanted crockery appears to be a set of gold-inlaid copper cookware, kitchen knives, a small cutting board, various utensils and bowls, and various herb and spice bottles. The entire set is designed to nest within each other, so that they fit together into the 15" x 15" x 12" slow-cooker pot. Upon closer inspection, each implement is engraved with small, intricate runes and sigils inlaid in a dark golden metal.

When used to prepare a meal as part of an exploration action, the crockery automatically casts the purify food and drink glamour on any ingredients added, and any creature that partakes in the meal while resting makes easier hit die rolls. With sufficient ingredients, one meal prepared by the crockery can serve 2d6 medium-sized creatures.

The crockery also allows an alchemist to prepare any alchemical elixir they know into the meal, extending its potency and softening its aftereffects. Any elixir that normally measures its effects in combat rounds instead measures its effects in exploration turns, and any aftereffects that inflict a critical hit are easier to save against.

Flying Carpet *Rare (Arcane)*

Ingredients: Air Pearl, feysilver, dragonmoth silk

Often imported from the Sultanate, a flying carpet is an ornate 3' x 5' rug that can be commanded to levitate with a word. Once airborne, the rug can carry up to 500 lbs of passengers or cargo at a speed of 100 paces per combat round, or 60 miles per hour, following the mental commands of the creature who activated it. It can maintain this pace for up to 1d6 hours before its enchantment suddenly fails, dropping itself and anything carried to the ground. The rug can also be deactivated manually by speaking the same command word while flying. Once deactivated, the carpet cannot be used again until the next sunrise or sunset.

Folding Carriage*Rare (Arcane)*

Ingredients: Aether Pearl, orichalc, feysilver, bamboo, giant spider silk, sapient pearwood

A folding carriage is a variant of the bag of holding enchantment built into an ornate covered wagon that folds down into an intricate wooden tile the size of a large human's palm. Unfolding a folding carriage is an intricate process that takes an entire exploration turn, and requires a Finesse check to unfold it correctly. Once expanded, the inside of the cart holds a trapdoor with a stairway down into a 20' by 30' by 10' tall internal space. It also holds four carriage seats, a seat for a coachman, and a modular hitch for two horses or one ox-sized beast.

Healer's Staff*Uncommon (Primal or Divine)*

Ingredients: Wood Pearl, orichalc, feysilver, exotic wood quarterstaff

A healer's staff appears to be a 6-foot long wooden quarterstaff with a crook at the end. Inlaid into the crook is a large round jade gemstone. Upon closer inspection, thin golden and silvered runes and sigils have been inlaid along the staff's length.

The healer's staff may be used as a normal quarterstaff in combat, or as a divine or primal focus. While you are holding it as a focus, whenever you heal any creature, any test or save made to perform a healing action is easier, any saving throw that you assist with is easier, and any hit dice rolled to recover hit points as a result of your actions are easier.

Holy Relic*Legendary (Divine)*

cannot be forged

Each holy relic weapon is unique, being the holy symbol used in life by a martyred saint. A holy relic grants a priest one additional preparation of each circle; these preparations may only be used to prepare spells from that saint's domain.

Lantern of Revealing*Uncommon (Arcane)*

Ingredients: Flame Pearl, Aether Pearl, orichalc

A lantern of revealing appears to be a dark brass lantern with a carved white gemstone holding the oil wick, and another golden gemstone inset into the front screen. The gaps in the lantern-cage that let out the lamp's light seem to form strange sigil-like shapes, which cast odd shadows when lit.

When a lantern of revealing is filled with normal lamp oil and lit, it gives off bright light out to 5 paces and dim light out to 10 paces. Additionally, any invisible object, or any object disguised by illusion magic, casts shadows based on its true shape, rather than any illusion cast on it. Noticing that a shadow does not correspond to any object is an Alertness roll, which is made easier if a creature devotes its entire action to scrutinizing the environment and the lamp's shadows.

Magic Wand*Any Rarity (Arcane)*

Ingredients: Dragon Pearl, orichalc or feysilver, exotic wood dowel

A magic wand is a stick of carved and polished wood with metal-inlaid runes carved along its body and a dragon pearl affixed to one end. Each magic wand can carry a different conjuration or transmutation spell, with the maximum circle that can be cast dependent on the rarity level of the dragon pearl used (which determines the rarity level of the artifact as a whole). The wand uses its wielder's attack throws, saving throws, and task checks to determine any spell effects.

A magic wand can be used once per sunrise or sunset at its full strength, or once per hour if its imbued spell is one circle lower than its dragon pearl. A rare magic wand may cast an imbued first circle spell once per turn.

A magic wand's cantrip effect can be used indefinitely until all its other charges have been expended, at which point it is merely a stick of wood with a shiny knob on the end until at least one casting has recharged.

Magic Staff*Any Rarity (Arcane)**Ingredients: Two Dragon Pearls, orichalc or feysilver, exotic wood quarterstaff*

A magic staff is identical to a magic wand, except that it is embedded in a longer stick of wood. This gives more space for the staff's runes and sigils, both focusing its magic, and allowing it to gather aetheric energies at a faster rate and thus recharge more quickly. It may also be used in combat as a standard (non-magical) quarterstaff weapon.

A magic staff operates identically to a magic wand, but any saving throw against its effects is one step harder. Additionally, it recharges as if it was one rarity level higher than an equivalent wand.

Magnificent Mansion*Legendary (Arcane)**Ingredients: Aether Pearl, Air Pearl, Flame Pearl, orichalc, feysilver, brass, silver, sapient pearwood*

A magnificent mansion is another variant of the bag of holding enchantment designed for storage volume rather than portability. A magnificent mansion typically appears as a pair of items: a brass doorknob with a keyhole, and a matching ornate silver key with a small inset crystal.

To activate the mansion, a creature needs only affix the doorknob to any flat surface more than 5' by 8' in size, then insert and turn the key. A doorway will then form on the surface, allowing entry to a vast internal space – often more than 500 feet on a side and more than 30 feet high. Within the space is a hearth with inset Air and Flame pearls to supply warmth and breathable air, plus whatever other amenities the designer sees fit to include.

If the outer doorway is closed, the doorknob can be detached and the key removed, causing the doorway to disappear altogether. The inner doorway does not require a key, but it can only be opened so long as the outer doorknob is attached to a suitable surface – legends abound of wizards trapped within their own mansions when a rival or rebellious servant made off with their doorknob while they were inside.

Mapmaker's Kit*Common (Arcane)**Ingredients: Earth Pearl, orichalc, jade, bamboo, cloth*

A mapmaker's kit appears to be a wooden tablet nine inches wide, twelve inches long, and a quarter inch thick, attached to a fine cloth pouch by its drawstring. Inside the pouch are a quill pen, an ink bottle, and a number of small hexagonal jade tiles, each with an engraved symbol. Upon closer inspection, the tablet and tiles are engraved with intricate designs inlaid with a dark gold metal, and the pouch's drawstring is closed by a golden-brown striped gemstone that emits a soft inner glow. Each of the jade tiles is an ink-stamp of a common cartographic symbol from the Old Empire.

A mapmaker's kit may be activated by filling the ink bottle with magic ink, placing a blank parchment on the tablet, dipping the quill into the ink and beginning to draw. It makes any Lore check easier to produce a map of what the viewer has seen over the past exploration turn or hour of travel.

Mirror of Distant Visions*Rare (Arcane)**Ingredients: Aether Pearl, feysilver, silver*

A mirror of distant visions appears to be a bluish-silver oval mirror with a clear gem inset below it. Various sigils and runes are engraved into the border in a different metal.

When a creature touches the gem, they can cause the view within the mirror to turn or move as if seen from the eye of a flying creature. The view can move at up to 1,000 paces per combat round, or 600 miles per hour. This can be quite disorienting; the controller must make a Lore or Survival check every three miles in order to know precisely where they are viewing. The mirror resets its viewpoint to a "normal" mirror at each sunrise or sunset.

If the controller has met another specific creature, they may speak their name aloud while touching the gem to see from that creature's eyes (albeit reversed left-to-right), and may then move the mirror normally from that position.

Ornithoptoculus*Rare (Arcane)*

Ingredients: Air Pearl, Aether Pearl, feysilver, brass, exotic leather, balsa wood, oiled parchment

An ornithoptoculus is a small silver-and-gold sphere the size of a ripe plum, covered in ornately carved grooves and whorls. Upon closer inspection, a small button can be found on one side; pressing this button activates the device.

When activated, the ornithoptoculus unfurls one or more pairs of mechanical wings, often fashioned to resemble dragonfly or hummingbird wings. A large, spherical eye-lens opens on the side opposite the activation button, and then the contraption rises to the air and hovers, awaiting the proper commands. If none is given within a span of six seconds, it slowly descends, then deactivates and closes back up into a sphere.

Construct -The ornithoptoculus is a tiny automaton with a Dexterity of +3 and a saving throw vs. blasts of 5+.

It is always considered to be evading, and automatically attempts to dodge any area effect that would affect it; it is destroyed if it suffers any damage, and can operate for one hour before it must power down and recharge until the next sunrise or sunset.

Synchronizing - An ornithoptoculus is designed to be used in conjunction with a Spectacles of Arcane Sight, Spectacles of Distant Vision, Mirror of Distant Visions, or Mapmaker's Kit. Without one of these devices, it is nothing more than a curious novelty.

When properly synchronized with a Mirror or pair of Spectacles, it may be piloted remotely by the wearer while they focus, relaying everything it sees into the viewing device. It has an intrinsic Arcane Sight enchantment woven into it, which any wearer may use at-will. It may also broadcast the wearer's voice, with a slight 'tinny' distortion, at normal speaking volume.

When synchronized with a mapmaker's kit, the kit also self-animates, its quill and tiles clacking across the tablet as they draw a map of whatever the construct sees. A mapping ornithoptoculus always hovers directly above the kit it is synchronized to, at a height based on the scale of the map being drawn (five feet above the map kit for a 25-pace dungeon map, 100' above the kit for a half-mile exploration map, or 1000' above the kit for a 24-mile travel map.) The kit cannot draw any features that the ornithoptoculus cannot see; areas of obstructed terrain are simply left blank.

Portable Hole*Rare (Arcane)*

Ingredients: Aether pearl, giant spider silk, feysilver, mimic ink

A portable hole appears to be a four-foot-diameter circle of black cloth with a drawstring. A glittering gem is affixed to the end of the drawstring, and thin metallic runes and sigils are woven into its border.

When the hole is unfolded and affixed to any solid surface, it immediately transforms into a 10 foot deep hole in that surface. If placed on a surface less than ten feet thick, the hole opens to the other side.

The hole may be removed from the surface by grabbing the gem on its drawstring and pulling; once used, a portable hole cannot be used again until the next sunrise or sunset.

Replenishing Decanter *Uncommon+ (Arcane)*

Ingredients: Water pearl, feysilver, silver, quartz

A replenishing decanter appears to be an expensive quartz flask with a silver handle and lid and an inset aquamarine gem, filled with clear fluid. On closer inspection, the handle is inlaid with runes and sigils of a darker silvery color. When the decanter is tipped while the gem is pressed, the lid opens and an unending stream of water pours out. A decanter can produce one cup of fresh, drinkable water per six-second combat round, or up to 5 gallons of water per ten-minute exploration turn.

An uncommon decanter can produce up to 5 gallons of water between one sunrise or sunset and the next. A rare decanter can produce up to 30 gallons of water per day, and a legendary decanter (sometimes called a never-empty decanter) can produce 30 gallons of water per hour indefinitely.

Revealing Mirror*Rare (Arcane)**Ingredients: Dream pearl, feysilver, silver*

A revealing mirror is a large silver wall-mirror with an inset gem on its frame. Any object or creature seen through the mirror is briefly shown for what it truly is, stripped of any illusion magic that might conceal it. Creatures that can shapeshift are seen as their natural forms, and undead creatures show a dark aura of decay.

Teleportation Circle*Legendary (Arcane)**Ingredients: Aether pearl, feysilver, orichalc*

A teleportation circle is a 10-foot-diameter circle on the ground inscribed with modular sigils that can link its location to any other teleportation circle, anywhere in the universe.

A teleportation circle is activated by touching its activation sigils in a particular sequence to specify a destination portal.

When activated, a shimmering portal opens within the circle and remains open until the end of your next turn. Any creature that enters the portal instantly appears within the destination circle. If the destination circle is occupied, if an improper sequence is keyed in, or if the destination portal is damaged, the travelers can choose for the activation to fail, or can attempt to push through. If the issue was due to an occupied or blocked portal, the travelers suffer 3d6 aetheric damage, but arrive within the circle and push any interposing creatures or material out of the circle in a random direction.

Determining a portal's sigil sequence after examining the portal for one hour is a hard Science check. You can commit a new sigil sequence to memory or write it in your spellbook after studying it.

Wishing Stones*Legendary (Unknown)**Ingredients: Dream Pearl, Aether Pearl, Earth Pearl, Water Pearl, Wood Pearl, Air Pearl, Flame Pearl, unknown additional ingredients*

The wishing stones are a collection of seven enormous dragon pearls, one of each element. When brought together in one place, they allow their possessor to perform a third-level Arcane, Divine, or Primal ritual which culminates in the summoning of the Mother of Dragons, an Aetheric being of immense power.

She will patiently listen as the ritualist describes their wish, and then will cause that wish to be fulfilled - but often with unexpected side-effects or consequences. She sometimes interprets wishes in inscrutably metaphoric ways, and other times interprets them shockingly directly. The ritualist must succeed in a Lore test, an Intuition test, and a Wit test, all with a difficulty based on the complexity of the wish; failure at any of these tests means that the wish was fulfilled with subtle twists or ironies that will be revealed later.

Once the wish is fulfilled, the seven wishing stones are scattered, each teleporting to a different random - but invariably difficult to reach - location.

[illegible]

Golem Armor

The golem armor is both an ancient symbol of feudal authority, and a marvel of dwarven magic. Golem armors are Huge magical constructs, usually humanoid in appearance, which can be “worn” and controlled by a golem knight - a trained warrior or stalwart who sits in the upper chest, and whose movements are mirrored by the golem armor through a synergy of engineering and arcane sympathetic magic, using a sequence of pulleys and gears to cause the golem armor to mimic the wearer’s movements. Supporting the golem knight is their engineer - a squire trained in the Arcane sciences who sits just below the knight’s harness and manages the golem armor’s various systems while the knight focuses on the fray.

Possessing golem armor is proof of patronage and legitimacy within the feudal hierarchy; these giant constructs are passed down from generation to generation, along with ancestral land to support them and the pledge to use them in defense of that land and its people.

The first golem armors were constructed by the dwarven kingdom of Samar, to defend it against the encroaching might of the Old Empire. They failed, and were conquered, but the Empire was so impressed with the design that they immediately granted full citizenship to the dweomersmiths who designed and built them, and commissioned them to produce enough to outfit six Imperial Legions.

Design and Construction

When the Old Empire fell, the knowledge to design and construct new golem armors was mostly lost; although a few of the Southern Sultanates retained or re-discovered the art. Recently, the industrious Hansa have at least partially re-discovered the art within the past two decades, and have risen to challenge the Sultanate for supremacy with a steady supply of newly-Knighted warriors in untested armors. The majority of golem armors, however, are over a thousand years old - passed down from father to son as a symbol of a noble family’s right to rule.

Equipment, Speed, and Encumbrance

The internal systems of a golem armor weigh 2000 lbs, and can support another 8,000 lbs of additional equipment before becoming burdened. A golem armor’s base walking speed is 20 paces per round (one field), and its dash speed when unencumbered is 120 paces per round (six fields). Its dash speed is reduced by 20 paces per round for every 2,000 lb of armor and equipment carried.

Total Weight	Dash Speed
2000 - 4000 lb	6 fields (120 paces)
4001 - 6000 lb	5 fields (100 paces)
6001 - 8000 lb	4 fields (80 paces)
8001 - 10,000 lb	3 fields (60 paces)

Combat Capabilities

In combat, a golem knight uses their own talents, attack throw thresholds, and saving throw thresholds whenever necessary. The difficulty of a given task should be adjusted appropriately for a huge construct. The golem armor itself has an effective Strength and Constitution of +5 when performing ability checks, and uses the golem knight’s other abilities.

Golem armors are 15 to 20 feet tall, and have ten sections: the Helm, Body, two Shoulders, two Arms, two Hands, and two Legs. When a golem armor is hit in combat by a large or huge attacker, the attacker must roll 2d6 to determine which section of the golem armor is damaged unless the attack is easy. Medium and smaller creatures choose which section to hit with a melee attack if their attack isn’t hard, but can only hit sections they can reach.

Golem armors are essentially an array of rare arcane artifacts, all constructed around a central legendary dragon pearl called the materia core, and then surrounded by armored plates of steel and orichalc alloy. Each section of a golem armor is an entire array of interlinked arcane magical items powered by this core; if the structure points of any one section are reduced to zero, each additional point of structure damage to that section automatically inflicts one critical hit. Each critical hit against a golem armor destroys one of its internal artifact slots at random in the section that was damaged – roll a d6 and eliminate that slot.

The Materia Core

There are three known designs for Materia cores. Each type of core must be integrated into a chassis that was designed to accommodate it, since the basic principles governing locomotion and power distribution are completely different between each type of core and chassis.

The simplest — if such a device can even be considered ‘simple’ — Materia core design is the alchemical cauldron. An alchemical cauldron uses a legendary flame pearl, suspended within an orichalc ‘boiler’ filled with water materia. The interaction of flame and water produces enormous pressure, which is vented through a series of valves at the top of the cauldron; each valve is connected through the golem armor’s gearworks, allowing steam pressure to be vented to the golem’s pistons when the knight moves their corresponding joints.

A much rarer design is the aetheric dynamo. The dynamo uses a legendary earth pearl, suspended within a set of orichalc coils and rings charged with Air materia. The interaction of earth and air produces an incredibly powerful magnetic field, which the orichalc rings tap into and channel into a series of relays behind the dynamo — each relay is connected through the golem armor’s gearworks, allowing electrical power to be routed to the golem’s limb solenoids when the knight moves their corresponding joints.

Finally, the rarest materia core is the greenheart. A greenheart is a legendary wood pearl, suspended within a beating ‘heart’ sculpted from living wood materia. Within the heart’s chambers is even more wood materia, kept in a liquid state to form the golem armor’s ichor. This ichor flows through veins and arteries into living musculature, which is controlled by a nervous system grown organically into the gearworks. Greenheart armors are made entirely without iron or steel components, allowing them to be piloted by fey champions. Additionally, greenheart golem armors are capable of self-repair, slowly healing any armor or critical damage inflicted on them. A greenheart golem heals one critical slot, or one point of armor per damaged section, each day that it is allowed to rest.

Construction Process

Once the Materia Core is designed and constructed, each additional ‘slot’ is a single rare magic item that can be built by an enchanter with sufficient experience.

First, an array of Pressure Pumps, Power Lines, or Arteries is built above the Core, to distribute power to the limbs. Then the Cauldron, Dynamo, or Greenheart is built around the Core and distribution network. Then the Gearworks are built atop the Hips, completing the Body section.

Second, the Engineer’s Seat, Knight’s Harness, and Scrying Lens are installed into the Helm.

Third, each Hip Linkage is built, followed by Pressure Pumps, Power Lines, or Arteries, then followed by an array of Leg Pistons, Servos, or Musculature necessary to hold the golem armor upright, followed by a Foot Assembly, which completes the Leg.

Finally, each Shoulder Linkage is built, followed by the Pressure Pumps, Power Lines, or Arteries, then followed by an array of Arm Pistons, Servos, or Musculature, and then the Hand Linkage.

The resulting assembly is a single Huge 3 construct, controlled by the knight strapped into the harness in its chest. Each Shoulder and Hand section of the armor is essentially an empty scaffolding, ready to accept any weapons or other equipment desired.

Once the entire set of internals are completed, the Golem Armor’s armor plating is forged and fitted to it. Greenheart Golem Armors must organically ‘grow’ their own armor around their musculature at this point, creating interlocking plates indistinguishable from dragonscale.

Hand-held and shoulder-mounted equipment can be attached or removed from the golem armor at any time. Shoulders are attached to the chest through a set of rivets and pins — a process which takes roughly a day’s work for a team of engineers with the proper tools and scaffolding. Hand-held equipment is simply picked up by the golem armor and wielded; many noble and royal golem armors are attended to by teams of squires carrying additional hand-held options.

Alternate Designs

Several Golem Armor variants were experimented with during the height of the Old Empire. Almost none of these designs survive to the modern day, and those that do are typically in severe disrepair.

A golem armor may convert one or both shoulders into turrets. A turret shoulder mounts its own Scrying Lens and a Gunner's Seat slot, giving a character in that seat control of all weapons in that Shoulder. Alternatively, a single oversized weapon may be mounted across both shoulders, taking up half its size in each shoulder. The weapon itself will sit above the Chest, with braces and moorings spanning either side of the back and shoulders to keep it secured. An oversized weapon cannot be mounted into a turret.

A golem armor may choose to trade flexibility for power, removing its Hand Linkage slot and permanently mounting a particular Hand assembly onto its Arm. This allows a two-handed melee weapon, or an oversized ranged weapon, to be mounted permanently into the combined space of the Arm + Hand. If even more space is desired, the Lower Arm Piston can also be removed, and the Shoulder, Upper Arm Piston, and Pumps can be moved inwards from the arm to the shoulder. This frees up 12 full spaces into that Arm + Hand location, allowing it to mount even the largest bombard.

For those golem armors with two functioning hands, a single two-handed weapon may be constructed which splits its total spaces across both Hands locations. Each 'half' of a two-handed weapon will have its own structure points, which protect the spaces mounted on its 'side' of the weapon. Ammunition on either side of a two-handed ranged weapon may feed both sides of the weapon.

A few rare Golem Armors were built with two extra legs, giving them an animalistic or centauroid appearance. The extra legs grant the armor an additional 20 paces of movement, and make it easier to maintain balance or traverse difficult terrain. Centauroid Golem Armors replace both shoulders with an extra pair of legs, while animal-form Golem Armors replace the arms.

Mounting Armor

Once all of a golem armor's equipment is mounted, armor is bolted onto the chassis. The weight of each structure point of armor depends on the material used, which also determines the maximum armor per section. Golem armors that mount a gull-wing cloak can only use feysilver or dragonscale armor on each shoulder, and cannot use orichalc armor on any other section.

Armor Type	Weight per SP	Cost per SP	Max SP
Steel	25 lb	1 drakh	15
Feysilver	10 lb	500 drakh	10
Dragonscale	15 lb	300 drakh	15
Orichalc	50 lb	250 drakh	20

Construction Examples

The legendary golem armor worn by St. George the Dragon-Slayer was called *Ascalon*. It was an alchemical cauldron design, with 20 SP of orichalc armor covering the body and helm (2,000 lb), and another 15 SP of gilded steel on each arm, shoulder, and leg (2,250 lb).

Each shoulder held a Heavy Sunlance (500 lb x 2), and an Amulet of Protection (250 lb).

Altogether, it weighed 7,500 lb before wielding any hand-held weaponry, and thus could dash 10 paces per phase.

When St. George famously slew his dragon, the Ascalon wielded a shield (1500 lb) and a spear (1000 lb) in its hands, increasing its total weight to 10,000 lb - the maximum possible. As such, it had a dash speed of only 3 fields per round.

By contrast, Percival's golem armor, the *Siege Perilous*, was much more nimble. Clad entirely in 800 lbs of feysilver, its only internal augmentations were a pair of Light Sunlances (100 lb x 2), bringing it to a total weight of only 3,000 lb. This allowed it to either carry a longsword (1000 lb) while maintaining a dash speed of 6 fields, or a longsword and shield (1000 lb + 1500 lb) at a dash speed of 5 fields.

Siege Weapons

Golem Armors and other artifact vehicles can mount siege weapons, such as cannon or other heavy alchemical weaponry. Each siege weapon has a size rating, which is how many artifact slots that weapon takes up within an artifact vehicle, or the number of Science-trained engineers needed to man the weapon when mounted in a crew-served carriage.

Siege weapons typically have two damage ratings - the first represents the structure damage they inflict, and the second represents the damage dealt to creatures within 10' that track hit points. Against creatures that track hit points, a direct hit from a siege weapon inflicts 5d6 piercing or elemental damage per structural damage die, plus (or minus) 1d6 per +1 static damage bonus.

Range

Golem armor ranged weapons can fire out to three times their listed range. Attacks out to the listed range are easy against other Huge targets; attacks out to twice the listed range are at normal difficulty, and attacks out to 3x the listed range are hard.

Area Weapons

Area weapons inflict damage to each section of a huge target caught within their blast; this damage is halved if the target saves vs. blast and the attack's area does not fully cover the target's occupied space. Area weapons must still make a ranged attack throw to hit their intended impact point; on a miss, the round scatters d6 paces in a random direction.

Bombards are massive siege cannon that fire explosive shells. Bombards are hard to aim while moving, or at targets within 500'. A bombard that rolls a '1' on its d20 attack roll detonates, obliterating each section it is mounted to and dealing its attack damage to each of the mounting vehicle's other sections.

Seeker Weapons are large hollow orichalc tubes, each of which contains a single self-propelled automaton that resembles something in between a crossbow bolt and an elongated bird. Each seeker ties into the vehicle's scrying lens, and is aimed and launched by the armor's engineer; on launch, a seeker will fly to the location designated, then ram its target or explode into a blast.

Ammunition

Ballistic siege weapons require ammunition. The amount listed is the amount that can be carried directly within the weapon's internal magazine, or within one external magazine; each external magazine takes up 1 space and weighs 100 lbs. Any ammunition magazine in a fixed section (such as the shoulder or chest of a golem armor) may feed into weapons in adjacent sections without difficulty; ammunition in a 'limb' of a golem armor is more limited, and may only feed a weapon that is mounted in the same section as that ammunition bay. If an ammunition magazine suffers a critical hit, it utterly destroys the section it is mounted in.

A golem knight may use their action to load a weapon or ammunition bay in one section with a spare magazine from another section, or a golem armor may use their action to load an ammunition magazine cartridge into an adjacent golem armor's weapon if neither golem armor moves during their action this round. The Old Empire's legions had "squire" class golem armor designed expressly for this purpose, who often follow heavier units as shield-bearers and munitions-loaders.

Power Draw

Each round on the engineer's turn, the golem armor's materia core produces 5 points of aetheric power. This power is stored within the alchemical cauldron until used; the cauldron can store a maximum of 10 points of power when undamaged. Extra dragon pearls can be mounted in various locations to increase the amount of power produced per turn, but not the maximum amount stored.

In order to fire an aetheric weapon or attack with an enchanted melee weapon, the golem armor must draw power from the cauldron into the weapon. Each aetheric weapon has a power draw, which determines how much power the weapon needs to fire. Various other golem armor-sized enchantments also draw power from the cauldron when in use; if the cauldron's power ever drops below zero, the golem armor shuts down until reactivated.

Ballistic Weapon	Damage	Range	Size	Weight	Magazine
Thunder Rattler	D6-1	200'	1	50 lb	25
Light Cannon	D6+2	500'	2	500 lb	10
Medium Cannon	2D6+1	500'	4	800 lb	6
Heavy Cannon	3D6	500'	6	1200 lb	4
Doomcannon	5D6	400'	8	1400 lb	2
Light Bombard	D6-1* thunder (2 pace blast)	1000'	6	1500 lb	5
Medium Bombard	2D6-2* thunder (3 pace blast)	1500'	9	2500 lb	3
Heavy Bombard	3D6-3* thunder (4 pace blast)	2000'	12	3000 lb	2
*Area Weapon (deals damage to each section of a Huge creature)					
Alchemical Weapons	Damage	Range	Size	Weight	Magazine
Dragon's Maw	D6-2* fire	30' cone	1	50 lb	5
*Area Weapon (deals damage to each section of a Huge creature)					
Aetheric Weapons	Damage	Range	Size	Weight	Power Draw
Light Sunlance	D6-1 radiant	300'	1	100 lb	1
Medium Sunlance	D6+2 radiant	400'	2	200 lb	2
Heavy Sunlance	2D6+1 radiant	500'	4	500 lb	3
Stormlance	3D6 lightning	600'	6	700 lb	5
*Minimum Range (within 100', a Stormlance cannon deals its damage to the target and the firing golem armor)					
Seeker Weapons	Damage	Range	Size	Weight	Magazine
Shrike	2D6	500'	1	100 lb	1
Falcon	D6-1* thunder (2 pace blast)	500'	1	100 lb	1
Thunderbird	2D6-2* thunder (3 pace blast)	1500'	2	250 lb	1
Phoenix	2D6-2* fire (3 pace blast)	1500'	2	250 lb	1
*Area Weapon (deals damage to each section of a Huge creature)					
Melee Weapons	Damage		Size	Weight	Power Draw
Light Weapon	D6		4	500 lb	-
Medium Weapon	D6+3 (2D6 two-handed)		6	1000 lb	-
Heavy Weapon	2D6+3		8	1500 lb	-
Shield	—		6	1500 lb	-
Common Melee Weapon or Shield Enchantment			+0	+0 lb	2
Uncommon Melee Weapon or Shield Enchantment			+0	+0 lb	3
Rare Melee Weapon or Shield Enchantment			+0	+0 lb	5
Enchantment Modules	Location		Size	Weight	Power Draw
Radiant Diadem	Both Shoulders		2 / 2	100 lb	2
Amulet of Protection	Both Shoulders		3 / 3	250 lb	3
+1 Strength Booster	Both Shoulders		3 / 3	250 lb	3
Cloak of Invisibility	Both Shoulders		5 / 5	500 lb	5
Gull-Wing Cloak	Both Shoulders		5 / 5	500 lb	5
+2 Strength Booster	Both Shoulders		5 / 5	500 lb	5
Spectacles of Arcane Sight	(Integrated into Scrying Lens)		0	250 lb	3
Bracer of Shielding	Arm		1	500 lb	5
Grip Gloves	Both Arms		1 / 1	500 lb	5
Dragon Pearl	Any		1	50 lb	+1 Power/turn

Golem Armor Combat

A golem armor operates as a single Huge 3 sized unit on the battlefield.

Knight Actions

The knight directs the armor's movement and attacks with all melee weapons and handheld ranged weapons. Attacks made by the knight use their melee and ranged attack thresholds.

Each ranged weapon may be fired once per round. The Knight may fire all identical weapons in the same hand as a single attack. If the target has hit locations, each weapon in an attack rolls a separate hit location.

All available melee weapons may be used once per melee attack, and each weapon applies its damage to a single hit location roll. Any melee weapons with reach multiply their effective reach by 3.

The Knight may also use their action to perform a feat of strength, such as lifting a boulder or uprooting a tree. All feats of strength rolls made by the golem armor are scaled up to the armor's size (multiplying any relevant weight limits by 100).

Knight Reactions

The golem knight can also make opportunity attacks with their armor's melee weapons.

A golem armor's balance is somewhat precarious; whenever a golem armor takes structure damage and one or more damage dice roll a '6', the golem knight must save vs. Hold to avoid falling prone. This saving throw is easy if the golem armor hasn't suffered critical damage to either of its legs or to its gearworks, and hard if the golem armor has suffered critical damage to both systems.

Engineer Actions

The engineer may use their action to perform an attack with any mounted ranged weapons, scry for hidden units with the golem armor's scrying lens, activate or deactivate various enchantment modules, or overcharge the core.

Overcharging the golem armor's materia core requires the engineer to succeed at a Science check; on a failure, the entire golem armor shuts down before any of the knight's actions can be resolved, the knight must save vs. Hold to keep the golem armor upright, and the core must be restarted by the engineer as another action with another Science check. While a golem armor's core is shut down it is immobile and helpless, and the knight and engineer are both effectively blinded to everything happening outside of the armor.

The risk of shutdown comes with substantial rewards. Successfully overcharging the golem armor's materia core allows the engineer to choose one of the following benefits until the end of the current turn:

- The warrior may perform two actions during this round.
- The engineer may increase the core's power output this round from 5 to to $2d6+3$. The Science roll for this is easier for Dynamo-based golem armors, and harder for Greenhearts.
- The engineer may add +1D6 to each unarmed or melee attack the warrior makes this round. This Science roll is harder for Dynamo-based golem armors, and easier for Greenhearts.

Engineer Reactions

The engineer may fire any Thunder Rattlers or Light Sunlances mounted on the armor's shoulders or chest as anti-seeker point defense weapons whenever targeted by one or more seeker weapons as a modified "opportunity attack", rolling $1d6-1$ per Rattler or Sunlance fired and reducing the incoming seeker salvo by that many missiles. The engineer may also engage any salvo of seekers that targets another unit, if the salvo's line of fire passes within 100'.

Damaging a Golem Armor

Roll 2d6 to determine which section of a golem armor is hit by incoming damage.

Component Damage

Each time a golem armor receives a critical hit from a weapon that deals structure damage, one of its internal components is destroyed; roll 1d6 to determine which. If a golem armor receives more structure damage than its current structure points to any location, one component in that section is also destroyed for each excess sp of damage.

Damage a golem armor's internal components degrades its performance, until those components can be replaced or repaired. A destroyed component must be removed from the golem armor, stripped down to its base parts, and rebuilt in order to be repaired.

Helm (2, 12) - The helm section contains the 'Knight's Harness', which is a large suit of plate armor with chains and pulleys riveted to it, allowing the knight to control the golem. Below this seat is the Engineer's Seat, where an engineer sits to maintain the Cauldron. critical hits to either seat inflicts 3d6 hit point damage to that crew member.

In front of the knight's harness is a 'Scrying Glass', which feeds sensory data to the knight; damage to this component blinds the armor. Because the chest is where the knight and engineer sit; each point of structure damage dealt to the helm also inflicts 1 hp of thunder damage to both occupants.

Body (7) - The body contains the 'Materia Core' critical slot itself; a critical hit to the core obliterates the entire body section in an enormous blast, and deals two damage dice of structural elemental damage to everything within 5 paces. Above the core is the Gearworks, which translates the Knight's motions into the Armor's; damage to this delicate system makes all rolls harder.

Integrated with the Gearworks are the Pressure Pumps, which distribute power throughout the armor. The remaining slots are the Alchemical Cauldron itself; damage to any Pump or Cauldron slot reduces the armor's total power generation and storage by 1 each, as energy leaks and vents from the core.

Shoulders (6: Left / 8: Right) - Each shoulder may house as many ranged weapons and ammunition as will fit. A critical hit to any ranged weapon disables that weapon, while a critical hit to an ammunition bin or aetheric weapon will obliterate that shoulder.

If a golem armor's shoulders have been outfitted with thunder pinions, a critical hit to either wing tears that wing off the armor, causing the armor to immediately plummet to the ground.

Legs (5: Left / 9: Right) - Each leg contains one 'Hip Linkage' critical slot; if this slot is damaged, the entire leg is torn free of the armor, hobbling it. Each leg also contains one 'Suspension' slot and one 'Foot Assembly' slot; if any of these slots are hit, the armor immediately falls prone, and all subsequent saving throws to move or brace are harder. The remaining slots are Pistons, Solenoids, or Musculature, depending on the Materia Core used; damage to any of them slows the armor.

Arms (4: Left / 10: Right) - Each arm contains one 'Shoulder Junction' critical slot; if this slot is damaged, the entire arm (and attached hand) is torn free of the Armor. Similarly, each arm contains one 'Hand Linkage' slot; if this slot is damaged, the corresponding hand section is torn free. The remaining slots are 'Arm Pistons'; damage to any of them makes any attack, parry, or other action performed with that arm harder.

Hands (3: Left / 11: Right) - Each hand can mount one or more ranged weapons along with their ammunition, wielding it like a giant crossbow. A critical hit to any ranged weapon disables that weapon, while a critical hit to an ammunition bin or a charged aetheric weapon will obliterate that entire handheld weapon.

Alternatively, a hand can mount a giant melee weapon or a shield. Golem Armor shields and melee weapons are essentially giant solid slabs of metal, and thus halve all structure damage dealt to them from non-sundering attacks. A critical hit to a melee weapon or shield is resolved as a sundering attack, and vice-versa.

Magic

Dweomercraft

At its heart, dweomercraft is the design and creation of arcane magic items and alchemical formulae. Dwarven dweomersmiths dedicate their lives to the pursuit of this craft, hoping to craft legacies that will last for generations.

Dwarven magic is most similar to human arcane magic, and in fact the first human wizards discovered its principles by studying dwarven dweomercraft. Much like arcane spellcraft, dweomercraft involves the precise alignment of arcana and materia to channel an elemental or aetheric effect, and this practice requires similar levels of intelligence, precision, and experience to master.

But in other respects, dweomercraft is similar to human divine magic. Dwarven craft-priests teach that the Divine Principle crafted the world, and then crafted mortals in Its own image, and as such "divine miracles" and "arcane spells" are simply an imitation of that original process of creation – an imitation which should be performed with utmost care, pride, and humble reverence.



Prepared Dweomers

A dwarf crafting a dweomer creates a volatile alchemical formula or temporary magic item out of raw materia and any other available materials. Preparing a dweomer uses the same alchemical formula or magic item blueprint as creating a permanent version of that object, but is much faster.

Every dwarf is taught from childhood how to assist with the preparation of enchantments and formulae; even those who go on to become stalwarts or delvers know how to assist dweomersmiths at the forge or brewers at the distillery. Those who show real talent are apprenticed at a young age to a master crafter, who teaches them to improvise various alchemies and enchantments with astonishing speed.

Volatile Alchemical Formulae

A volatile alchemical formula is identical to a normal formula, but loses its potency at the next sunrise or sunset. It must be periodically maintained during the day by the alchemist that brewed it; inspecting it for a few seconds once per hour is sufficient to keep its energies stable. The net result is a potion that uses and occupies a preparation of the appropriate circle until imbibed or otherwise used.

Once an alchemical formula is used, attention is freed up for the brewer to prepare another one, or to prepare any other formula of the same rarity or magic of the same circle.

Magic Item Enchantments

Similarly, a magic item enchantment uses arcane ink and materia to temporarily enchant any common object with a magic item effect. The enchantment lasts until the next sunrise or sunset, and must be maintained during the day by the enchanter that made it; touching the enchantment and inspecting it for a few moments once per hour is sufficient to keep its energies stable. The net result is effectively a functional magic item, which occupies a preparation of the appropriate circle.

Magic item enchantments may be recharged using the same process as constructing them, and may be disenchanting during the day to free up their preparation, allowing the dwarf or wizard to prepare a new enchantment or other magic instead.

Dweomersmith Rituals

Dweomersmith also learn more elaborate rituals as part of their class training. A dweomersmith may analyze or recharge a magic item in two exploration turns; at third level, they may perform the unbind cursed item ritual in four turns; and at fifth level, they may perform the hallow ritual dweomer in six turns.

Analyze Magic Item

First Circle

You perform this ritual while holding an object or item with an empty hand, or while touching a piece of a larger structure. You learn its magical properties, how many charges or uses it has, and how to activate it. You also learn whether any active spells or other supernatural effects are affecting it, their approximate power levels, and the rough nature of those effects.

Mend

First Circle

As an exploration action, you repair up to 2d6 breaks or tears in a single damaged non-living object, such as broken chain links, two halves of a broken key, a tear in a cloak, or a leak in a wineskin. As long as each break or tear is no larger than 1 foot in any dimension, you mend it, leaving no trace of the former damage. You may also repair all of a weapon or armor's reduction in performance from a sundering effect. This dweomer can physically repair a magic item or construct, but the blessing can't restore magic to such an object.

Recharge Magic Item

Second Circle

You can perform this ritual while holding any arcane magic item with an expended charge, then make a Science check and a Finesse check, with a difficulty based on the item's rarity; if both rolls succeed, the item regains one charge. Each time you attempt this ritual, you use one charge of materia of an element appropriate to the magic item.

Unbind Cursed Item

Second Circle

You touch a cursed object that is bonded to a mortal and offer a prayer of deliverance, then make a Science check. If you succeed, the item relinquishes its hold. Your Science check is easy for a common cursed item, or hard for a rare item. This ritual will not un-curse an item, but only un-bonds it from a mortal.

Consecrate Workspace

Third Circle

You bless a workspace up to 20 paces in diameter and all of its tools and equipment, while tidying and organizing and tending to any necessary minor repairs. Until the next sunrise or sunset, all rolls that you make to design or craft an item or alchemical formula within the space are easier, and all alchemy and crafting tasks to produce a permanent item take half as much time as normal.

If multiple dwarves assist with the ritual, they can increase the size of the workspace, and all participants gain the effect's bonuses. Most dwarven forges are consecrated daily at each sunrise and sunset; after one lunar month of this, the effects become permanent until the workspace is damaged or the blessing is dispelled.

Arcane Spells

Arcane magic is dedicated to producing reliable results based on understood aetheric principles. A wizard spends most of their time studying these abstract principles, with actual spellcasting seen as simply a rote application of those principles.

Arcana, Materia, and Soma

Each castable arcane spell has three components, called the spell's Arcana, Materia, and Soma.

A spell's **Arcana** is the specific configuration of runes and sigils as laid out in the wizard's spellbook. Each arcane spell has a unique Arcana, which can be copied from one spellbook to another.

A spell's **Materia** is the magical "fuel" used to help power the spell; this is usually a material component with magical properties, which is ground into powder during the spell's preparation to create magical ink, then painted onto the wizard's body in a pattern following the runes and sigils dictated by the spell's Arcana. This pattern is nearly complete, only requiring a trigger to perfectly match the Arcana described in your spellbook.

A spell's **Soma** is the specific triggering words or gestures that must be performed by the wizard to "complete" the spell, activating and consuming the prepared Materia and producing the spell's effect. Each spell's Arcana must be placed in an appropriate place on the wizard's body, and the wizard's skill and training determine how large and precise the spell's Arcana must be in order to be reliably triggered by the spell's Soma.

Most spells have both a verbal soma and a kinetic soma – that is, they require both speech and precise motion to activate. Trying to cast while deafened or restrained requires a hard Science check to successfully execute the spell; Attempting to cast while silenced simply fails altogether, unless the spell requires no verbal somatic component. On a failure, the spell is wasted in a flash of light with no other effect.

Preparation

Within the two-hour span around sunrise or sunset, you may spend time preparing arcane spells from your spellbook. Spell preparation is easiest when the veil between worlds is thinnest, in the hour before or after dawn or before or after sunset; a wizard may also prepare their chosen school's spells outside of this window, but with more difficulty. Each prepared spell lasts until you cast it, or until after the next sunrise or sunset.

Each spell to be prepared requires $\frac{1}{2}$ of a bottle of magic ink per circle. This ink is consumed during the spell preparation process as it is applied directly to the wizard's skin; the ink must contain ground-up and emulsified Materia with the same aspect as the spell. Most spells have a trigger-sigil prepared onto one of the wizard's hands, which must be free and empty in order to cast the spell. The remainder is prepared onto other portions of the wizard's body, which cannot be covered by armor in order for the spell's Arcana to properly function – wearing any armor other than cloth halves the total number of spells that a wizard may prepare.

Spell Scrolls

You may choose to use specially prepared parchment, rod, and inks while preparing a spell to create a spell scroll instead of preparing it onto your body; if you spend one full day from sunrise to sunset (or sunset to sunrise) enchanting a single scroll, that scroll becomes supernaturally resilient, and will retain its potency indefinitely until used.

A scroll prepared by a wizard may be used by any other wizard of an appropriate level to cast the prepared spell. Non-wizards, or wizards who are not of a sufficient level to cast spells of that circle, may also attempt to cast a spell from a scroll by first spending an action to save vs. Trick, with a difficulty based on the scroll's circle. If they succeed, they cast the spell as their next turn's action.

A wizard may also attempt to reverse-engineer a spell from a scroll and record the complete spell in their spellbook; this takes an hour of research and destroys the scroll. The wizard saves vs. confusion with a difficulty based on the scroll's circle; if they succeed, they add the spell to their spellbook.

Spell Schools

Each arcane spell always belongs to two schools of magic: one set of schools is called its Substance, and the other is called its Form. Each arcane spell always has one Substance and one Form. There are five Forms and three Substances, although wizards argue incessantly about whether there are really three Substances, seven, or twelve.

Arcane Forms

The four Forms are Abjuration, Conjunction, Divination, and Transmutation. An Arcane Form shapes the "intent" of a spell towards a specific goal: abjurations protect from harm or change, conjunctions manifest raw magical substances or energies and weave them into specific forms, divinations reveal information to the caster or provide a creature with new sensory abilities, and transmutations change one substance or shape into another.



Abjuration



Conjunction



Divination



Transmutation

Arcane Substances

While the Form of a spell determines its intent, the Substance of the spell defines the energies that will be commanded to accomplish that intent. There are three Form schools - aetheric, psychic, and elemental - with the elemental school further divided into four elements of Earth, Water, Air, and Flame.

Aetheric spells affect the raw tapestry of material reality itself, twisting and re-weaving the fundamental relationships between events that mortals call time, space, motion, and probability. Aetheric spells that cause harm inflict aetheric damage.

Psychic spells affect the thoughts, beliefs, actions, perceptions, and emotions of sentient beings. Harmful psychic spells inflict psychic damage.

Elemental spells depend on their prepared materia to determine their damage type. Wizards recognize four types of elemental materia (earth, water, air, and flame), each with two corresponding damage types based on polarity (yin and yang).

Stone (Yin earth) deals petrification damage by transforming flesh and wood into sandstone, metal into rust, and liquids into mud. A creature being petrified can save vs. Hold to arrest the progress of the affliction.

Metal (Yang earth) is affected by armor like normal weapon damage, and can deal piercing, blunt, or sundering damage depending on the spell.

Ice (Yin water) deals cold damage, slowing and freezing the target. Rolling a '6' for cold damage forces the victim to save vs. Hold or be hobbled or immobilized by the ice.

Acid (Yang water) deals acid damage, which sunders armor and weapons on a damage roll of '6'. A wizard may choose to cast any acid spell non-lethally by spraying the target with seawater rather than acid, dealing blunt damage instead.

Lightning (Yin air) deals lightning damage, which stuns affected creatures on a damage roll of '6' unless they save vs. Hold. All saving throws vs. lightning-based spells are harder if a creature is wearing metal armor or wielding a medium or heavy metal weapon.

Thunder (Yang air) deals thunder damage, which deafens affected creatures on a damage roll of '6' unless they save vs. Blast.

Radiant (Yin fire) deals radiant damage, flash-burning the target with intense light and blinding them on a damage roll of '6' unless they save vs. Blast.

Flame (Yang fire) deals fire damage, roasting the target with intense heat and igniting their flesh and possessions on a damage roll of '6' unless they save vs. Blast.

Creating A New Arcane Spell

When not adventuring, wizards spend most of their time performing arcane research. Much of this research is theoretical, but sometimes a wizard makes a discovery that provides practical results.

Every Arcane spell known was created by a Wizard at some point in the distant past. Player characters may wish to create their own spells; doing so should follow the following guidelines:

Research Points

Each month that a wizard spends in their laboratory researching a spell design, they make a Science test with a difficulty determined by the desired circle of the spell; if they succeed, they accumulate 1d6 research points.

If the wizard has a magic item or item blueprint, or a similar magical effect to work backwards from that they can reliably experiment upon, their Science test is easy.

Designing the Spell

Once a wizard has accumulated enough research points to attempt to design their spell, they may do so. Actually attempting the spell design involves a final Science test to avoid a mishap. If this Science test fails, the referee will choose some kind of spell effect appropriate to the spell being designed, which manifests during the attempt to design the spell with chaotic results. Otherwise, the new spell works as intended, and is added to the wizard's spellbook.

Non-damaging spells require significantly more referee judgment than spells designed to simply deal hit point damage. The best guideline is to begin with an existing spell, and then adjust its parameters until the players and referee all agree on the final spell's balance and required research.

Determining Spell Range

Spells that affect the caster themselves, or only creatures that they touch, do not need to devote any research points to range. Area effect spells that originate from the caster's space also do not need to devote research points to range. Otherwise, each 5 paces of range costs 1 research point, up to a maximum range of 20 paces for a first-circle spell, 50 paces for a second-circle spell, or 100 paces for a third-circle spell.

Spells with unusual effects may have their maximum possible range limited by the referee more stringently.

Area of effect is similarly limited by research points - a spell can affect 6 square paces of area per research point, and the total amount of research that can be put into range, area, and damage together cannot exceed 6 research points per circle. The approximate 'square pace area' of various radii, cones, and lines as follows:

Area Size	Research Points
Single Target	0 points
1-pace radius	1 point
2-pace radius	2 points
3-pace radius	4 points / cone: 1 point
4-pace radius	8 points / cone: 2 points
5-pace radius	12 points / cone: 3 points
6-pace radius	16 points / cone: 4 points
7-pace radius	24 points / cone: 6 points
8-pace radius	32 points / cone: 8 points
1-pace wide line	1 point per 6 paces long
2-pace wide line	1 point per 3 paces long
3-pace wide line	1 point per 2 paces long

Determining Spell Damage

Spells that instantaneously inflict damage are relatively straightforward. Most spells that directly inflict damage are conjurations, although some transmutations can also instantaneously damage their targets.

The maximum theoretical damage that a spell can do is 3d6 per circle for a melee attack or close-range area, or 2d6 per circle for a ranged attack or long-range area; each research point put into damage translates into 1d6 damage. Spells that harm or hinder the target without inflicting dice of damage need to be balanced individually on a case-by-case basis.

A damaging spell can be made to cause one elemental effect per damage die that rolls '6'; this costs 1 research point per 2 dice of damage, and the maximum number of research points that can be spent this way is equal to the spell's circle. A spell can also automatically inflict an elemental effect on a failed saving throw; each elemental effect that is automatically inflicted costs 2 research points, and reduces the spell's maximum damage by 1 die.

Some damaging transmutations can operate more slowly than conjurations, gradually transforming a creature or object into a less functional form. The maximum damage per round of a sustained damaging transmutation is limited to one die per spell circle. Each die of direct ongoing damage costs 2 research points, and automatically inflicts an elemental effect on a '6'; each elemental effect directly inflicted regardless of damage costs 3 research points.

Non-Damaging Spells

Non-damaging spells will require direct negotiation with the referee to determine the spell's circle and limitations.

Abjurations require slightly more referee judgment than damaging transmutations or conjurations. Each die of temporary hit points granted to one creature is approximately the equivalent of one die of damage dealt, and so costs 1 research point. Shields that erect barriers which protect everyone in an area should have a similar cost as conjurations that damage everyone within that area, so the area of effect research cost is also the same. Making saving throws easier or harder is approximately equivalent to granting critical hit chances, and so the costs there can be directly translated as well. Beyond this, some amount of tweaking will be required to line up the spell's research point cost with established spells.

Finally, **divinations** and non-damaging utility spells of any school must be adjudicated on a case-by-case basis by the referee, using existing spells as an example to judge the new spell's circle, effects, and requirements.

Spell Design Examples

Fireball represents nearly the theoretical maximum power for conjuration spells that inflict damage. Fireball inflicts six dice of elemental damage (+6 research points) in a 20' blast radius (+8 research points) within 20 paces (+4 research points), and ignites one target for each die that rolls a '6' (+3 research points), for a total of 21 research points.

Lightning bolt also inflicts six dice of elemental damage (+6 research points), doing so in a 3-pace wide line 30 paces long (+10 research points), and inflicts a stun effect on each die that rolls a '6' (+3 research points), for a total of 19 research points.

Arcane Spells

There have been thousands of arcane spells created since humans first discovered magic, but this list represents the most well-known spells and their associated cantrips.

First Circle

Arcane Bolts	<i>Magic Missile</i>
Arcane Mark	<i>Spell Ward</i>
Beguile	<i>Friends</i>
Continual Light	<i>Flickering Light</i>
Darkness	<i>Shroud</i>
Elemental Cone	<i>Elemental Grasp</i>
Feather Fall	<i>Jump</i>
Floating Disc	<i>Mage Hand</i>
Shield	<i>Resistance (physical or aetheric)</i>
Silent Image	<i>Shroud</i>
Sleep	<i>Elemental Grasp (Psychic)</i>
Subtle Weave	<i>Spell Ward</i>

Second Circle

Arcane Sight	<i>Detect Magic</i>
Arcane Lock	<i>Mage Hand</i>
Comprehend	<i>Detect Magic</i>
Detect Illusions	<i>Detect Magic</i>
Elemental Ray	<i>Magic Missile</i>
Invisibility	<i>Shroud</i>
Knock	<i>Elemental Grasp (Blunt)</i>
Levitate	<i>Jump</i>
Locate Object	<i>Detect Magic</i>
Phantasm	<i>Minor Image</i>
Read Thoughts	<i>Uncanny Insight</i>
Sending	<i>Silent Whisper</i>

Third Circle

Circle of Protection	<i>Spell Ward</i>
Clairvoyance	<i>Friends</i>
Cloud of Daggers	<i>Magic Missile (Piercing)</i>
Cone of Cold	<i>Magic Missile (Cold)</i>
Darkvision	<i>Detect Magic</i>
Dispel Magic	<i>Spell Ward</i>
Fireball	<i>Magic Missile (Fire)</i>
Fly	<i>Jump</i>
Hold Person	<i>Mage Hand</i>
Lightning Bolt	<i>Magic Missile (Lightning)</i>
Shelter	<i>Blade Ward</i>
Suggestion	<i>Friends</i>

Fourth Circle

Arcane Eye	<i>Detect Magic</i>
Confusion	<i>Friends</i>
Dimension Door	<i>Mage Hand</i>
Dominate	<i>Friends</i>
Wall of Stone	<i>Elemental Grasp (Piercing)</i>
Wall of Ice	<i>Elemental Grasp (Ice)</i>
Wall of Miasma	<i>Elemental Grasp (Poison)</i>
Wall of Flame	<i>Elemental Grasp (Fire)</i>
Weave Element	<i>Resistance (elemental)</i>

Fifth Circle

Disintegrate	<i>Magic Missile (Aetheric)</i>
Flesh to Stone	<i>Magic Missile (Piercing)</i>
Giant Fist	<i>Mage Hand</i>
Resilient Sphere	<i>Resistance (all damage)</i>
Summon Elemental	<i>Magic Missile (elemental)</i>
Telepathic Bond	<i>Uncanny Insight</i>

Cantrips

Each Wizard spell has a cantrip effect. Many spells share the same cantrip effect, so they are listed here and referred to by name in each spell's description. Any cantrip that deals damage always deals the same type of damage as the prepared spell.

Detect Magic

While a spell with the Detect Magic cantrip is prepared, you sense the presence of any active magic within 3 paces of you. When you notice a magic effect, you may make a hard Science check to determine what kind of magic it is (arcane, divine, or primal), or to determine what schools of magic it belongs to if arcane.

Elemental Grasp

While a spell with the Elemental Grasp cantrip is prepared, you may make a melee attack throw with a bare hand that inflicts 1d6 damage of the spell's prepared element.

Flickering Glow

While a spell with the Flickering Glow cantrip is prepared, you may create a torch-sized orb of light in your hand. This orb sheds dim light in a 2-pace radius in a color of your choice.

Friends

While a spell with the Friends cantrip is prepared, any Charm or Wit test vs. a mortal within 5 paces who is not hostile towards you is easy for as long as you maintain focus and eye contact. When this effect ends, the target knows that you influenced its mind, and their attitude towards you degrades by 1d6 steps.

Jump

While a spell with the Jump cantrip is prepared, your jumping distance is doubled, and you halve any falling damage that you take. You may also touch another adjacent creature as it performs the jump action to double its jump distance, but its falling damage is not halved.

Mage Hand

While a spell with the Mage Hand cantrip is prepared, you may project a ghostly shadow of one of your own hands up to 5 paces away. The hand can manipulate items, open doors or containers, or perform appropriate tests and saving throws, but cannot attack, activate magic items, or carry any object weighing more than 10 lbs.

Magic Missile

While a spell with the Magic Missile cantrip is prepared, you may make a ranged attack throw with a 10 pace range that inflicts 1d6 damage of the same type as the prepared spell.

Resistance

Fast - While a spell with the Resistance cantrip is prepared, you halve all damage you receive from any source of the prepared element whenever you evade.

Shroud

While a spell with the Shroud cantrip is prepared, your Stealth checks to hide are easier.

Spell Ward

While a spell with the Spell Ward cantrip is prepared, your saving throws vs. spells, miracles, or other magical effects are easier whenever you evade.

Silent Whisper

While a spell with the Silent Whisper cantrip is prepared, you may telepathically whisper a short message to one creature that you are aware of within 5 paces. The target may not respond.

Uncanny Insight

While you have a spell with the Uncanny Insight cantrip prepared, all your Intuition checks against another intelligent creature are easier as long as you maintain eye contact with that creature.

First-Circle Arcane Spells

Arcane Bolts

Aetheric Conjunction

Cantrip - Magic Missile (Aetheric)

When you cast this spell, a number of motes of aetheric energy appear around you equal to half your level (round up). While you focus, they circle you slowly at a distance of two feet; they do not emit light to see by, but can be seen from up to 20 paces away as if they emitted dim light.

Fast - At any time thereafter, you may fire one of these motes at a creature that you can see within 10 paces. The mote passes through all non-aetheric barriers on its way to its target, inflicting 1d6 aetheric damage.

Arcane Mark

Aetheric Divination

Cantrip - Detect Magic

Fast - You touch a small or tiny inanimate object and an invisible rune appears on it, visible only through the Identify Magic or Arcane Sight spells, or similar effects. While you maintain focus, you know precisely the distance and direction to the object, and its approximate speed and direction of travel.

Beguile

Psychic Transmutation

Cantrip - Friends

You attempt to beguile an intelligent mortal creature within 5 paces that makes eye contact with you or can hear your voice. If it saves vs. Trick, it knows that you attempted to manipulate its mind, and its attitude likely degrades by one step. If it fails, its attitude towards you becomes Friendly for as long as you focus. The effect immediately ends if you do anything harmful to the beguiled creature; if they suffer injury from any other source, they also immediately make a saving throw to attempt to snap out of it.

Continual Light

Flame Conjunction

Cantrip - Flickering Glow

While you maintain focus, your hand or one held object emits bright light out to 5 paces and dim light out to 10 paces. If you touch the light directly to a creature and succeed in a melee attack, it suffers 1d6 radiant damage and is blinded.

Darkness

Flame Conjunction

Cantrip - Shroud

While you maintain focus, you snuff out all light within a 5 pace radius. Any light that is further than 5 paces away, but within 10 paces, is dimmed by one step - bright light becomes dim light, dim light becomes deep shadow, and deep shadow becomes pitch blackness. A supernaturally produced light that is being actively maintained by another magic-user may be able to pierce the darkness if the caster saves vs. Trick; this saving throw is easier if the other caster is higher level than you, or hard if they are below half your level.

Elemental Cone

Elemental Conjunction

Cantrip - Elemental Grasp

You unleash a torrent of elemental energy from your empty hand. Make an area attack against a 3-pace cone originating from your hand; all creatures within the area must save vs. blast or take 3d6 elemental damage. Each damage die that rolls a '6' inflicts one ongoing effect of the chosen element to one target that failed its saving throw.

The elemental damage type of this spell is determined when it is prepared, based on the type of elemental materia used to prepare it:

- Earth - Obsidian Shards (piercing)
- Water - Chill Spray (cold), Acid Spray (acid)
- Air - Arc Burst (lightning), Gust of Wind (thunder)
- Flame - Cone of Flame (fire), Sunburst (radiant)

Feather Fall

Air Transmutation

Cantrip - Jump

Fast - You can cast this spell on a creature within 10 paces. While you focus, its rate of descent drops to 50 feet per round whenever it would fall, and it always lands on its feet and takes no falling damage.

Floating Disc

Aetheric Conjunction

Cantrip - Mage Hand

You may conjure a circular, horizontal plane of force in the shape of a cupped disc 3 feet in diameter, that floats 3 feet above the ground in an unoccupied space of your choice that you can see within range. The disc remains while you maintain focus, and can hold up to 500 pounds. If more weight is placed on it, the spell ends, and everything on the disc falls to the ground.

The disc is immobile while you are within 5 paces of it, following you within 5 paces as you move further away. It ignores difficult terrain, but it can't cross elevation changes of 10 feet or more, and the spell ends if it is ever more than 20 paces away.

Shield

Aetheric Abjuration

Cantrip - Resistance (physical or aetheric)

Fast - You can cast this spell with a free hand in reaction to a weapon attack or similar physical non-elemental injury, or by any effect that deals aetheric damage.

An invisible bubble of aetheric energy forms around you, absorbing some of the damage and shielding you from harm. Roll two 2d6 and gain that many temporary hit points. While any hit points are remaining, you halve all damage that you receive from weapons or aetheric effects.

Silent Image

Psychic Conjunction

Cantrip - Shroud

You create the image of an object, a creature, or some other visible phenomenon that is no larger than a 15-foot cube. The image appears at a spot within 10 paces and lasts for the duration. The image is purely visual; it isn't accompanied by sound, smell, or other sensory effects. Physical interaction with the image reveals it to be an illusion, because things can pass through it.

While you maintain focus, you can cause the image to move to any spot within range. As the image changes location, you can alter its appearance so that its movements appear natural for the image.

You can also use this spell to make yourself and your clothing and equipment look different. To discern that you are disguised, a creature can inspect your appearance and make a saving throw.

Sleep

Psychic Transmutation

Cantrip - Elemental Grasp (Psychic)

You make eye contact with another living creature or creatures within 5 paces of you whose total levels are less than twice your own. Each affected creature is stunned for one combat round, then must save vs Curse or fall unconscious for 1d6 exploration turns. A creature higher than your own level rolls an easy saving throw; a creature less than half your own level rolls a hard saving throw. Once asleep, an affected creature cannot wake on its own, and any attempt to rouse the creature is hard.

Subtle Weave

Aetheric Abjuration

Cantrip - Spell Ward

This spell does not require any somatic or verbal aspects. While you maintain focus, you can attempt to silently cast another prepared spell without its normal somatic aspects.

Make a hard Stealth check; if you succeed, the other spell is cast without needing to speak or move. If you fail, you lose focus on this spell, and lose the other prepared spell without casting it.

Second-Circle Arcane Spells

Arcane Sight

Aetheric Divination

Cantrip - Detect Magic

While you maintain focus, you can see any invisible creatures, supernatural effects, or magical auras as glowing shapes. You may focus your attention on an individual item or creature, gaining detailed information as if casting Identify Magic on it.

Arcane Lock

Aetheric Abjuration

Cantrip - Mage Hand

You touch a closed door, window, gate, chest, or other entryway or container with an empty hand, and it becomes locked until this effect is dispelled. All attempts to pick the lock or force it open are hard. You may choose a password when you cast this spell; speaking the password will release the lock and open the entryway for ten minutes.

Comprehend

Psychic Divination

Cantrip - Uncanny Insight

While you focus, you understand the literal meaning of any spoken language that you hear while you make eye contact with the speaker. You also understand the meaning of any written language that you see, but you must be touching the surface on which the words are written. Encoded messages and secret glyphs are not decoded by this spell.

Detect Illusions

Psychic Divination

Cantrip - Uncanny Insight

You close your eyes and then open them to take in your surroundings. If there are any supernatural illusion effects affecting your perceptions, you will notice them as a slight shimmer in your vision and a tingling sensation on the back of your neck.

This spell will not let you pierce the illusion or see what is actually present; it will only alert you that there is, in fact, some kind of effect obscuring or altering your true perceptions.

Elemental Ray

Elemental Conjunction

Cantrip - Magic Missile (elemental)

You fire a ray of energy, of an element chosen during preparation. Make a ranged attack throw that deals 2d6 elemental damage at a range of 20 paces.

- Earth - Obsidian Dagger (piercing)
- Water - Acid Arrow (acid)
- Air - Arc Bolt (lightning)
- Flame - Scorching Ray (fire)

Invisibility

Psychic Transmutation

Cantrip - Shroud

You touch a creature or object. While you maintain focus, the target is invisible to normal sight and darkvision. Anything the target is wearing or carrying is invisible as long as it is on the target's person. The spell ends if the target attacks or casts any other magic.

Knock

Earth Transmutation

Cantrip - Elemental Grasp (Blunt)

You rap your hand against a door, lock, or other portal. That portal instantly and permanently opens, destroying any mechanism that might allow it to close again. Doors or mechanisms with a structure rating might withstand this spell; such a door suffers 1D6 structure damage.

Levitate

Air Transmutation

Cantrip - Jump

You touch one creature or loose object of your choice that weighs less than 500 lbs. The target rises vertically, up to 20 feet, and remains suspended there while you maintain focus. An unwilling creature may save vs. Hold against this effect.

The target can only move itself by pushing or pulling against a fixed object or surface within reach with an Agility check. You can move the target by up to 10 feet in any direction as your action, within the spell's range. When the spell ends, the target falls to the ground.

Locate Object

Aetheric Divination

Cantrip - Detect Magic

Describe or name an object that is familiar to you. While you maintain focus, you sense the direction to the object's location and its approximate distance, as long as that object is within one mile of you. If the object is in motion, you know the direction of its movement.

The spell can locate a specific object known to you, as long as you have seen it up close – within 5 paces – at least once. Alternatively, the spell can locate the nearest object of a particular kind, such as a certain kind of apparel, jewelry, furniture, tool, or weapon.

This spell fails if any thickness of orichalc or lead, even a thin sheet, blocks a direct path between the caster and the object.

Phantasm

Psychic Conjunction

Cantrip - Minor Image

You create the image of an object, a creature, or some other phenomenon that is no larger than a 20-foot cube. It appears at a spot that you can see within 15 paces, and seems completely real, including any sounds, smells, or other appropriate sensations. A creature that closely examines it can save vs. Trick to notice that it is an illusion.

As long as you focus and stay within range of the illusion, you can cause it to move to any other spot within range, and you can alter its appearance and other sensory effects so that its movements, sounds, and so on appear natural for the image, such as making it appear to walk or even making it carry on a conversation.

Read Thoughts

Psychic Divination

Cantrip - Uncanny Insight

While you maintain focus, you can read the thoughts of certain creatures. When you cast the spell and as your action on each turn until the spell ends, you can detect the presence of thinking creatures within 5 paces of you with Intelligence of -2 or higher, even if you can't see them. The spell can penetrate barriers, but 2 feet of rock, 2 inches of metal other than lead or orichalc, or a thin sheet of lead or orichalc blocks you. Once you detect the presence of a creature in this way, you can read its thoughts as described above even if you can't see it while it is within 5 paces.

You can focus your mind on any one creature within 5 paces of you that you can see or detect with this spell. If the creature you choose has an Intelligence of -4 or lower or doesn't speak any language, it is unaffected.

You initially learn the surface thoughts of the creature you focus on – what is most on its mind in that moment. As an action, you can either shift your attention to another creature's thoughts or attempt to probe deeper into the same creature's mind. If you probe deeper, the target can resist with a save vs. Trick. Otherwise, you gain insight into its reasoning (if any), its emotional state, and something that looms large in its mind (such as something it worries over, loves, or hates). If you fail, the spell ends. Either way, the target knows that you are probing into its mind, and unless you shift your attention to another creature's thoughts, the creature can use its action on its turn to make another saving throw to break the spell.

Sending

Psychic Conjunction

Cantrip - Silent Whisper

You silently send a message of 25 words or less to one creature that you are familiar with, regardless of distance. The target hears the message in their mind and recognizes you as the sender. As long as the target has an Intelligence of -3 or higher, they understand the meaning even if they do not normally speak your language.

Third-Circle Arcane Spells

Circle of Protection

Aetheric Abjuration

Cantrip - Spell Ward

You sprinkle roughly an ounce of aetheric materia, ground iron dust, and ground feysilver dust in a 5-foot-diameter circle, pausing every few inches to inscribe appropriate runes and sigils, to create a 10-foot-tall cylinder of magical energy. The ground dust that defines the circle glows with an eerie light while the spell remains active. If cast as a ritual, the spell creates a 10-foot radius circle which proscribes a 20-foot-tall cylinder.

Celestial, elemental, fey, infernal, and undead creatures can't willingly enter or leave the cylinder by non-magical means. If the creature tries to use teleportation or interplanar travel to do so, it must first succeed at a hard save vs. Curses. Each such creature also finds its attack throws against targets on the other side of the border are harder, and targets on the other side of the border can't be beguiled, panicked, or possessed by such a creature. Finally, all arcane magics within the circle are easier, and all non-arcane magics cast within or across the circle's boundary are harder.

The circle lasts while you maintain focus, or until the next sunrise or sunset if cast as a ritual. It then fades into a dusty residue and a lingering faded or burned-in pattern where the circle was made.

Clairvoyance

Aetheric Divination

Cantrip - Detect Magic

You create an invisible sensor up to a mile away in a location familiar to you (a place you have visited or seen before) or in an obvious location up to 20 paces away that is unfamiliar to you (such as behind a door, around a corner, or in a grove of trees).

The sensor remains in place while you maintain focus, and it can't be attacked or otherwise interacted with. You can choose to perceive all sight and sound through the sensor throughout the next round, as if you were standing in the sensor's space. As you do, you may choose to move for sensor to move up to 3 paces in any direction, including up or down.

Cloud of Daggers

Earth Conjunction

Cantrip - Magic Missile (Earth)

You fill the air with spinning, razor-sharp shards of crystal in a sphere two paces in radius, centered on a point you choose within range. Each creature within the area must save vs. blast, or take 1d6 piercing damage for every 2 levels of the caster (round up). Each damage die that rolls a '6' inflicts ongoing bleeding damage to one target that failed its saving throw.

While you focus, each creature must save again or take 2d6 piercing damage when it starts its turn in the spell's area or enters that area for the first time on a turn.

Cone of Cold

Water Conjunction

Cantrip - Magic Missile (Cold)

You blast a cone of freezing air 20 paces long from your hands that inflicts 1d6 cold damage per level of the caster. Each damage die that rolls a '6' stuns and hobbles a creature of your choice that failed its saving throw.

Darkvision

Flame Divination

Cantrip - Detect Magic

While you maintain focus, you can see in perfect darkness out to 10 paces. You cannot distinguish colors or read fine detail without light, but can see the shape of any objects that are not invisible or obscured.

This spell projects a particularly bright 'beacon' of magical energy in a 10-pace cone; while this effect is invisible to mundane eyes, creatures that can see magic can spot it from a great distance.

Dispel Magic

Aetheric Abjuration

Cantrip - Spell Ward

Fast - You choose a magical effect on the target while touching them with your hand, then make a Science check to end that effect. You may also target any spell, miracle, or other magical effect that you can see within 25 paces as it is being cast. This roll is easy for an effect made by a creature or magic-user whose level is less than half your own, or hard if the effect is from a source whose level is higher than your own.

Fireball*Flame Conjunction**Cantrip - Magic Missile (Fire)*

You fling a glowing red ember at a space within 20 paces, which detonates into a 4-pace radius fiery explosion that inflicts 1d6 fire damage per level of the caster. Any damage die that rolls a '6' ignites a target of your choice that failed its saving throw, inflicting ongoing fire damage.

Fly*Air Transmutation**Cantrip - Jump*

You gain a flying speed of 15 paces for as long as you maintain focus. When the spell ends, you plummet to the ground if you are still aloft, unless you can stop the fall. As your action while flying, you can dash up to 60 paces in a straight line rather than moving 15 paces; if you pass adjacent to any other creature or obstacle, you must take an Agility check as part of your action to avoid colliding with it.

Hold Person*Aetheric Abjuration**Cantrip - Mage Hand*

As your action, choose a Large or smaller humanoid that you can see within 10 paces. The target must save vs. Hold or be restrained for the duration. On each of its turns, the restrained creature can use its action to attempt to break free.

Lightning Bolt*Air Conjunction**Cantrip - Magic Missile (Lightning)*

You gesture with your hands, and a stroke of lightning forming a line 20 paces long and 2 paces wide blasts out from your hands in a direction you choose, dealing 1d6 lightning damage per level of the caster to each creature along the line.

Creatures with metal armor or weapons find their saving throw harder, and the lightning may ignite flammable objects in the area that aren't being worn or carried. For each damage die that rolls a '6', one affected creature of your choice that failed its saving throw becomes stunned, and is disarmed if it is wielding a metal weapon.

Shelter*Aetheric Abjuration**Cantrip - Blade Ward*

A 10-foot-radius immobile dome of force springs into existence around and above you and remains stationary while you maintain focus and don't leave its radius. The sphere has 3d6 structure points, is resistant to all non-aetheric damage, and immune to all non-structure damage. eight medium or small creatures can fit inside the dome with you. The spell fails if its area includes a larger creature or more than nine creatures. Spells and other magical effects can't extend through the dome or be cast through it.

If cast as a ritual at sunrise or sunset, the dome lasts until the next sunrise or sunset without your focus so long as you remain within it, and all creatures and objects within the dome when you cast this spell can move through it freely. All other creatures and objects are barred from passing through it.

Until the spell ends, you can command the interior to become dimly lit or dark. The dome is opaque from the outside, of any color you choose, but it is transparent from the inside. The atmosphere inside the space is comfortable and dry, regardless of the weather outside.

Suggestion*Psychic Transmutation**Cantrip - Friends*

You make eye contact with a target within 5 paces and suggest a belief or course of activity (no more than a sentence or two). Unless they save vs. Tricks, they must follow or believe your suggestion for as long as you continue to focus. Whenever they would be presented with evidence that contradicts your suggestion, they may make another saving throw to attempt to snap out of it.

This spell has no effect if the target cannot hear or understand you, and the target's saving throw is easy if your command is obviously and immediately harmful to it.

Fourth-Circle Arcane Spells

Arcane Eye

Aetheric Divination

Cantrip - Detect Magic

You cause an invisible, magical eye to form at your forehead. You mentally receive visual information from the eye when you close your own eyes, and it has darkvision out to 5 paces. The arcane eye can look in every direction, and can also see magical auras and creatures as if casting the Arcane Sight spell. You can move the eye up to 5 paces in any direction each round.

Confusion

Psychic Transmutation

Cantrip - Friends

This spell assaults and twists creatures' minds, spawning delusions and provoking uncontrolled actions. Each creature within 3 paces that can hear you must save vs. Trick or be confused. Each creature confused by this spell rolls a d6 at the start of each round of combat to determine its behavior:

1 - The creature uses its action to make a melee attack against a randomly determined creature within its reach, then becomes stunned. If there is no creature within its reach, the creature does nothing this round.

2, 3 - The creature uses all its movement to move in a random direction. It then becomes stunned.

4, 5 - The creature is for stunned this round.

6 - The creature can act and move normally this round. At the end of the round, it can save vs. Trick to attempt to snap out of it; if it succeeds, the effect ends for this creature.

Dimension Door

Aetheric Conjunction

Cantrip - Mage Hand

You teleport it and all its carried equipment from its current location to any other spot that you can see within 100 paces. You can teleport yourself along with it, if desired.

If a creature would arrive in a location already occupied by an object or a creature, it takes 3d6 aetheric damage, and the spell fails to teleport it. If any damage dice rolled a '6', that creature suffers a critical hit.

Dominate

Psychic Transmutation

Cantrip - Friends

You attempt to beguile a creature within 5 paces. If it fails its save vs. Trick, the target is beguiled for the duration. If the target is hostile to you, its saving throw is easier. Each time the target takes damage, it makes a new saving throw to end the spell.

While the target is beguiled, you have a telepathic link with it as long as the two of you are on the same plane of existence. You can use this telepathic link to issue commands to the creature while you are conscious (no action required), which it does its best to obey. You can specify a simple and general course of action, such as "attack that creature", "run over there", or "fetch that object". If the creature completes the order and doesn't receive further direction from you, it defends and preserves itself to the best of its ability.

You can take total and precise control of the target. Until the end of your next turn, the creature takes only the actions you choose, and doesn't do anything that you don't allow it to do.

Elemental Wall

Elemental Conjunction

Cantrip - Elemental Grasp

Each of these four spells conjures a wall of elemental energy: stone, ice, poisonous vapor, or flame. The wall is up to 10 feet high, and takes up a total of 50 contiguous squares that are each one pace by one pace wide; each space must be within 20 paces of you. Any creature caught within the wall's area must save vs. Blast to avoid its initial effects.

While you maintain focus, the wall's elemental effects fill the chosen space:

Wall of Stone - a wall of stone blocks passage, and inflicts 4d6 blunt damage as it erects to each creature caught within any of its spaces. Those creatures are then forcibly ejected to the nearest non-wall space. Each space has 5 structure if attacked.

Wall of Ice - a wall of ice blocks passage. Any creature caught within it as it erects suffers 4d6 cold damage, and is immobilized and trapped within the ice if any damage die rolls a '6'; otherwise, that creature is forcibly ejected. Each space has 2 structure if attacked.

Wall of Miasma - a wall of vapour obscures vision; each creature within or adjacent to the wall or passing through it becomes hobbled for one round, and must save vs. Doom or be stunned as they retch and gag from the fumes.

Wall of Flame - a wall of flame inflicts 2d6 damage to any creature that passes through it, or 4d6 damage to any creature that starts its turn within it. If any damage dice roll a '6', that creature is lit on fire.

Weave Element

Elemental Abjuration

Cantrip - Resistance (elemental)

Fast - You can cast this spell when you would be damaged by an elemental effect or attack that matches the prepared element or its opposite (*air opposes earth, water opposes fire*).

If cast against an opposing element, ignore all damage from that element that you would receive from this effect or attack, and this spell immediately ends.

If cast against the same element, you halve all damage from that element immediately and for as long as you focus, and you also ignore one die of elemental damage from each attack or damage source that affects you.

For each die of elemental damage negated by this spell from any one source, you gain one die of elemental energy. If at any point you have more elemental energy dice than your level, or if you lose focus, this spell immediately ends and all remaining elemental energy dice are rolled as damage in a 5 pace wide blast centered on you. Creatures other than you can attempt to save for half damage.

While you have one or more elemental energy dice, if you would receive any damage from the opposing element, each elemental energy die cancels out one die of damage from that element. If this reduces your elemental energy dice to zero, this spell ends.

Finally, the next time you make a weapon attack or cast a damaging elemental spell of this spell's element while you have one or more elemental energy dice, you add all those elemental energy dice to that spell or attack's damage roll and then end this spell. You also end this spell whenever an adjacent creature hits you with a melee attack, to automatically inflict those dice as damage to the attacker.

Fifth-Circle Arcane Spells

Disintegrate

Aetheric Transmutation

Cantrip - Magic Missile (Aetheric)

You direct an impossibly thin, vividly purplish-white beam of energy at a target within 25 paces as a ranged attack throw that inflicts 3D6 aetheric structure damage; if any damage dice roll a '6', the attack is a critical hit. If reduced to 0 hp, the target is reduced to a fine grey powder.

If an object less than 5' on a side is destroyed by this spell, it is also reduced to a fine grey powder. An object larger than a 5' cube instead has a 5' spherical hole vaporized into it at the point of impact.

Flesh to Stone

Earth Transmutation

Cantrip - Elemental Grasp

Make eye contact with a creature within 10 paces that can see you. If it saves vs. Hold, the spell ends and has no effect; otherwise, it is immobilized and suffers 3d6 petrification damage. While you maintain focus, it suffers this damage again at the end of each round. The target can use its action to attempt to break free of the spell, ending the effect on a successful save vs. Hold.

A creature reduced to 0 hit points by the spell becomes fully petrified. Only a restoration miracle or dispel magic spell can undo the effect, returning them to life at zero hit points, in exactly the condition they were in when petrified.

Giant Fist

Aetheric Conjunction

Cantrip - Mage Hand

You conjure a Large construct of a giant floating hand that mirrors the motions of your own hand for as long as you maintain focus. The hand has a Strength and Constitution of +5, and a Dexterity equal to your Intelligence. Melee attacks with the hand are easy. It has 2D6 structure points, and all non-aetheric damage dealt to it from any source is halved.

You may use the hand as your action to attack, push, grasp, or block, moving it up to 5 paces in any direction as you do so. If you perform any other action, the hand moves alongside you as you move.

Attack - You direct the hand to make a melee attack. If you hit, the hand inflicts 5d6 aetheric damage, or 1D6 structural aetheric damage.

Push - You direct the hand to push a target up to 2d6 paces in a direction that you choose, unless it saves vs. knockdown. The target's saving throw is hard if it is medium-sized or smaller, and easy if it is a huge creature.

Grasp - You direct the hand to make a melee attack, which is easy if the target is Medium or smaller. On a success, the target is grappled, but can attempt to break free as its action with a save vs. knockdown — this saving throw is hard for medium or smaller creatures, and easy for huge creatures. While you have a target grappled, you may use your action each round to crush it, inflicting 5d6 blunt damage or 1D6 structural blunt damage.

Block - The hand automatically moves itself between you and a creature of your choice, and will continue to do so as a free action until you give it a different command. You gain half cover, and the target must save vs. knockdown to attempt to move through its space. If it succeeds, the space is still considered difficult terrain. Any ranged attack that passes through the hand's space is harder to hit, and any blast, cone, or ray that the hand shelters a creature from is easier for that creature to avoid.

Resilient Sphere

Aetheric Abjuration

Cantrip - Resistance (all damage)

A sphere of shimmering force encloses a creature or object of Large size or smaller within 10 paces. If any unwilling creature is within the area, each such creature must successfully save vs. Blast and dodge, or be enclosed until the sphere is destroyed.

While you maintain focus, the sphere has 3d6 structure points, is resistant to all non-aetheric damage, and immune to all non-structure damage. Nothing – not physical objects, energy, or other spell effects – can pass through the barrier, in or out. While the sphere remains, a creature or object inside can't be damaged by attacks or effects originating from outside, nor can a creature inside the sphere damage anything outside it. Any attempt to fire in or out automatically deals its damage to the sphere itself, rather than passing through.

The sphere is weightless and just large enough to contain the creature or object inside. An enclosed creature can use its action to push against the sphere's walls and thus roll the sphere at up to half the creature's speed. Similarly, the globe can be picked up and moved by other creatures.

Any damaging spell targeting the globe that destroys it does not harm anything inside it; the globe perfectly absorbs and dissipates all remaining energy as it shatters.

Summon Elemental

Elemental Conjunction

Cantrip - Magic Missile (elemental)

You summon an Elemental spirit to cross the veil into the Material and aid you and your allies in battle. The Elemental is a 5hd creature with +0 in all abilities; it automatically returns to the Elemental Chaos once either its hit points are depleted, or when the duration of its summoning ends.

Upon summoning, the elemental makes a saving throw; if the Elemental successfully saves, it immediately goes free and is likely to be hostile to the summoner. Otherwise, the Elemental is bound to do the Wizard's bidding until the next sunrise or sunset, after which it is automatically banished back to its home on the Elemental Chaos.

The Elemental is controlled by the referee; it may cast any elemental spell or glamour that matches its element by spending 1d6 of its hit points per circle.

Telepathic Bond

Psychic Divination

Cantrip - Uncanny Insight

With an action, you can link the minds of a number of different adjacent willing creatures up to 1d6 + your Intelligence. While you maintain focus, each creature in the link can sense the emotions of each other creature, and can communicate telepathically whether or not they share a common language, regardless of distance.

If performed as a ritual, this spell links the minds of all participants until the next sunrise or sunset.

Divine Miracles

Each priest has a domain of faith, which is a particular aspect of the divine that they dedicate themselves to. A priest can perform divine miracles from that domain simply by channeling that innate faith, while other miracles must be prepared. Preparing a divine miracle requires time spent in deep prayer and meditation while writing the request for that miracle out on a prayer strip, which will retain potency until the next sunrise or sunset.

Prayer Strips

A prayer strip is a small piece of pure white paper or parchment, approximately the size of an open palm, upon which a short prayer has been written in expensive ink with fine calligraphy. This prayer strip is the physical token used to perform a prepared miracle, and must be kept clean and unspoiled in order to be used for divine purposes.

If something causes you to lose a charged prayer strip before you can use it, you don't necessarily lose the magic that you invested - the Saints are not quite so fickle. As an exploration action after losing your prayer strips, you can use any available paper and writing utensils to attempt to recreate suitable tokens. So long as you show proper reverence, the original prayer strips will be consumed - wherever they are - and whatever makeshift scraps you have produced will magically transform into exact copies of the originals.

Once you have prepared a miracle into a prayer strip, you must use the strip as you perform the miracle; the sacrifices performed when you prepared it fuel the miracle. If a prayer strip miracle has a range of touch or melee, you must physically touch the prayer strip to the target, at which point it magically adheres and begins to burn away in a nimbus of holy light. If the miracle is ranged, you hold the strip up towards the target, say the first verse of the prayer aloud, and fling it at the target, at which point it magically flies from your hand to attach to the target, and then begins to glow brightly and burn away as it activates.

Prayer Scrolls

A prayer strip lasts until the next sunrise or sunset, after which it loses its divine power and must be discarded or recharged with additional prayer and sacrifice. You may choose to make sacrifices and burnt offerings worth at least 100 gp per circle while preparing a prayer strip; if you do, that prayer strip becomes supernaturally resilient, and will retain its potency indefinitely until used. Such a prayer strip can be used by any priest to perform the prepared miracle.

A non-priest may attempt to perform a miracle from a prayer scroll, but doing so takes additional time and effort. First, the non-priest must save vs. Curse, which is easy for a first-circle prayer and hard for a third-circle prayer. If they succeed, they perform the prayer properly and the miracle occurs; if they fail, the prayer scroll is consumed but a divine mishap occurs - possibly targeting the prayer at random, reversing the effect of the miracle, or some other effect chosen by the referee.

Divine Rituals

A priest's miraculous power is significantly enhanced by proper adherence to ritual. Divine rituals led by a priest of the appropriate domain allow multiple priests working in tandem, or even sufficiently devout non-priests, to each contribute to the ritual's success.

Each earnest participant in a divine ritual saves vs. Curse, even if they are not a priest. Each participant that succeeds contributes to the ritual's intended effect.

A divine ritual lasts for as long as all of its contributing participants continue to maintain focus on it. If any participant who positively contributed to the ritual breaks focus, the ritual and its associated miraculous effect immediately ends.

Any priest may perform a ritual blessing or curse from their faith's domain during the hour before dawn or sunset to cause that ritual's effects to last until the next sunrise or sunset, without anyone needing to maintain focus on it. Others may participate in the ritual as well, increasing its power and hardening it against counter-magics.

Sanctified Oaths

Many divine blessings have multiple different ritual forms, adjusting the nature of the blessing to match a special occasion. For example, various wedding ceremonies weave a Bless or Sanctuary effect into the officiating priest's sanctification of the couple's vows. Any such blessing is known as a sanctified oath.

All recipients of a sanctified oath must directly participate in the ritual sanctifying their oath, and must succeed in their save vs. Curse to contribute to the ritual. An oath must be sworn in earnest by all participants, for the oath's own sake, or it will not be sanctified by the Divine.

A properly sanctified blessing sustains itself indefinitely without focus so long as all ritual participants continue to uphold their end of their sworn oaths. If any member breaks their oath, however, all members who participated in the ritual lose their blessing, and the participant who directly violated their oath suffers a curse proportional in strength to their original blessing. The details of this curse vary from oathbreaker to oathbreaker, but will always be ironically appropriate to the nature of their vow and violation.

Sanctified oaths are visible via identify magic and similar effects. An oath blessing appears as strands of light woven into the oathkeeper's aura, while an oathbreaker's curse appears as dark chains binding them and cutting painfully into their aura.

A priest can release another creature from a sanctified vow through a ritual of atonement, which must be performed at the same circle as the ritual that originally sanctified the vow. The creature being released must participate successfully in the ritual to be released from their vow, and must make appropriate sacrifices to demonstrate their sincerity. If successful, the oath (and its attendant blessing or curse) are nullified.

A creature may not be bound by more circles worth of sanctified oaths than their level or hit dice. If they attempt to swear an oath beyond this limit, they simply fail until they can be released from one of their previous oaths.

Domains of Faith

A priest can call on their inner faith to perform miracles aligned with a specific aspect of the Divine through any prayer strip. Certain miracles can also be performed via faith regardless of the priest's chosen domain.

Common Miracles

Can be performed with faith by Priests of any domain

- ① Sense the Divine
- ② Bless
- ③ Divine Guidance
- ④ Sustenance
- ⑤ Divine Intervention

Death

- ① Cause Fear
- ② Speak With Dead
- ③ Curse Ability
- ④ Lay to Rest
- ⑤ Revive

Life

- ① Heal Minor Wounds
- ② Cure Poison or Disease
- ③ Enhance Constitution
- ④ Heal Serious Wounds
- ⑤ Heal Critical Wounds

Fate

- ① Command
- ② True Strike
- ③ Divine Censure
- ④ Banish the Unnatural
- ⑤ Divine Geas

Freedom

- ① Calm Emotions
- ② Divine Rebuke
- ③ Enhance Dexterity
- ④ Remove Curse
- ⑤ Restoration

War

- ① Heroism
- ② Smite
- ③ Enhance Strength
- ④ Shield of Faith
- ⑤ Divine Champion

Peace

- ① Sanctuary
- ② Tongues
- ③ Enhance Wisdom
- ④ Beacon of Hope
- ⑤ Hallow

Truth

- ① Holy Light
- ② Reveal the Unnatural
- ③ Enhance Intelligence
- ④ Zone of Truth
- ⑤ Commune

Beauty

- ① Inspire
- ② Beguile
- ③ Enhance Charisma
- ④ Fantasy
- ⑤ Irresistible Dance

Nature

- ① Protect from Elements
- ② Speak with Animals
- ③ Bountiful Harvest
- ④ Create Water
- ⑤ Call Storm

Artifice

- ① Mend
- ② Recharge Magic Item
- ③ Common Dweomer
- ④ Uncommon Dweomer
- ⑤ Rare Dweomer

Good and Evil, Right and Wrong

The chief duty of a priest is offering moral guidance to others. As such, a priest must be an exemplar of the four cardinal virtues of justice, mercy, honor, and prudence.

Justice

A priest should encourage their companions to be honest and forthright with all their dealings, not to cheat or steal, and to obey the local authorities insofar as those authorities are themselves known to be virtuous. Conflicts between different authorities should be handled through the proper authorities whenever possible, unless doing so would create a larger miscarriage of justice.

Mercy

The Prophet was sent into the world to redeem it, and turn all minds to obedience to the Divine Principle. This offer of redemption is the most sacred tenet of the Faith, and inflicting cruelty in the name of "justice" is one of its gravest sins. Inasmuch as surrender and redemption can be offered to one's enemies, the priest and their allies must seek to do so.

Honor

A priest and their companions should face danger with courage, and should never place another mortal at risk when they could reasonably take that risk on themselves. Above all, a priest and their companions should never abuse their power and authority to gain unfair advantage over others, or use trickery and guile when a fair fight is possible.

Prudence

While justice, mercy, and honor are all important, prudence is the virtue that tempers them and seeks balance between them.

Justice that turns to cruelty or madness is no justice at all, and the genuine needs of the people and the realm must temper the principles that uphold them.

Creatures that betray a good faith offers of surrender and redemption might forfeit their right to mercy, if the benefit of the doubt would reasonably place innocents at risk.

Those that show themselves without honor similarly forfeit their right to be fought with honor, and may be dispatched expediently.

Church Dogma

Church dogma holds that the Divine Principle lays out an ideal course for man to follow, but that greed and vengeance and fear tempt men to disobey; that the Prophet, by fully accepting their role as the Lamb of Sacrifice, was made one with the Will of the Divine, thus planting the seed for the Kingdom of Heaven which cleanses the sins of the world, and that obedience to the Divine Principle, as demonstrated by the Lamb of Sacrifice, allows men to participate in the communion of the Divine Spirit, by which the Kingdom of Heaven is built and eternally improved.

Sects and Heresies

Various groups show themselves perfectly capable of channeling Divine magic, whether or not they agree with the Church's dogma. Some of these sects are considered to be in faithful communion with the Church, while others are considered heretical. Nevertheless, a priests of the Divine must never sanction the following acts:

- Blood sacrifice of an intelligent mortal
- Cruelty or torture towards any being capable of feeling
- Slavery or imprisonment lasting more than 7 years, including maintaining willing servitude under false pretenses
- Murder, including deliberately depriving a mortal of their necessities
- Gross and deliberate injustice wrought for personal gain

Sins and Atonement

A priest that fails to live up to the ideals of the four cardinal virtues, or who commits even graver sins against the Divine Principle, may find themselves unable to perform miracles until they atone for their sins. The process of atonement depends upon the sins committed, but invariably involves confessing those sins to a higher-ranking priest, then making an honest effort to right whatever wrongs can be undone, and finally a heartfelt commitment to avoid similar transgressions in the future. A priest who attempts to atone under false premises will find themselves completely cut off from their granted powers until they align their beliefs and behavior with the Divine.

Ghosts and The Underworld

Another duty of a priest is maintaining the boundary between the living material world and the underworld of the dead. Angry ghosts require appeasement and guidance to give up their mortal passions and move on to the afterlife; convincing them to do so falls upon the clergy. Failure to fulfill that duty in a timely fashion can lead to an unappeased ghost becoming one of the undead; over an extended time, accumulations of necromantic energy can even lead to the Shadow of the underworld bleeding over into the material.

Like Faerie, the Shadow is a liminal realm between the Underworld proper and the Material Plane, whose distance waxes and wanes with the phases of the moon. During the three days around the full moon, travel into and out of the Shadow is harder, while during the three days around the new moon, travel between Shadow and the Material is easier. Both of these times create a lot of work for priests, as the new moon permits ghosts and the undead to manifest, while the full moon tends to trap them on whichever side of the veil they find themselves on.

Whenever a living being dies, its death will emit a burst of Aetheric energy which 'imprints' upon the Shadow, creating a pale copy of its consciousness called a 'ghost'. This imprint might be anything from a vague impression of the being it once was, to a fully formed visage and personality, capable of carrying out the wishes of the living being it was copied from. Stronger ghosts contain most of the memories and personalities of the creature that they echo; intelligent beings, such as sapient mortals, produce a ghost that is nearly identical to its mortal form. Even so, most ghosts arrive in the Shadow disoriented and confused. If the body that spawned a ghost is restored to life, that ghost will be pulled irresistibly to it, restoring its mind and memories and adding the ghost's memories to its own.

Most ghosts immediately leave the Shadow realm for the Everafter, the collection of afterlives that serve as the "eternal reward" for the once-living. The church maintains that those in faithful communion will reach heaven, an Everafter where they are united with the Divine Principle and become saints.

Saints

Ghosts that have been properly appeased and sanctified move onto the afterlife, where they are judged for their deeds in life and united with the divine. Most religion in the world treats sacred ancestors, called saints, as intermediaries between the Divine and living mortals. It is part of a priest's duties to serve as an ambassador and messenger between the saints and the living, reminding both of their duties to the other.

Other Saints, called Numina, were never living mortals at all; these Saints are Fair Folk or even Baalim that were offered redemption and communion into the Faith, and accepted. These beings are considered just as saintly as the martyred dead; most such Saints concern themselves with the protection of a particular area within the Material world, and its corresponding echoes within Faerie.

One of the more common responses to a priest's prayers for divine intervention is the manifestation of a Saint. A summoned saint will manifest adjacent to the priest as they pray, and will act to aid them directly, with the referee controlling the saint's actions. A Saint manifests as a 5 hd medium creature with 5 faith; it returns to the Everafter once either its hit points or its faith are depleted, or at the next sunrise or sunset.

The Unholy

Undead and infernal creatures together make up the unholy - creatures so inimical to the divine order that they must be defied and destroyed on sight. Particularly savage fair folk might also qualify as unholy, depending on their natures.

Mortal beings are never unholy, unless they are currently being possessed or directly controlled by an unholy supernatural being. Unholiness is not mere wickedness, but is an intrinsic nature that is deeply inimical to both the divine and primal orders. Countering the efforts of the unholy is the primary reason that the Divine imbues priests and sends them forth into the world.

Common Miracles

Sense the Divine

First Circle Divination

You close your eyes and tune into your inner senses. While you maintain focus, you can sense any objects and beings within 5 paces of you that are affected by holy or unholy forces.

Bless

Second Circle Blessing

You touch an adjacent creature, blessing it. While you maintain focus, each of that creature's saving throws is easier.

This miracle can also be used to create a blessed token from a piece of elemental materia - a holy symbol, holy water, blessed incense, sacramental bread, or sacred flame. Blessed tokens can be used to make a saving throws easier; incense and flame may also create a 5-pace zone of protection where undead and infernal actions are harder. Holy water and sacred flame may also be used to inflict two dice of radiant damage if thrown onto an unholy creature.

Enhance (Ability)

Third Circle Blessing

You touch an adjacent creature as you recite a brief prayer. While you maintain focus, you grant that creature a +1 bonus to the chosen ability, which immediately adjusts each of its attack and saving throws. If any other effect would grant that creature a bonus to the same ability, only the higher bonus applies. If the chosen ability has linked talents, choose one of them as you cast this spell; the bonus granted by this miracle is also applied to any task checks made with that talent. Bonuses that would reduce a talent's threshold below 2+ will instead make task checks at 2+ easier.

There are six different enhance (ability) miracles, each of which is under a different Domain of Faith. Each may also be performed as a third-circle or fourth-circle miracle, which grant a +2 or +3 bonus instead.

Divine Guidance

Third Circle Divination

After closing your eyes and reciting a brief prayer, you receive a divine omen about the likely results of a specific course of action that you plan to take within the next 30 minutes. The answer doesn't take into account any possible supernatural circumstances that might change the outcome. The referee chooses from the following possible omens:

- Weal, for good results
- Woe, for bad results
- Weal and woe, for both good and bad
- Nothing, if results aren't good or bad

You may also use this as an extremely versatile divination ritual, which can also be used in one of two additional ways:

Find Traps - You sense the presence of any trap within 20 paces that is within line of sight. A trap, for the purpose of this miracle, includes anything that would inflict a sudden or unexpected effect you consider harmful or undesirable, which was specifically intended as such by its creator. Thus, the miracle would sense an area affected by the alarm spell, a glyph of warding, or a mechanical pit trap, but wouldn't reveal a natural weakness in the floor, unstable ceiling, or hidden sinkhole.

Dowse - You may use this ritual to find the direction of a particular object or creature. During the ritual, your divining tool becomes a compass that points in the direction of the target while you maintain focus. You must know the target to perform this miracle, or sacrifice a physical object with symbolic significance to the target and make a Lore test with a difficulty based on the relationship.

Sustenance

Fourth Circle Miracle

You conjure 1d6+1 nourishing meals, which last until consumed or until the next sunrise or sunset, along with sufficient potable water.

Divine Intervention

Fifth Circle Miracle

You contact a Celestial servant of the Divine and beg for aid, then make a hard save vs. Fear. If you succeed, and the situation is judged sufficiently dire, a powerful and unique miraculous effect manifests, with details determined by the referee.

Beauty Domain Miracles

Inspire

First Circle Blessing

Fast - you grant another creature within 5 paces a reroll on one attack throw, saving throw, or task check; the new roll is easier.

Beguile

Second Circle Curse

You attempt to beguile an intelligent mortal creature within 5 paces that makes eye contact with you or can hear your voice. If it saves vs. Trick, it knows that you attempted to manipulate its mind, and its attitude likely degrades by one step.

On a success, roll 1d6 + your Charisma and divide by 2; the target's attitude towards you improves by that many steps for as long as you focus. The effect immediately ends if you do anything harmful to the beguiled creature; if they suffer injury from any other source, they also immediately make a saving throw to attempt to shake it off.

Enhance Charisma

Third Circle Blessing

You touch a creature, giving it a +1 bonus to Charisma for as long as you maintain focus.

Fantasy

Fourth Circle Curse

You make eye contact with a target within 5 paces that can hear and understand you, then begin describing an illusion that you wish it to perceive. While you focus, you control the target's perceptions, choosing what it can see, hear, taste, smell, and so on. Each time the target perceives or interacts with an illusory sensation that it finds in any way unpleasant or unbelievable, it may save vs. Trick to attempt to break free of the illusion. More subtle illusions are harder to break free from, while illusions that are wildly different than what the creature would otherwise be experiencing are easier.

Irresistible Dance

Fifth Circle Curse

You begin singing a song or chanting, calling those around you to join you in compelled celebration. While you focus, each creature within 5 paces that can hear you must save vs. Curse at the end of each round to break free of the effect, or it is helpless and forced to perform a comic dance as its action, while moving in whichever direction you choose.

Truth Domain Miracles

Holy Light

First Circle Blessing

You cause your holy symbol or the prepared prayer strip in your hand to grow with bright light out to 5 paces, and dim light out to 10 paces, for as long as you maintain focus. Undead or infernal beings caught in the bright light find that their attacks and saving throws are harder.

Reveal the Unnatural

Second Circle Divination

You touch an adjacent creature or object as you recite a brief prayer. You immediately know whether any supernatural influence is on that creature or object. If the influence is from an undead or infernal source, you know which type, as well as its approximate power level.

You may also perform this miracle in a 3-space cone in front of yourself, briefly revealing any supernaturally hidden creature or object, but doing so will only show indistinct outlines.

Enhance Intelligence

Third Circle Blessing

You touch a creature, giving it a +1 bonus to Intelligence for as long as you maintain focus.

Zone of Truth

Fourth Circle Divination

You create a magical zone that guards against deception within 5 paces of you. While you maintain focus, any creature that enters the effect's area or starts its turn there must make a hard Charisma saving throw, or it can't speak a deliberate lie while within the radius, and any illusions on it are dispelled. You know whether each creature succeeds or fails on its saving throw, and each affected creature is aware of the effect and can avoid answering a question, or answer evasively, if it would normally respond with a lie.

Commune

Fifth Circle Divination

You contact a servant of the Divine and ask it a single simple yes-or-no question concerning a specific goal, event, or activity to occur within the next 7 days. You receive a correct answer if it can be made known to you. Saints aren't necessarily omniscient, so you might receive "maybe" as an answer if the question depends on as-yet unmade decisions.

Fate Domain Miracles

Command

First Circle Curse

You make eye contact with a target within 5 paces that can both hear and understand you, then say a single imperative word such as "jump" or "quiet". It must save vs. Trick or follow the command on its next action. Its saving throw is easy if the command is obviously harmful.

True Strike

Second Circle Divination

Fast - You touch a weapon and utter a brief prayer. The next attack throw made with that weapon before the end of the next combat round replaces its d20 with a '20'.

Divine Censure

Third Circle Curse

You choose a creature that you can see within 25 paces. While you maintain focus, this curse interferes with the target's connection with aetheric energies; while censured, a creature may not cast spells, perform miracles, or generate other magical effects of any kind. A target with more hit dice than your own may save vs. Curse to attempt magic.

Banish the Unnatural

Fourth Circle Curse

You force a being within 5 paces that is not native to the Material Plane to make a save vs. Fear. If it fails, that being is banished to its native plane, and cannot return to the Material for one lunar month. If it succeeds, you cannot attempt this miracle against it again for one month.

Divine Geas

Fifth Circle Curse

You force a creature that can see and hear you within 20 paces to save vs. Curse. If they fail, you place a powerful curse on them, forcing them to carry out some service or refrain from some action or course of activity while you maintain focus. You may use this glamour to sanctify an oath or boast made in your presence, binding the oath-swearer to their word. If you do, their save becomes harder.

If cast as a ritual, your curse may be worded so that only a certain action or circumstance may break it. If the target fails to save, and the referee determines that the conditions are possible to fulfill, the curse becomes utterly permanent until those conditions are met - not even a remove curse miracle can break it. You cannot undo such a curse once it is done.

Freedom Domain Miracles

Calm Emotions

First Circle Blessing

You attempt to suppress strong emotions in all mortals within 5 paces of you. You can suppress any effect causing them to be beguiled, hostile, or panicked for as long as you maintain focus, and all their saving throws vs. Fear become easier.

Divine Rebuke

Second Circle Curse

Fast - You react to another creature within 20 paces that you can see casting a spell, miracle, glamour, or other supernatural effect to save vs. Curse at a difficulty equal to the effect's circle; if you succeed, you negate that effect.

Enhance Dexterity

Third Circle Blessing

You touch a creature, giving it a +1 bonus to Dexterity for as long as you maintain focus.

Remove Curse

Fourth Circle Blessing

You touch an object or willing creature and offer a prayer of deliverance. The target may immediately make a saving throw to shrug off an ongoing effect or break a curse or other supernatural affliction affecting it. This saving throw is easy for a first-circle effect, or hard for a third-circle effect, and the target may use your save vs. Curse threshold instead of its normal saving throw threshold.

Restoration

Fifth Circle Blessing

You lay your hands on an injured, disabled, or cursed creature, praying for its afflictions to be lifted. Make a hard save vs. Curse as you pray fervently; if you perform this miracle as a ritual, you may reduce the difficulty by one step per 1,000 gp worth of sacrifices made.

On a success, you may remove one curse, disease, or poison that is affecting the creature, or heal one debilitation or maiming effect even if it is from an old injury. On a critical success, you remove one affliction, plus a number of additional afflictions equal to the number of 1,000 gp sacrifices made. If you fail, the target may not be the subject of this prayer again for one lunar month.

Life Domain Miracles

Heal Minor Wounds *First Circle Blessing*

You touch a living creature, allowing it to roll one hit die and heal that many hit points. If you perform this miracle on a creature that has lost half or more of its hit points, it instead only heals one hit point.

Cure Poison or Disease *Second Circle Blessing*

You touch a creature, instantly removing one poison or disease affecting it.

Enhance Constitution *Third Circle Blessing*

You touch a creature, giving it a +1 bonus to Constitution for as long as you maintain focus.

Heal Serious Wounds *Fourth Circle Blessing*

You touch a living creature and it rolls all of its hit dice, setting its hit points to the rolled value if that roll is higher than its current hit points, or healing one hit point if the roll isn't higher than its current hit points.

Heal Critical Wounds *Fifth Circle Blessing*

You touch a living creature to immediately heal all its hit points, then it awakens if it was unconscious due to injury.

Raising the Dead

When performed as a ritual, the Revive miracle can affect the corpse of a creature that died within the last hour, rolling a hard save vs. Curse as you try to call the creature's spirit back from the afterlife. The difficulty is reduced by one step for every 10,000 gp worth of sacrifices made. If you succeed, it heals one hit die worth of hit points and returns to life. If both d20 rolls fail, the creature's corpse reanimates as an undead monster and immediately attacks the party.

If performed as a ritual with at least 3 participants, this miracle can resurrect a corpse that has been dead for up to one lunar month. Each participant in the ritual must be someone who knew the target in life; each participant must succeed in a hard save vs. Curses; if fewer participants succeed than the number of days that the target has been dead, the corpse reanimates as an undead revenant. Each participant may reduce the difficulty of their own saving throw by one step per 10,000 gp worth of sacrifices that they personally offer.

Death Domain Miracles

Cause Fear *First Circle Curse*

You instill terror in every living creature within a 5-pace cone. Each target immediately saves vs. Fear or drops whatever it is holding and becomes panicked by you for as long as you maintain focus.

Speak With Dead *Second Circle Divination*

You must hold a portion of a corpse, or a possession that it valued in life, as you call its ghost from the Shadow across the veil, allowing it to answer a question that you pose. Its answers are usually brief, cryptic, and repetitive.

This miracle may also be used to interact with an incorporeal undead within 5 paces of you. An intelligent ghost may attempt to resist as a save vs. Trick; if it does not or cannot resist, it must answer any questions that you pose to it while you maintain focus, and may not take other actions.

Curse Ability *Third Circle Curse*

You make eye contact with a creature within 5 paces as you recite a brief prayer and choose an ability. It must save vs. curses or suffer a -2 penalty to the chosen ability while you maintain focus, and all its task checks linked to that ability are harder.

Lay to Rest *Fourth Circle Curse or Blessing*

You make a melee attack throw to touch an undead creature with fewer hit dice than your own. If you succeed, the creature must immediately save vs. curses or be destroyed. If its hit dice are fewer than half your own, its saving throw is harder, and a mindless undead is automatically destroyed regardless of hit dice.

This prayer may also be performed on a willing, dying creature as a blessing to free its soul into the Everafter, killing it immediately and preventing it from reincarnating or rising as any kind of undead.

Revive *Fifth Circle Blessing*

You touch a creature that has died within the last 10 minutes. It is immediately restored to life at 1 hp. Any diseases that are affecting it are also cured.

War Domain Miracles

Heroism

First Circle Blessing

You may touch a willing creature and imbue them with bravery. While you maintain focus, that creature is immune to being panicked, and each of its attack throws is easier.

Smite

Second Circle Curse

You may perform this miracle as you or an adjacent ally hits with a melee weapon attack. Your weapon flares with white-hot intensity, and the attack deals +2d6 radiant damage in addition to its normal weapon damage. An undead or infernal creature suffers a critical hit if either of these damage dice roll a '6'.

If performed as a ritual, you specify a single distinguishable creature by name while blessing a melee weapon. The first time the weapon hits that creature, its damage is augmented as above.

Enhance Strength

Third Circle Blessing

You touch a creature, giving it a +1 bonus to Strength for as long as you maintain focus.

Shield of Faith

Fourth Circle Blessing

Fast - You may react with this miracle when a creature within 10 paces would suffer hit point damage. A radiant aura of divine energy forms around the target, granting the target 4d6 + your level bonus hit points before damage is applied. Any leftover hit points are sustained if you maintain focus.

Divine Champion

Fifth Circle Blessing

You raise your weapon high above your head and call upon the favor of the Divine to prevail against evil. While you focus, you emit bright light out to 5 paces and dim light out to 10 paces. You and all allies within 5 paces of you are immune to being panicked, all attack throws and saving throws made by those creatures are easier, and all attack throws and saving throws made by unholy beings within 10 paces of you are harder. While you are focusing on this effect, you may choose for any attack made by you or within 5 paces of you to gain all of the effects of the smite miracle.

Peace Domain Miracles

Sanctuary

First Circle Blessing

You touch a creature, warding it against attack. While you maintain focus, any creature who targets the warded creature with an attack or a harmful magic must first save vs. Fear. On a failed save, the creature loses their action. If the warded creature makes an attack, casts magic that affects an enemy, or intentionally damages a creature, the blessing ends.

Tongues

Second Circle Divination

You touch a creature, granting it the ability to understand any spoken language it hears while you maintain focus. Moreover, when the target speaks, any creature that knows at least one language and can hear the target understands what it says.

Enhance Wisdom

Third Circle Blessing

You touch a creature, giving it a +1 bonus to Wisdom for as long as you maintain focus.

Beacon of Hope

Fourth Circle Blessing

You inspire hope in all nearby allies. While you maintain focus, all saving throws and hit die rolls of each ally within 5 paces are easier, and all allied creatures within that radius automatically succeed at any save vs. Fear.

Hallow

Fifth Circle Blessing

You touch the ground with your bare hands or feet and infuse an area up to 5 paces around it with holy power. While you maintain focus, unholy creatures can't enter the area, nor can such creatures beguile, panic, or possess creatures within it. Any creature so affected by an undead or infernal creature is no longer affected upon entering the area.

Consecrating Hallowed Ground

If cast as a ritual, the effects of the Hallow miracle do not require focus to maintain, but remain until the next sunrise or sundown. You may designate a larger space by marking the boundary with holy water, incense, or other blessed tokens, using one such token for every pace of the space's boundary. If this ritual is cast in the same place at each sunrise and sunset for a lunar month, the effects become permanent until dispelled.

Nature Domain Miracles

Protection from Elements *First Circle*

You may touch a creature, granting it protection from poison, disease, and temperature extremes while you maintain focus. All fire, cold, and poison damage is halved, and any environmental effects related to temperature or toxins that would make actions harder are ignored.

Speak With Animals *Second Circle*

You make eye contact with a natural animal or fey beast. You establish an empathic bond between yourself and that creature, allowing you to exchange simple concepts, emotions, and requests wordlessly for as long as you maintain focus.

Create Water *Third Circle*

You create 1d6 gallons of potable water; enough to last a single medium creature that many weeks.

Bountiful Harvest *Fourth Circle*

You touch an edible plant and channel vitality into it, causing it to cycle through its growing season over several seconds, immediately yielding a rich harvest sufficient to provide 1d6+1 nourishing meals.

When cast as a ritual, you may alternatively channel vitality within a specific area with long-term benefits. All plants in a half-mile radius centered on you become enriched for one year, doubling their harvest and making all Survival checks to cultivate the land easier.

Call Storm *Fifth Circle*

You begin this prayer as your action while outdoors in a heavy storm. For as long as you maintain focus, you may use your action each round to influence the storm for 25 paces around you. If cast as a ritual, you may conjure a storm from a clear sky over the course of an hour, rolling 2d6 to determine the number of hours that the storm will last. You may also use this ritual to calm a storm in progress, dissipating it into clear skies. Two druids performing this ritual at cross-purposes within a mile of each other each make a Survival test to determine which ritual succeeds, with no net effect happening if both succeed or both fail.

Artifice Domain Miracles

Mend *First Circle*

As an exploration action, you repair up to 2d6 breaks or tears in a single damaged non-living object, such as broken chain links, two halves of a broken key, a tear in a cloak, or a leak in a wineskin. As long as each break or tear is no larger than 1 foot in any dimension, you mend it, leaving no trace of the former damage. You may also repair all of a weapon or armor's reduction in performance from a sundering effect. This dweomer can physically repair a magic item or construct, but the blessing can't restore magic to such an object.

Recharge Magic Item *Second Circle*

You can perform this miracle while holding any arcane magic item with an expended charge, then make a Science check and a Finesse check, with a difficulty based on the item's rarity; if both rolls succeed, the item regains one charge. Each time you attempt this miracle, you use one charge of materia of an element appropriate to the magic item.

Enchant Common Dweomer *Third Circle*

You can brew common potions and prepare common dweomer enchantments. Each common dweomer takes up one third-circle prayer strip preparation.

Enchant Uncommon Dweomer *Fourth Circle*

You can brew uncommon potions and prepare uncommon dweomer enchantments. Each uncommon dweomer takes up one fourth-circle prayer strip preparation.

Enchant Rare Dweomer *Fifth Circle*

You can brew common potions and prepare common dweomer enchantments. Each rare dweomer takes up one fifth-circle prayer strip preparation.

Primal Magic

Druid glamours and talismans are much simpler than Wizard spells, and so do not require a spellbook to prepare. A druid never needs to prepare glamours; these magics are performed through raw force of will, while elemental talismans require focusing through elemental materia, somewhat like light focuses through a lens.

Druids recognize five kinds of elemental materia - Stone, Water, Wood, Air, and Flame. Psychic and aetheric materia can be used by druids to craft primal magic items, or to create non-elemental talismans.

All glamours and talismans are fey magic. As such, you cannot cast them if you are wearing iron or steel armor, wielding an iron or steel weapon or shield, or carrying any other iron or steel objects.

Primal glamour is attuned to the ebb and flow of energies within Faerie, making it easier to replenish from within faerie, and harder to replenish within the Shadow. While on the Material Plane, preparing talismans and regaining glamour on the night of the full moon is easy; recharging on the night of the new moon is hard.

Primal glamour is also dependent on the attitudes and dispositions of the local fey spirits. Each 3-mile hex will typically have its own disposition, although those near a sacred grove will likely be strongly influenced by the disposition of that grove. When entering a new area, the referee can roll a d6 - on a '1', the local fey are unfavorably disposed to the druid; on a '6', the local fey are favorably disposed. Their disposition makes preparing talismans and regaining glamour easier or harder for any druids in the party. Since the whims of the fey shift from day to day, the referee should make this roll fresh each morning and evening.

Adjusting the disposition of the local fey typically involves convoluted arguments and quests that obey the twisted logic of Faerie. A particularly important favor done for the local fey might earn their favor for up to a year and a day, but typically any favor earned will only last until the next sunrise or sunset.

Learning Glamours

Druids learn new glamours by practicing them under the tutelage of a druid, wisp, fey beast, or fair folk that knows the glamour. Each day spent attempting to learn the glamour allows the student to make an Intuition check; once they have accumulated a number of successes equal to the glamour's circle, they may add it to their list of known glamours. If a druid's total known glamours exceeds the maximum they can know at their level, they must "forget" one glamour as they learn the new one. Forgotten glamours may be re-learned at a later time.

A good teacher can make this process easier, while a bad teacher can make it harder. If the teacher expressly guides the student during their study, they also make an Intuition check; success makes the student's check easier, but failure makes the student's check harder.

Primal Talismans

Druids must shape and focus their glamours in a manner similar to (but simpler than) an arcane spell. Glamours are prepared onto small objects called talismans, which contain enough materia of the appropriate element to power the magic contained within them.

To prepare a primal talisman, a druid begins with a charge of materia or a dragon pearl, and paints or carves runes and other shapes and patterns into it. This process takes a number of Survival checks equal to its circle, with each roll taking one exploration turn.

The talisman remains prepared until the next sunrise or sunset. Once the talisman is used to cast the glamour it is consumed by faerie fire, and burns harmlessly to ash in the caster's hand. More permanent talismans can be fashioned by using a dragon pearl of the appropriate element and rarity or a willing wisp of the appropriate element, thus crafting the talisman into a proper magic item.

Druids who are not of a sufficient level to craft a talisman of a given circle may attempt to cast a glamour from such a talisman by first spending their action to save vs. curse, with a difficulty based on the talisman's circle. If they succeed, they cast the glamour as their next round's action.

Ritual Glamours

Druids can perform any primal effect as a ritual glamour with an appropriate materia charge. A druid that performs any ritual glamour requiring focus is assumed to continue focusing on it to maintain its effect; while focusing, that character cannot be on watch or perform other exploration actions.

Druids of any level can participate in any primal rituals led by a druid that knows the glamour, following all the normal rules for group rituals. This is usually used to "anchor" the effects of various rituals permanently, such as sacred grove, mirage, or geas. Making such effects permanent usually also requires the sacrifice of a dragon pearl of the appropriate elemental aspect and rarity, both to anchor the glamour into the material plane and to provide it with a steady supply of elemental energies.

Some ritual glamours can also be anchored by repeatedly performing the ritual each sunrise and sunset for a lunar month, effectively infusing the local environment with enough ambient elemental energies to act as a sort of diffused dragon pearl. Continuing to perform a ritual after it has been permanently woven into the material plane provides a kind of "aetheric armor" which makes dispelling the magic harder; certain sacred groves, which have been in constant use for thousands of years, cannot be dispelled short of direct divine intervention.

In civilization, primal magic is often used by druids and priests of the nature domain to weave the effects of the bountiful harvest glamour into local farmland, dramatically increasing crop yields. This requires a side-by-side application of magic and scientific knowledge, to prevent the overabundance from permanently depleting the soil fertility.

Wild Magic

In a pinch, a druid can shatter a talisman to release the energy within as a wild elemental attack, either as a ranged attack with a range of five paces or a three pace long cone of energy. The attack or blast inflicts one die of elemental damage per circle of the glamour enchanted into the talisman.

Stone manifests shards of flint or obsidian that deal piercing, blunt, or sundering damage as if from a weapon. Fourth-circle stone talisma may instead deal petrification damage by transforming flesh and wood into sandstone, metal into rust, and liquids into mud.

Water deals cold damage, encasing the target in ice and slowing their movement, or acid damage, slowly dissolving the target. A druid may also choose to cast any water elemental glamour non-lethally by spraying the target with seawater rather than acid, dealing blunt damage instead.

Air deals lightning damage, stunning and cooking creatures from within. Any saves vs. blast against a lightning strike are harder for a creature wearing metal armor or wielding a medium or heavy metal weapon. Air can also inflict thunder damage, blasting the target with hurricane winds that might deafen them, push them back or knock them prone.

Flame deals fire damage, roasting the target with intense heat that might even set them alight. It can also deal radiant damage, flash-burning the target with intense light that might also blind or stun.

Wood deals poison damage to living creatures, exposing them to deadly toxins that continue to work their way through their bloodstreams, or deal necrotic damage to them by invigorating all the tiny microbes and parasites within a creature to begin rotting them from within.

Dream directly attacks the target's mind with psychic damage. Dream materia is used to prepare Dream and Song glamours.

Finally, **Aether** deals aetheric damage, channeling eldritch energies directly from Faerie into the core of the target's being. Aetheric materia is used to prepare Wyrd and Mist glamours.

Stone Glamours

Iron Ward *First Circle*

Fast - You make all attacks that target you with steel or iron weapons harder to hit you for as long as you maintain focus. If an attack is from a projectile weapon smaller than a dagger, such as a steel arrowhead or a cast iron bullet, you also halve its damage, and the projectile cannot lodge into your body or clothes.

Tremorsense *Second Circle*

You touch your ear to solid stone, then strike it with a hard object, revealing the layout of any underground area within 5 paces of yourself (including vertically).

Meld With Earth *Third Circle*

You step into a natural stone or earthen object or surface large enough to fully contain your body, melding yourself and all dedicated equipment with the earth for as long as you maintain focus. Nothing of your presence remains visible or otherwise detectable by non-magical senses. When this glamour ends, you fall prone in the closest unoccupied space.

You cannot see or move while submerged, and any Alertness tests you make to hear nearby sounds are harder. Minor physical damage to the earth doesn't harm you, but its destruction or a change in its shape or substance (to the extent that it is no longer earth or you no longer fit within it) ends the glamour and deals 2d6 blunt damage to you.

Earthquake *Fourth Circle*

You cause a short but intense earthquake in the ground in a 5-pace radius. The area becomes difficult terrain until cleared. While you maintain focus, you may use your action each round to make an area attack, forcing each creature other than you in that area to save vs. Hold or suffer 3d6 blunt damage and be knocked prone.

This spell can also be used to directly control up to a roughly 3-pace radius of earth or stone centered on yourself for as long as you maintain focus, fusing it into rock or breaking it into sand, or shaping it as you desire. Stone structures will hold their shape if sturdy enough to do so.

Water Glamours

Cleansing Waters *First Circle*

You touch one living creature, drenching it with cooling water and drawing out any negative influences. Any ongoing damage is instantly ended, and you grant the creature an immediate saving throw vs. a single effect that a save could end.

Purify Food and Drink *Second Circle*

You may flush up to 2d6 x 10 lbs of non-magical food or drink with vital energy as you touch it, cleansing it of any poisons or diseases.

When performed as a ritual, you may instead infuse a smaller amount of food or drink harvested fresh from the local environment with a lingering healing energy. Each bite of food or swallow of drink so enchanted restores 1 hp, and provides enough nourishment to sustain a medium creature for one day. This second ritual form of the glamour is often called the goodberry ritual. When you perform the goodberry ritual, you produce 2d6 portions. Each portion will last until the next sunrise or sunset before reverting to a normal bite of food or drink.

Create Water *Third Circle*

You create 1d6 gallons of potable water; enough to last a single medium creature that many weeks.

Tidal Wave *Fourth Circle*

You cast this glamour while adjacent to a large body of water to summon a vast tidal wave. The wave propagates in a 10-pace cone from you, dealing 6d6 blunt damage to each creature and knocking it prone unless it saves vs. Hold. (Creatures who successfully save only suffer half damage.)

This spell can also be used to directly control up to a roughly 5-pace radius area of water or ice centered on yourself for as long as you maintain focus, either freezing or melting it, or shaping and flowing it as you desire to cover up to nine square paces worth of ground. Ice structures will hold their shape if sturdy enough to do so.

Air Glamours

Fog Cloud

First Circle

You create a 10-pace-radius sphere of fog that billows out from a space within 5 paces, spreading around corners and obscuring everything, for 2d6 exploration turns.

Fresh Air

Second Circle

You touch one living creature. While you maintain focus, that creature can hold its breath indefinitely.

Gust of Wind

Third Circle

A blast of hurricane-force wind rushes out from you in a 5-pace cone that inflicts 2d6 thunder damage. Each creature within the area must save vs. Hold or be knocked prone and thrown backwards 1d6+1 paces, suffering another 2d6 blunt damage on landing. Unsecured objects are automatically pushed away from you, but heavier objects will only be pushed back half this distance; exceptionally dense objects will only be pushed back one pace.

Call Storm

Fourth Circle

You begin this glamour as your action while outdoors in a heavy storm. For as long as you maintain focus, you may use your action each round to influence the storm for 25 paces around you. If cast as a ritual, you may conjure a storm from a clear sky over the course of an hour, rolling 2d6 to determine the number of hours that the storm will last. You may also use this ritual to calm a storm in progress, dissipating it into clear skies. Two druids performing this ritual at cross-purposes within a mile of each other each make a Survival test to determine which ritual succeeds, with no net effect happening if both succeed or both fail.

Controlling a Storm

Winds can be used to push affected creatures; your action may be spent to target any creatures within a circle 10 paces wide or a cone 40 paces deep, knocking them prone and moving them 1d6 paces in a direction of your choice.

Lightning called from the clouds inflicts 5d6 damage in a two-pace blast; creatures in metal armor have harder saves.

Hail and sleet deal 1d6 cold damage to each creature within a 25-pace area (save vs. Hold for half damage); well-insulated waterproof clothing makes this saving throw easier.

Flame Glamours

Protection from Heat and Cold

First Circle

You may touch a creature, granting it protection from temperature extremes while you maintain focus. All fire and cold damage is halved, and any other environmental effects related to temperature that would make actions harder are ignored.

Heat Metal

Second Circle

You choose one manufactured metal object – such as a metal weapon or a suit of heavy or medium metal armor – that you can see within 10 paces, causing it to glow red-hot. Any creature in physical contact with that object immediately takes 2d6 fire damage. Any creature that takes this damage must save or drop the object if it can. If it doesn't or can't drop the object, all its rolls are harder.

While you focus, you can use your action each round to cause this damage again.

Sunlight

Third Circle

You raise your arms above your head and conjure an orb of bright, golden sunlight. While you maintain focus, it casts bright light out to 10 paces and dim light out to 20 paces. As your action on subsequent turns, you may focus it into a searing ray of light that deals 2d6 radiant damage in a line 20 paces long.

Wall of Flame

Fourth Circle

You cast this glamour while adjacent to a large bonfire (covering at least one five foot square) to rapidly control its growth and spread, blazing it into up to ten contiguous square paces each up to ten feet high. While you focus, you can reshape the wall as you see fit, so long as it fits within ten continuous paces and at least one pace is adjacent to yourself. The wall inflicts 3d6 fire damage to any creatures that are engulfed or who attempt to pass through the wall; a creature may save vs. Blast as it is engulfed.

Wood Glamours

Lifesense

First Circle

While you maintain focus, you can see all living beings in your line of sight, whether invisible, concealed, or camouflaged. This vision is unaffected by light or darkness, fog, or foliage, but cannot penetrate through solid earth, stone, or unliving wood thicker than one foot, metal thicker than one inch, or cold iron or living wood of any thickness.

If you touch an ingestible substance while focusing on this glamour, you immediately know whether it is safe to eat or drink. If you touch a living creature, you learn its species, size, sex, state of health, and what physical conditions are affecting it - including whether it suffers from any poisons or diseases, whether they are treatable, and what treatments are likely to be effective.

Protection from Poison

Second Circle

You may touch a creature, granting it protection from toxins and diseases while you maintain focus. The protected creature is immune to all poison damage or effects, and automatically succeeds any saving throw vs. any effect caused by a poison or disease.

Restore Health

Third Circle

You touch a creature, either allowing it to roll one hit die and heal its level + that many hit points, or instantly removing one poison or disease affecting it.

Wild Growth

Fourth Circle

This glamour channels vitality into plants within a specific area. Choose a point within 20 paces; all normal plants in a 10-pace radius centered on that point become thick, overgrown, and bristling with long, sharp thorns. You can exclude one or more patches of any size within the area from being affected. You can instead choose a line 2 paces wide and 25 paces long, creating a wall of brambles 5 feet high.

A creature must spend its action and save vs. Hold to attempt to move forward one pace through the area; even if they succeed, the thorns cause 1d6 piercing damage per pace moved. Creatures may instead attempt to hack it down by attacking it with suitable bladed weapons; each 5-foot patch of the area has 1D6 structural hit points, and halves all damage inflicted on it that isn't sundering or fire damage. While you focus and remain within the area, trees, roots, vines, and grasses within 5 paces of you become animated, with the following effects:

Grasses and Undergrowth - Any area of ground in the cube that is covered by grass or undergrowth is difficult terrain.

Trees - At the end of each round of combat, each of your enemies within 10 feet of any tree in the area must save vs. blast or take four dice of damage from whipping branches.

Roots and Vines - At the end of each round of combat, one creature of your choice that is in the affected area must save vs. Hold or be knocked prone and restrained until the glamour ends. A restrained creature can use its action to attempt to break free.

Nature's Bounty - You may instead touch a living edible plant and channel vitality into it, causing it to cycle through its growing season over several seconds and immediately yield a rich harvest sufficient to provide 1d6+1 nourishing meals.

When cast as a ritual, you may alternatively channel vitality within a specific area with long-term benefits. All plants in a half-mile radius centered on you become enriched for one year, doubling their harvest and making all Survival checks to cultivate the land easier.



Beast Glamours

Each of these glamours directly interact with animals or fey beasts in some way. A beast glamour is prepared as a wood talisman unless the target is a fey beast with any elemental powers, in which case it must be prepared with the appropriate element.

Call Beasts

First Circle

You send out a subtle psychic summons, intermingled with natural sounds and scents that will attract the attention of any nearby animals. Make a Survival check; if you succeed, a natural or fey beast (or possibly a herd of them) arrives within a number of exploration turns based on their distance and previous activities. You may specify a particular kind of natural animal or fey beast as you cast this glamour, or you may emit a general summons to all nearby creatures.

Speak With Animals

Second Circle

You make eye contact with a natural animal or fey beast, and establish an empathic bond between yourself and that creature. This allows the exchange of simple concepts, emotions, and requests through wordless communication for as long as you focus.

An intelligent creature can end the connection at-will, and must be bargained with to obey any requests; creatures with Intelligence of -4 or less will obey any non-harmful action that they can understand unless they succeed at a save vs. Trick.

When cast as a ritual, you may speak a short message to a tiny animal within 5 paces that you can see, while thinking of a location that you have visited and a description of a person that you expect to be in that location.

The glamour weaves its way into the animal, which remains enchanted for 2d6 days. The animal then immediately swims, scurries, or flies off at its speed towards its destination.

Upon arrival, the animal magically speaks the message you gave it to the first person it sees matching the description you gave, roughly duplicating the sound and tone of your voice. If the glamour runs out before the animal can find a suitable recipient, the message is lost, and the animal magically finds its way home as the enchantment unweaves.

Beast Bond

Third Circle

You make eye contact with a natural animal or fey beast within 5 paces. You beguile that creature until the next sunrise or sunset unless it saves vs. Trick. Its saving throw is easy if it has more hit dice than your level, or hard if your level is more than twice its hit dice. The effect ends immediately if you or your allies harm the creature in any way.

If you cast this glamour on a creature as a ritual at every sunrise and sunset for a lunar month, the creature becomes trained and loyal to you if you continue to treat it well.

Polymorph

Fourth Circle

You may use a prepared Wild Shape talisman to forcibly transform a living creature into the talisman's stored shape. This transformation does not protect the target's intelligence. The target must save vs. Curse to resist being transformed, and remains transformed until they touch the talisman that transformed them.

You may also coax one of your elemental wisp companions to use this glamour on itself, to grow in size and manifest before you in the shape of any elemental, awakened plant, fey beast, or fey or elemental monster appropriate to the wisp's elemental nature, with all of that creature's abilities and hit points. You or the chosen wisp must have interacted with a creature of the chosen species before, and the referee is the final arbiter of whether this glamour can emulate the traits of any particular creature. The creature is under the referee's control, but is loyal to you and will obey your commands. If its hit points drop to zero, it shrinks back to Tiny size and finds its way back into your pouch. Otherwise, this glamour ends at the next sunrise or sunset.

You may perform this glamour as a ritual to permanently merge a wisp of the appropriate element into a tree or a natural animal with 5 or fewer hit dice and an Intelligence of -4, granting the recipient of this ritual true intelligence. An awakened tree becomes a Treant, while an awakened animal gains an Intelligence based on the results of a d6 roll: 1-3: -3, 4-5: -2, 6: -1. It knows one language that you speak, and awakens with a friendly disposition towards you; it will continue to serve you or not depending upon how it is treated by you and your allies.

Dream Glamours

Sleep

First Circle

You make eye contact with another living creature or creatures within 5 paces of you whose total levels are less than twice your own. Each affected creature is stunned for one combat round, then must save vs Curse or fall unconscious for 1d6 exploration turns. A creature higher than your own level rolls an easy saving throw; a creature less than half your own level rolls a hard saving throw. Once asleep, an affected creature cannot wake on its own, and any attempt to rouse the creature is hard.

Phantasm

Second Circle

You create the image of an object, a creature, or some other phenomenon that is no larger than a 20-foot cube. It appears at a spot that you can see within 15 paces, and seems completely real, including any sounds, smells, or other appropriate sensations. A creature that closely examines it can save vs. Trick to notice that it is an illusion. As long as you focus, you can cause it to move to any other spot within range, while altering it so that its movements, sounds, and so on appear natural (such as making a phantasmal creature appear to walk, or even carry on a conversation).

Suggestion

Third Circle

You make eye contact with a target within 5 paces and suggest a belief or course of activity (no more than a sentence or two). Unless they save vs. Trick, they must follow or believe your suggestion for as long as you focus. Whenever they would be presented with evidence that contradicts your suggestion, they may make another saving throw to attempt to snap out of it.

This spell has no effect if the target cannot hear or understand you, and the target's saving throw is easy if your command is obviously and immediately harmful to it.

Confusion

Fourth Circle

This spell assaults and twists creatures' minds, spawning delusions and provoking uncontrolled actions. Each creature within 3 paces that can hear you must save vs. Trick or be confused. Each creature confused by this spell rolls a d6 at the start of each round of combat to determine its behavior:

- | |
|--|
| <p>1 - The creature uses its action to make a melee attack against a randomly determined creature within its reach, then becomes stunned. If there is no creature within its reach, the creature does nothing this round.</p> <p>2, 3 - The creature uses all its movement to move in a random direction. It then becomes stunned.</p> <p>4, 5 - The creature is for stunned this round.</p> <p>6 - The creature can act and move normally this round. At the end of the round, it can save vs. Trick to attempt to snap out of it; if it succeeds, the effect ends for this creature.</p> |
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Song Glamours

Fascinate

First Circle

You use your action to begin moving and speaking hypnotically. Each creature within 20 paces that can see and hear you must save vs. Trick or become oblivious to everything but you. You may weave this effect into a musical performance if you wish.

If you move at a normal pace, each enthralled creature will follow you if physically able. While you focus and continue speaking or performing, each affected creature must succeed at a hard Alertness test to notice any hazard or creature other than you.

Beguile

Second Circle

You attempt to beguile an intelligent mortal creature within 5 paces that makes eye contact with you or can hear your voice. If it saves vs. Trick, it knows that you attempted to manipulate its mind, and its attitude likely degrades by one step. If it fails, its attitude towards you becomes Friendly for as long as you focus. The effect immediately ends if you do anything harmful to the beguiled creature; if they suffer injury from any other source, they also immediately make a saving throw to attempt to snap out of it.

Inspiration

Third Circle

You begin singing a song or chant of bravery and valor. While you focus, you radiate an aura of inspiration and courage. Once per round, you may choose to allow an ally within 5 paces that can see or hear you to reroll an attack, save, or check; their new roll is easier.

Irresistible Dance

Fourth Circle

You begin singing a song or chanting, calling those around you to join you in compelled celebration. While you focus, each creature within 5 paces that can hear you must save vs. Curse at the end of each round to break free of the effect, or it is helpless and forced to perform a comic dance as its action, while moving in whichever direction you choose.

Glamours and Bardsongs

Bards can perform Dream and Song glamours as 'bardsongs', which are a unique form of magic that does not require the use of materia. A bard performing a bardsong taps into the deepest, most primordial rules of faerie, beyond even the eldest and wisest druid's understanding.

While a druid performs their glamours by directly shaping the flow of elemental energy as it weaves its way between faerie and the material world, a bard performs a bardsong through pure skill and passion, inviting the semi-sentient energies of faerie to take notice and reward the bard's performance with the effects of the glamour.

In practice, this means that a bard performing a bardsong takes longer to achieve a magical effect than a druid casting a glamour directly, and the druid's glamour is guaranteed to work (barring interference from opposing magic or cold iron), while the bardsong has only a chance of success based on the skill of the bard and the circle of the glamour attempted.

Wyrd Glamours

Fey Luck

First Circle

Fast - You force another creature within 5 paces to reroll an attack throw, saving throw, or task check at an easier or harder difficulty.

Augury

Second Circle

By casting lots using talisman-enchanted runestones, you receive an omen about the likely results of a specific course of action that you plan to take within the next 30 minutes. The answer doesn't take into account any possible supernatural circumstances that might change the outcome. The referee chooses from the following possible omens:

- Weal, for good results
- Woe, for bad results
- Weal and woe, for both good and bad
- Nothing, if results aren't good or bad

Primal Geas

Third Circle

You force a creature that can see and hear you within 20 paces to save vs. Curse. If they fail, you place a powerful curse on them, forcing them to carry out some service or refrain from some action or course of activity while you maintain focus. You may use this glamour to sanctify an oath or boast made in your presence, binding the oath-swearer to their word. If you do, their save becomes harder.

If cast as a ritual, your curse may be worded so that only a certain action or circumstance may break it. If the target fails to save, and the referee determines that the conditions are possible to fulfill, the curse becomes utterly permanent until those conditions are met - not even a remove curse miracle can break it. You cannot undo such a curse once it is done.

Reincarnate

Fourth Circle

You invoke the spirits of nature to create a new body for a fallen comrade. By interring a creature's remains in the fresh earth of a faerie grove and planting a magically-imbued seed, you consume the accumulated fey energies of the sacred grove to cause a Large flower-bud to grow out of their remains overnight.

This ritual fails if the interred creature has been dead for longer than one lunar month. Otherwise, if the interred creature's soul is able to return to the material world, the bud blooms at dawn — revealing the slumbering form of a newly created body that contains that creature's memories and personality.

The new form is crafted from the chaotic energies of Faerie, and so it will not necessarily be of the same sex or species as the creature's original body. Roll a d20 and consult the following chart to determine the creature's new species. The referee is encouraged to modify this list based on the location the ritual is performed, the phase of the moon, or any other fickle whims of Faerie.

Any curses, diseases, or lasting injuries that the creature's previous body suffered from are not transferred to the new body, but any particularly memorable scars or afflictions might manifest as a birthmark or other pattern on their new form. The reincarnated creature retains all of their original memories and personality, including talents and class levels, but re-rolls their abilities.

Their new body will be 1d6 years old when the flower opens, and will continue to grow at an accelerated rate until it reaches young physical maturity, although a particularly strong-willed creature might manage to will their body to stop aging at a younger or older point while the magic is still fresh. They will have reached a stable age by sundown, aging normally from that point forward.

D20	Reincarnated Species
1-6	Goblin
7-12	Beastfolk
13-16	Gnome
17-19	Elf
20	Intelligent Fey Beast (referee decides)

Mist Glamours

Faerie Grove

First Circle

By binding a Wood materia, a Dream materia, and an Aether materia together and burying them in the earth while whispering a softly sussurating song, you pull Faerie and the Material closer together within a circular area up to 30 paces in radius. Some kind of border marker, usually a ring of mushrooms or a wild thorny hedge, will spring out of the ground around the borders as you complete the glamour. Within the grove, all primal magics are easier and all other forms of magic are harder until the next sunrise or sunset.

If you perform this ritual in the same place each sunrise and sunset for one lunar month, and leave at least one wisp of each elemental aspect within the area to tend to the grove, all effects and defenses become permanent until dispelled. Other glamours may be woven into a permanent grove's defenses and features as well: awakened animals or treants may be bound to its protection, or elemental defenses such as mirage, nature's wrath, or call storm may be woven into the grove as rituals, to be called on by any druid that is recognized by the grove as part of its circle.

Druids who maintain a permanent Faerie Grove usually continue to perform the necessary rituals at each sunrise and sunset, weaving their magic deeper and deeper into the bones of the earth. A permanent grove that has been maintained for less than a decade is easy to dispel, while a permanent grove that has been maintained for a century or more is hard to dispel.

Misty Step

Second Circle

On your action instead of moving, you conjure a silvery mist from Faerie, which quickly dissipates as you teleport up to 5 paces away into an unoccupied space that you can see.

If cast as a ritual at sunrise or sunset within a faerie grove, you open a portal directly between Faerie and the Material, which remains open until the next sunrise or sunset.

Leyline Travel

Third Circle

As an action, you touch a surface or archway made of living plant matter - such as a tree or vine-covered wall - and open a portal through Faerie. An identical portal appears within a faerie grove that you have stepped foot in since the last sunrise or sunset. You may maintain focus to keep the portals open, allowing others to follow you.

Make a Survival test with an easy difficulty for a portal within one league, or at hard difficulty for a portal more than eight leagues away. On a failure, you step out somewhere in between, determined randomly.

Mirage

Fourth Circle

You cast this ritual to make the terrain around you look, sound, and smell like some other sort of natural terrain. The glamour's effect flows out from you in a sphere that grows one pace per round in radius to a maximum of 100 paces in every direction, transforming your surroundings as the wave of magic passes over them. Open fields can be made to resemble difficult or impassable terrain. A pond can be made to seem like a grassy meadow, a precipice like a gentle slope, or a rock-strewn gully like a wide and smooth valley. Manufactured structures, equipment, and creatures within the area aren't changed in appearance.

The tactile characteristics of the terrain are unchanged, so creatures entering the area are likely to see through the illusion. If the difference isn't obvious by touch, a creature carefully examining the illusion can attempt a save to disbelieve it.

Bestiary



Natural Mortals

The only two species of mortal known to be fully native to the Material Plane are humans and dwarves, who evolved together before the Flood.

Humans

Enhanced Abilities: None

Humans are one of the two original species of mortal on the Prime Material, seemingly unaffected by its collision with the Aether. Originating from the savannas of the Southern continent, humans spread north during the last ice age to eke out a living in every environment imaginable. If not for the coming of magic, it is likely that humans would have out-competed the dwarves and driven them to extinction.

Because they conquered the surface world while dwarves built their underground empires, humans are something like the 'default' species of the world. In some human cultures, non-human prejudice is almost nonexistent, while in others it borders on rabid xenophobia. Most civilized places, though, find the rewards of diversity too rich to pay the costs of racism.

By the time of the Old Empire, humans and dwarves had largely set aside their differences. The combination of Dwarven technological know-how and Human ambition led to a rapid expansion of the Old Empire across the known world; even today, the Successor States live fully in its historic shadow.

Humans and dwarves can interbreed, and their children will typically take after both parents - although usually with a stronger resemblance for one or the other.

Dwarves

Enhanced Abilities: Strength, Constitution

Deficient Abilities: Dexterity

Dwarves, like humans, are an original species of mortal from the Prime Material. Humans and dwarves share a distant ancestry that diverged approximately 400,000 years ago in the Southern continent, when the ancestors of the dwarves first spread north and east into the larger world. The species that became the dwarves was almost extinct when the Aether re-joined the Material 12,000 years ago, driven deep into the wilds by human competitors and the harsh climate of the last ice age.

The discovery of magic changed all that.

Dweomercraft allowed the dwarven race to survive, and thrive, in conditions where humans could not gain a foothold. Dwarves built vast empires underground, where they studied the arcane sciences and unlocked the secrets of the universe, largely sheltered from the predation of humans or the Fair Folk. When they re-emerged onto the surface world over 8,000 years ago, much had changed - both within them, and within the world that greeted them.

Dwarven medicine and technology, combined with their natural hardiness, has resulted in a species with almost twice the longevity of humans - although a dwarf subjected to the same conditions that a "civilized" human normally lives in would likely only live a few meager decades longer than their neighbors.

Dwarven temperament seems biologically predisposed to a certain kind of obsessive focus more often than in other species, giving them a distinct advantage in learning new tasks related to knowledge and attention to detail, but at the cost of some amount of warmth and connection when relating to those who do not think as they do. As a result, most social skill checks made between a dwarf and a non-dwarf are harder.

Small Size - Dwarves are smaller than most mortals; as a result, it's harder for them to wield Heavy weapons, and they must wield Medium weapons with both hands. It's easier for them to attack medium or larger creatures, and it's harder for medium or larger creatures to attack them.

Fey Mortals

There are a myriad of diverse types of fey. Each type of fey is either the product of wild fey energies interacting directly with mortal bloodlines, or the descendant of interbreeding between those original fey mutations and 'natural' humans or dwarves.

Iron Vulnerability - Each of the fey is vulnerable to cold iron - unalloyed lodestone, telluric iron, or meteoric iron that has never been heated enough to glow by mortal means. Damage to a fey creature from any cold iron weapon also stuns them, and causes all saving throws to be harder until it heals.

Expanded Fey Origins - The fey type origin roll in the Introduction handbook can be expanded to a d20 roll to include all the fey types presented here:

D20	Fey Subtype	Ability Adjustments
1-10	Elf	+Dex, +Wis, -Con
11-16	Gnome	+Dex, +Cha, -Str
17	Troll	per subtype
18	Faun	per subtype
19	Pucca	per subtype
20	Centaur	per subtype

Elves

Enhanced Abilities: Dexterity, Wisdom

Deficient Abilities: Constitution

Millennia of humans living side-by-side with the fey has resulted in a species that combines attributes of both. Elves are slender, delicate beings with large, brightly-colored eyes and large ears, often reminiscent of a deer's or a rabbit's. Elves find themselves most at home within the beauty of wild nature, although longer-established elven civilizations will likely have cultivated that nature into a vast patchwork of parks and groves which blend seamlessly into living and working spaces, merchant stalls, and military strongholds.

An elf's apparent age is almost entirely dependent on the emotional hardships they have experienced. Elves have inherited some of the magical resilience of their fey ancestors, often living for hundreds of years in bodies that appear to be in their mid to late teens before they show any signs of age at all. Once they do begin to age, they typically settle into a middle-aged appearance that lasts for several more centuries, before becoming wizened and frail for the remainder of their lives. Unlike humans, who tend to fear aging, elves see middle-age and even the frailty of the old as badges of honor, signs of a rich life filled with meaning and stories.

Many elves can tap into the primal magic of their fey ancestry if they choose, but most forgo this easy road to power in favor of exploring their other faculties. Their culture teaches elves to take pride in the breadth of their experience and expertise, and magic often provides too many 'easy outs' to truly learn how to manage one's problems the hard way. Thus, most elves avoid magic until they settle into middle age, however long that might take. An elven druid who took up training as a child is often seen as impulsive or undisciplined, although when they reach old age, their sheer depth of knowledge and power is appreciated by their community.

Elven Senses - elves can see in dim light as well as most other races can see in bright light, and they can hear and distinguish sounds more easily than other races. In general, any Alertness check related to raw sensory acuity is easier for an elf.

Gnomes

Enhanced Abilities: Dexterity, Charisma

Deficient Abilities: Strength

Gnomes, like elves, originated from unions between mortals and the fey. While elves are tall, slender, feral beings, hobs most often resemble small dwarven children, with wide eyes and a ready smile. Their small stature has led to their colloquial nickname of halfling among humans. Dwarves, on the other hand, call their halfling cousins gnomes, and rely on them for most of their above-ground dealings.

Much of gnome society is distinctly agrarian, favoring comfort and tradition over spectacle and innovation. Those gnomes that choose to adventure among the big folk are often seen by their kin as somewhat queer.

Elusive - Most gnomes retain some of their fey heritage, possessing a natural glamour that seeks to subtly camouflage them wherever they go. Their hair and skin color often shift visibly as they shift moods or enter a new environment, brightening to match their emotions or forming near-perfect camouflage patterns when they become frightened. As a result, gnomes find all Stealth checks easier while in any natural environment.

Small Size - Gnomes are smaller than most mortals; as a result, it's harder for them to wield Heavy weapons, and they must wield Medium weapons with both hands. It's easier for them to attack medium or larger creatures, and it's harder for medium or larger creatures to attack them.

Trolls

Enhanced Ability: per Elemental Affinity

Trolls are often formed through the union of a mortal and a nymph or djinn lover, although some are created through rarer natural fluctuations of primal energies. All trolls have an inborn talent for elemental magic that matches the element of their birthright.

Most trolls typically display striking colors and patterns which reveal their elemental heritage. Stone-trolls show deep browns and greys mottled with the metallic hues of precious metals and the slight glitter of gemstones, while water-trolls display deep blues, greens and purples with a slick and often translucent lustre, wood-trolls have deep browns and brilliant greens with flashes of every flower-color imaginable, air-trolls show pale blues, greys and yellows that shift and billow with their moods, and fire-trolls show dark blacks and ash-greys with flashes of brilliant red, orange and gold. An individual troll might be able to hide some of their elemental birthright with magic or makeup, but any action that taps into that birthright will put their true colors out on display.

Elemental Affinity - Each troll is aspected from birth to one of the five elements: stone, water, wood, air, or flame. They halve all damage that they receive from that element, and troll druids can perform magics that correspond to their birthright aspect without needing materia to focus the magic. Each troll has a single enhanced ability based on their subtype.

If your origin indicates a troll, roll a d20 to determine your elemental affinity:

D20	Elemental Affinity	Enhanced Ability
1-4	Stone	+Con
5-8	Water	+Str
9-12	Wood	+Cha
13-16	Air	+Wis
17-20	Flame	+Dex

Beastfolk

Beastfolk are intelligent fey mortals that combine traits of humans or dwarves with the traits of natural beasts. They are a dream of Faerie, produced as echoes of the human fairy-tales of animals whose lives and politics are as complex as their own.

Most beastfolk are champions of their animal kin, tapping into their animal nature in combat. Pucca champions whose animal form matches their patron can battle-frenzy when in animal form, and any beastfolk champion whose animal form matches their patron gains experience faster, regardless of their prime requisite abilities. These creatures have given rise to all the legends of werewolves and other shapeshifting monsters.

Beastfolk druids and hunters are uncommon, but not unheard of. Fox pucca are the most notable exception; reyngarou almost invariably choose the path of the druid.

Fauns

Fauns have the appearance of feral elves with pronounced animal features - their ears, eyes, and lower legs are almost entirely those of some species of wild animal; they typically possess a tail, a slight muzzle, and horns or antlers if appropriate to the animal species (and gender) that they resemble.

If your origin indicates a faun, you can roll a d6 to determine which natural animal you most resemble:

D6	Faun subtype	Adjusted abilities
1	Goat	+Con, +Str, -Int
2	Wolf	+Str, +Dex, -Int
3	Cat	+Str, +Dex, -Int
4	Deer	+Str, +Dex, -Int
5	Owl	+Dex
6	Fox	+Dex

Pucca

Shapeshift - All pucca have the ability to transform between a humanoid form and a single kind of natural beast. Unlike a druid's 'Wild Shape' magic, a pucca's magic - and their animal form - is innate to their fey nature, and their animal form is considered their 'natural' form. In their humanoid form, a pucca often resembles an elf or human with some faun-like features. Fox and owl pucca have enhanced Dexterity and no impaired abilities, while other pucca species have enhanced Dexterity and Strength, and impaired Intelligence.

Pucca feel just as home in either of their forms, but often have difficulty maintaining their human form when injured or startled. Most pucca have a 'tell' - such as a long, luxurious fox's tail, or a cat's reflective eyes - that can only be partially hidden under clothing or illusion magic, but that discerning mortals might still spot. Noticing a pucca's tell if you have never seen it in animal form is a hard Alertness check, while noticing its tell if you have seen its animal form (even if you didn't know it was a pucca) is an easy Alertness check. The referee makes this check for you in secret each time you cross paths.

Pucca shapeshifting follows all the rules for a druid's wild shape feat, but it is their animal form rather than their human form that is considered natural. A pucca in human form does not need to maintain focus on their form, but must still make a saving throw vs. Doom when injured to avoid reverting back into their animal form. This saving throw is hard if the damage is from a cold iron weapon or projectile.

If your origin indicates a pucca, roll a d20 to determine your natural animal form:

D20	Pucca subtype	Animal Form
1-5	Reyngarou	Fox
6-10	Sea Selkie	Seal
11-14	River Selkie	Otter
15	Tagashee	Badger
16	Stryx	Owl
17	Daimgarou	Deer
18	Caitshee	Cheetah
19	Loupgarou	Wolf
20	Arktoi	Black bear

Centaurs

Centaurs are fey chimera, possessing the upper body of a faun and the lower body of some form of natural beast. Horse, deer, seal, dolphin, snake, spider, and cheetah centaurs are all known to exist in populations large enough to maintain a tribal presence in the wilderness, while more unique specimens occasionally prowl the deep forests.

The most common form of centaur encountered by humans are hippocentaurs, who possess a lower body that resembles a small pony. Wild hippocentaur tribes typically live in close proximity to elven and human barbarians, and share many of their habits and beliefs. Cervitaurs, or deer centaur, are more elusive creatures, keeping mostly to their own kind in small tribal herds.

In coastal regions, dolphin and seal centaurs called merfolk are most commonly encountered. While merfolk cannot breathe underwater by nature, they can hold their breath for nearly an hour at a time, and often craft intricate magic items allowing themselves to transform into two-legged forms and walk on dry land.

Other centaur types are more often seen as a threat than an ally, although there are always exceptions. Tribes of serpentfolk dot the wild jungles of the world, still offering mortal sacrifices to the Fair Folk. Ettercap are typically proud, solitary creatures, but will often enslave tribes of elves or goblins in the deep underground caverns of Faerie. Leotaurs are most often found as solitary predators, waylaying the unwary and devouring them.

Enhanced Movement - The animal lower half of a centaur gives them the movement rates of the animal species they most resemble, as well as determining their enhanced and deficient abilities. Each particular body plan will also make specific task checks and saving throws hard or easy depending on the environment - for example, a quadruped will find it easier to save vs. Hold in many circumstances, but will find Agility checks to climb a ladder or a rope harder.

If your origin indicates a centaur, roll a d20 to determine the shape of your lower half:

1-6. Hippocentaurs (+Str, +Dex, -Int) possess a lower body that resembles a small pony. They may dash up to 30 paces, or up to 20 paces while encumbered.

7-10. Cervitaurs (+Str, +Dex, -Int) possess a lower body that resembles a deer or small elk. Lighter and more nimble than other centaur, they may dash 40 paces when unencumbered, and find it easy to navigate difficult terrain.

11-14. Leotaurs (+Str, +Dex, -Int) possess a lower body that resembles a cheetah. Like cervitaur, they may dash up to 30 paces when unencumbered, and find it easy to navigate difficult terrain.

15-16. Merfolk (+Con, +Wis, -Dex) possess a lower body that resembles a dolphin or porpoise, but with elaborate fins and bright colors. Merfolk are hobbled on land, but may dash 30 paces underwater.

17-18. Serpentfolk (+Str, +Dex, -Int) possess a lower body that resembles a massive snake - often 15 ft long or longer. Serpentfolk are not hobbled while prone, and may even dash 20 paces while prone. They may make a grapple attack with their tail with a reach of 2 paces.

Serpentfolk find it harder than other creatures to save vs. Hold to prevent being moved, unless they can grab or wrap around something while making their saving throw.

19. Ettercaps (+Con, +Dex, -Int) possess a lower body that resembles a gigantic spider. An ettercap may climb reliably without needing an Agility check, and may dash 20 paces while climbing. They find it easy to avoid being knocked over or moved.

20. Garda (+Dex, +Int, -Con) are unusual in that it is their lower body that is humanoid, while their head and shoulders are those of a large owl, magpie, crow, or raven. Garda are small creatures with hollow bones and enormous wings, allowing them to fly 20 paces as a dash action when unencumbered.

As **small** creatures, it's harder for garda to wield Heavy weapons, and they must wield Medium weapons with both hands. It's easier for them to attack medium or larger creatures, and it's harder for medium or larger creatures to attack them.



rcs

In addition to natural animals and fey beasts, there are plenty of intelligent enemies that threaten civilization. The most common threats that an adventuring party are likely to face are called orcs.

Orcs are barbarian cannibal-warriors that follow Orcus, a dark god of terror and blood. While some human and fey barbarian tribes can be orcs, by far the most common orcs are goblins and lizardfolk.

Orcs are built as fey/barbarian non-player characters, with character classes and levels as normal. Goblin and lizardfolk orcs can come in small, medium, large, or huge size, with the largest typically also having the most hit dice. Small goblin-orcs are called redcaps, while medium goblin-orcs are called hobgoblins, large goblin-orcs are called bugbears, and huge goblin-orcs are called ogres. Small lizardfolk-orcs are called kobolds, medium lizardfolk-orcs are called troglodytes, and large lizardfolk-orcs are called dragonborn. While there are technically no huge lizardfolk-orcs, lizardfolk tribes are often led by huge primordial dragons.

The statistics for small, medium, and large goblin and lizardfolk orcs are presented here for player and referee alike to familiarize themselves with, while the statistics for huge creatures are presented later in this book.

Goblin Orcs

Goblin physiology seems particularly suited to orc marauding, as the consumption of the flesh of intelligent creatures allows them to increase in size almost without limit. As they grow, a goblin orc's hunger for manflesh increases faster than their height and weight, leaving bugbears and ogres thinking of little but their next succulent meal. Orc tribal hierarchy is almost entirely based on size, with the smaller redcaps living in constant fear of being caught and eaten by their ravenous larger cousins.

Redcap (Level 1 to 3, Small)

Con +1 Str +0 Dex +1 Int +0 Wis +0 Cha -1

Movement: Normal

Size: Small

Armor: (per worn armor)

HP: (per hd)

Hobgoblin (Level 2 to 4)

Con +2 Str +2 Dex +1 Int +0 Wis +0 Cha +0

Movement: Normal

Size: Medium

Armor: (per worn armor)

HP: (per hd)

Bugbear (Level 3 to 5, Large)

Con +3 Str +3 Dex +1 Int +0 Wis +0 Cha +1

Movement: Normal

Size: Large

Armor: (per worn armor)

HP: (per hd)x2

Goblin Player Characters

It's theoretically possible for a redcap or even a hobgoblin to decide to swear off mortal flesh and attempt to join civilization. A redcap player character is a small creature with enhanced Constitution and Dexterity, and deficient charisma. Hobgoblins and bugbears that swear off "manflesh" slowly shrink in size as their body consumes itself for nutrients, until they are the size of a redcap again. The "weaning" period is intensely unpleasant and not compatible with adventuring.

Lizardfolk Orcs

Lizardfolk orc druids, called bone-mothers, possess dark rituals that allow their gravid females to give birth to young with some of the memories and skills of any intelligent creatures that they consume.

All lizardfolk begin as kobolds and grow into troglodytes if they survive into adulthood. Those lizardfolk who distinguish themselves among their tribe are given a brew by their druid elders, which transforms them into dragonborn. This is only done after a promising lizardfolk orc has laid or sired a litter of eggs, as all dragonborn are infertile.

Kobold (Level 1 to 3, Small)

Con +0 Str +1 Dex +1 Int +0 Wis +0 Cha -1

Movement: Normal Size: Small

Armor: 1 HP: (per hd)

Troglodyte (Level 2 to 4)

Con +2 Str +2 Dex +1 Int +0 Wis +0 Cha +0

Movement: Normal Size: Medium

Armor: 2 HP: (per hd)

Dragonborn (Level 3 to 5, Large)

Con +3 Str +3 Dex +1 Int +0 Wis +0 Cha +0

Movement: Normal Size: Large

Armor: 3 HP: (per hd)x2

Lizardfolk Player Characters

Like goblins, lizardfolk are theoretically capable of renouncing Orcish ways and joining civilization. A "civilized" lizardfolk only engage in ritual cannibalism for reproductive purposes, and only of their own dead (who can fully expect to be reincarnated through the process). Lizardfolk have enhanced strength and dexterity, and deficient charisma; they choose between the fey character classes. Kobolds are small creatures, troglodytes are human-sized, and dragonborn are large. The dragonborn formula is only available to a troglodyte that has reached character level nine and distinguished itself in its clan's eyes.

Beastman Orcs

Many beastman tribes form marauding bands of orc champions and hunters, tapping into their animal natures to sow terror as they raid civilization. To create an orc beastman, choose a faun, pucca, or centaur subtype and set each of its enhanced abilities to +1 and its deficient ability (if any) to -1.

Orcish centaur warbands will typically be comprised exclusively of centaurs, while pucca often work together as a single pack, which might also include members of their associated animal species. Orc faun tribes, called "gnoles" by peasant villagers, might even organize into entire clans, conquering large swaths of territory and enslaving mortals for labor and food.

A pack will typically be led by a champion, who will have the highest level among the marauders. For each champion in the pack, there will typically be 2-3 hunters, serving as archers and skirmishers to support the champions' direct assault. Some warbands will also include a druid for magical support.

Some beastmen types, such as ettercaps, prefer to be solitary hunters or a single mated pair. The only known large tribe of orcish ettercaps is the vast subterranean empire of Svartalfheim, where eerily pale dwarf, elf, and ettercap cannibals have managed to form a brutal but effective civilization within the Hyperborean ruins of an ancient Atlantean city-state that was buried and forgotten beneath the northernmost wastes of the Danemarch by the Great Flood.

Beasts

Animals typically have an armor rating between 1 and 2, representing a leathery or thick hide. A few animals or fey beasts might have even thicker hides. A beast's armor never encumbers it. Many animals have unusual movement modes. A fast animal can dash 30 paces per round when unencumbered, while a very fast animal can dash 40 paces per round. Animals with a swim or climb speed never have to roll to swim or climb, and can dash while using that movement. A slow animal, on the other hand, is considered hobbled when moving along the ground; most slow creatures have some alternate movement mode (such as flight or swimming) that is their natural movement.

Many animals also have various senses that are either poor or superior compared to a mortal. Alertness checks made with poor senses are harder, while Alertness checks made with superior senses are easier. A few animals have senses that are completely unique, such as a bat's sonar. Finally, some animals have special feats that they can perform during a combat encounter. An animal can perform such a feat a number of times per encounter equal to its level.

At the referee's discretion, a particular animal or beast might have better or worse abilities than a typical specimen — the referee might roll a d6 to determine which ability is affected, then roll a second d6 and adjust that ability by +1 on a '6', or by -1 on a '1'.

Animal Intelligence

Most animals are of bestial intelligence, with sufficient cunning to problem-solve but not to understand complex concepts. Mechanically, this is represented by an Intelligence of -4; creatures with higher Intelligence might be capable of some amount of complex reasoning and training, sufficient to teach them skills outside their normal repertoire. Dolphins, crows, and elephants in particular display signs of intelligence that rivals our own (-2 to +0 Intelligence); the kinds of skills that such creatures can be taught is left up to the referee to decide. Some creatures do not have an Intelligence ability at all; such a monster is essentially mindless, only responding to basic stimulus and following a few rote instincts.

Animal Companions

Druids and hunters with expertise in Survival can gather a menagerie of animal companions about them; these creatures follow the druid like a retinue but do not count against their Bearing limit. A druid or hunter may have a total number of creatures in their menagerie based on Survival rather than Bearing, and those creatures' total levels cannot exceed twice the character's level. Keep in mind that feeding a Large creature will represent a substantial investment in resources, and such creatures cannot typically follow a party of adventurers underground into tight caverns and darkly-lit spaces.

Other characters with Intuition of 5+ or better may have a single trained animal companion - either a 2 hd large dog or a 3 hd warhorse. Commanding a trained animal companion in battle requires an Intuition check each time a command is given, to ensure that the creature understands and obeys the order. This check will be easier or harder depending on the intelligence, stubbornness, and training of the animal, as well as its current attitude and relationship to its handler.

Natural Animals

Natural animals are creatures from the Material Plane, with no particular connection to Faerie or Shadow. The vast majority of creatures that scurry about the material are native to this realm, and are simply trying to survive as best they can within their territory. Most such creatures only fight if cornered, or (if carnivorous) when more desperate for a meal than they are wary.

Giant Rat (Level ½)

Doom 16+ Hold 16+ Blast 13+ Trick 18+ Curse 13+ Fear 15+			
Movement	Normal	Size	Small
Armor	0	HP	2
Attacks (16+)	bite (d6+2 piercing)		
Con -2 Str -2 Dex +1 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha -1			
Talents (4+)	Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival		
Behavior (d6)	1-2 fearful, 3-5 wary, 6 aggressive		

Bat (Level ½)

Doom 16+ Hold 16+ Blast 11+ Trick 18+ Curse 13+ Fear 14+			
Movement	Slow / Fly Fast	Size:	Small
Armor	0	HP:	2
Attacks (17+)	bite (l)		
Con -2 Str -2 Dex +3 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha +0			
Talents (4+)	Agility, Alertness, Survival		
Senses	Sonar (special)		
Behavior:	Wary		

Hawk (Level ½)

Doom 15+ Hold 15+ Blast 12+ Trick 18+ Curse 12+ Fear 14+			
Movement:	Slow / Fly Fast	Size:	Small
Armor:	0	HP:	3
Attacks (14+):	bite (d6+2 piercing), talons (d6-l)		
Con -1 Str -1 Dex +2 Int -4 Wis +2 Cha +0			
Talents (4+):	Agility, Alertness, Survival		
Senses:	Sight (superior), Hearing (superior)		
Behavior:	Wary		

Owl (Level ½)

Doom 15+ Hold 15+ Blast 12+ Trick 18+ Curse 12+ Fear 14+			
Movement	Slow / Fly	Size:	Small
Armor	0	HP:	3
Attacks (15+)	bite (d6+2 piercing), talons (d6-l)		
Con -1 Str -1 Dex +2 Int -4 Wis +2 Cha +0			
Talents (4+)	Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival		
Senses	Touch (superior)		
Behavior	Wary		

Raven (Level ½)

Doom 15+ Hold 16+ Blast 12+ Trick 15+ Curse 12+ Fear 14+			
Movement:	Slow / Fly	Size:	Small
Armor:	0	HP:	3
Attacks (16+)	bite (d6+2 piercing), talons (d6÷2)		
Con -1 Str -2 Dex +2 Int -1 Wis +2 Cha +0			
Talents (4+)	Agility, Finesse, Alertness, Survival		
Behavior (d6):	1-2 wary, 3-5 curious, 6 aggressive		

Badger (Level 1)

Doom 13+ Hold 14+ Blast 14+ Trick 18+ Curse 13+ Fear 14+			
Movement:	Normal	Size:	Small
Armor:	1 (0)	HP:	7
Attacks (14+):	bite (d6 piercing), claws (d6÷2)		
Con +1 Str +0 Dex +0 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha +0			
Talents (4+):	Alertness, Survival		
Senses:	Sight (poor), Smell (superior)		
Behavior (d6):	1 wary, 2-5 indifferent, 6 aggressive		

Fox (Level 1)

Doom 15+ Hold 15+ Blast 12+ Trick 16+ Curse 13+ Fear 14+			
Movement:	Fast	Size:	Small
Armor:	0	HP:	5
Attacks (15+):	bite (d6÷2 piercing)		
Con -1 Str -1 Dex +2 Int -2 Wis +1 Cha +0			
Talents (4+):	Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival		
Senses:	Smell (superior)		
Behavior (d6):	1 fearful, 2-4 wary, 5-6 curious		

Otter (Level 1)

Doom 15+ Hold 15+ Blast 13+ Trick 18+ Curse 13+ Fear 14+			
Movement:	Swim Fast	Size:	Small
Armor:	0	HP:	5
Attacks (15+):	bite (d6÷2 piercing)		
Con -1 Str -1 Dex +3 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha +0			
Talents (4+):	Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival		
Senses:	Touch (superior)		
Behavior (d6):	1 fearful, 2-4 wary, 5-6 curious		

Sheep (Level 1)

Doom 13+ Hold 14+ Blast 14+ Trick 18+ Curse 14+ Fear 14+			
Movement:	Normal	Size:	Medium
Armor:	1	HP:	8
Attacks (14+):	charge (2d6 blunt)		
Con +2 Str +0 Dex +0 Int -4 Wis +0 Cha +0			
Talents (4+):	Agility, Survival		
Behavior (d6):	1-3 wary, 4-5 curious, 6 aggressive		

Viper (Level 1)

Doom 15+ Hold 15+ Blast 12+ Trick 18+ Curse 13+ Fear 15+			
Movement:	Normal	Size:	Small
Armor:	0	HP:	5
Attacks (12+):	bite (d6 piercing+ d6 ongoing poison)		
Con -1 Str -1 Dex +2 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha -1			
Talents (4+):	Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival		
Senses:	Heat vision (special)		
Behavior (d6):	1 fearful, 2-5 wary, 6 aggressive		

Black Bear

(Level 2)

Doom 10+ Hold 10+ Blast 13+ Trick 17+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+	
Movement:	Normal
Armor:	2
Attacks (10+):	claws (2d6), grapple (2d6+3 blunt)
Con +3 Str +3 Dex +0 Int -4 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Talents (4+):	Alertness, Survival
Behavior (d6):	1 wary, 2-5 indifferent, 6 aggressive

Cheetah

(Level 2)

Doom 13+ Hold 13+ Blast 9+ Trick 17+ Curse 12+ Fear 13+	
Movement:	Very Fast
Armor:	1
Attacks (11+):	bite (2d6 piercing), claws (d6)
Con +0 Str +0 Dex +4 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha +0	
Talents (4+):	Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival
Behavior (d6):	1 fearful, 2-5 wary, 6 curious

Deer

(Level 2)

Doom 11+ Hold 12+ Blast 12+ Trick 17+ Curse 12+ Fear 13+	
Movement:	Fast
Armor:	1
Attacks (11+):	charge (2d6 blunt or piercing)
Con +2 Str +1 Dex +1 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha +0	
Talents (4+):	Stealth, Alertness, Survival
Behavior (d6):	1 fearful, 2-5 wary, 6 aggressive

Donkey / Mule

(Level 2)

Doom 11+ Hold 10+ Blast 13+ Trick 17+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+	
Movement:	Normal
Armor:	0
Attacks (10+):	bite (d6 piercing), hooves (2d6 blunt)
Con +2 Str +3 Dex +0 Int -4 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Talents (4+):	Agility, Alertness, Survival
Behavior (d6):	1 wary, 2-5 indifferent, 6 aggressive

Goat

(Level 2)

Doom 10+ Hold 12+ Blast 12+ Trick 17+ Curse 12+ Fear 13+	
Movement:	Climb
Armor:	1
Attacks (11+):	charge (2d6+1 blunt or piercing)
Con +3 Str +1 Dex +0 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha +0	
Talents (4+):	Agility, Alertness, Survival
Behavior (d6):	1 wary, 2-5 indifferent, 6 aggressive

Seal

(Level 2)

Doom 12+ Hold 13+ Blast 13+ Trick 17+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+	
Movement:	Slow, Swim Fast
Armor:	1
Attacks (12+):	bite (d6 piercing)
Con +1 Str +0 Dex +0 Int -4 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Talents (4+):	Agility, Alertness, Survival
Behavior (d6):	1-2 wary, 3-6 indifferent

Boar

(Level 3)

Doom 10+ Hold 9+ Blast 12+ Trick 16+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+	
Movement:	Fast
Armor:	1 (0)
Attacks (9+):	gore (2d6+3), charge (3d6+3 piercing)
Con +2 Str +3 Dex +0 Int -4 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Talents (4+):	Survival
Behavior (d6):	1-4 wary, 5-6 aggressive

Cattle

(Level 3)

Doom 9+ Hold 9+ Blast 12+ Trick 16+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+	
Movement:	Normal
Armor:	0
Attacks (9+):	hooves (2d6), horns (2d6+3 piercing)
Special Feat:	Trample - cattle can pass through medium or smaller creatures when they dash, dealing 1d6 blunt damage to each creature that doesn't save vs. Blast.
Con +3 Str +3 Dex +0 Int -4 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Behavior (d6):	1 fearful, 2-5 wary, 6 curious

Dolphin

(Level 3)

Doom 10+ Hold 11+ Blast 10+ Trick 12+ Curse 11+ Fear 11+	
Movement:	Slow / Swim Fast
Armor:	1 (0)
Attacks (11+):	bite (d6 piercing)
Con +2 Str +1 Dex +2 Int +0 Wis +1 Cha +1	
Talents (4+):	Agility, Alertness, Survival
Senses:	Sonar
Behavior (d6):	Intelligent - 1-3 wary, 4-6 curious

Draft Horse

(Level 3)

Doom 10+ Hold 9+ Blast 12+ Trick 16+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+	
Movement:	Fast
Armor:	0
Attacks (9+):	hooves (2d6 blunt)
Special Feat:	Trample - horses can pass through medium or smaller creatures when they dash, dealing 1d6 blunt damage to each creature that doesn't save vs. Blast.
Con +2 Str +3 Dex +0 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha +0	
Talents (3+):	Alertness
Behavior (d6):	1 fearful, 2-5 wary, 6 curious

Elk

(Level 3)

Doom 10+ Hold 10+ Blast 12+ Trick 16+ Curse 11+ Fear 12+	
Movement:	Fast
Armor:	1 (0)
Attacks (10+):	hooves (2d6), charge (3d6+2 piercing)
Special Feat:	Trample - elk can pass through medium or smaller creatures when they dash, dealing 1d6 blunt damage to each creature that doesn't save vs. Blast.
Con +2 Str +2 Dex +0 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha +0	
Talents (4+):	Alertness, Survival
Behavior (d6):	1 fearful, 2-5 wary, 6 aggressive

Leopard

(Level 3)

Doom 11+ Hold 10+ Blast 10+ Trick 16+ Curse 11+ Fear 12+			
Movement:	Fast	Size:	Medium
Armor:	0	HP:	3d6+3
Attacks (10+ x2):	bite (d6+2 piercing), claws (2d6+2)		
Con +1 Str +2	Dex +2 Int -4	Wis +1	Cha +0
Talents (4+):	Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival		
Senses:	Smell (superior)		
Behavior (d6):	1 fearful, 2-5 wary, 6 aggressive		

Wolf / Mastiff

(Level 3)

Doom 11+ Hold 10+ Blast 11+ Trick 15+ Curse 11+ Fear 11+			
Movement:	Fast	Size:	Medium
Armor:	0	HP:	3d6+3
Attacks (11+):	bite (d6+2 piercing), grapple (2d6)		
Con +1 Str +2	Dex +1	Int -3	Wis +1 Cha +1
Talents (4+):	Stealth, Alertness, Survival		
Senses:	Smell (superior)		
Behavior (d6):	1 curious, 2-5 wary, 6 aggressive		

Dire Wolf

(Level 3)

Doom 10+ Hold 9+ Blast 11+ Trick 14+ Curse 11+ Fear 10+	
Armor:	1 (0) HP: (3d6+6)x2
Movement:	Fast Size: Large
Attacks (9+ x2):	bite (d6+3 piercing), grapple (3d6+3)
Con +2 Str +3	Dex +1 Int -2 Wis +1 Cha +2
Talents (4+):	Stealth, Alertness, Survival
Senses:	Smell (superior), Hearing (superior)
Behavior (d6):	1 curious, 2-4 wary, 5-6 aggressive

War Horse

(Level 3)

Doom 9+ Hold 9+ Blast 12+ Trick 16+ Curse 11+ Fear 11+			
Movement:	Fast	Size:	Large
Armor:	1 (0)	HP:	(3d6+9)x2
Attacks (8+):	hooves (2d6 blunt)		
Special Feat:	Trample - a warhorse can pass through medium or smaller creatures when they dash, dealing 1d6 blunt damage to each creature that doesn't save vs. Blast.		
Con +3 Str +3	Dex +0	Int -4	Wis +1 Cha +1
Talents (4+):	Alertness, Survival		
Behavior (d6):	1 curious, 2-5 wary, 6 aggressive		

Ox

(Level 3)

Doom 8+ Hold 8+ Blast 13+ Trick 16+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+					
Movement:		Normal		Size: Large	
Armor:		1 (0)		HP: (4d6+16)x2	
Attacks (8+):		hooves (2d6), horns (2d6+4 piercing)			
Special Feat: Trample - oxen can pass through medium or smaller creatures when they dash, dealing 1d6 blunt damage to each creature that doesn't save vs. Blast.					
Con +4 Str +4		Dex -1 Int -4		Wis +0 Cha +0	
Behavior (d6):		1 fearful, 2-5 wary, 6 aggressive			

Lion

(Level 4)

Doom 10+ Hold 8+ Blast 9+ Trick 15+ Curse 10+ Fear 11+			
Movement:	Fast	Size:	Large
Armor:	1 (0)	HP:	(4d6+4)x2
Attacks (8+ x2):	bite (2d6 piercing), claws (2d6+4)		
Con +1 Str +3	Dex +2 Int -4	Wis +1	Cha +0
Talents (4+):	Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival		
Behavior (d6):	1 curious, 2-4 wary, 5-6 aggressive		

Tiger

(Level 4)

Doom 10+ Hold 7+ Blast 9+ Trick 15+ Curse 10+ Fear 11+			
Movement:	Fast	Size:	Large
Armor:	1 (0)	HP:	(4d6+8)x2
Attacks (7+ x2):	bite (2d6 piercing), claws (3d6+4)		
Special Feat:	Frenzy - a tiger can add +2d6 damage to each attack it makes in an action.		
Con +2 Str +4	Dex +2	Int -4	Wis +1 Cha +0
Talents (4+):	Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival		
Behavior (d6):	1 curious, 2-4 wary, 5-6 aggressive		

Grizzly Bear

(Level 4)

Doom 7+ Hold 7+ Blast 11+ Trick 15+ Curse 10+ Fear 11+			
Movement:	Normal	Size:	Large
Armor:	2 (1)	HP:	(4d6+16)x2
Attacks (7+):	bite (2d6 piercing), claws (2d6+4)		
Special Feat:	Frenzy - a grizzly bear can add +2d6 damage to an attack while injured.		
Con +4 Str +4	Dex +0	Int -4	Wis +1 Cha +0
Talents (4+):	Alertness, Survival		
Behavior (d6):	1 curious, 2-4 wary, 5-6 aggressive		

Orca

(Level 4)

Doom 8+ Hold 8+ Blast 10+ Trick 11+ Curse 11+ Fear 11+			
Movement:	Slow / Swim Fast	Size:	Large
Armor:	2 (1)	HP:	(4d6+12)x2
Attacks (8+):	bite (d6 piercing)		
Con +3 Str +3 Dex +1 Int +0 Wis +0 Cha +0			
Talents (4+):	Agility, Alertness, Survival		
Senses:	Sonar		
Behavior (d6):	1-4 wary, 5-6 aggressive		

Shark

(Level 4)

Doom 8+ Hold 8+ Blast 10+ Trick 15+ Curse 11+ Fear 11+			
Movement:	Slow / Swim Fast		Size: Large
Armor:	2 (1)	HP:	(4d6+12)x2
Attacks (8+):	bite (d6 piercing)		
Special Feat:	Frenzy - a shark can add +2d6 damage to an attack if the target is injured.		
Con +3 Str +3	Dex +1	Int -4	Wis +0 Cha +0
Talents (4+):	Agility, Alertness, Survival		
Behavior (d6):	1-4 wary, 5-6 aggressive		

Fey Beasts

Many strange creatures are native to Faerie, created by its chaotic energies as strange echoes of mortal beasts. Most such creatures are chimerae, displaying a mixture of features from different "natural" animals. Centaurs and griffins are both examples of kinds of creatures that began as chimerae, but had sufficiently sensible internal organs that they could breathe, eat, and even breed in the mortal world.

Iron Vulnerability - The fey are vulnerable to cold iron – unalloyed lodestone, telluric iron, or meteoric iron that has never been heated enough to glow by mortal means. Damage to a fey beast from any cold iron weapon also stuns them, causes all saving throws to be harder until it heals, and prevents it from using any of its special feats until healed.

Glamour - Fey beasts retain a spark of Faerie's power, even in the mortal world. Fey beasts can often weave primal magic more readily than a druid, using materia in their own body to power their glammers. Areas in the material world that have been exposed to elemental energies will often see the offspring of natural animals mutating into fey beasts, as residual energies diffuse into the environment.

All fey beasts have a pool of glamour equal to their level which they can use to power their special feats, sometimes including primal magics. A fey beast uses and regains glamour as a druid: A first-circle glamour costs 1 point from its pool, a second-circle glamour costs 2 points, and a third-circle glamour costs 3. A fey beast can regain one glamour by resting and making a Survival check.

Fey Beasts in Their Natural Environment

While fey beasts are supernatural creatures, they integrate fully into the ecosystem of the material plane, breeding and hunting and being preyed upon like any other creature. Their presence puts serious pressure on any ecosystem they live in, however, making it obvious when they have made a particular area their home.

Noticing that a one-league hex is the territory of a fey beast is a Survival check, which can be made in secret on behalf of the party's guide by the referee when they first enter the hex. Determining what kind of fey beasts inhabit a hex requires deliberate investigation.

Fey Beast Intelligence

Most fey beasts have the intelligence of a very cunning natural animal, but a few fey beasts, such as unicorns, are intelligent creatures that are often capable of speech. These creatures either choose to live in harmony with nature, or simply lack the capacity or desire to use tools and integrate with mortal society. An intelligent fey beast is still considered a beast, rather than a mortal, for magical effects that care about such matters.

Fey Beasts as Animal Companions

Druids capable of casting Beast Bond can attempt to "train" a fey beast as an animal companion, but such creatures are far more willful and temperamental than natural animals. Hunters can also try to train a fey beast if they acquire them young enough - ideally immediately after birth. Raising a fey beast will be an arduous montage of hard Survival checks and minor quests to keep it fed and healthy until it reaches maturity.

An intelligent fey beast is another matter, since it has its own will and desires and intellect. They are negotiated with and brought on as hirelings using Bearing, rather than Survival, even though they count as beasts in all other respects. An intelligent fey beast will often have quite unusual demands, compared to other allies or hirelings.

Barrow-Cat

(Level 3)

A barrow-cat is a large feline the size of a leopard with large, luminous eyes and a wide face with an oversized grinning mouth. Exceptionally long and prehensile tendrils extend from either side of its face like a pair of animated whiskers, each terminating in a 'tuft' of fur and true whiskers. The most common coloring for a barrow-cat is black, often with a white 'star' pattern on its chest.

Doom 11+ Hold 9+ Blast 8+ Trick 14+ Curse 11+ Fear 10+	
Armor: 1	HP: 3d6+3
Movement: Very Fast	Size: Medium
Attacks (9+):	bite (2d6+3 piercing), claws (2d6+3)
Special Feat: A barrow-cat can use its action to become invisible until it attacks. While invisible, it may cast a major illusion of itself up to 5 paces away.	
Con +1 Str +3 Dex +4 Int -2 Wis +1 Cha +2	
Behavior (d6):	1 curious, 2-5 wary, 6 aggressive
Talents (3+):	Agility, Alertness, Stealth, Survival
Senses:	Hearing (superior)

Chuckboe

(Level 3)

A chuckboe is a large flightless predatory bird with a massive, curved beak for tearing flesh, powerful legs, and vibrant colors. Barbarian tribes sometimes raise chuckboes as mounts.

Doom 11+ Hold 11+ Blast 10+ Trick 16+ Curse 11+ Fear 12+			
Movement:	Fast	Size:	Large
Armor:	0	HP:	(3d6+3)x2
Attacks (9+):	bite (2d6+2 piercing), talons (2d6)		
Con +1 Str +1	Dex +2	Int -4	Wis +1 Cha +0
Talents (3+):	Agility, Alertness, Survival		
Behavior (d6):	1-2 curious, 3 wary, 4-6 aggressive		

Firefox

(Level 3)

A firefox appears to be a normal fox until it begins weaving glamour, at which point its tail begins to glow and fan out into multiple separate tails.

Doom 13+ Hold 13+ Blast 10+ Trick 12+ Curse 10+ Fear 10+			
Armor:	0	HP:	3d6-3
Movement:	Very Fast	Size:	Small
Attacks (13+):	bite (1d6 piercing), claws (1d6)		
Special Feat:	A firefox can cast as a druid.		
Con -1 Str -1	Dex +2	Int +0	Wis +2 Cha +2
Talents (3+):	Agility, Alertness, Stealth, Survival		
Behavior:	Intelligent and curious		

Keryne

(Level 3)

A keryne, also sometimes called a hunthind (female hunthart), is a snow-white deer or elk with gleaming golden antlers and hooves, piercing ice-blue eyes, and impossibly graceful movements.

Doom 11+ Hold 10+ Blast 8+ Trick 13+ Curse 11+ Fear 10+			
Armor:	0	HP:	3d6+3
Movement:	Very Fast	Size:	Medium
Attacks (9+):	bite (2d6+3 piercing), claws (2d6+3)		
Special Feat:	A keryne can cast beguile or fey illusion to lure mortals into danger.		
Con +1 Str +2	Dex +2	Int -1	Wis +1 Cha +2
Talents (3+):	Agility, Alertness, Stealth, Survival		
Behavior:	Intelligent and malevolent		

Omencrow

(Level 3)

An omencrow appears to be an oversized crow, magpie or raven with unusually intelligent eyes. They are sapient, and fully capable of learning mortal speech.

Doom 13+ Hold 13+ Blast 10+ Trick 11+ Curse 11+ Fear 12+			
Armor:	0	HP:	3d6-3
Movement:	Very Fast	Size:	Medium
Attacks (9+):	bite (2d6+3 piercing), claws (2d6+3)		
Special Feat:	An omencrow can cast as a druid, and can also cast the mage hand cantrip.		
Con -1 Str -1	Dex +2	Int +1	Wis +1 Cha +0
Behavior:	Intelligent and curious		
Talents (3+):	Agility, Alertness, Stealth, Survival		

Dire Vole

(Level 3)

A dire vole seems to be the product of Faerie's odd sense of humor - a nearly cat-sized vole or shrew with lightning reflexes.

Doom 12+ Hold 11+ Blast 8+ Trick 16+ Curse 11+ Fear 12+			
Armor:	0	HP:	3d6
Movement:	Very Fast	Size:	Small
Attacks (9+ x2):	bite (d6+1 piercing), claws (d6+1)		
Special Feat:	An direvole can dig through solid earth at its full dash speed, then emerge to perform a sneak attack with a 5' leap.		
Con +0 Str +1	Dex +4	Int -4	Wis +1 Cha +0
Talents (3+):	Stealth, Alertness, Survival		
Behavior:	1 fearful, 2-3 wary, 4-6 aggressive		

Phoenix

(Level 4)

A phoenix is a magnificent raptor nearly the size of a man, resembling an eagle with a peacock's tail. Its feathers range from a deep red and ruddy purple at the neck and body, to a brilliant golden-orange at the wings and tail, which are adorned with an array of brightly glowing eyespots like embers from a fire.

Doom 11+ Hold 9+ Blast 7+ Trick 14+ Curse 9+ Fear 9+			
Movement:	Slow / Fly Fast		Size: Medium
Armor:	0		HP: 4d6
Attacks (9+):	bite (1d6+2 piercing), talons (2d6)		
Special Feat:	A phoenix can cast any Flame-based primal glamour. Once per day, a Phoenix can cast a Primal equivalent of the revive miracle.		
Con +0 Str +2	Dex +4	Int -3	Wis +2 Cha +2
Talents (3+):	Agility, Alertness, Survival		
Behavior (d6):	1-3 curious, 4-5 wary, 6 aggressive		

Roc

(Level 4)

A roc is a vast eagle the size of a horse, with a wingspan of 30 feet. Most are brown or grey.

Doom 9+ Hold 7+ Blast 9+ Trick 15+ Curse 9+ Fear 11+			
Con +2 (9+)	Str +4 (7+)	Dex +2 (9+)	
Int -4 (15+)	Wis +2 (9+)	Cha +0 (11+)	
Movement:	Slow / Fly Fast	Size:	Large
Armor:	0	HP:	(4d6+8)x2
Attacks (9+):	bite (2d6 piercing), talons (3d6+4 sunder)		
Special Feat:	A roc can lift and carry up to 4 tons.		
Con +2 Str +4	Dex +2 Int -4	Wis +2	Cha +0
Talents (3+):	Agility, Alertness, Survival		
Senses:	Sight (superior)		
Behavior (d6):	1 curious, 2-4 wary, 5-6 aggressive		

Thunderbird

(Level 4)

A thunderbird resembles a vast eagle the size of a horse, with black feathers streaked with gold and light blue reflective patches. The air around a thunderbird condenses into storm clouds as it flies, and the tips of its feathers crackle and glow with static electricity.

Doom 11+ Hold 9+ Blast 7+ Trick 14+ Curse 9+ Fear 11+	
Movement:	Slow / Fly Fast Size: Large
Armor:	0 HP: 4d6x2
Attacks (9+):	bite (2d6 piercing), talons (3d6+2 sunder)
Special Feat:	A Thunderbird can cast any Air-aspected Primal glamour.
Con +0 Str +2 Dex +4 Int -3 Wis +2 Cha +0	
Talents (3+):	Agility, Alertness, Survival
Behavior (d6):	1 curious, 2-5 wary, 6 aggressive

Frostfang

(Level 4, Large)

A frostfang is an enormous white direwolf capable of summoning and controlling ice, snow, and winter storms.

Doom 8+ Hold 8+ Blast 10+ Trick 13+ Curse 10+ Fear 9+	
Armor:	1 (0) HP: (4d6+8)x2
Movement:	Fast Size: Large
Attacks (8+ x2):	bite (d6+3 piercing), grapple (3d6+3)
Special Feat:	A frostfang can cast call storm to summon a blizzard, or cast the cone of cold spell.
Con +3 Str +3 Dex +1 Int -2 Wis +1 Cha +2	
Talents (3+):	Stealth, Alertness, Survival
Senses:	Smell (superior), Hearing (superior)
Behavior (d6):	Semi-Intelligent

Landshark

(Level 4)

The odd creature known as the "landshark" resembles a fairy armadillo the size of an ox, with an armored forehead and a fin-like bony protrusion on its back.

Doom 7+ Hold 8+ Blast 9+ Trick 15+ Curse 10+ Fear 11+			
Armor:	1	HP:	(4d6+16)x2
Movement:	Dig Very Fast	Size:	Large
Attacks (8+):	bite (2d6+3 piercing), claws (2d6+3)		
Special Feat:	An landshark can dig through solid earth at its full dash speed, then emerge to perform a sneak attack with a 10' leap.		
Con +4 Str +3	Dex +2	Int -4	Wis +1 Cha +0
Talents (3+):	Stealth, Alertness, Survival		
Behavior:	always aggressive		

Kelpie

(Level 4)

Kelpies are large river-otters with elongated faces that somewhat resemble a horse's. They attempt to lure mortals into the water, where they can drown and eat them.

Doom 10+ Hold 10+ Blast 10+ Trick 12+ Curse 10+ Fear 11+			
Armor:	0	HP:	(4d6+4)x2
Movement:	Dig Very Fast	Size:	Large
Attacks (8+):	bite (2d6+3 piercing), grapple		
Special Feat:	A kelpie can cast the beguile, fey illusion, mirage, and tidal wave glammers.		
Con +1 Str +1	Dex +1	Int -2	Wis +1 Cha +0
Talents (3+):	Stealth, Alertness, Survival		
Behavior:	Semi-Intelligent		

Hippogryph (Level 5)

A hippogryph is a type of griffon, a fey beast that merges a large mammal with a bird of prey. Its body and hindlegs are those of a large warhorse, while its wings, neck, and head are those of a giant red kite, and its forelegs end in a kite's raptor-claws.

Doom 8+ Hold 8+ Blast 8+ Trick 14+ Curse 9+ Fear 9+	
Movement:	Fast / Fly Fast Size: Large
Armor:	1 HP: (5d6+10)x2
Attacks (8+ x2):	bite (2d6+2 pierce), claws (3d6+2 sunder)
Special Feat:	Gryphons can gain +2d6 damage to each of their attacks when injured
Con +2 Str +2 Dex +2 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha +1	
Talents (3+):	Agility, Alertness, Survival
Senses:	Sight (superior)
Behavior (d6):	1 curious, 2-4 wary, 5-6 aggressive

Leogryph (Level 5)

A leogryph's body and hindlegs are those of a lion, while its wings, neck, and head are those of a giant eagle, and its forelegs end in an eagle's raptor-claws.

Doom 7+ Hold 8+ Blast 8+ Trick 14+ Curse 9+ Fear 9+	
Movement:	Fast / Fly Fast Size: Large
Armor:	1 HP: (5d6+10)x2
Attacks (7+ x2):	bite (2d6+3 pierce), claws (3d6+3 sunder)
Special Feat:	Gryphons can gain +2d6 damage to each of their attacks when injured
Con +3 Str +2 Dex +2 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha +1	
Talents (3+):	Agility, Alertness, Survival
Senses:	Sight (superior)
Behavior (d6):	1 curious, 2-3 wary, 4-6 aggressive

Ursagryph (Level 5)

An ursagryph's body and hindlegs are those of a brown or white bear, while its wings, neck, and head are those of a giant horned or snowy owl. Unlike other griffins, ursagryphs are usually slow fliers, although their wings are almost entirely silent.

Doom 7+ Hold 7+ Blast 10+ Trick 14+ Curse 9+ Fear 9+	
Movement:	Fly Size: Large
Armor:	1 HP: (5d6+15)x2
Attacks (7+ x2):	bite (2d6+3 pierce), claws (3d6+3 sunder)
Special Feat:	Gryphons can gain +2d6 damage to each of their attacks when injured
Con +3 Str +3 Dex +0 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha +1	
Talents (3+):	Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival
Senses:	Sight (superior)
Behavior (d6):	1 curious, 2 wary, 3-6 aggressive

Nightmare (Level 5)

A nightmare appears to be a large black warhorse, but starved enough that its ribs show through its sides. Two black vulture-wings sprout from its shoulder blades.

Doom 8+ Hold 7+ Blast 9+ Trick 14+ Curse 9+ Fear 10+	
Movement:	Very Fast / Fly Size: Large
Armor:	1 HP: (5d6+15)x2
Attacks (8+):	hooves (2d6+3 blunt)
Special Feat:	A nightmare can cast the beguile, fey illusion, or sleep glamours, as well as the cause fear miracle.
Con +2 Str +3 Dex +1 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha +1	
Talents (3+):	Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival
Senses:	A nightmare can smell fear, giving it an innate sense of any creature's save vs. fear threshold.
Behavior:	Intelligent and malevolent

Pegasus (Level 5)

A pegasus appears to be a large white warhorse, with two vast white gull-wings sprouting from its shoulder blades.

Doom 8+ Hold 7+ Blast 9+ Trick 14+ Curse 9+ Fear 10+	
Movement:	Very Fast / Fly Size: Large
Armor:	1 HP: (5d6+15)x2
Attacks (8+):	hooves (2d6+3 blunt)
Special Feat:	A pegasus can spend 1 glamour to dash up to 160 paces while flying.
Con +2 Str +3 Dex +1 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha +0	
Talents (3+):	Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival
Behavior (d6):	1-2 curious, 3-5 wary, 6 aggressive

Unicorn (Level 5)

A unicorn appears to be a slender horse, similar to an Arabian breed, with pearlescent hooves and a spiraling pearlescent horn growing from its forehead.

Doom 8+ Hold 8+ Blast 9+ Trick 11+ Curse 8+ Fear 8+	
Movement:	Very Fast / Fly Size: Large
Armor:	1 HP: (5d6+15)x2
Attacks (8+):	hooves (2d6+2 blunt)
Special Feat:	A unicorn can perform the sanctuary and cure critical wounds miracles.
Con +2 Str +2 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +2 Cha +2	
Talents (3+):	Medicine, Alertness, Intuition, Survival
Senses:	Emotion Sense
Behavior (d6):	Intelligent - 1-4 wary, 5-6 friendly

Fey Monsters

The unbridled creativity and chaos of Faerie alone means that no bestiary can ever be complete; strange new beasts are spawned every day in the deep wilds of the Fey, some of whom will inevitably manage to survive in the Material world. A fey monster is similar to a fey beast, but its mind and body are too alien to be targeted with glamours such as call beasts or beast bond. As such, fey monsters can never be learned as wild shape forms.

Bloodstirge (Level 1)

Bloodstirges are giant, bloated mosquitoes with powerful gripping claws on their forelegs. While not particularly dangerous alone, a large swarm of bloodstirges can drain a mortal of blood in seconds.

Doom 17+ Hold 17+ Blast 11+ Trick 18+ Curse 14+ Fear —			
Movement:	Fly	Size:	Tiny
Armor:	0	HP:	1
Attacks (17+):	latch on (grapple), bite (1 hp)		
Con -3 Str -3	Dex +3 Int -4	Wis +0	Cha —
Talents (5+):	Agility, Stealth, Alertness		
Senses:	Can sense warm-blooded creatures from up to 10 paces away		

Drain Blood - A stirge that latches onto a victim will stay attached for 1d6 combat rounds. Each round, the victim must save vs. Doom or suffer -1 to Constitution (reducing both hit points and maximum hit points accordingly).

Lost Constitution is healed via bedrest before any hit point damage is regained naturally. It can also be healed with a restoration miracle.

Disease Carrier - A creature bitten by a stirge that achieves a critical hit, or a creature with a stirge latched onto it when that stirge is killed, must make a saving throw vs. Doom or contract a nasty bloodborn infection.

Rustgrub (Level 2)

Rustgrubs are the larvae of rust hulks, which are capable of chewing through and digesting metal. They are attracted to iron and steel but ignore flesh.

Harvesting - If properly harvested, a rustgrub yields 2d6 materia charges, half of which are water materia and half of which are stone materia.

Doom 11+ Hold 16+ Blast 15+ Trick 17+ Curse 15+ Fear —			
Movement:	Slow	Size:	Medium
Armor:	1	HP:	(2d6+4)
Attacks (17+):	bite (0 hp, sundering)		
Con +2 Str -3	Dex -2	Int -4	Wis -2 Cha —
Talents (4+):	Stealth		
Senses:	Can sense ferrous metals up to 5 paces away		

Rust Metal - A rustgrub's saliva will reduce the effectiveness of any steel weapon, shield, or armor by 1 point per round until it is either washed off, or the gear is completely destroyed. Any non-metallic gear with steel or iron fasteners instead makes a 12+ saving throw each round that it is exposed.

Spit - A rustgrub has two glamour, which it can spend to propel a gob of corrosive saliva at anyone within 3 paces that it senses is wearing steel armor or wielding a steel weapon (treat as a range 1 thrown attack). This deals zero hit point damage, but begins sundering steel weapons at 1 point per round until it is washed off, or the gear is completely destroyed.

Fire Beetle (Level 3)

Fire beetles are massive beetles the size of a large dog, with brightly glowing patches on the sides of their head and abdomen. When threatened, they can produce a corrosive and highly flammable substance, which they then ignite and spray at the source of the threat.

Harvesting - If properly harvested, a fire beetle yields 3d6 charges of flame materia.

Doom 10+ Hold 12+ Blast 12+ Trick 16+ Curse 12+ Fear —					
Movement:	Slow, Fly Slow		Size:	Small	
Armor:	3		HP:	(3d6+6)÷2	
Attacks (12+):	bite (1d6 hp)				
Con +2	Str +0	Dex +0	Int -4	Wis +0	Cha —
Talents (4+):	None				

Bioluminescence - A fire beetle’s lightspots produce bright light out to 2 paces, and dim light out to 5 paces.

Flamethrower - A fire beetle has three points of glamour, which it can use to generate a 4-pace cone of flame in front of it that inflicts 2d6 fire damage.

Cave Spider (Level 4)

Cave Spiders are overgrown spiders infused with energy from faerie. While some cave spiders foray aboveground, most make their homes in dark caverns or abandoned ruins, where they can spin elaborate webs to trap prey. Cave spider silk is an important ingredient in various alchemical potions and magic items.

Harvesting - A cave spider’s web can be harvested for 4d6 dinar worth of spider silk.

Doom 9+ Hold 10+ Blast 9+ Trick 15+ Curse 10+ Fear —					
Movement:	Climb		Size:	Large	
Armor:	1		HP:	(4d6+8)x2	
Attacks (10+):	ensnare (grapple), bite (2d6 poison)				
Con +2	Str +1	Dex +2	Int -4	Wis +1	Cha —
Talents (4+):	Agility, Stealth, Alertness				

Ensnaring Web - A creature grappled by the spider is restrained and immediately wrapped in webbing, immobilizing the victim until it saves to break free.

Poison Bite - A cave spider’s bite inflicts ongoing poison damage, making the victim's actions slower until they make a successful save vs. Doom.

Web Tremors - Cave spiders will lay almost invisibly thin strands of webbing across a large area surrounding their lair that conducts vibrations back to the spider, allowing it to sense the presence of any creature within 5’ of its web. Vibrations as subtle as breathing or a heartbeat can be picked up by the web. A cave spider’s webbing will typically stretch to cover an area up to 100’ from its lair.

Gelatinous Ooze (Level 5)

Gelatinous Oozes are giant slime-mold colonies infused with water materia, making them nearly transparent and enhancing their acidic mucus to supernatural levels. An ooze is a mindless creature, which simply moves forward inexorably as it engulfs and digests any organic matter that it comes across - leaving inorganic material embedded in its bulk. While in a corridor less than 3 paces wide, the ooze's shape perfectly fills the entire corridor to a depth and height of 10 feet.

Harvesting - An ooze's gelatinous remains can be alchemically processed to render 5d6 charges of water materia.

Doom 5+ Hold 6+ Blast 12+ Trick — Curse — Fear —	
Movement:	1 pace Size: Large
Armor:	3 (vulnerable cold) HP: 5d6+25
Attacks (6+):	engulf (grapple), dissolve (2d6 acid)
Con +5 Str +4 Dex -2 Int — Wis — Cha —	
Talents (2+):	Stealth

Paralyzing Mucus - Any creature grappled by the ooze suffers acid damage from a dissolve attack at the end of the round, and must also save vs. Hold to not be rendered helpless. Any creature that succeeds is hobbled and its actions are slower, but it may attempt to escape the ooze's grapple on its next action with another hard save vs. Hold.

Digestion - Any acid damage dealt to a living creature by the ooze also heals the ooze for that many hit points. If this increases the ooze above its current maximum hit points, it immediately increases in size until it can accommodate its new hit point total.

Mitosis - A large ooze that is reduced to below half its hit points by weapon damage splits into two medium-sized oozes, each with half the original creature's starting hit points; a medium ooze splits into two small oozes, and a small ooze splits into two tiny oozes.

Rust Hulk (Level 6)

Rust hulks appear to be a cross between a giant beetle and a gorilla, with a dark brown shell made of rusted iron.

Harvesting - If properly harvested, a rust hulk yields 6d6 charges of stone materia.

Doom 5+ Hold 5+ Blast 10+ Trick 11+ Curse 9+ Fear 9+			
Movement:	Slow, Fly Slow		Size: Large
Armor:	3	HP:	6d6 + 5 SP
Attacks (5+):	claws (2d6 blunt), mandibles (1d6 piercing)		
Con +4 Str +4	Dex -1	Int -2	Wis +0 Cha +0
Talents:	None		

Hard Shell - A rust hulk's structure points must be depleted before any hit point damage may be dealt, unless the attacker achieves a critical hit.

Frenzy - When any hit point damage is inflicted on a rust hulk, it may make two melee attacks on its next action.

Mimic (Level 7)

Mimics are a strange kind of air-breathing cephalopod, which can adjust its coloration and shape to match nearly any small or medium object. Mimics are extraordinarily clever animals; a mimic in a dungeon will often transform itself into the appearance of valuable treasure, in order to lure unwary adventurers close. Once its prey is close enough, it lashes out with six long, rope-like tentacles to draw the victim towards its beak.

Harvesting - If properly harvested, a mimic yields 7d6 charges of fey or dream materia.

Doom 8+ Hold 8+ Blast 5+ Trick 9+ Curse 8+ Fear 8+					
Movement:	Normal		Size:	Small	
Armor:	0		HP:	7d6÷2	
Attacks (9+):	grapple (reach 2), bite (2d6 piercing)				
Con +0 Str +0	Dex +3	Int -1	Wis +0	Cha +0	
Talents (3+):	Agility, Finesse, Stealth				

Crushing Hug - A mimic’s tentacles begin squeezing once they grapple a target, dealing 1d6 bashing damage per round. Biting any target that it has already grappled is easier.

Poison Bite - Any creature bitten by a mimic is poisoned, slowing its actions until it makes a successful save vs. Doom.

Camouflage - Detecting a camouflaged mimic is a hard Alertness check. Mimics prefer to attack from ambush with their grappling tentacles; a hidden mimic can sneak attack like a Scout or Hunter. Any successful sneak attack also hobbles its target.

Roper & Piercers (Level 8)

A Roper is a mollusc that evolved to metabolize Earth materia, allowing it to grow to enormous size and camouflage itself as a stalagmite. Its young are called piercers, and hang from the ceiling near their parent, waiting to drop on unsuspecting creatures and impale them with their sharp shells.

Harvesting - If properly harvested, a roper’s shell yields 8d6 charges of stone materia.

Doom 5+ Hold 5+ Blast 5+ Trick 9+ Curse 7+ Fear 7+			
Movement:	climb 3 paces	Size:	Large
Armor:	3	HP:	8d6 + 6 SP
Attacks (5+ x2):	4 tentacles (grapple), bite (1d6 piercing)		
Con +4 Str +2	Dex +2 Int -2	Wis +0	Cha +0
Talents (4+):	Agility, Finesse, Stealth		

Hard Shell - A roper’s structure points must be depleted before any hit point damage may be dealt, unless the attacker achieves a critical hit. Its shell is indistinguishable from a stalagmite when not moving.

Paralyzing Bite - The roper’s bite injects a paralyzing poison, slowing the victim's actions until it successfully saves vs. Doom. An affected creature is also hobbled until they save.

Piercer Nest - The roper will be accompanied by 1d6+1 piercers (small 1 hd larval ropers with 2 hp and 1 sp each), which cling to the ceiling and resemble stalactites. Piercers drop down on creatures grappled by the roper; treat each dropping piercer as a sneak attack with an attack threshold of 12+ that deals 1d6 piercing damage and achieves a critical hit if the damage die rolls a '6'. Piercers that critically hit embed themselves into the target and must be dug out, or they will keep their host paralyzed as they slowly devour them from the inside. Digging out a piercer requires a hard Medicine check while inflicting damage onto the victim with a dagger.

The Fair Folk

"The Fair Folk" is the traditional name for intelligent Fey creatures that can appear in a mortal guise, but whose natural forms are not made of Material substance. The Fair Folk are universally dangerous, although some can be successfully bargained with by those who are sufficiently careful and clever.

Each Fair Folk is a unique creature, and most defy categorization - although mortals are still wont to try. At best, the Fair Folk can be categorized by their apparent elemental correspondences, motivations, and modus operandi - although all of these are subject to change at the whim of the eldritch intelligences behind their fey masks.

The Fair Folk are fickle and treacherous, but they can be bound by geasa, and can bind mortals with geasa in turn. A Fair Folk that chooses to willingly bind itself by oath to treat peacefully with mortals is known in civilization as a Numen. Compared to an unbound Fair Folk, the demeanor of a Numen is surprisingly benevolent, and the longer a Numen and its mortal subjects remain true to their oaths, the more benevolent and humane its temperament becomes.

Mortal travelers are advised to be exceptionally wary of any Fair Folk they meet; they are known to delight in tricking mortals, and their words carry weight that can entrap even the cleverest of sages. The Church advises any mortal that has an unusual run-in with the fey to immediately flee, and report their experience to the nearest place of worship, where the local clergy will hopefully be better-equipped to handle the situation.

While the Fair Folk appear human, their bodies are merely constructs of Materia, woven out of the Elemental Chaos as they pass through towards the Material. As fey, their bodies are vulnerable to cold iron, which is any unalloyed iron dug up from the ground (not smelted from ore) that has never been heated enough to glow.

Damage to a fey creature from any cold iron weapon inflicts disadvantage on all saving throws until it heals. Any damage inflicted to a Fair Folk that is not from a cold iron weapon is only temporary; upon "death", their essence simply flees back into the Elemental Chaos, where they weave themselves a new body and return again to vex the mortals that "vanquished" them.

A Fair Folk that takes an "interest" in a particular mortal is a recipe for legendary tales of woe and hardship. Their mercurial natures make them just as dangerous to "friend" and "foe" alike, and it is impossible whether rescuing a Fair Folk or killing it is more likely to lead to that Fair Folk falling madly in love or swearing an undying oath of vengeance. Hence the Church's stance to best let them be, hurry on one's way, and tell the nearest Pastor.

Within Faerie, accepting any kind of help or generosity from the Fair Folk makes one vulnerable to both their beguiling glammers and their primal oath-weaving. Many tales end with a hapless mortal supping with an unknown stranger, only to find that they have been bound into service by a Fair Folk trickster looking for a new "pet".

Numina are far more generous and benevolent with their gifts and their oaths, sanctifying promises made within their sacred groves and offering their bounty freely to all those who have honored their pacts. A Fair Folk who becomes a Numen might choose to release their mortal captives upon conversion, or those captives might find themselves permanently bound into service to the new Numen - which will at least be substantially less unpleasant than "service" to an unbound Fair Folk master.

Wisp

(Level 1)

Wisps are tiny, barely-sentient bundles of materia that occasionally manifest within faerie. Nearly indestructible, a wisp that suffers any damage at all will dissipate, then re-form at the next sunrise or sunset. Wisps come in five elemental aspects – stone, water, wood, air, and flame. They are believed to be the “larval” form of other fair folk, eventually evolving into more powerful forms once they have gained enough experience to choose a coherent shape and personality.

Doom – Hold –	Blast 12+ Trick 15+ Curse 14+ Fear 12+
Movement:	Fly Size: Tiny
Armor:	0 HP: 1
Attacks (12+):	The wisp can make a ranged attack out to 2 paces which inflicts 1d6 elemental damage
Con – Str –	Dex +2 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +2
Talents (5+):	Alertness, Survival

Primal Magic - The wisp can cast a first-circle primal glamour of its element.

Familiar Pact - By swearing a mutual geas with a druid, a wisp can receive up to three glamour from that druid, allowing it to cast first-, second-, or third-circle elemental glammers of its element by spending glamour equal to the desired effect's circle. A wisp bound to a druid no longer has their own glamour, but must use whatever is granted them by their druid companion.

Regeneration - a Wisp reduced to 0 hit points does not die, but instead regenerates at the next sunrise or sunset, emerging out of the nearest natural occurrence of its element.

Wisps and Druids

At the referee’s discretion, a druid harvesting materia from an environment might discover a wisp - a small piece of sentient materia that must be befriended or bargained with before it can be harvested and used. Elemental wisps typically manifest as small, sentient creatures made out of their element, which appear as tiny balls of ghostly light until they choose to reveal their full corporal forms to a mortal. Wisps are capable of speech and locomotion, but are typically content to rest in a druid’s pockets once a pact of service is settled on.

Wisps are fickle, so keeping them happy and willing to serve a druid can be challenging, but the rewards are often worth it - investing elemental glamour into a wisp allows that wisp to cast and maintain any glamour that matches its element, of any circle up to the amount of glamour invested into it, on behalf of the druid it has bonded with.

A first level druid may invest one glamour into a wisp; a third level druid may invest up to two glamour into a single wisp, and a fifth level druid may invest up to three glamour into any one wisp. A wisp may use this glamour to cast any elemental effect that matches its own element, and any glamour cast by a wisp is sustained by that wisp rather than the druid.

In addition to its spellcasting aid, a wisp provides a druid with something akin to a wizard’s cantrips - small, at-will magics related to their elemental aspect. A flame wisp might provide a spark to light a campfire, an air wisp might accurately predict today’s weather for a druid, or a water wisp might help a druid resist being poisoned. Each wisp can also provide a simple elemental attack out to 5 paces, which uses the druid’s ranged attack throw and inflicts 1d6 damage on a hit.

Wisps are hardy little creatures, which can regenerate their bodies from the tiniest spark of elemental energy, and retreat into Faerie when that body is damaged or destroyed. A wisp that is hurt too often in the service of a druid will likely abandon that druid, but otherwise they are nigh indestructible companions.

Pixie

(Level 2)

Pixies appear to be diminutive elves with beautiful, diaphanous insect wings that sparkle in iridescent colors. All pixies are natural wellsprings of primal fey magic – a newborn pixie is able to cast primal spells almost as quickly as a newborn foal is able to take its first steps. Pixies tend to see their magic as a natural extension of themselves, and thus do not usually think to use tools or technology the way the “big folk” do. A pixie is typically too small to wield a weapon larger than a sewing needle.

Doom 13+ Hold 13+ Blast 10+ Trick 13+ Curse 11+ Fear 11+	
Movement:	Slow, Fly Size: Tiny
Armor:	0 HP: 3
Attacks (10+):	The pixie can make a ranged attack out to 5 paces which inflicts 2d6 psychic, aetheric, or elemental damage of its choice.
Con +0 Str +0 Dex +3 Int +0 Wis +2 Cha +2	
Talents (4+): Finesse, Stealth, Survival, Charm, Wit	

Primal Magic - As a druid.

Boggle

(Level 3)

In their natural form, boggles appear to be small, twisted grey goblins with oversized heads, eyes, and hands. They frequently change shape to attempt to frighten away interlopers, taking on the form and apparent behavior of any living thing that they have observed long enough to mimic.

Doom 12+ Hold 12+ Blast 12+ Trick 12+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+	
Movement:	Normal Size: Small
Armor:	0 HP: (3d6)÷2
Attacks (8+):	The boggle can make eye contact with a target to make a ranged attack out to 5 paces which inflicts 1d6 psychic damage and frightens the target unless they save.
Con +0 Str +0 Dex +0 Int +0 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Talents (4+): Finesse, Stealth, Intuition, Survival, Wit	

Shapeshift - The boggle has three glamour. It can spend one glamour as an exploration action to change its appearance and voice to match any other small, medium, or large creature it has closely observed for one previous exploration turn.

Goodfellow

(Level 4)

Goodfellow are Fair Folk that wander deserted highways and unbroken earth, pretending to be mortal travelers. They may appear as any kind of mortal imaginable, but often appear as an elf, hob, or goblin. A goodfellow will often have a particular unusual feature that might reveal their fey nature to a perceptive mortal - such as backward-facing hands or feet, eyes that don't reflect the light as they should, or hair that blows the wrong way in the wind.

A goodfellow that is spotted for what it is will typically immediately promise aid of some kind to the “clever mortal” that saw through its disguise, in exchange for a promise in kind to never tell another mortal soul about its true nature. Keeping this promise will usually “reward” the mortal with an even mixture of aid and mischief, while breaking the promise - even accidentally - will curse the mortal with no end of bad luck.

Doom 11+ Hold 11+ Blast 11+ Trick 11+ Curse 9+ Fear 9+	
Movement:	Normal Size: Medium
Armor:	1 (0) HP: 4d6
Attacks (10+):	feysilver rapier (1d6 piercing)
Con +0 Str +0 Dex +0 Int +0 Wis +2 Cha +2	
Talents (4+): Finesse, Lore, Survival, Charm, Wit	

Primal Magic - As a druid.

Geas - Once per encounter as its action, the goodfellow can spend three glamour to cause any promise made or implied to become a sworn geas, binding the speaker to its word.

Thyrs (Level 5)

Thyrsa are a form of stone troll that form barbarian tribes across the wilds of Europa. All thyrsa have an innate affinity for stone and an aversion to sunlight, suffering 2d6 petrification damage per round when in bright sunlight, or 1d6 damage per round when in dim or diffuse sunlight.

Thyrsa are intelligent creatures, and often have the champion, hunter, or druid class template. While often solitary, more sociable trolls occasionally gather together in family dwellings, or even establish small villages.

Doom 6+ Hold 6+ Blast 12+ Trick 10+ Curse 9+ Fear 10+					
Movement:	Normal		Size:	Large	
Armor:	2		HP:	(5d6+20)x2	
Attacks (5+):	per wielded weapon; as a Large creature, a thyrs's weapon attacks deal 2x damage.				
Con +4	Str +4	Dex -2	Int +0	Wis +1	Cha +0
Talents (3+):		Science, Survival, Medicine			

Regenerate - The thyrs may spend one glamour to roll a hit die, then recover that many hit points.

Stoneheart - Thyrsa lose their regeneration ability until the next sunrise or sunset when exposed to sunlight, which inflicts 2d6 damage per round until the troll is turned to stone. At the next sunset, a troll that has been turned to stone immediately un-petrifies and rolls all its hit dice to heal.

Hag (Level 6)

Hags are fair folk nightmares that embody mortals' fear of strangers and sorcery. In their natural form, a hag appears to be a hideously ugly, impossibly old woman with a maw full of razor-sharp teeth. However, most hags will cast illusions over themselves and their surroundings, most often in order to appear as kindly old women living in warm, inviting cottages.

Hags collect all manner of magical trinkets, regardless of their use to the hag, but items that aid in weaving illusions are especially coveted. They also delight in enslaving mortals, and turning them to cannibalism and depravity. A hag will occasionally "adopt" a goblin orc tribe, granting them magical protection in exchange for any shiny baubles they can bring back from their raids.

Doom 7+ Hold 7+ Blast 7+ Trick 7+ Curse 7+ Fear 7+					
Con +1 (7+)		Str +1 (7+)		Dex +1 (7+)	
Int +1 (7+)		Wis +1 (7+)		Cha +1 (7+)	
Movement:		Normal		Size:	Medium
Armor:		0		HP:	6d6+6
Attacks (8+):		Evil Eye (10 pace ranged attack, 2d6 psychic stunning damage).			
Con +1	Str +1	Dex +1	Int +1	Wis +1	Cha +1
Talents (3+):		Survival, Intuition, Medicine, Wit			

Primal Magic -As a druid.

Nymphs

Nymphs are fey spirits that embody the primal Material elements - stone, water, wood, air, and flame. While most Fair Folk move freely between the Aether and the Material, nymphs choose to anchor themselves into the Material and Faerie, giving up some freedom in exchange for a deeper connection to the playground of the mortal world.

Nymphs invariably manifest as beautiful men or women carved from living materia, with features taken from the specific stone, water, tree, ravine, or hearth they are bound to. A nymph numen will become a fierce protector of the mortals under its care, so long as those mortals are equally fierce protectors of its tree and the surrounding lands.

When a druid casts the Nature's Ally spell without specifying a creature for their wisp familiar to transform into, the wisp will almost always manifest as a nymph of the appropriate element. This tendency, plus the marked resemblance of most wisps to "baby" nymphs, lends credence to the theory that wisps are somehow the 'larval' forms of nymphs. Since a wisp's material anchor is their druid, a wisp-nymph's magics must be fed by their druid's primal attunements, rather than their own innate glamour.

Oreiad (Level 7)

Oreïades are nymphs that bind themselves to the earth itself, usually to a particular large boulder, vein of crystal, or precious metal.

Doom 5+ Hold 7+ Blast 8+ Trick 8+ Curse 5+ Fear 5+			
Movement:	Normal	Size:	Medium
Armor:	3	HP:	7d6+9 + 2SP
Attacks (7+):	obsidian shards (1d6 piercing)		
Con +3 Str +1	Dex +0 Int +0	Wis +3	Cha +3
Talents (3+):	Intuition, Survival, Charm		

Primal Magic - The oreiad may cast any Stone- or Fey-aspected glamour by spending glamour equal to its circle.

Recharge - As its action, the oreiad may regain one primal attunement if it is touching solid unbroken earth or natural stone or bedrock.

Regenerate - As its action, the oreiad rolls 1d6+3 and heals that many hit points, or one structure point if it rolls 10 or higher. The oreiad must be on natural stone or bedrock to perform this action.

Naiad (Level 7)

Like all nymphs, Naiads are fey spirits that choose to bind themselves to living matter. A naiad binds themselves to a river, brook, lake, or other body of water.

Naiad numina are fiercely loyal to their mortal subjects, so long as the health and purity of their waters are protected. A naiad numen whose water becomes polluted rapidly becomes corrupted and evil, delighting both in wanton destruction and minor acts of sadistic cruelty.

Ocean naiad, called nereid, bind themselves to a particular bay or inlet or other piece of coastland. They are less likely to become numen, but those that do are unparalleled protectors of the sailors within sight of their shores.

Doom 7+ Hold 7+ Blast 5+ Trick 8+ Curse 5+ Fear 5+			
Movement:	Swim 20		Size: Medium
Armor:	0		HP: 7d6+7
Attacks (7+):	watery grapple (1d6 bashing)		
Con +1 Str +1	Dex +3 Int +0	Wis +3	Cha +3
Talents (3+):	Intuition, Survival, Wit		

Primal Magic - The naiad may cast any Water- or Fey-aspected glamour by spending glamour equal to its circle.

Recharge - As its action, the naiad may regain one primal attunement if it is touching its body of water.

Regenerate - As its action, the naiad rolls 1d6+1 and heals that many hit points. The naiad must be within 100' of its body of water to perform this action.

Dryad (Level 7)

Dryads are nymphs that choose to bind themselves to a single living tree. Eventually, their fey nature takes on enough aspects of the tree that its survival and health becomes their greatest passion.

Dryad numen are particularly benevolent, working to ensure bountiful harvests for their mortal subjects in exchange for protection from fire, disease, and drought. In exchange, any damage to their sacred tree - whether intentional or not - must be met with swift and cruel punishment, meted out within the dryad's sacred grove.

Doom 6+ Hold 7+ Blast 6+ Trick 8+ Curse 5+ Fear 5+			
Movement:	Normal	Size:	Medium
Armor:	1	HP:	7d6+14
Attacks (7+):	thorn rake (1d6 poison)		
Con +2 Str +1	Dex +2	Int +0	Wis +3 Cha +3
Talents (3+):	Intuition, Survival, Medicine, Charm		

Primal Magic - The dryad may cast any Wood- or Fey-aspected glamour by spending glamour equal to its circle.

Recharge - As its action, the dryad may regain one primal attunement if it is touching its tree.

Regenerate - As its action, the dryad rolls 1d6+2 and heals that many hit points. The dryad must be within 100' of its tree to perform this action.

Auriad (Level 7)

Unlike other nymphs, Auriads choose to remain unbound from a single piece of base matter, embodying the freedom and capriciousness of the winds themselves. Auriads almost never become numina, finding the binding nature of oaths inimical to their very natures.

Doom 8+ Hold 8+ Blast 6+ Trick 8+ Curse 5+ Fear 5+
Con +0 (8+) Str +0 (8+) Dex +2 (6+)
Int +0 (8+) Wis +3 (5+) Cha +3 (5+)
Movement: Fly 20 Size: Medium
Armor: 0 HP: 7d6
Attacks: resonant scream (1d6 thunder)
Con +0 Str +0 Dex +2 Int +0 Wis +3 Cha +3
Talents (3+): Agility, Stealth, Science, Lore, Intuition, Survival, Wit

Primal Magic - The auriad may cast any Air- or Fey-aspected primal glamour by spending glamour equal to its circle.

Recharge - As its action, the auriad may regain one primal attunement if it is unrestrained and flying under the open sky.

Regenerate - As its action, the dryad rolls 1d6 and heals that many hit points. The auriad must be unrestrained and flying under the open sky.

Hestaiad (Level 7)

Hestaiads are nymphs who choose to incarnate as sacred hearth-flames and household guardians. Most hestaiads are drawn to peaceful households and sacred sites, and offer themselves up as numina almost immediately upon first manifesting a material body.

Those hestaiads who remain wild fair folk are terrifying elemental forces of rage and wildfire, eager to consume and burn down all that they see. Once they have devoured everything burnable, a wild hestaiad will typically gutter and “die”, returning to the Elemental Chaos until a new opportunity to burn and consume presents itself.

Doom 7+ Hold 7+ Blast 5+ Trick 8+ Curse 5+ Fear 5+
Con +1 (7+) Str +1 (7+) Dex +3 (5+)
Int +0 (8+) Wis +3 (5+) Cha +3 (5+)
Movement: Dash 25 Size: Medium
Armor: 0 HP: 7d6+7
Attacks: burning touch (1d6 fire)
Con +1 Str +1 Dex +3 Int +0 Wis +3 Cha +3
Talents (3+): Intuition, Survival, Medicine, Charm

Primal Magic - The hestaiad may cast any Flame- or Fey-aspected primal glamour by spending glamour equal to its circle.

Recharge - As its action, the hestaiad may regain one primal attunement if it is within its hearth.

Regenerate - As its action, the hestaiad rolls 1d6+1 and heals that many hit points. The hestaiad must be within its hearth to perform this action.

Leannán-Sí (Level 8)

The Leannán-Sí is an achingly beautiful Fair Folk seductress, who promises eternal love to a mortal in exchange for their vitality and life-force. A Leannán-Sí is not necessarily female; the fey spirit will reach into the mind of a vulnerable mortal, and weave itself a body that most perfectly matches that mortal's desires. While it survives in this form, that mortal's saving throws vs. Trick from the Leannán-Sí are harder.

Doom 8+ Hold 8+ Blast 5+ Trick 6+ Curse 6+ Fear 5+			
Movement:	Normal		Size: Medium
Armor:	0		HP: 8d6-16
Attacks:	none, but can cast beguile at-will.		
Con -2 Str -2	Dex +2	Int +1	Wis +1 Cha +5
Talents (2+):		Finesse, Intuition, Charm, Wit	

Primal Magic - The leannan-si has ten glamour, which it can spend to cast primal effects. Casting a primal glamour costs a number of glamour equal to its circle.

Fey Seductress - All of the Leanan-Sí's beguiling effects are harder to resist.

Drain Essence - As its action, the Leanan-Sí may touch a willing mortal, inflicting a critical hit as the mortal visibly ages 1d6 years. The Leanan-Sí then regains one glamour.

A chosen mortal who swears their undying love to the Leannán-Sí receives its earnest and undying love in return, and will be genuinely cherished and protected as it gradually drains their life-force.

Horned Hunter (Level 9)

The Horned Hunter is an impossibly tall, intimidating Fair Folk hunter with elk antlers growing from its head, wearing hunting-garb woven from forest leaves. It often rides a Nightmare steed, and is surrounded by fey spirits that take the guise of Dire Wolves, which serve as its hunting-hounds.

Doom 5+ Hold 5+ Blast 5+ Trick 8+ Curse 5+ Fear 5+			
Movement:	Very Fast	Size:	Large
Armor:	2	HP:	(9d6+36)x2
Attacks (5+ x2):	Legendary Aetheric Blade dagger (1d6+Str+4 piercing sneak attack), Legendary Windbow greatbow (2d6+4 piercing and poison sneak attack)		
Con +4 Str +4	Dex +4	Int +1	Wis +4 Cha +0
Talents (2+):	Agility, Stealth, Intuition, Alertness, Survival, Bearing		

Primal Hunter - The horned hunter has ten glamour, which it can spend to cast elemental primal effects. Casting a primal glamour costs a number of glamour equal to its circle.

Wild Hunt - As its action, the Horned Hunter may designate a quarry for its hunt. While it maintains focus, it unerringly knows the distance and direction to its quarry, regardless of any natural or supernatural means of concealment or misdirection, and it can always recognize its quarry despite any disguise or illusion.

Dragons

Before the world belonged to mortals, it was the domain of the dragons. When the Starfall destroyed their civilization, a precious few used draconic magic to escape into the Elemental Chaos, where they waited until they could return to the Prime Material.

Those that survived found the world changed, host to the mammalian mortal races and their fey echoes. A great schism formed within Dragonkind, over whether to wipe out these furry upstarts and restore the world to its former glory, or aid the new mortal races as they reached for heights that only the elder dragons fully understood.

The so-called Celestial Dragons began guiding human civilization from its earliest beginnings. Indeed, some of them claim that it was they who directly shaped humanity from the small, furry creatures inhabiting the savannas deep to the south of Khemet's Itru river. Regardless of the truth, the celestial dragons aided mortalkind in the discovery of agriculture, medicine, and magic.

The Primordial Dragons, on the other hand, set about to restore their civilization. Enough of their lizardfolk servants survived with them to begin rebuilding their civilization, and so the primordials and their kobold servants began to colonize the tropical jungles that most reminded them of their homes. The Primordial Dragons of the Jambud jungles even welcomed serpentfolk centaurs into their ranks, bolstering their numbers in the early days of their new empire.

Dragonscale — In addition to hit points, all dragons' hides are protected by a thick layer of dragonscale. Before any hit point damage can be dealt to a dragon, this armor must be penetrated.

Draconic Lizardfolk and Serpentfolk

Lizardfolk and serpentfolk under the sway of a dragon are not technically orcs, but the distinction is often lost on civilized mortals. They still practice a form of ritualized cannibalism, and often perform gruesome blood sacrifices for their dragon masters.

Serpentfolk

(Level 1 to 5)

Con +0	Str +1	Dex +1	Int +0	Wis +2	Cha +0
Movement:		Normal		Size:	Medium
Armor:		0		HP:	(per hd)

Kobold

(Level 1 to 3, Small)

Con +0	Str +1	Dex +1	Int +0	Wis +0	Cha -1
Movement:		Normal		Size:	Small
Armor:		1		HP:	(per hd)÷2

Troglodyte

(Level 2 to 4)

Con +1	Str +2	Dex +1	Int +0	Wis +0	Cha +0
Movement:		Normal		Size:	Medium
Armor:		2		HP:	(per hd)

Dragonborn

(Level 3 to 5, Large)

Con +2	Str +3	Dex +1	Int +0	Wis +0	Cha +0
Movement:		Normal		Size:	Large
Armor:		3		HP:	(per hd)x2

Cockatrice and Basilisk

Cockatrices and Basilisks are a form of devolved Earth-aspected Primordial Dragon. While millennia of inbreeding and mutation has resulted in a degenerate species of dragon with only animalistic intelligence, a cockatrice still poses a significant danger to an adventuring party. All cockatrices are male, while all basilisks are female.

At first glance, a cockatrice appears to be a scaly cross between a lizard, a bat, and a rooster, with four bird-like legs, a long serpentine tail, and a cockscomb. Adult cockatrices rarely grow larger than three feet in length from beak to tail.

Basilisks, on the other hand, appear to be massive six-legged crocodiles with a grey, stone-like hide. They often possess a crown of short, thick horns adorning the backs of their heads.

A cockatrice or basilisk's Earth Pearl is visible on its forehead, and both its Pearl and its milky-white eyes glow with an eerie light. Any creature that catches the cockatrice or basilisk's gaze is stunned, and hobbled until they save to shake it off. Any creature that continues to meet its gaze is turned to stone over several seconds. Even a partial glance is excruciatingly painful, as thin slivers of stone begin growing and spreading within the victim's muscles and other tissues.

Cockatrice

(Level 3)

Doom 11+ Hold 10+ Blast 9+ Trick 14+ Curse 10+ Fear 10+			
Movement:	Fly	Size:	Small
Armor:	5 (dragonscale)	HP:	1d6+ISP
Attacks (10+):	bite (1d6+2 piercing), claws (1d6 slashing)		
Con -1 Str +0	Dex +3	Int +0	Wis +0 Cha +0
Talents (2+):	Stealth, Survival		
Senses:	Dragons have a form of heat vision, allowing them to see warm-blooded creatures in total darkness.		

Petrify - The cockatrice has 3 points of ichor, which it can spend to make a 3d6 stunning petrification gaze attack in a 10-pace cone. Any creature stunned by the cockatrice's gaze must save vs. Hold or be immobilized and suffer a critical hit; a creature reduced to 0 hit points by its petrification attack is turned completely to stone, and can only be revived with a remove curse or similar effect.

Basilisk

(Level 8)

Doom 5+ Hold 5+ Blast 8+ Trick 11+ Curse 7+ Fear 9+			
Movement:	Normal	Size:	Large
Armor:	5 (dragonscale)	HP:	8d6 + 8SP
Attacks (5+):	bite (1D6+5 piercing structural), claws (1D6+5 slashing structural), tail bash (2D6 bashing structural)		
Con +5 Str +5	Dex -1	Int -4	Wis +0 Cha -2
Talents (2+):	Stealth, Survival		
Senses:	Dragons have a form of heat vision, allowing them to see warm-blooded creatures in total darkness.		

Petrify - The basilisk has 8 points of ichor, which it can spend to make a 3d6 stunning petrification gaze attack in a 10-pace cone. Any creature stunned by the basilisk's gaze must save vs. Hold or be immobilized and suffer a critical hit; a creature reduced to 0 hit points by its petrification attack is turned completely to stone, and can only be revived with a remove curse or similar effect.

Celestial Dragon (Level 8)

While smaller and weaker than their Primordial kin, a Celestial dragon is still a terrifying force of nature. Many Celestial dragons set themselves up as local gods and protectors, much like the Fair Folk; some of these beings have even become Numina under the aegis of the holy Church, taking their place within the Faith as incarnate protectors of a place or people. A Celestial Dragon numen's various lizardfolk and serpentfolk servants find themselves in an awkward position, as does the Church; so long as the cannibalistic fertility rites necessary for their reproduction are performed willingly, posthumously, and only upon their own kind, the representatives of the Church in most Successor Kingdoms will do their best to look the other way.

While Primordial Dragons are colored based on the elemental energies they have infused into their bodies, the scales of Celestial Dragons are typically a brilliant array of metallic hues and lustrous gem-like inclusions. No two Celestial Dragons have the same coloration, but translucent scales of ruby-red, jade-green, amethyst-purple, and turquoise-blue are common, usually in alternating stripes against metallic shades of bronze, copper, silver, gold, or rainbow metallic patinas.

All Celestial dragons are made, not born. A dragonborn lizardfolk that has lived for a century and proven itself worthy undergoes a primal ritual, where they consume and merge with a Dragon Pearl over an arduous month-long process of transformation. Once its mortality has been fully burned away by the materia's power, the new Celestial dragon takes its place as a leader of its tribe.

Celestial Dragons are much less inimical to humankind than their Primordial cousins. Some celestial dragons claim to have been the source of the myth of the fabled Serpents of Paradise - a corrupted memory of their original role, they claim, of uplifting the ancestors of human and dwarfkind from simple apes into true thinking beings. Certainly, many celestial dragons show credible linkages to ancient serpent-cults in prehistoric Europa and Asia.

Doom 5+	Hold 5+	Blast 5+	Trick 5+	Curse 5+	Fear 5+
Movement:	Fly Fast (hover)		Size:	Large	
Armor:	5 (dragonscale)		HP:	8d6 + 6SP	
Attacks (5+):	bite (1D6 piercing structural), claws (1D6 sundering structural), tail bash (1D6+4 blunt structural)				
Con +4	Str +4	Dex +4	Int +4	Wis +4	Cha +4
Talents (2+):	All skills				
Senses:	Dragons have a form of heat vision, allowing them to see warm-blooded creatures in total darkness.				

Dragonscale - In addition to hit points, a dragon's hide is protected by a thick layer of dragonscale. Before any hit point damage can be dealt to the dragon, this armor must be penetrated.

Elemental Ichor - The dragon has nine points of elemental ichor. It may cast any glamour by spending charge equal to its circle, or may spend charge on the following feats:

Breath Attack - The dragon makes a breath attack with a 30-pace cone area, which inflicts 1D6 structural elemental damage to everything along its path.

Focused Breath - The dragon spends 3 ichor to make a breath attack with a 60-pace line area, which inflicts 2D6 structural elemental damage to everything along its path. If the line is stopped short by a barrier, roll each damage die one at a time against the barrier until it gives way; if it does, the line continues past the barrier reduced by the number of damage dice rolled.

Primordial Wyrmling (Level 9)

While Celestial dragons are impressively powerful beings, they are not the pinnacle of draconic potential. Before the Starfall, Celestial dragons discovered a means to transform themselves into a new class of being, the Primordial dragon, through a dark and bloody ritual.

A Celestial dragon must tear out its own Dragon Pearl, alchemically refine it, and then bathe it in the heartsblood of thousands of worthy mortals over the course of a century. Once the pearl is sufficiently anointed it is re-implanted, and the transformation into a Primordial wyrm is rapid and spectacular.

Primordial wyrmlings are ravenously hungry both for meat and precious metals, which their bodies alchemically smelt into orichalc and feysilver. These materials are incorporated into the wyrmling’s scales as it grows, giving it nearly impenetrable armor and greatly enhancing its magical abilities.

Doom 5+ Hold 5+ Blast 5+ Trick 5+ Curse 5+ Fear 5+			
Movement:	Fly Fast	Size:	Large
Armor:	5 (dragonscale)	HP:	9d6 + 9SP
Attacks (5+ x2):	bite (1D6+1 piercing structural), claws (1D6+1 sundering structural), wing buffet (5d6 thunder), tail bash (1D6+5 blunt structural)		
Con +5 Str +5	Dex +5	Int +5	Wis +5 Cha +5
Talents (2+):	All skills		
Senses:	Dragons have a form of heat vision, allowing them to see warm-blooded creatures in total darkness.		

Dragonscale - In addition to hit points, a dragon’s hide is protected by a thick layer of dragonscale. Before any hit point damage can be dealt to the dragon, this armor must be penetrated. While any structure points remain in a location, a primordial dragon halves all elemental damage to that location that matches its element.

Elemental Ichor - The dragon has ten points of elemental ichor. It may cast any glamour of its element by spending charge equal to its circle, or may cast a glamour of any other element by spending charge equal to twice its circle. It can also spend charge on the following feats:

Breath Attack - The dragon makes a breath attack in a 10-pace cone, which inflicts 2D6 structural elemental damage to everything along its path.

Focused Breath - The dragon can spend 3 ichor to make a breath attack in a 50-pace line, which inflicts 3D6 structural elemental damage to everything along its path. If the line is stopped short by a barrier, roll each damage die one at a time against the barrier until it gives way; if it does, the line continues past the barrier reduced by the number of damage dice rolled to penetrate it.

The Undead

An undead creature is any being from the Shadow which has pushed through to manifest into the Material world. Breaching the veil requires an enormous amount of willpower and drive, so only those beings with intense unresolved passions manage it.

The undead are chiefly divided into two categories - ghosts and wights. A ghost is any undead being which does not possess a corporeal form, but instead uses its sheer will to exert influence over the material world via miracle-like effects. A wight, on the other hand, is a corpse animated by undead energy from the Shadow - either a mere animated construct such as a skeleton or a plague-shambler, or a being animated by its own possessing ghost, such as a revenant or a vampire.

The energies that animate the undead are inimical to the life-force that flows through all living beings. When a priest performs any miracle that would heal an undead creature's hit points, that miracle instead inflicts an amount of damage equal to the amount it would normally heal. If the healing miracle has a range of touch, the priest must make a melee attack throw in order to touch it. If a priest miracle heals multiple creatures, it heals those that are living while simultaneously damaging those that are undead.

All undead are also vulnerable to feysilver. Damage to an undead creature from any feysilver weapon makes all saving throws harder until it heals.

Ghosts

Ghosts, the most common form of undead, are those restless spirits who do not possess a material body. As spirits, they are immune to physical attacks, and reducing them to 0 hit points merely forces them back across the Veil into the Shadow, where they cannot return to the mortal world until after sundown, within the 3 days around the next full moon.

Truly ridding a haunting of a ghost requires fulfilling its unfinished business, or binding it with divine oaths to abandon the Material world; both are tasks for a Priest, especially one dedicated to the Death domain.

Spirit Form - As incorporeal beings, ghosts are immune to all damage except force, psychic, and radiant damage. When its hit points are reduced to zero it is banished, and cannot manifest again until the next sunrise or sunset.

Shade (Level 1)

Shades are the sad echoes of mortals who die with will and passion sufficient to keep fighting for something, but insufficient to hold onto their identity and consciousness. A shade repeats a few scripted sets of actions, over and over again, until the passion that drove it to manifest is fulfilled. Any attempt to interfere with a shade's routine will be met with terrifying hostility.

Doom — Hold —	Blast 14+ Trick —	Curse 14+ Fear —
Movement:	Fly	Size: medium
Armor:	0 (immaterial)	HP: 1
Attacks (14+):	2d6 stunning necrotic damage; achieves a critical hit if either damage die rolls a '6'.	

Wraith (Level 2 to 5)

Wraiths are the spirits of mortals with sufficient willpower to maintain their identity and consciousness as they cross the Veil into Shadow. While most ghosts choose to move onto the Everafter, or content themselves in Shadow with maintaining their descendants' ancestor-cults, a rare few vex the living with darker passions.

Con — Str —	Dex *	Int +0	Wis *	Cha *
Armor:	0 (immaterial)	HP:	per hd	
Movement:	Fly	Size:	Medium	
Attacks (*):	2d6 stunning necrotic damage; achieves a critical hit if either damage die rolls a '6'.			
Talents (2+):	any that it had in life.			

Necromancy - The wraith has dark faith equal to its level, which it may use to cast any curse from the Death domain.

Wights

Wights are those undead which possess corporeal form. The most common wights are animated skeletons and revenants - mindless automata restored to a mockery of life by necromancy, possessing all the malice and fear and rage of the Shadow but no independent thought or will.

Animated Corpse - Any mortal, natural animal, or fey beast can be made into a skeleton or shambler. Wights are immune to poison, psychic, and necrotic damage, and automatically succeed at any saves vs. Fear.

Skeleton

(Level 1 to 3)

Con +2	Str +0	Dex +0	Int -2	Wis -2	Cha —
Movement:	varies		Size:		varies
Armor:	Per worn armor		HP:		per hd
Attacks (*):	per wielded weapon.				

Skeletons suffer half damage from piercing weapons, but 2x damage from blunt weapons. They are instantly slain by any divine attack that inflicts hit point damage.

Shambler

(Level 1 to 3)

Con +4	Str +2	Dex -2	Int -4	Wis -4	Cha -
Movement:	Slow		Size:		varies
Armor:	0		HP:		per hd
Attacks (*):	unarmed strike (d6+2 bashing), grapple, bite (d6 piercing).				

Shamblers suffer half damage from all piercing weapons. They are instantly slain by any divine attack that inflicts hit point damage. A shambler's actions are always slow, and it can't dash or react.

Infectious - A creature bitten by a shambler must save vs. Doom or contract the plague. Plague prevents a victim from healing hit points, and inflicts 1d6 damage per day until the victim dies. Saving throws vs. plague are hard, and natural recovery requires three days of consecutive saves.

Curing the plague magically requires a remove curse or restoration miracle; a cure disease miracle will merely allow the target to regain hit points normally for one hour. Any creature killed by plague rises as a shambler on the next sunset.

Revenant

(Level 1 to 5)

More dangerous are the intelligent undead, who possess all the cunning and drive that they did in life. An intelligent undead is a conduit for necromantic power, able to cast dark curses or raise armies of lesser undead to do their bidding.

A revenant is the result of a curse, or a botched attempt to revive a mortal. A revenant possesses all of the intelligence and memories of the mortal it once was, but its living spirit does not control its body; instead, it is guided only by malevolent, feral desires for cruelty and vengeance on the living.

Con +2	Str +2	Dex +0	Int +0	Wis +0	Cha +0
Movement:	Normal		Size:		Medium
Armor:	Per worn armor		HP:		per hd
Attacks (*):	as mortal; a revenant may also perform a bite attack on any creature they have restrained or grappled (1d6+1 stunning necrotic damage'). Each 10 hp inflicted heals 1d6+2 hp or restores one faith.				
Talents:	any that it had in life.				

Necromancy

The revenant has dark faith equal to its level, which it may use to cast any miracle from the Death or War domain.

Raise Undead - By touching a corpse and spending faith equal to the corpse's desired level, the revenant may bid it arise and join its ranks as a shambler or skeleton, based on its current level of decay. The Revenant then rolls 2d6 + its own hit dice; if the result is greater than the total number of shamblers and skeletons the revenant currently controls, the corpse arises as a new shambler or skeleton under the Revenant's control.

Vampire (Level 6 to 9)

Vampires are the apex predator of the undead, stalking the night to drink the blood of the living. Vampires may use their blood to create thralls. A thrall is a mortal or vampire minion that has been fed the blood of a vampire - even unwillingly or unknowingly - and whose will is thus completely enslaved to their vampiric master.

Con +2	Str +2	Dex +2	Int +2	Wis +2	Cha +2
Movement:	Fast	Size:	Medium		
Armor:	Per worn armor	HP:	6d6+12		
Attacks (5+ x2):	as mortal; a vampire may also perform a bite attack on any creature they have restrained or grappled (1d6 piercing damage); each '6' rolled heals 1d6+2 hp or restores 1 blood.				
Talents (2+):	any that it had in life.				

Vampiric Blood

The vampire has blood equal to its hit dice, which it can spend as follows:

Blood Frenzy - The vampire may spend three blood to gain an additional action on its turn.

Undead Strength -The vampire may spend any amount of blood when it hits with a Strength-based melee attack to add 1d6 to its damage roll per blood spent.

Blood Potency - The vampire may spend one blood to make any one roll easier.

Dark Miracles - The vampire may cast a necromantic version of any Divine miracle by spending blood equal to twice its circle. Miracles which deal damage inflict necrotic damage.

Enthrall - The vampire gives a mortal or vampire with fewer hit dice than its own a drop of its blood to drink, enthralling them and granting them the vampire’s bite attack and a +1 bonus to each of their abilities for one lunar month.

Enthralled creatures cannot save vs. their master’s powers, and must make a save vs. Curse whenever adjacent to a living mortal to deny the desire to drink blood. If an enthralled mortal tastes another mortal’s mortal living blood and is subsequently killed, it will arise upon death as a new vampire, still enthralled to its master.

Undead Vigor - a vampire is immune to poison and disease, and halves all damage received from any non-Divine attack that isn’t fire or radiant damage, or inflicted by a feysilver weapon. Any fire or radiant damage that a vampire receives also inflicts ongoing fire damage.

Even if a vampire is “killed”, it rises again the next night unless it is staked through the heart with a rowanwood shaft, after which the lay to rest miracle must be performed on its incapacitated body by a priest, followed by decapitation with a feysilver blade. Correctly performing this process is a hard Lore check.

Lich (Level 10)

A lich is an undead creature whose soul has been preserved through ancient Atlantean arts, known only in modern times through the funeral-rites of the Khemetian pharaohs.

Unlike a vampire, a lich requires no sustenance to maintain their undead form; so long as their animating relic remains undisturbed, they can slowly regenerate from literally any injury, including the complete annihilation of their body. A lich temporarily bereft of physical form functions as a 10 hd wraith until they can possess a new host, or their original form regenerates sufficiently to move about.

Doom 5+ Hold 5+ Blast 5+ Trick 5+ Curse 5+ Fear 5+			
Con +4 (5+)	Str +0 (5+)	Dex +0 (5+)	
Int +5 (5+)	Wis +5 (5+)	Cha +5 (5+)	
Movement:	Normal	Size:	Medium
Armor:	Per worn armor	HP:	10d6+40
Attacks (5+ x2):	as a mortal, plus any prepared spells or cantrips.		
Con +4 Str +0	Dex +0 Int +5	Wis +5	Cha +5
Talents (2+):	all		

Master Necromancer

Liches have 10 points of dark faith, which they can use as follows:

Priest-King of Undeath - A Lich may perform any divine miracle from the Death domain by spending faith equal to its circle; they can also prepare miracles from any other domains into prayer strips. Their considerable knowledge and occult power also allows them to prepare arcane spells as a fifth level wizard, spending their faith as they prepare the spell as if it was a prayer strip.

Raise Undead - By touching a corpse and spending faith equal to the corpse's base hit dice, the lich may bid it arise and join its ranks as a shambler or skeleton, based on its current level of decay. Unlike a revenant, a lich has no limit to the number of mindless undead that they can control.

Animating Relic - Each lich has an animating relic that binds their soul to the material plane. If this relic is found, a sufficiently powerful group of Divine priests might be able to destroy it with a collective ritual. Determining the necessary rituals and sacrifices is likely to be an extended, and arduous, research task.

Blush of Life - When at full hit points, a lich appears to be a living, breathing mortal in exceptionally good health. Only as they take damage is their undead nature revealed. When the lich first takes damage, anyone paying close attention can make a hard Alertness check to notice that something is amiss. Once the lich is injured (below half its hit points), this check becomes easy; at zero hit points, noticing is automatic.

A lich in the process of regenerating from destruction is a ghastly sight indeed, often little more than a bleached skeleton with dried flesh hanging off it in rags.

The Infernal

Infernal creatures are the Church's term for malevolent beings from beyond the Material that corrupt mortals into their service. Two categories of Infernal are recognized by the church - the Djinn, who hail from the Elemental Chaos and arrive through Faerie, and the Baalim, who hail from the Abyss and arrive through the Shadow. Each kind of unholy being seeks to corrupt mortals in its own insidious way.

Djinn typically operate alone or in apparent opposition to each other, each offering a single mortal their heart's apparent desire as they push their "masters" to greater and greater heights of hubris. A pair of djinn might work together as a "two man con", each enabling their "master" in an ever-escalating fight against the other where neither can truly gain the upper hand. A sufficiently clever and strong-willed mortal might never experience their comeuppance, establishing a generational empire of slavery and vice such as the infamous Demon Sultanate of the Aussamans.

Baalim, on the other hand, tend to provide a more unified front when corrupting mortals, and tend to encourage cooperation in spreading their malice and misery. An imp will establish a foothold in the mortal realm, summoned by a single mortal's cruelty and selfishness; once it fully corrupts that mortal (and perhaps recruits a few more), it aids them in summoning greater demons and recruiting more followers into their cult, until eventually an entire religion of human sacrifice and sadistic cruelty is established. Such kingdoms were the norm before the coming of the Prophet and the establishment of the Church, and so priests are admonished to be ever-vigilant against the forces of evil, lest civilization return to the Old Ways.

Stranger still are the qlippothim. The cults of Yog-Sothoth and Azathoth are considered blasphemous by the Church, who believe that even if they were true, they foster an obsession with the multiverse and the possibility of escape from causality - both of which corrosively undermine the Sage and the Prophet's teachings. The cults of Shub-Nergath and Hastur are considered blasphemous for more prosaic reasons, as each teaches their followers to abandon the Divine Principle in favor of darker, more primordial urges.

Within the Successor Kingdoms, infernal cults must operate primarily through stealth and subterfuge. Many high priests of the baalim will masquerade as priests of the holy Church, while directing the very inquisitions tasked to find them towards persecuting the innocent instead. Djinn often masquerade as numina until their true nature is discovered, by which time they have likely created a nearly unfixable mess of granted wishes and inflamed desires. The qlippothim and their cultist followers tend to present themselves as wizards, druids, or other students of magic; those who have been twisted beyond the ability to maintain the facade will abandon civilization to skulk about in the forgotten corners of the world.

Djinn

Djinn are malignant Fair Folk hailing from the deep Elemental Chaos. While all Fair Folk are capricious and potentially cruel, the djinn hold a hostility towards material existence that sets them apart. Djinn almost never become numina, but the legendary Suleman the Wise found a way to force many of them to swear Divinely-sanctified oaths such that they are bound to holy relics, and compelled to serve the possessors of those relics until such time as the djinn learns piety and humility, and its master releases it from its service in good faith. The accomplishments of Suleman are legendary throughout civilization, and no priest since has discovered the secret of binding djinn.

Even a bound djinn is usually a force of malevolent power. Djinn feed off the emotions and desires of humans, and it is for this reason that they enter into the mortal realm. To ensure their sustenance, they offer a mortal their heart's desire, fulfilling any wish within their power that the mortal can name - but they always seek to find ways to twist the fulfillment of that wish to ensure their mortal "master's" ever-increasing dependency on their largesse.

Free djinn are able to continue this process to the utter ruin of one "master" after another without end, while a bound djinn's oaths forbid them from granting more than a set number of wishes to any single mortal, or from granting wishes that violate the sanctity of the mortal soul in one of three proscribed ways: ending a life, disturbing the rest of the dead, or creating or severing bonds of true love.

A mortal dependent on a free djinn finds themselves gradually unable to accomplish any of their goals without the djinn's help, and trapped in a web of ever-growing "coincidences" and "unforeseen consequences", giving the djinn more and more desperate wishes to fulfill. One need only wander the streets of the great Bagh-shagad to see the end result of their work; the Demon Sultanate is a testament to both the djinn's might and power, and the utter folly of trusting in their aid.

Jabal

(Level 5)

The Djinn of earth are the most concerned with matters of the directly material, offering their "masters" undreamed-of wealth and material resources. Gems, precious metals, and ornate statuary carved from the rarest of lapis and marble are child's play for the jabal to conjure at its "master's" mere whim. Legend says that Suleman himself commanded a great host of jabali to carve his Temple from living rock, establishing the first permanent place of worship for the people from whom the Prophet would eventually descend.

Doom 6+	Hold 5+	Blast 10+	Trick 5+	Curse 8+	Fear 5+
Movement:	Normal	Size:	Large		
Armor:	3	HP:	(5d6+20)x2		
Attacks (5+):	Large weapon (2x damage); may also cast flesh to stone at-will				
Con +4	Str +5	Dex +0	Int +5	Wis +2	Cha +5
Talents (2+):	Finesse, Science, Lore, Wit				

Djinn Magic - The jabal may cast any Stone- or Fey-aspected glamour effect by spending glamour equal to its circle.

Conjure Treasure - Once per day as its action, the jabal may conjure one of the following:

- precious metals, gems, and other treasures worth 5d6 x 1000 gold.
- three uncommon, two rare, or one legendary magic item.
- A palace keep that occupies up to 100 x 100 paces, with exceptional facilities.

Marid

(Level 5)

Water-djinn seem, at first glance, to be the kindest of the djinnfolk. They tend to counsel their “masters” towards wisdom and fulfillment of an emotional nature, offering advice on love and grief, joy and pain, and unimagined beauty and creativity.

The advice and aid of a free marid never quite seems to satisfy, though, always pushing their “master” onward towards deeper and greater passions. A marid muse will push their master towards greater and greater expressive talent, right up until the artist takes their own life to drown out the maddeningly perfect visions of inspiration that they can never quite conjure into the mortal world. A lover counseled by a marid matchmaker will find themselves a perfect seducer and rake, able to make anyone fall in love with them, but never quite finding satisfaction in any of them.

Doom 6+ Hold 5+ Blast 8+ Trick 5+ Curse 7+ Fear 5+			
Movement:	Normal	Size:	Large
Armor:	1	HP:	(5d6+20)x2
Attacks (5+):	Large weapon (2x damage)		
Con +4 Str +5	Dex +2	Int +5	Wis +3 Cha +5
Talents (2+):	Finesse, Science, Lore, Charm, Wit		

Djinn Magic - The marid may cast any Water- or Fey-aspected glamour effect by spending glamour equal to its circle.

Inspire Perfection - The marid may cause any Finesse, Charm, or Bearing skill roll that a mortal makes to become easier.

Sila

(Level 5)

Wood-djinn take after the guise of natural animals or fey beasts, often resembling particularly comely pucca. Legends from the near Orient suggest that some pucca, called the benu silat, were originally begat from the union of Silatu and mortals. Many mortals of the near East thus harbor a natural prejudice against their local pucca neighbors, believing them permanently tainted by their supposedly infernal origins.

Above all else, Sila delight in fulfilling desires of the flesh, enticing their mortal “masters” into all manners of lustful and gluttonous debauchery. The pleasure-palaces of the Demon Sultans are said to be filled with “bound” Sila slaves of all shapes and sizes, ready to make any mortal’s earthly fantasies come to life.

Doom 8+ Hold 8+ Blast 5+ Trick 5+ Curse 5+ Fear 5+			
Movement:	Normal	Size:	Medium
Armor:	1	HP:	(5d6+10)x2
Attacks (5+):	any weapon; the sila may also cast beguile at-will		
Con +2 Str +2	Dex +5	Int +5	Wis +5 Cha +5
Talents (2+):	Finesse, Lore, Intuition, Charm, Wit		

Djinn Magic - The sila may cast any Wood- or Fey-aspected glamour effect by spending glamour equal to its circle.

Perfect Lover - The sila may make any roll to beguile a creature easier, and make that creature’s saving throws against its beguilement harder.

Jatham (Level 5)

The great Suleman the Wise is said to have bound more jatham than any other kind of djinn, and so for many mortals, jatham are the only kind of djinn they know. A being of mercurial air, the jatham delights in weaving illusions and visions, in treachery and deceit, and in counseling its “master” towards intrigue, politics, and too-clever strategy. They are also masters of travel, granting their masters the power of flight and teleportation, and revealing secrets and visions from far distant times and places.

Doom 10+	Hold 10+	Blast 5+	Trick 5+	Curse 5+	Fear 5+
Movement:	Normal	Size:	Large		
Armor:	1	HP:	(5d6)x2		
Attacks (5+):	Large weapon (2x damage)				
Con +10	Str +10	Dex +5	Int +5	Wis +5	Cha +5
Talents (2+):	Finesse, Science, Alertness, Intuition, Lore, Charm, Wit				

Djinn Magic- The jatham may cast any Air- or Fey-aspected glamour effect by spending glamour equal to its circle.

Sage Counsel - The jatham may make any Science, Medicine, Lore, or Alertness roll that a mortal makes easier.

Ifrit (Level 5)

Of all the djinn, none are so haughty and boastful as the ifrit. As befits their nature as beings of fire and smoke, the ifrit delight in fulfilling dreams of war, conquest, and violence. An ifrit “bound” into service with a mortal will push them onwards towards greater and greater martial glories, up until their “master’s” ambition leads to a glorious but bloody downfall - at which point, some new unfortunate will be offered a chance at victory under the ifrit’s humble but masterful tutelage.

Doom 6+	Hold 6+	Blast 5+	Trick 5+	Curse 5+	Fear 5+
Movement:	Normal	Size:	Large		
Armor:	1	HP:	(5d6+20)x2		
Attacks (5+):	Large weapon (2x damage); may also cast elemental grasp (flame) and elemental dart (flame) at-will				
Con +4	Str +4	Dex +5	Int +5	Wis +5	Cha +5
Talents (2+):	Finesse, Science, Lore, Charm, Wit				

Djinn Magic - The ifrit may cast any Flame- or Fey-aspected glamour effect by spending glamour equal to its circle.

Spur to Glory - The ifrit may make all the attacks and saving throws of one mortal hero or an entire formation of mortal soldiers easier while it maintains focus. When it stops, those rolls all become harder until the next sunrise or sunset.

Baalim

Before the Sage and the Prophet, most of the world worshiped darker gods - gods who demanded human sacrifice and blasphemies. When the War in Heaven came to an end, these false gods fled into the deep Aether, where they reach out to this day in search of new worshipers to twist to their evil ways.

Civilized priests who worship the baalim are called warlocks, because they have forsaken their sacred vows to the Church for the sake of personal power. The baalim offer many dark secrets to their cultists, but all those secrets come at a terrible price.

Demons of the Baalim often appear, at first, to be Divine beings offering simple rationalizations and solutions to dire circumstances. As their words are heeded, though, it gradually becomes apparent to any sane observer that they are leading their followers down a dark road. Of course, this means that the demons start by convincing their new worshipers to sacrifice their moral clarity first, one insignificant scrap at a time.

Chief among the baalim is Baal Hamman, the ancient Lord of Qarthadst. Baal Hamman's demons are an insidious, never-ending threat against the Church's dominion; wherever hard choices have to be made, and wherever competition drives men to sacrifice their principles for the sake of expediency or survival, a crack opens for Baal Hamman to whisper promises of power.

Also counted among the Baalim are the Baal Hamman's Consort, Tannith Ashtoreth, the Lady of Lust and indulgence; Baal Zebul, the Lord of the Skies, who promises a glorious heavenly afterlife if his worshipers will only corrupt their souls with contempt and selfish pride; the goblin-god Ashemadeus, the Lord of Wrath (also called Orcus), who offers vengeance to all those who give themselves fully over to hate; and Mammon, the Lord of Wealth, who teaches men to excel in competitive strife and avarice at the cost of any hope of cooperation or contentment. Scholars of the faith believe that there are yet more Baalim hidden in the dark recesses of the deep Aether, but these five are chief among those whose influence still reaches out most successfully to the Material.

Common among all the Baalim is the Moloch ritual of human sacrifice. Many tomes describing the Baalim use the terms 'Baalim' and 'Moloch' interchangeably to describe both these beings and the rituals used to worship and appease them, but properly speaking, a 'Moloch' is a human sacrifice (or a ritual or altar built to accommodate it), while a 'Baalim Lord' is the dark power being sacrificed to.

Moloch rituals formed the foundation of most human religions until the Divine Principle arose to forbid them, and they still hold sway in the darker corners of the world. Various Fair Folk can also gain power from Moloch rituals; it can sometimes be challenging for an inquisition from the Church to determine whether a Moloch cult is being led by Baalim or Fair Folk.

Unlike the Fair Folk, the demon servants of the Baalim seldom manifest in physical form among civilization - the Church's blessings and ritual sacraments make this far too difficult - but their more subtle influences chip away at those blessings incessantly. A village that lapses in its sacred vows might open a crack in the parish's spiritual defenses, allowing a demon to slip through and take possession of the weak-willed; with their hands, the forces of the Baalim set to work setting brother against brother and friend against friend, until all vows have been broken and all hope seems lost. It is then, when the congregation despairs that the Church's blessings have seemingly abandoned it, that the demons show themselves - and offer the forlorn villagers a dark alternative.

Some Moloch sacrifices can even be made unknowingly - any time a priest willingly allows a mortal to die for the sake of expediency rather than necessity, they risk that death being accepted as a suitable Moloch sacrifice. The Reconquests were rife with Baalim incursions, brought about by blurred lines between the supposed "necessities" of war, and the economic and political conveniences of the Church's crusaders. Some members of the Papal See even suspect that the church's negligence directly brought about the Great Famine and Great Plague, as the opening salvo of a Baalim siege on the Successor Kingdoms that is still ongoing.

Imp (Level 1)

Imps are tiny demon servants, often summoned and bound by warlocks to aid them in their quest for power. An imp may be summoned unwittingly by any sufficiently vile act of selfish cruelty, and often follows its “summoner”, whispering subtle suggestions that they mistake for their own thoughts. In this manner, imps begin the process of recruiting new cultists to summon more powerful demons into the world.

Doom 15+ Hold 15+ Blast 12+ Trick 13+ Curse 13+ Fear 12+					
Movement:	Dash 30 / Fly 5		Size:	Small	
Armor:	1		HP:	3	
Attacks (15+):	sting (1d6 poison)				
Con +1	Str -1	Dex +2	Int +1	Wis +1	Cha +3
Talents (2+):		Agility, Finesse, Stealth, Wit			

Spirit Form

An imp is immune to poison, disease, and critical hits. When its hit points are reduced to zero it is banished, and cannot be summoned again for one lunar month.

Divine Vulnerability - An imp suffers double damage from any divine magic.

Infernal Favor

The imp has two points of favor, which it can spend as follows:

Dark Miracle - The imp may cast an infernal version of any Divine miracle by spending favor equal to its circle. Miracles which deal damage inflict aetheric damage.

Disappear - The imp may become invisible and intangible at will, hiding within the Shadow until it decides to re-manifest. While intangible, the imp cannot be touched or damaged by mundane weapons.

Shedim (Level 3)

Shedim are possessing demons that lurk in the Shadow, waiting for a weak-willed human to inhabit. Once they have possession of a mortal’s body, they add their hit dice and abilities to that mortal’s. However, once they sense that their mortal host might be in true danger, they flee, leaving them to their fate.

Doom 10+ Hold 10+ Blast 10+ Trick 10+ Curse 10+ Fear 10+					
Movement:	Dash 50		Size:	Medium	
Armor:	0 (immaterial)		HP:	3d6+6	
Attacks (10+):	per host				
Con +2	Str +2	Dex +2	Int +2	Wis +2	Cha +2
Talents (2+):		Stealth, Charm, Wit			

Spirit Form

A shedim (or its host) is immune to poison, disease, and critical hits. When its hit points are reduced to zero the shedim is banished, and cannot be summoned again for a month.

Divine Vulnerability - A shedim (or its host) suffers double damage from divine magic.

Infernal Favor

The shedim has three points of favor, which it can spend as follows:

Dark Miracles - The shedim may cast any Life- or Death-aspected miracle by spending favor equal to its circle.

Possess - The shedim may touch a human to attempt to possess them. If the human is unwilling, they may make a Wisdom saving throw to resist possession. Once possessed, the human host gains +2 to each ability, gains the Charm and Wit skills at 2+ if they were lower, and gains 3 additional hit dice worth of hit points (up to a maximum of 10 hit dice), recalculating their saves and attack throws.

Hellhound (Level 5)

Hellhounds are the hunters and guardians of infernal cultists, summoned to protect the cult and dispatch its enemies. A hellhound manifests as a large black dire wolf with glowing red eyes, a scorpion tail, and a ridge of poisonous spines down its back.

Doom 8+ Hold 5+ Blast 8+ Trick 7+ Curse 9+ Fear 10+					
Movement:	Dash 50		Size: Large		
Armor:	1		HP: (5d6+10)x2		
Attacks (5+ x2) :	bite (2d6+2 piercing), sting (2d6 poison)				
Con +2 Str +5	Dex +2	Int +3	Wis +1	Cha +0	
Talents (2+):		Stealth			
Senses: Smell (superior), Hearing (superior)					

Spirit Form

A hellhound is immune to poison, disease, and critical hits. When its hit points are reduced to zero it is banished, and cannot be summoned again for one lunar month.

Divine Vulnerability - A hellhound suffers double damage from any divine magic.

Infernal Favor

The hellhound has five points of favor, which it can spend as follows:

Dark Miracles - The hellhound may cast any War- or Death-aspected miracle by spending favor equal to its circle.

Track Prey - The hellhound may designate one mortal target that it has smelled, seen, or been given a treasured possession to examine. While it maintains focus, it knows that creature's direction and distance.

Lilin (Level 7)

A lilin (sometimes called a succubus) is an infernal ambassador into the mortal world, manifesting as a spirit of lustful temptation and carnal desire. Lilin often manifest explicitly to breed with mortals, creating half-infernal offspring. These demon-blooded children will usually be raised into their infernal parent's cult, where they will in turn be used as breeding-stock, creating more and more potent demonic bloodlines.

Doom 8+ Hold 8+ Blast 5+ Trick 5+ Curse 5+ Fear 5+					
Movement:	Normal			Size:	Medium
Armor:	2			HP:	7d6
Attacks (--):	none, but can cast beguile at-will.				
Con +0 Str +0	Dex +3	Int +3	Wis +3	Cha +5	
Talents (2+):	Finesse, Science, Lore, Charm, Wit				

Spirit Form

A lilin is immune to poison, disease, and critical hits. When its hit points are reduced to zero it is banished, and cannot be summoned again for one lunar month.

Divine Vulnerability - A lilin suffers double damage from any divine magic.

Infernal Favor

The lilin has seven points of favor, which it can spend as follows:

Dark Miracles - The lilin may cast any Beauty-, Freedom- or Fate-aspected miracle by spending favor equal to its circle. Miracles which deal damage inflict psychic damage.

Shapeshift - As its action, the lilin may disguise itself as a mortal with any apparent features that it desires.

Succubus Kiss - The lilin may touch a willing or beguiled mortal as its action to inflict 2d6 necrotic damage, then regain one favor.

Baal-malak (Level 10)

A baal-malak is a Duke of Hell, a vast arch-fiend summoned to the mortal plane to spread misery and destruction. In order for a baal-malak to manifest, a sizable cult of worshipers must already exist to feed it a steady supply of mortal sacrifice. While its cult empowers it, a baal-malak is nearly invincible.

Doom 5+ Hold 5+ Blast 5+ Trick 5+ Curse 5+ Fear 5+			
Movement:	Fast / Fly Fast	Size:	Large
Armor:	5 (aetheric form)	SP:	(2D6+10)x2
Attacks (5+ x2):	longsword (1D6+5 fire structure damage), whip (1D6 lightning structure damage)		
Con +5 Str +5	Dex +3	Int +5	Wis +5 Cha +5
Talents (2+):	Science, Medicine, Lore, Bearing, Charm, Wit		

Spirit Form

A baal-malak is immune to poison, disease, and critical hits. When its hit points are reduced to zero, it is banished, and cannot be summoned again for one lunar month.

Divine Vulnerability - The baal-malak suffers double damage from any divine magic.

Infernal Panoply - A baal-malak’s armor and weapons are an innate part of its form, and disappear if it is banished. It can grant a loyal mortal the use of one or both of its weapons on “loan”, and can change the size of its weapons to fit whoever it bestows them to. They still inflict their full structure damage even when shrunk to fit in a mortal’s hand.

Infernal Favor

The baal-malak has ten points of favor, which it can spend as follows:

Dark Miracles - The baal-malak may cast an infernal version of any Divine spell from the Fate, War, or Death domains, by spending favor equal to its circle. Any Miracle which deals damage inflicts fire or lightning damage at the baal-malak’s choice.

Shapeshift - The baal-malak disguises itself as a medium or small mortal, giving itself any appearance that it desires.

Smite - The baal-malak makes a melee weapon attack and adds +5D6 damage if it hits.

Cultists

A baal-malak will be accompanied by 2d20 mortal warlocks. Two of these warlocks will be initiates (5 hd) and one will be the high priest (9 hd); the remainder are 3 hd acolytes. Any warlock may perform a blood sacrifice, wounding itself or a restrained mortal captive with its ceremonial dagger to heal the baal-malak for 1d6 structure points or restore one favor to it.

Qlippothim

In the shadowed halls of the Demon Sultan's libraries, dark tomes speak of the Primordial Twins - incomprehensible beings whose very natures simultaneously define and violate all that is possible. Each of the Twins defies everything that the Church understands and teaches about the natural order, but in maddeningly opposite ways.

Chief among them is called Yog-Sothoth, the Keeper of the Ways, Gate and Key. Not even an "entity" as-such, Yog-Sothoth represents all possible Orders by which universes may be manifest. All law, all time, all logic, all causality flows from Yog-Sothoth, whose inscrutable infinite variations contain all possibilities somewhere within Its being.

Beside Yog-Sothoth and equal in rank is called Azathoth, the Primordial Nuclear Chaos, the infinitely compressed seed of identity that says "this, not that". While Yog-Sothoth gazes dispassionately across all timelines and all dimensions and says, "I AM", Azathoth writhes fitfully in its sleep and imperiously murmurs, "BÉ!" Azathoth's mote of singular identity denies all possibility of variation beyond Azathoth itself, but Yog-Sothoth's fractal encapsulation of all possible order expands in infinite fecundity.

Within the labyrinth that is Yog-Sothoth, the chiefest substructure that imparts its order onto the mortal world is a principle that is sometimes called Shub-Nergath - the idea of evolution and adaptation, competition and consumption and, cancer and growth, life and death. Shub-Nergath represents a concept within Yog-Sothoth that most mortals find easier to grasp - at first, at least; the idea of "nature red in tooth and claw" sings deep in the blood of every living thing to have ever walked the Earth, and most things in Faerie and the Shadow besides.

Opposing the relentless change of Shub-Nergath is a principle sometimes called Hastur, the desperate desire for individual beings with identities and egos to stay as they are, and not be forced to struggle endlessly to adapt or die. Somewhere in the deep aether languishes the King in Yellow, a once-mortal herald of Hastur who sacrificed its soul, its mind, and its living self to preserve its precious kingdom of Karkosh for all time.

The raw qlipphothic energies of Azathoth and Yog-Sothoth's dance occasionally find purchase within the Deep Aether, where they clot together with strewn detritus from the material to form something like a creature. Powerful arcane magics can sometimes call to these creatures from across the Veil, attracting them to the bright aura of a wizard like a moth to a flame.

Compared to the Fair Folk, or even the Djinn and Baalim, Qlippothic threats are exceedingly rare. Most Church inquisitors can go their whole lives without encountering one. But those who do encounter them never forget the experience.

Yuggothi Infiltrator (Level 3)

Few mortals have seen a Yuggothim in their natural form and lived. The creatures are said to be strange, fungal mixtures of crab and insect, with thin membranous wings that are too diaphanous to support flight in our world.

As worshipers of Shub-Nergath and peerless sculptors of flesh, Yuggothim that encroach into our world tend to begin by enthralling mortals into their service. A Yuggoth master will typically have an entire town completely bent to its will before it is discovered; any mortal under its sway will be irredeemably lost, its brain consumed and replaced with a rotten fibrous mass that links it to the Yuggothi hive-mind.

Doom 12+ Hold 12+ Blast 10+ Trick 10+ Curse 10+ Fear 12+					
Con -2	(14+)	Str -2	(14+)	Dex +2	(10+)
Int +4	(8+)	Wis +2	(10+)	Cha +0	(12+)
Armor:	2		HP: 3d6-6		
Speed:	Normal		Size: Medium		
Attacks (10+):	per weapon; Yuggothi infiltrators prefer arcane ranged weapons of their own design that usually deal 2d6 radiant or aetheric damage.				
Con +0	Str +0	Dex +2	Int +4	Wis +2	Cha +0
Talents (2+):		Stealth, Science, Lore, Survival			
Senses:		Arcane Sense (superior)			

Eldritch Artificer - The infiltrator can brew potions and construct arcane inventions as a fifth level dweomersmith.

Hound of Tindalos (Level 6)

Hounds of Tindalos are Qlippothic aberrations attracted to - or possibly formed by - wizards who attempt to violate the causal flow of past to future. Manifesting as painfully thin, spiked shadows with a vaguely quadrupedal silhouette, a hound of tindalos seeks to devour anything out of place from the timestream. Anything or anyone touched by a “time traveler” or subject to the effects of a temporal paradox may find itself hunted to the ends of Creation by the Hounds.

Doom 9+	Hold 9+	Blast 5+	Trick 8+	Curse 8+	Fear –
Con +0 (9+)		Str +0 (9+)		Dex +4 (5+)	
Int +1 (8+)		Wis +1 (8+)		Cha – (–)	
Movement:	Very Fast		Size:	Medium	
Armor:	structure		SP:	1d6+1	
Attacks (9+):	unmaking bite (6d6 aetheric damage plus a critical hit if any damage die rolls a '6')				
Con +0	Str +0	Dex +4	Int +1	Wis +1	Cha –
Talents (2+):	Agility, Stealth, Science				
Senses:	Arcane Sense (superior)				

Qlippothic Charge - The hound has two points of charge, which it can spend as follows:

Track Prey - The hound may designate one mortal target that has been exposed to a temporal paradox. While it maintains focus, it knows its quarry’s direction and distance.

Teleport - The hound may teleport from anywhere, into any space within 20 paces of its prey that is adjacent to two solid surfaces that meet at a 90 degree or sharper angle.

Aetheric Form - A hound is immune to poison, disease, and critical hits. When its structure points are reduced to zero it is banished, and cannot manifest again until the next sunrise or sunset.

Eye of Yog-Sothoth (Level 10)

Eyes of Yog-Sothoth are Qlippothic aberrations that manifest wherever arcane elemental forces have strained the Material laws of physics beyond their breaking point. An Eye of Yog-Sothoth manifests as a large sphere surrounded by a mane of writhing tentacles, each tipped with a staring, lidless dark globe like the eye of a mollusc. Centered in the main body is yet another vast eye, with a lid that resembles a mouth when closed.

Doom 5+ Hold 5+ Blast 5+ Trick 5+ Curse 5+ Fear 5+			
Movement:	Fly (hover)	Size	: Large
Armor:	structure	SP:	2d6+3
Attacks (5+ x2):	bite (2d6 piercing), grab (reach), magic missile, elemental bolt (any),		
Con +3 Str +3	Dex +0	Int +5	Wis +1 Cha +5
Talents (2+):	Stealth, Science, Lore, Wit		
Senses:	Sight, Arcane Sense (superior)		

Qlippothic Charge - The eye has ten points of arcane charge, and may cast any arcane spell by spending an amount of charge equal to that spell's circle.

Devour magic - as its action, the central eye can make a 5-pace cone area attack vs. all active or prepared magics, magic items, or alchemical formulae within its gaze. The eye negates each effect that doesn’t fail a save vs. curse, then regains an amount of charge equal to each devoured effect’s circle or rarity. Drained magic items recharge at the next sunrise or sunset.

Huge Creatures

Combat Rules

A huge creature has a span of 3 or more, taking up a circle on the battlefield with a width equal to its span and filling most of its space. Its attacks naturally reach another span paces beyond this, and if it wields a weapon with the reach property, it multiplies that property by its span.

Attack throws from a large or smaller creature that target a huge creature are easier, and its attack throws against those creatures are harder. It also has disadvantage to its saving throws vs. any area attack roll that completely covers all of its spaces. Even so, it typically has five times the hit points of a medium creature, and so represents a threat equivalent to an entire party of heroes of equivalent level.

Structure Points

Some Huge monsters such as dragons have an outer layer of tough hide or armor. Such creatures will have structure points in addition to hit points; in order to inflict hit point damage, the creature's structure points must first be reduced to zero.

Any attack against a structure with a weapon that inflicts hit point damage inflicts one point of structure damage for each damage die that rolls a '6'.

Huge Weapons

Weapons wielded by Huge creatures always deal structure damage, rather than hit point damage. If they make an unarmed attack, their unarmed strike also inflicts structure damage. Against creatures that do not track structure, such a weapon deals 5d6 damage for every 1D6 of structure damage they inflict, plus (or minus) 1d6 for each static +1 bonus.

Hit Locations

A Huge creature's hit points are split between multiple locations; any attack that hits must roll a die to randomly determine the location hit, unless the attack was easy and both the attacker's d20s hit.

The referee should be sensible about which hit locations are exposed to a particular attack, and adjust the hit location roll accordingly (or forgo it altogether if it's clear which section would be hit).

Ducking

Most Huge creatures have a head or head-like appendage that is extremely sensitive to damage. They can react whenever that section is hit to force the attacker to re-roll the hit location.

Crippling Wounds

Each location on a huge creature becomes crippled if its hit points are reduced to zero. Critical hits only affect the hit points of the section hit.

Frenzy

A Huge creature that suffers a crippling wound will often immediately fly into a frenzy, immediately making an attack against everything nearby even if it has already acted in this round of combat.

Area Attacks

A Huge creature that suffers an attack from an area effect rolls the attack's damage for each of its locations, reducing that damage by half if it saved vs. the attack; if successful, no damage is dealt to its head or head-like location. A huge creature does not distinguish between burst and blast attacks, since the creature itself fills most of its space.

Falling

Giant creatures that fall prone suffer 1d6 bashing damage to each of their possible hit location die roll numbers, due to their immense bulk. If they fall from a height of 10 feet or more, increase this damage by another 1d6 for every full 10 feet fallen. This damage ignores structure, and is applied directly to each location's hit points. A giant creature or construct that has only structure points instead takes 1d6-1 structure damage to each possible location roll per 20 feet fallen.

Treant (Level 4)

A huge tree may be awakened by a primal ritual, granting it motion and sentience. If left to its own devices, such a creature typically becomes a warden and guardian of the forest where it first sprouted, learning primal magic and tending to the living things within it.

A treant’s thoughts and reactions are naturally slow, but that does not make it stupid. When given time to think, a treant can show a deep and clever wisdom - although it will seldom apply that wisdom beyond its duties. Above all else, treants love peace, quiet, and sunlight; if nothing threatens their forest home, they are content to sit and meditate for years on end, soaking up nourishment from sun and rain and soil as they contemplate the beauty of the world around them.

Doom 6+ Hold 6+ Blast 13+ Trick 13+ Curse 9+ Fear 11+					
Movement:		Normal		Size: Huge 3	
Armor:		2		HP: [2d6+10]	
Attacks (5+):		battering blow (106 blunt structure)			
Con +5 Str +5		Dex -2 Int -2		Wis +1 Cha +0	
Talents (2+):		Stealth, Survival			

Huge Size - A treant’s hit points are split between multiple body sections. When the treant is hit by an attack that wasn’t easy, the attacker must roll 2d6 and consult the following chart:

3-4	Left Leg	1x [hp]
5	Left Arm	1x [hp]
6-8	Body	4x [hp]
9	Right Arm	1x [hp]
10-11	Right Leg	1x [hp]
12	Face	½ [hp]

Barkskin - The treant halves all slashing, piercing, and bashing damage inflicted on it that isn’t inflicted by a sundering weapon, but all fire damage against it automatically inflicts the ongoing fire damage condition.

Cripple - A critical hit to any location halves that location’s remaining hp, or reduces that section’s hp to zero if it fails its saving throw. Reducing the body to zero hp kills the treant, while reducing either leg to zero hp hobbles it, reducing either arm to zero hp makes all attacks harder, and reducing the face to zero hp blinds it.

Regeneration - If not destroyed, the treant’s Body heals 1 hit point per combat round.

Frenzy - Whenever any location is reduced to 0 damage, the treant immediately replenishes all glamour, then may immediately make a sweep attack.

Sweep Attack - As its action, the treant makes an area burst attack with its battering blow vs. all creatures within 3 paces of it. Any damaged creature is knocked prone.

Primal Magic - The treant may cast any Wood-aspected spell by spending glamour equal to its circle.

Regenerate - As its action, the treant spends 1 glamour, then chooses a damaged location and rolls 1d6+5, healing that many hit points in that section.

Ogre (Level 6)

A well-fed goblin redcap will eventually grow into a hobgoblin, and a well-fed hobgoblin will eventually grow into a bugbear. A bugbear that can keep its bottomless stomach full might eventually become an ogre.

Other processes exist that can create ogres; certain fey curses can transform a mortal into an ogre, for example, and ogres might themselves beget more goblin-whelps already at ogre size.

An ogre's appetite is truly voracious, and above all else they crave the flesh of other mortals. It is possible for an ogre to ignore this hunger, for a time, but the smell of blood will invariably send them into a feeding-frenzy that they have little hope of denying.

And ogres can smell blood from miles away.

Doom 5+	Hold 5+	Blast 11+	Trick 12+	Curse 9+	Fear 9+
Movement:	Normal			Size: Huge 3	
Armor:	2 (0)			HP: [3d6+12]	
Attacks (5+):	unarmed strike (D6 blunt structure), earthbreaker maul (3D6+4 blunt structure)				
Con +4	Str +4	Dex -2	Int -3	Wis +0	Cha +0
Talents (3+):	Alertness, Survival				
Senses:	Smell (superior)				

Sweep Attack - The ogre has three rage. It can spend one rage as its action to make a 3d6 damage burst vs. each creature within 3 paces of it; each creature may either save vs. Blast or save vs. Hold for half damage. Any creature that fails to save is knocked prone and flung 1d6 paces away.

Huge Size - An ogre's hit points are split between multiple body sections. When the the ogre is hit by an attack that wasn't easy, the attacker must roll 2d6 and consult the following chart:

3-4	Left Leg	1x [hp]
5	Left Arm	1x [hp]
6-8	Body	4x [hp]
9	Right Arm	1x [hp]
10-11	Right Leg	1x [hp]
12, 12*	Head	½ [hp]

***Duck** - The ogre can react to force an attack that hits its head to re-roll another location; damage to its head stuns it.

Cripple - A critical hit to any location halves that location's remaining hp, or reduces that section's hp to zero if it fails its saving throw. Reducing the head or body to 0 hp kills the ogre, while reducing a leg to 0 hp hobbles it, and reducing an arm to 0 hp makes all attacks harder when not using its reckless attack.

Frenzy - Whenever any location is reduced to 0 damage, the ogre immediately replenishes all rage and makes a sweep attack.

Smell Blood - Ogres automatically succeed on any attempt to smell blood, and can smell freshly-spilt mortal blood from a distance of nearly a mile.

Jötunn (Level 8)

The titanic kings of the Elemental Chaos, Jötnar are massive Fair Folk the size of hills, wielding terrifying elemental powers.

Doom 5+ Hold 5+ Blast 7+ Trick 7+ Curse 7+ Fear 7+					
Con +5	(5+)	Str +5	(5+)	Dex +0	(5+)
Int +0	(5+)	Wis +0	(5+)	Cha +0	(5+)
Movement:		Fast		Size: Huge 4	
Armor:		5 (elemental armor)		HP: [4d6+20]	
Attacks (5+):		unarmed strike (D6 structural bashing), ax or sword (2D6+5 structural slashing)			
Con +5	Str +5	Dex +0	Int +0	Wis +0	Cha +0
Talents (2+):		Science, Medicine, Survival, Lore, Charm, Wit			

Elemental Glamour - The jötunn has eight points of glamour, which it can spend as follows:

Elemental Attack - The jötunn makes a melee weapon attack and adds +3D6 elemental structure damage if it hits.

Primal Spellcasting - The jötunn may cast any primal glamour of its element, by spending glamour equal to its circle.

Elemental Vulnerability - The jötunn halves all elemental damage that matches its element, but suffers double damage from any damage of an opposing element.

Huge Size - A jötunn’s hit points are split between multiple body sections. When the the jötunn is hit by an attack that wasn’t easy, the attacker must roll 2d6 and consult the following chart:

3-4	Left Leg	1x [hp]
5	Left Arm	1x [hp]
6-8	Body	4x [hp] + 2 SP
9	Right Arm	1x [hp]
10-11	Right Leg	1x [hp]
12, 12*	Head	½ [hp]

***Duck** - The jötunn can react to force an attack that hits its head to re-roll another location; damage to its head stuns it.

Elemental Armor - In addition to hit points, a jötunn is protected by elemental armor, providing it with a small amount of structure. Before any hit point damage can be dealt to its body, this armor must be penetrated.

Cripple - A critical hit to any location halves that location’s remaining hp, or reduces that section’s hp to zero if it fails its saving throw. Reducing the head or body to 0 hp kills the jötunn, while reducing a leg to 0 hp hobbles it, and reducing an arm to 0 hp makes all attacks harder.

Frenzy - Whenever any location is reduced to 0 damage, the jötunn immediately replenishes all glamour, then makes an elemental attack without spending glamour.

Primordial Dragon (Level 10)

Primordial wyrmlings that survive for more than a few centuries eventually grow into adult primordial dragons. Each primordial dragon has imbued itself with one of the five elemental essences – Stone, Water, Wood, Air, or Flame – in a primal ritual that also grows its body to an enormous size.

Doom 5+ Hold 5+ Blast 5+ Trick 5+ Curse 5+ Fear 5+	
Movement:	Fast / Fly Very Fast Size: Huge 3
Armor:	5 (dragonscale) HP: [3d6+15]
Attacks (5+ x2):	claws (2D6 sundering structural), bite (1D6+5 piercing structural), wing buffet (1d6 thunder structural), tail bash (1D6+5 blunt structural)
Con +5 Str +5 Dex +1 Int +5 Wis +5 Cha +5	
Talents (2+):	All skills
Senses:	Dragons have a form of heat vision, allowing them to see warm-blooded creatures in total darkness.

Elemental Ichor - The dragon has ten points of elemental ichor. It may cast any primal glamour of its element by spending charge equal to its circle, or may cast a glamour of any other element by spending charge equal to twice its circle. It can also spend charge on the following feats:

Dive Bomb - The dragon can fly 160 paces on its turn, or dash 100 paces per phase.

Breath Attack - The dragon makes a breath attack in a 10-pace cone, which inflicts 2D6 structural elemental damage to everything along its path.

Focused Breath - The dragon can spend 3 ichor to make a breath attack in a 60-pace line, which inflicts 3D6+15 structural elemental damage to everything along its path. If the line is stopped short by a barrier, roll each damage die one at a time against the barrier until it gives way; if it does, the line continues past the barrier reduced by the number of damage dice rolled to penetrate it.

Huge Size - A dragon’s hit points are split between multiple body sections. When the the dragon is hit by an attack, the attacker must roll a d20 and consult the following chart unless the attack was easy:

1-5	Body	3x [hp] + 25 SP
6-9	Tail	2x [hp] + 15 SP
10	Left Hindleg	1x [hp] + 7 SP
11	Right Hindleg	1x [hp] + 7 SP
12	Left Foreleg	1x [hp] + 5 SP
13	Right Foreleg	1x [hp] + 5 SP
14-16	Left Wing	½ [hp] + 3 SP
17-19	Right Wing	½ [hp] + 3 SP
20*	Head	½ [hp] + 5 SP

***Duck** - The dragon can react to force an attack that hits its head to re-roll another location; any hit point damage to its head stuns it.

Dragonscale - In addition to hit points, a dragon’s hide is protected by a thick layer of dragonscale. Before any hit point damage can be dealt to the dragon, this armor must be penetrated. While any structure points remain in a location, a primordial dragon halves all elemental damage to that location that matches its element.

Cripple - A critical hit to any location halves that location’s remaining hp, or reduces that section’s hp to zero if it fails its saving throw. Reducing the head or body to 0 hp kills the dragon, while reducing a leg to 0 hp slows it and makes all claw attacks harder; and reducing a wing to 0 hp prevents the dragon from flying.

Frenzy - Whenever the head suffers hit point damage or any location is reduced to 0 damage, the dragon immediately replenishes all charge, then makes a focused breath attack without spending charge.

Tarrasque (Legendary Threat)

There are huge creatures, and then there is the tarrasque. The tarrasque is a vast draconic creature the size of a small island. It spends most of its time lurking beneath the waves, but can be roused from its slumber by warfare or powerful works of magic. Once awakened, the beast will rampage across the earth, devastating settlements and toppling tall buildings, until it can be laid low.

Towering hundreds of feet high, the tarrasque's roar and aetheric breath are devastating weapons that can destroy cities before the creature even reaches shore. Once landed, the tarrasque's trampling feet and thrashing tail destroy buildings and bridges, while crushing thousands underfoot.

It is believed that there is only one tarrasque in all the world. No known power has yet managed to kill it — when gravely injured, the tarrasque will retreat into the waves and submerge, wandering along the seabed until it finds its nest. There, it slumbers until some new disturbance awakens it.

Doom 3+ Hold 3+ Blast 3+ Trick 3+ Curse 3+ Fear 3+	
Movement:	Normal Size: Huge 20
Armor:	5 (dragonscale) HP: special
Attacks (5+):	stomp (5D6+10 blunt structure), bite (5D6+10 piercing structure)

Primordial Rage - The tarrasque has ten points of rage, which it can spend as follows:

Roar - The tarrasque's roar inflicts 1D6+10 thunder structure damage and 3d6 psychic hp damage to everything within 50 paces. Each creature must save or be frightened for 1d6 minutes; this saving throw is hard.

Thrash - As its full action, the tarrasque makes an area attack vs. everything within 10 paces of it. Any creature that fails to save suffers 5D6+10 structure damage and is knocked prone and stunned.

Aetheric Breath - The tarrasque can spend 5 rage to deal 5D6+10 structure damage in a 100-pace cone or 500-pace line.

Huge Size - Ranged and melee attacks against the Tarrasque are always easy.

The tarrasque's hit points are split between multiple body sections. When the tarrasque is hit by an attack at long range, the attacker rolls a d20 and consults the following chart:

1-6	Body	500 hp, 150 SP
7-9	Left Hindleg	275 hp, 80 SP
10-12	Right Hindleg	275 hp, 80 SP
13-16	Left Foreleg	250 hp, 70 SP
17-19	Right Foreleg	250 hp, 70 SP
20*	Head	50 hp, 20 SP

***Duck** - The tarrasque can react to force any ranged attack that hits its head from any range to re-roll another location; any hit point damage to its head stuns it.

Dragonscale - In addition to hit points, a tarrasque's hide is protected by a thick layer of dragonscale. Before any hit point damage can be dealt to the tarrasque, this armor must be penetrated. While any structure points remain in a location, the tarrasque ignores all critical hits to that location that aren't from attacks that deal structure damage.

Cripple - Once the dragonscale is penetrated, a critical hit to any location halves that location's remaining hp, or reduces that section's hp to zero if it fails its saving throw. Reducing a leg to 0 hp hobbles the tarrasque, while reducing the head or body to 0 hp incapacitates it.

Frenzy - Whenever the head suffers hit point damage or any location is reduced to 0 damage, the tarrasque immediately replenishes all rage, then makes a thrash attack without spending rage.

Regenerate - The tarrasque regenerates 1d6 hp and 1 SP per damaged section at the end of each round, even if that section has been reduced to 0 hp.





Lore and Myth

Structure and Origin of the Universe

In the beginning, the universe called Creation was two separate “universes” within the cosmos. The first of these universes is called the Prime Material by Occidental students of natural philosophy. It is a universe of matter, and energy, and physical laws, which came into being unfathomably many aeons ago, eventually producing galaxies, stars, and planets - and life. It is apparent that something very like the human and dwarven races existed in some form well before the Flood, living in primitive tribes in the wilds. Archaeological and paleontological evidence suggests that the dwarven race was almost extinct by the time of the Great Flood, while humans were well on their way to becoming the sole mortal race on the planet.

Luckily for the dwarves, the world contains realities beyond the ken of mortal senses. Forces and dimensions beyond our senses occasionally interact with the physical world that we know, granting seemingly supernatural powers to those who can harness them. The connection between these forces and the world of matter wax and wane, but some time in the distant past they rose to prominence again, offering the dwarves a chance at survival.

Adventurers will occasionally find themselves confronting these “planes of existence”, and so it is wise to spend some time trying to understand them. Everything presented here can be recalled by a character with a Science check, as the Science skill includes a deep understanding of the aetheric planes, their orientations, and their interactions. A hard Lore roll might also reveal some of this information at the referee’s discretion.

A note on Historical Fiction

This game is set in a fantasy world whose history parallels our own in some important ways - and our own world's history can be an ugly, brutal thing. All fantasy role-playing games draw from our world's history to some extent, so they all have to face this problem in their own way; a deliberate choice was made as this book was written to face some of our world's historical prejudices head-on. There's simply no way to approach these topics at all without offending somebody, and pretending not to approach them while presenting a world that borrows them for aesthetics seemed even more disrespectful.

The Aether

The Aether, also called the Astral Plane or the Foundation of Being, is a universe of pure transformation and possibility, where any concept is willed into existence merely by imagining it, and where any concept capable of imagination spawns an infinite cascade of creation.

The Prime Material

The Material Plane, also called the Prime Material, is the reality familiar to most mortals, with matter, energy, time, and six ‘cardinal directions’ of space - Up, Down, Forward, Back, Left, and Right. It follows all the familiar laws of physics, and has existed for untold billions of years.

Science and observation show that the Material Plane was created by the Divine at least ten billion years ago, but likely no more than twenty. This universe began as a single white-hot burst of light, which evolved over some billions of years into its current shape - with galaxies, suns and planets all held together by the fundamental forces of gravity, electromagnetism, and stranger nuclear energies.

The laws of the prime material are consistent, and usually straightforward. Everything in the material is made of matter, and animated with energy, and the physical laws of the prime material merely transform these matters and energies into different configurations, without ever truly destroying either. Chemistry, physics, and biology are all reasonably well-understood by most mortal scholars, as the Old Empire extensively studied them to further its Arcane goals of conquest and progress. These laws of physics would be immutable and omnipresent, if not for the influence of the Aether.

The Primordial Conjunction

At some point in the distant past, inscrutable forces within the Aether moved it into conjunction with the Material, surrounding it and permeating it. Through this slow process, the Prime Material has thus far mostly held its shape - and by shape we mean the physical laws of its reality - while the Aether was split approximately in half, like a sharp knife passing through a lump of clay.

Yin and Yang

The Aether contains two additional directions, unknown on the Material Plane. Oriental scholars call these two directions 'Yin' and 'Yang'; yin is the opposite of yang in exactly the same way that up is the opposite of down, or left is the opposite of right. It is unknown if Yin and Yang are natural directions within the Aether, or whether the imposition of the Material Plane into the Aether created them. Nevertheless, these two directions exist, and can be traveled through.

The Prime Material is now "wedged" between the two halves of the Aether. The "yangward" side of the Aether is called the "Elemental Chaos", while the "yinward" side is called the "Everafter". At the interface between the Prime Material and these two realms, a pair of interface membranes called "demiplanes" emerged after the Starfall. These demiplanes are known as "Faerie" and "Shadow".

Faerie

Where the Elemental Chaos presses up against the material, the pressure "molds" the Aether's clay into distorted mirrors of the material's shapes. The gap between the Elemental Chaos and the Prime Material is imperceptibly thin, but still present; the Starfall tore the two realms apart for millions of years, with the membrane forming as scar tissue. Material and even consciousness have since accumulated within the rift for aeons.

The membrane between the Elemental Chaos and the Prime Material therefore operates as an entire "mirror world", taking on a distorted appearance of the Prime Material colored by the wild energies of the Elemental Chaos. This mirror world is called "Faerie", as are the shapes that coalesce within it.

The more self-aware these shapes are, the more likely they are to form a space around them, and populate that space with their "thoughts". The most powerful of these phantasms manage to form enough of a coherent identity to stabilize, becoming ephemeral eldritch beings called the Fair Folk. The less powerful are either eroded by the chaotic whims of Faerie, or drift far enough into the material that its physical laws can stabilize them.

These latter beings are called the "fey", and are the origin of most - if not all - of the mortal races in Creation that are not human or dwarven. They are also the origin of most fantastic beasts, from the griffin to the gelatinous cube - all survivors of incursions into the material, left stranded as Faerie rolled back like a tide of chaos.

Not all fey beasts can survive in the material. In fact, it is extraordinarily rare that Faerie produces a creature with sufficiently organized internal organs that it can continue to eat and breathe once the tides of Faerie rolls back, let alone with a sufficiently organized reproductive system that it can breed and populate the material plane with offspring. But on the borders between the Material and Faerie, creatures that are almost "real" enough to survive tend to produce such a diverse variety of offspring that at least a few of them can stake a toehold into the mortal world.

Faerie itself appears as an overgrown mirror of the Material Plane, bursting with life-energy and vibrancy. Colors are brighter, scents and tastes more pungent, sensations more acute. Primal magic is more powerful within Faerie, where it is closer to its primal source.

Strands of Faerie occasionally 'descend' yinward into Material reality, creating pockets that hapless mortals can wander into unawares. Wilder places, with ecosystems that have stabilized over thousands of years, tend to 'pull' Faerie closer to the Material. Druids from barbarian tribes exploit this tendency to enhance their magics, creating cairns and ley-lines to tap primal wellsprings.

Fey beings live within Faerie and are native to it, such as goblins and fauns and fairies. Elves, too, were once native to Faerie, and can survive within it better than most. The most powerful beings within Faerie are the Numina and the Fair Folk, powerful spirits of nature who wield influence over the Primal world in much the same way that Saints and ancestors influence mortal affairs. Most Barbarian tribes worship - or at least respect and revere - the Fair Folk, offering them sacrifices and honors in exchange for aid in their daily lives.

The Elemental Chaos

Yangward from Faerie is the Elemental Chaos itself, a realm seemingly made from pure Elemental Materia. Mortals typically cannot live for long within the Elemental Chaos, where the roiling elemental energies tend to dissolve non-Aetheric matter in short order.

Djinn and elementals live within the elemental chaos, vying for control over territory. Scholars are divided as to whether Djinn are ultimately fey-aspected elementals, or elemental-aspected fey; nonetheless, they are clearly more familiar with the Material Plane than their purely elemental cousins, and so they tend to be encountered first by mortals as one climbs yangward.

Dragons are not native to the elemental chaos as djinn and elementals are, but they adapted to survive within it for some sixty million years, altering their physiology and substance into much more elemental forms. Upon return to the material, primordial dragons chose to maintain most of these adaptations, while celestial dragons have re-adapted themselves to material and even aetheric substances.

Materia

The elemental chaos is also the source of elemental materia, solidified patterns of elemental energy that sometimes make their way through Faerie into the Material. All Primal and Arcane effects on the Material - whether manifest by a magic-user or a fey beast - are the result of materia interacting with and altering the behavior of base matter. While fey beasts incorporate materia into their very metabolism, magic-users must harvest materia from the environment and arrange it into patterns that cause a specific effect.

Elemental materia that makes its way into the material world manifests in a bewildering variety of forms, but the most common shapes that adventurers are familiar with are materia charges. A materia charge often resembles a small gemstone or particularly brilliant pebble that emits a soft glow. It will often be warm or cold to the touch, depending on the element that comprises the materia, and striking it against a hard surface will often manifest a small elemental effect such as a spark of flame or lightning or a small patch of frost.

Shadow

The Shadow is just on the "other side" of the Prime Material, where the Everafter presses up against it. While Faerie echoes the forces of life and creation, the Shadow tends to echo the forces of death and decay. As you descend Yinward, colors and sensations become muted and dull, and the air darkens and stills - hence leading to its other name, the "Underworld". The 'nearest' parts of the Shadow feel like a cold, muted reflection of the Material Plane, rife with subtle signs of decay and age. Almost nothing is truly alive in the Shadow, but it is still full of predation and dangers.

Ghosts

Whenever a living being dies with sufficient strength of will and identity, its death will emit a burst of Aetheric energy that 'imprints' upon the Shadow, creating a pale copy of its consciousness called a 'ghost'. This imprint might be anything from a vague impression of the being it once was, to a fully formed visage and personality, capable of carrying out the wishes of the living being it was copied from. Stronger ghosts contain most of the memories and personalities of the creature that produced them; more intelligent beings, such as sapient mortals, produce a ghost that is nearly identical to its mortal form. Even so, most ghosts arrive in the Shadow disoriented and confused. If the body that spawned a ghost is restored to life, the ghost will be pulled irresistibly to it, restoring that body's mind and memories and adding the ghost's memories to its own.

For all intents and purposes, a ghost and the living person whose death spawned it are one and the same - memory, personality and goals all pass instantaneously from one to the other at the moment of death, and pass back just as instantaneously at any moment of revival. The fact that this "soul" only exists because of the strange interactions of the material and the aetheric is of no consequence to the spirits of the departed, who spend their afterlives echoing the goals and desires they had in life.

Ancestor Cults

As the Shadow-world grew populated with the spirits of the dead, the more powerful of them found themselves able to manifest to their living descendants, forming the first ancestor cults. It was discovered that objects ritually sacrificed by the living in the presence of the dead would create similar “shadows” that the dead could use, a discovery that evolved these ancestor cults into elaborate rites of prayer and appeasement, gifting ancestors with food and drink and precious items in exchange for aid to the living.

As it turns out, even nonliving objects can form ghosts within Shadow, so long as they exist as important symbols within enough mortal minds and those minds have a clear enough picture of them. This can happen by accident, when a mortal relic is destroyed in a fateful moment, or on purpose, when a mortal deliberately sacrifices a treasured heirloom to gift it to their ancestors.

These ‘grave gifts’ are the primary currency of the Shadowlands, as they are typically more solid and durable within the Shadow than the mere echoes that typically inhabit it.

When this same process of sanctification and sacrifice is performed on a living being, the ghost that enters the Shadowlands is both enhanced and lessened by the process. Blood sacrifice is an incredibly potent means of exchanging energy between the Material and the Shadow, but the damage that it inflicts on the soul makes it a forbidden practice within the holy Church.

As buildings, villages, and even whole cities passed into ruin, their shadows too began to manifest within the Shadowlands, and the kingdoms of the dead began to form around them. The richest of the dead - those blessed with the most prosperous and devoted living descendants - used their wealth and power to make themselves kings over these kingdoms, proving that the dead are like the living in almost every way.

Ghosts that survive their first few days in the Shadow typically find like-minded ghosts and band together with them for further survival, forming small communities within Shadow centered around the echoes of familiar locales.

The Everafter

Yinward from Shadow is the Everafter, a realm of vast civilizations of the dead carved out from the Aether and given a kind of semi-permanent stability by the collective belief and effort of their ghostly inhabitants. The energies of the Everafter are even powerful enough to reach through the Shadowlands into the Material Plane, empowering Priests with their Divine miracles.

Ghosts who lived their lives in accordance with the tenets of a particular Afterlife within the Everafter may petition to join it, where they can exist in relative comfort with their like-minded peers, cultivating whatever talents and growth the dead can manage. Typically, an afterlife will require a period of ‘purgatory’ before a petitioner can truly join its ranks; while tales of purgatory describe lurid and sadistic torture, the actual purpose is to purge away those tendencies that would destabilize a given Everafter if permitted to run unchecked. It is still quite unpleasant, however.

Eventually, through processes not fully understood by the living or the dead, ghosts can be called back into the world of the living. The second-most straightforward means is through a miracle, which restores a dead body to life and then calls its ghost to re-inhabit it. If done properly, this restores them to life as if they had never died; improperly, it creates an undead mockery of the living that spreads misery and evil wherever it goes.

The most straightforward means for a ghost to return to the Material Planes, of course, is through natural reincarnation. Eventually, a ghost might feel that it is time to ‘move on’; when this happens, it fades out of the Shadow and finds its way to an unborn child, where it quickens it with some of its personality and memories. Most newborns remember very little of their past lives, if they even had any - it takes a very strong ghost to hold onto their identity through the process of rebirth.

Just as the Fair Folk can influence the living, the honored dead can channel power to those who still remember them. This power is the basis of all divine and necromantic magics, for good or ill.

Prehistory

The Material Plane has existed, as near as scholars can tell, for at least ten billion years. It is unclear whether "time" even has meaning within the Aether, independent of its interaction with the Material; but if it does, it is even older. Mortal scholars have uncovered only a fraction of that deep history.

The Age of Dragons

When the world was younger, magic was wilder – more potent, but also more dangerous. In that primordial world, the first beings to raise themselves out of the mud and build a civilization were the Dragonkind.

Chief among them were Dragons - massive predators of scale and claw and wing, who commanded Primal magics far beyond mortal ken. These Dragons took it upon themselves to tame the world, and rose up mighty empires of lizardfolk, and even stranger eldritch beings. Then, according to the Dragons, a calamity called the Starfall wiped out their world, scorching the earth, blotting out the sky, and severing the Material Plane from the Aether for over 60 million years.

The Starfall

The draconic civilization was able to predict the Starfall by a few precious months. During this time, the most powerful of the dragons took a select few of their lizardfolk subjects and fled into the Elemental Chaos. They assumed that they would wait there for a few years, a decade or two at the most, while the world repaired itself.

Instead, they were trapped within the Elemental Chaos for millions of years.

In addition to wiping out much of the world's life, the Starfall tore a rift between the Material and the Aether, preventing travel between the planes. The dragons were forced to adapt to life within the Elemental Chaos, transforming their bodies more and more into creatures of pure elemental materia, and using the primordial magics available to them to keep pockets of material reality for their subjects to live within.

The Second Conjunction

Research records from the Old Empire show that the rift between the Aether and the Material caused by the Starfall began to heal roughly 40,000 years ago. The Earth was in a deep ice age at the time, with primitive human and dwarven tribes hunting each other for food and territory across the tundra. The dwarven race was on the verge of extinction when magic returned, allowing them to retreat underground and begin building a civilization.

The "scar tissue" of the rift between the Aether and the Material Plane remains to this day, as the membranes of Faerie and Shadow.

Little remains of that civilization's works; both their war with the Ancients and the ensuing Great Flood have wiped most traces of them from the earth.

Celestial and Primordial Dragons

As the wound in the Veil finally healed, the dragons returned. The world they returned to is quite different from the one they fled during the calamity. Most of the creatures familiar to them have died; instead, small furry beings scurry across the ground, and their only recognizable descendants fly through the air in tiny mockery of their once-majestic forms.

The dragons were understandably conflicted about all of this.

Two camps have formed from all this turmoil, each with its own grand vision of how to repair the world.

Celestial dragons see the world that mammals have created, and are duly impressed with what they have managed to accomplish with their meager bodies and lesser magics. Most celestial dragons have joined the Celestial Afterlives of mortals, where they serve as lieutenants and viziers to the Saints and Baalim of the mortal hereafters.

The primordial dragons, on the other hand, are utterly disgusted with the very idea of mammalian dominance, and wish to return the world to something resembling what they left - a predatory paradise of hot, steamy jungles and savage steppes, filled with prey and worshippers.

The Age of the Ancients

The first non-dwarven civilization to arise after the Second Conjunction were the human and elven Ancients, who rose to prominence nearly 11,000 years ago with the resurgence of magic. It is believed that elves themselves were the result of Ancient humans interbreeding with the Fair Folk, whom they worshipped as eldritch gods.

The Three Empires

The Ancient human empire of Aztlanteos spanned the world, reaching out in trade and conquest to all corners of the earth from their island beyond the Gates of the Inner Sea. Its elven counterpart of Mu spanned several continents across the far western ocean, while the Dwarven empire of Babilim spread across the fertile crescent from its hub at the Godgate, a vast tower-city taller than a mountain.

The Aztlanti, Lemuran, and Babilim protocultures fought for centuries, with the Aztlanti and Lemurans ruling the skies and the waves while the Babilim built vast underground empires literally beneath their feet. There is some evidence of truces, trade, and even alliances between these three cultures, possibly to contain incursions and raids from the newly-emerged Primordial Dragons.

The Great Flood

Then, one day, an unknown disaster sank the Ancients' entire continent beneath the waves.

Massive flooding over much of the world of men followed, and when the floodwaters receded, their empires were nearly destroyed. Those who still remembered their arcane secrets taught them to the primitive tribes of men, seeking to rebuild some shadow of the Ancients' glory, while the dwarven survivors strove in vain to rebuild the Godgate.

The Age of Strife

Between the fall of the Ancients and the rise of the Old Empire, men, elves, and dwarves struggled and fought among each other for nearly ten thousand years. The underground First Kingdoms of the dwarves slowly collapsed during this time, mostly due to the ravages of time and damage inflicted during the Great Flood.

The Rise of the Pharaohs

One of the earliest civilizations to rise from the ashes of the Ancients was the empire of Tawy-Kemeth, ruled over by an order of Ancient refugees who specialized in craftsmanship and necromancy. They built a mighty empire across the span of the Ithru river, and directed their slaves to build them impressive temples and tombs that still stand today, over two thousand years after the fall of their civilization.

The remnants of Kemeth stand today, watched over by hungry undead who patiently await the re-awakening of their slumbering masters.

The Pact of Ibram

Sometime at the height of the Pharaohs' reign, a small tribe of Kanahani men and dwarves formed a Pact with a minor Baalim storm-God, before entering Kemeth and integrating with a caste of dwarven craft-priests. Such occurrences would hardly be noteworthy, except that the taboos and rites of this particular Pact laid the foundation – deliberately or otherwise – for a path towards the Divine Principle.

So profound was its impact, that the day of this Pact marks the beginning of the Church's calendar. Its inheritors went on to become the Benysreli people, a tribe seemingly forged by fate to protect mankind's knowledge of the Principle and topple all empires that choose to oppose it.

The First Republics

The "first" republic was anything but, of course; everything they accomplished was far outstripped by the majesty of Ancients' world-spanning civilization. But the First Republic holds the esteem of being the first civilization after the Flood to reach a level of education and civic engagement that could compare even weakly to the Ancients' glory.

The First Republic arose as a collection of warring city-states, until it consolidated its power around the cities of Spartha and Athenas and conquered most of the regions north of the Inner Sea. Modern natural philosophy was first established during the First Republic, and the principles of Arcane spellcasting were re-discovered from Ancient fragments held in the Delphan temple at Pythos.

Antiquity

The fortunes of the First Republic waxed and waned until it was finally conquered and subsumed by the Old Republic, which adopted much of its culture and scholarship. Developing from a loose collaboration of elder tribal leaders in southern Tiberis, the Old Republic grew over three centuries to rival even the Ancients in scope and power.

The Old Republic

To the Successor Kingdoms, the Old Republic represents the pinnacle of human governance. For three hundred years, the Tiberian Republic expanded northward from its peninsula on the Inner Sea into barbarian kingdoms of Europa, bringing with it roads, aqueducts, fortifications, and all manner of civic infrastructure.

Tyr

The only true rival to the Old Republic in its heyday were the Tyrians, a mercantile empire across the Inner Sea. While the primary reason for the rivalry was economic, many of Tyr's religious customs — especially the practice of live child sacrifice — were seen as cruel and barbaric to the Tiberians.

The ongoing war between the Tyrians and the Republic lasted for nearly a hundred years, ending in the sacking and burning of Qarthadst, the Tyrian capital. While the Tiberian legions were stronger and better disciplined, the Tyrian navy was the undisputed ruler of the Inner Sea, and their meager armies were bolstered by a Dwarven technology called the golem armor.

Once Qarthadst was burned and its foundations ritually salted, desecrated, and reconsecrated to the Republic, the secrets of constructing and fielding golem armors passed into the hands of the Republic. The Republic used its wealth and reach to supply its Dwarven dweomersmith slaves with enough resources to build legions of golem armors — each Tiberian centurion was given their own armor from which to lead a hundred legionnaires.

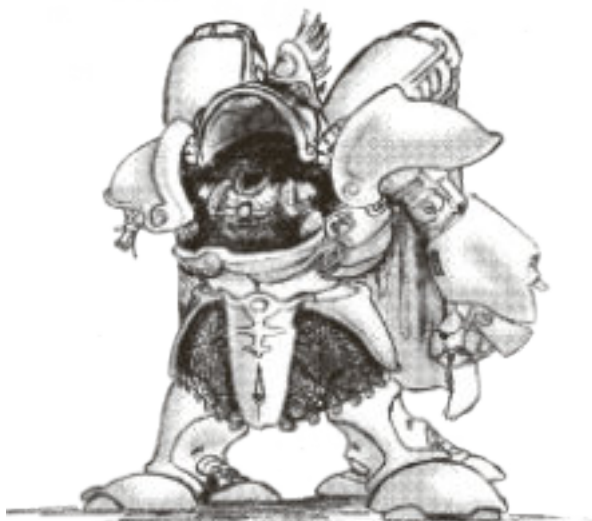
The Golem Armor

To the modern Successor Kingdoms, Tiberia was an empire of marvels and wonders. The ruins of Tiberian aqueducts, bathhouses, civic centers and roads dot the landscape of the Successor Kingdoms, some still holding secrets that wait to be discovered. But of all the arcane splendour of the Tiberian age, the golem armor captivates the mind of the Successor Kings like no other.

A golem armor resembles a stocky suit of plate mail over fifteen feet high, with a hinged chest that opens to reveal an inner chamber. Within that chamber, the golem knight sits in a special harness, which translates the knight's movement into sympathetic movements of the armor. Below the knight is an engineer's seat, where a dwarf or human wizard sits and manages the armor's functioning during battle.

New golem armors have not been constructed for a thousand years, although the league of Hansa has taken strides to salvage and restore broken armors thought lost by the other Successor Kingdoms, and the Sultanate sometimes uses djinn-magic to wish themselves siege engines of similar power. While the most talented craftsmen of this century can sometimes hope to replicate the metalwork of a golem armor, the creation of a dragon pearl of sufficient power to serve as an armor's materia core eludes even the most powerful of alchemists.

Thus, golem armors are passed down from father to son, and have grown to signify a feudal lord's right to rule his subjects. Adventurers who discover and salvage a lost armor, or even the materia core of an abandoned ruin, can expect to be paid handsomely — or even directly awarded a knighthood, if they are not betrayed. Those deemed by their lord to be sufficiently trained in soldiery or wizardry will likely be granted the armor themselves, and given a small fiefdom and keep in order to maintain it.



The Old Empire

For three hundred years, the Old Republic ruled from its capital of Aeterna in Tiberis. Then, the first Emperor claimed supreme dictatorial power and refused to relinquish his armies at the end of a long campaign against the barbarian hordes, and instead marched across the Rubis river to conquer Tiberis.

The empire rapidly grew in sophistication and power over a mere 60 years, quickly evolving into a spectacle of opulence and decadence where arcane technology could cure any ill, or ease any boredom, for those who could afford it.

The Sage and the Prophet

Onto this stage strolled the Sage and the Prophet.

The Sage was an immortal from the East. Many say they were the first Awakened Being – the first mortal creature to fully unlock the path of Enlightenment that leads to perfection of body and mind, and transcendence from suffering. Originally a sheltered prince or princess who renounced their birthright in the face of the world's suffering, for 600 years the Sage taught the ways of enlightened nobility to the kingdoms southeast of Aeterna.

The Prophet was a priest from a small tribe conquered by the Old Empire. He taught the ways of Peace, Life, and Truth, while brutally condemning the hypocrisy and callousness of both the Old Empire and his own tribe.

The Sage came to the Prophet in the height of the Empire's reign. The legends and scriptures say that they wandered, and talked, for 40 days and nights in the deep desert, trading insights and their hopes for the world.

Then the Prophet returned to his people, and attacked the other priests of his God in their own temple, for hypocrisies and blasphemies that he could not bear.

He was tortured and executed within a month.

War in the Heavens

The Sage issued a single proclamation, that the Prophet would bring Enlightenment even to the dead, and walked away into self-imposed exile. They were never seen again.

Within a year, the practices of Divine worship that held the empire together began to lose their potency, as the righteous dead rebelled against the Old Gods and established a new order. The priests of this new order were horribly persecuted by the Old Empire, until eventually, 300 years later, the new Constant Emperor declared himself a warrior-priest of their faith, and converted the armies under his command by Imperial decree.

The Rise of the Church

The Constant Emperor created a new church by decree in 2375, and granted it full Imperial authority to establish practices of worship and culture across the Empire. The First Council of Nikai spent decades resolving nuances between the Sage's Four Truths and Eight Journeys, and the Prophet's Golden Rule and Promise of Forgiveness.

The chief unresolved controversy at the Council of Nikai was a dispute of orthodoxy between two Alhanrian bishops – Arius and Athanasius - over the divine nature of the Prophet. While Athanasius and the Emperor both wished the prophet to be seen as an incarnate God, the Arian dissent held that the Prophet - while a direct incarnation of the Will of God - was a created being and subject to God's greater will.

The Council was convened in deep debate over the humanity or divinity of the Sage and the Prophet, and the relative importance of each, when the barbarian hordes from the east began to overrun the Old Empire's defenses. A hundred years of slow wars of attrition against the barbarians depleted the Empire's resolve, and there was never again sufficient peace and safety to reconvene the Council.

The Successor Wars

Finally, after even another century of warfare and decay, the barbarian hordes overthrew the capital – and thus, in 2740, the Old Empire fell into ruin.

In its wake, the barbarian tribes rose up and reclaimed much of the territory that the Empire had conquered. As they did, each of the provincial satraps declared themselves the next logical successor of the Emperor, and began a long, bloody war to establish their legitimacy and undermine any rivals. The attrition and bloodshed rolled back centuries of medical and technological progress, creating a time that historians call the Successor Wars, or simply the Dark Ages.

The first three hundred years of the successor wars saw endless conflict both between the Church and various barbarian tribes, and between various sects and remnants of the Old Empire itself, before the Imperial crown was placed upon the head of Emperor Charles Magnus in 3005. His successors failed to inherit the throne, however, and so it remained empty for generations until a series of weak Emperors were installed as puppets of an increasingly degenerate Church, culminating in the Papal Crisis of 3243.

The crisis began as a split in the Church between the Eastern and Western territories. The cities of Aeterna and Byzantios each elected a Pope, then spent the better part of two centuries competing against each other to retake the Prophet's homeland from the Demon Sultanates and claim it for their side of the Church, in a series of wars called the Reconquests. While many brave and faithful knights and paladins were sent eastward into the Sultanates, the story on the whole was one of opportunity, avarice and corruption.

The Reconquests

For generations, the Demon-Sultans have held both southern Hiberas, the Qaranhu capital of Makkah, and the holy Benysreli capital of Yershalm as conquered vassal-states. Much of the surrounding territory has been reclaimed in successive centuries, as the Holy See issued edict after edict calling for the reconquest of southern Hiberas and the Holy Lands. The Successor Kings, of course, saw this as a calling to distinguish themselves above their peers, and so countless gold and blood has been spilled to move the borders on a map even an inch.

Several holy orders participated in the Reconquests. The qaranhu sufi warriors and the Patmian templars both see it as their sacred duties to retake Makkah and Yershalm respectively, while the Benysreli Sons of the Hammer wish to re-settle the Holy Lands and restore them to their pre-Imperial glory. The logistics of the Reconquests necessitated an establishment of supply lines, trade routes, and accommodations, all of which were managed by the Hospitalier order. Finally, individual pilgrims to the holy land have joined the Reconquests in waves, including an army of children in 2633.

Makkah and Yershalm repeatedly changed hands during the early Reconquests, but have now been firmly under Sultanate dominion for over two centuries.

The Reconquests were finally cut short by the famine and plague, as too many knights and farmers died to sustain the Successor Kings' armies. In the aftermath, the church has begun to go through various reforms, focusing on the reconstruction of devastated communities.

Famine and Plague

In 3400, the Divine Principle seemingly voiced Its displeasure in the Church's ways by revoking all ongoing blessings, leading to a complete crop failure across most of the Successor Kingdoms. When this did not end the corruption, but instead spurred the island kingdom of Albion and the Frankish kings across the sea to ignite a new Successor War for the Imperial throne, the next seemingly divine escalation was a horrible plague that proved resistant to Divine healing.

The famine and plague should have spurred a reconciliation and reform within the Church, re-uniting both halves of the schism and placing the Papal throne back in Aeterna, next to the still-empty throne of the Emperor. Instead, the Church fell into schism for nearly a century, as the plague burned through the European countryside.

Thus far, the longest single active conflict of the Successor Wars is still ongoing, although the Great Famine and Plague ground it to a near-halt for several decades. Albion and Francia continue to fight between each other to unite their kingdoms under one crown, and so lay claim to enough of the Old Empire's territory that the Church must take their claim to the Imperial Throne seriously. The conflict had recently begun to draw to a close with the Albion victories at Azincourt and Avre, but the recent emergence of the Frank peasant-paladin Jeanne and her entourage has begun to turn the tide back against the Albians.

Meanwhile, in the far east of the Old Empire, the capital of Byzantios lies under siege by the Sultans, defended only by remnants of the Reconquests and legions of devout qaranahu sufi warriors. The ongoing siege has recently escalated, and the sufis have sent emissaries west to beg the Church for military aid.

Apostasy

The pressure of the Sultanate's advance, combined with the famine and plague itself, overwhelmed the Church's ability to respond. The entire duchy of Vlahia within Byzantios was left to defend for itself, and many qaranahu sufi and Patmian templars were cut off from resupply and trapped in the holy lands.

Such times try men's faith.

While many remain faithful, some have abandoned the Faith altogether, gradually turning to the Baalim or the Djinn for aid. Those that did not join the Sultanate outright still fight guerrilla wars within its territory, but powered by infernal magics instead of the divine. Many do not even realize that they serve the Baalim; war forces many sacrifices, and some of the Faithful failed to notice in moments of crisis that they had lost their way.

The Baalim are always eager to accept new worshipers, and can mask their power to the apostate to appear Divine instead of Infernal. Deceiving a wayward devout seems to give them great pleasure.

Of course, the possibility of covert Infernal worship disguised as holy Faith is a recipe for paranoia, especially on the battle-fronts. Hiberas in particular descended into madness, ending centuries of peaceful cooperation between the qaranahu, the Benysreli, and the Patmians in favor of a Grand Inquisition to root out heresy and Infernal influence.

So great was the tension, that during the height of the great plague the Church itself was split asunder, with no fewer than seven bishops each declaring themselves the Papal head of holy communion. This chaos would continue until only five years ago, when the Council of Konstans met to resolve the schism and restore unity to the Church.

The new High Father shows himself as humbled by the retribution of the Divine against his predecessors, and has publicly vowed to restore the Church as a beacon of faith and good works across the Old Empire and beyond, but does not go so far as to admit that the famine and plague were direct acts of the Divine sent to punish the Church.

The Plague

The only direct consequence to come out of the Reconquests was a terrible plague, the likes of which the Successor Kingdoms had never imagined. In its aftermath, half of the population lie dead, their lands fallow and their cities emptied. The Kingdoms are just now regaining their footing and rebuilding.

The Plague first came to the Successor Kingdoms from the Sultanate. No one knows the exact circumstances of its arrival, or why it proved so virulent and so resistant to supernatural healing, but theories abound. Some claim the plague was conjured by powerful djinn under the guide of their sha'ir masters, as a weapon of the Sultanate. Still others claim the plague was itself a punishment from the Divine, for sins and excesses committed by the supposed Faithful during the Reconquests. During the plague itself, the Patmians frequently claimed that it was a sign of the coming apocalypse, and that soon the Prophet would return to reclaim the whole world as His kingdom. As this has failed to occur for nearly a century, most of the Faithful dismiss such claims entirely.

The papal Bishops remain conspicuously silent about their own theories.

While isolated pockets of the disease still remain, most of those who survived show considerable resistance to its symptoms, as do their descendants. Any sign of its telltale black nodules will still prompt immediate quarantine and the burning of all the infected's possessions, however.

Infection

The disease itself is spread through blood and other body fluids, usually from biting insects. Dwarven hygiene practices prove remarkably effective at curbing its spread; human and fey settlements that listened to dwarven advice during the outbreak showed only half the mortality of those who blamed the "suspiciously healthy" dwarves for the disease and drove them off or killed them.

The Disease

The symptoms of the plague begin with intense fever and chills, followed by swelling in the neck and under the arms. Eventually the swollen areas turn bruised, and a dark purplish-black rash begins to spread across the body. Soon after, the victim finally dies in delirious agony.

Oftentimes, this is not the end. A corpse slain by the plague will often rise within three nights as an undead wight, seeking living victims to consume or infect. Those with strong will might occasionally rise as revenants with much of their minds and memories intact, while those with weaker spirits arise as mindless shamblers. Burning the corpse and burying the remains on consecrated ground is the only reliable means found to prevent this.

Treatment

Once infected, there is a brief window of two weeks while the disease is taking hold. Detecting the disease is hard at this time, but if detected, a trained alchemist can create brewed elixirs of blue bread-mold and filtered healthy blood from a willing donor, which can be injected slowly directly into the veins of the affected. Dwarven or Church blessings hopefully ensure that the Baalim do not see this as a blood-offering, and a priest or druid will typically hold vigil over the infected throughout their hospice. After two weeks of this treatment, the patient finds it easier to shake off the disease.

If they fail, the disease progresses to its bubonic stage, and little more can be done. Victims at this stage are typically given a mercy brew of poppy milk and strong alcohol, and guided into the hereafter before their bodies and bedsheets are burned to ash and buried deep in consecrated earth.

The Hiberan Inquisition

The Reconquests and the Plague created a time of upheaval for the kingdom of Hiberas. Their response, unfortunately, has been the paranoid oppression of their own people, under the auspices of rooting out infernal cults "snuck in" by apostates returning from the Crusades.

The Inquisition is not entirely evil. Its priests genuinely believe that baalim, djinn, and qlipphothic threats lurk behind every shadow, and they are not entirely wrong. Priests trained by the Inquisition are quite skilled at fighting the undead and infernal threats that clearly threaten civilization in the aftermath of the Great Plague; it's unfortunate that they are often less skilled at distinguishing genuine threats from simple differences in culture, tradition, or philosophy.

The Inquisition has wide latitude to travel across Europa, rooting out infernal cults and necromantic abominations wherever they crop up. The two highest concentrations of the Inquisition are in Byzantium, where outposts desperately train new priests against a steady attrition from fighting the horrors of Vlahia, and Hiberas, where local Patmian sects have all but taken over the clergy, using the order as cover to persecute their benysreli and qaranahu brethren.

Baalim and Qlipphothic Cults

Even given the excesses of the Inquisition, no one can deny its ultimate necessity. Rumors of infernal practices among the Francian nobility are common, with genuine evidence coming to light every few decades (only to be quickly swept under the rug by the royal court). The shambler-infested ruins of settlements wiped out from the plague still dot the landscape of most European countrysides, and of there are always rumors of even darker beings crossing the borders from Vlahia into Byzantium every day. Djinn-addled spies of the Sultanate travel the countryside disguised as qaranahu pilgrims, while the Orc cults in the Misty Isles whisper of the return of their dark god, Crom Cruach, and his bloodthirsty fey pantheon.

False Accusations and Persecution

The worst excesses of the Inquisition are still ongoing, where opportunistic merchants use false testimony of Infernal influence to have their rivals imprisoned and their assets seized. Most of the victims of the Inquisition are the qaranahu and benysreli, but many peasant medicine-women also find themselves falsely accused of witchcraft, usually to settle some lover's spat or family quarrel.

It is an Inquisitor's job to get to the heart of the matter, discover the truth, and see to it that justice and mercy prevail. This isn't always what happens, of course, but the faithful hope that direct Divine intervention will act as the last defense against Infernal treachery and petty human greed.

Djinn Mischief

Meanwhile, the Sultanate continues to slowly encroach back into Hiberas and Byzantium, often fueled by djinn magics. Various trinkets find their way into the hands of Hiberian peasants, where the bound djinn hidden within can begin corrupting their hearts with promises of love, wealth, fame, and glory all at the rub of a lamp or the clutching of a coin.

The Inquisition is much better trained to deal with Baalim cults or Fair Folk witchcraft than it is to deal with djinn magic from the Orient. Prejudices and misunderstandings abound, causing all kinds of harmless druidcraft to be misidentified as consorting with the djinn.

The Church is striving to train new inquisitors in recognizing both djinn magic and beneficial pagan druidry, but the process is slow, and in the meantime too many country healers and midwives sit in jail awaiting trial.

The Renaissance

The current year is 3638 – 1,422 years after the birth of the Prophet – and the world that is dawning is full of wonders. The secrets of the Old Empire are being re-discovered, tall ships sail the horizons in search of new lands and new fortunes, and adventurers cross the continent in search of long-forgotten marvels.

The Successor Kingdoms

Each Successor Kingdom is unique. Some are ruled by wise, benevolent rulers with the council of the Church, while others squabble endlessly, hoping to declare themselves the true heir to an empire whose throne has not held an emperor in centuries.

Below these kings are dukes and barons, counts and marquis, who curry favor with their king to gain land and influence and riches. Below these are noble knights, granted castles and Armor by the crown and sworn to protect the people who work the land their keeps oversee. Below the knights are their counsel — men of learning and cunning who seek to guide their lieges towards the good and the right, or turn them to sin and avarice.

Francia

Francia is one of the richest, oldest, and most corrupt of the Successor Kingdoms. It frequently meddles in the Church's internal affairs, bribes clergy, and otherwise does everything it can to inch ever closer to the Imperial throne, only to be exposed for its corruption and set back to square one.

While the higher nobility is thoroughly corrupt, the lower ranks and the peasantry are mostly good folk, forced to endure the petty ineptitude of their lieges. Indeed, the minor nobility has become almost obsessed with chivalric ideals, hoping to atone for the excesses of their leadership.

Albion

Across the waters from Francia, the island-kingdom of Albion is a surprisingly powerful contender to the Imperial Throne, given its small size. A united kingdom of Bretonian and Gael chieftains bordered to the West by the fey-haunted Misty Isle, Albion alternates between currying favor with the Church and declaring itself an independent monarchy.

Hiberas

To the west of Francia is Hiberas, a diverse culture of Imazig Qaranahu, Patmian Franks, and Benysreli exiles from Kanahan. Besieged to the south by invaders from the Sultanate, the Qaranahu and Benysreli first appeared centuries ago as refugees from the Sultanate's relentless advance. A Qaranahu khilafa gradually evolved, which was dismantled and replaced during the Reconquests.

Paranoia over the plague and the Sultanate has led to a kingdom that can barely maintain its holy communion with the Church, and whose Inquisition zealously seeks out any sign of non-conformity to punish as heresy. The Benysreli and Qaranahu in particular find themselves frequent victims of Inquisitional persecution at the hands of the ascendant Patmian inquisitors.

Byzantios

Byzantios fancies itself the resurrection of the Old Empire, while only laying claim to a small collection of squabbling kingdoms in its Eastern ruins. As the 'Little Empire' nominally contains Aeterna and the Imperial Throne, the kings of Byzantios exert unmatched influence over the inner workings of the Church's politics. As of yet, this influence is still insufficient to secure the old Imperial crown and unite the other kingdoms of the Old Empire under one rule.

Hansa

The Hansa are a league of dwarven and human merchants spread across the Golden river and the North sea. While the Successor Kingdoms have mostly lost the capacity to produce new golem armors or greater siege weapons from scratch, the Hansa's dwarven smiths have come the closest, and regularly construct 'new' armors from salvage – both for their own use, and on commission from other Successor Kings willing to pay their price.

The "Petty Empire"

The Little Empire is a swath of minor duchies between Byzantium and Francia who swear fealty directly to the Empty Throne, awaiting a newly crowned Emperor before granting allegiance to any lesser crown. Their politics and loyalties shift as quickly and confusingly as the duchies of Byzantium; geographical proximity to Aeternum is all that maintains any semblance of stability in the region.

The Danemarch

To the north of Hansa lies the Danemarch, a union of small kingdoms formed when the northern barbarian Vik raiders finally came into communion with the Church. Unlike the other Successor Kingdoms, the kings of the Danemarch make no claim to the Imperial throne, content to rule themselves in peace.

Polarus

East of Byzantios lies Polarus, a federation of hyperborian kingdoms and duchies waging constant battle against the fair folk and orc barbarian hordes in the frozen wastes of the far north. Little news arrives in Aeternum about the going-on in these realms.

Vlahia

Ostensibly, Vlahia is a small kingdom within greater Byzantium, tasked with defending all of the Successor Kingdoms against the Sultanate. The Church has been aware for several centuries that the truth is much, much darker.

The prince-protector of Vlahia was a knight of the Order of the Dragon, sworn to protect the Church and Empire against the Sultans. As the Reconquests turned political, his dissatisfaction with the Church's lack of military support turned to rage when his family was lost in a Sultanate siege. Dracul renounced holy communion and began worshiping the Baalim-idol Orcus, turning to cannibalism and necromancy to empower his army against the Sultan's.

The Sultanate

As the centuries turned, the wonders of the Old Empire slowly decayed further into ruin. The Church and the Successor Kings struggled to reclaim the lost knowledge, but it wasn't until the Eastern trade routes were re-established that the Sultanate's troves of knowledge and research could be compared with the scraps that the Church had saved, and reconstituted into a new Arcane understanding of the universe.

These troves of knowledge did not come cheaply. The differences in culture between the Church and the Sultanate, combined with the greed of some of the Eastern Successor Kingdoms, led to a period of war and bloody conquest between the Successor Kings and the Sultanate known as the Reconquests.

Barbarian Hordes

As the successor kings and queens gave up on their loftier ambitions and turned to securing their borders, the problem of the barbarians in their midst became apparent.

Some barbarian hordes followed the Old Ways, dark religions taught to them by the Fair Folk involving blood sacrifice and slavery. Many eschewed these practices even before the coming of the Church, but prejudice and ignorance tend to paint all barbarians as wild, bloodthirsty monsters before the Church "civilized" them. Regardless, as the priests of the Church negotiated with these barbarians and their fey patrons, and as the darker practices of blood sacrifice and cannibalistic war rituals were abandoned, a truce was eventually negotiated.

Many of the more sensible barbarian druids and chieftains saw the advantages that civilization could bring for their tribes, but did not want to abandon the connection to nature that their fey patrons gave them. The fair folk, in turn, saw the power and threat that the Successor Kings still represented, and wished to make peace if they could.

Those fair folk who agreed to the Church's terms became the numina, respected guardians of nature that are given the sacrifice and respect due to beings responsible for the health of crops and livestock and the stability of the weather and ecology. Their shamans and medicine women would be allowed to continue their cultural practices unmolested, and would retain a position of respect and reverence within their communities. In return, the darker sacrifices and practices would be abandoned.

Most of the fair folk and barbarians that refused the Church's peace offering doubled down on the darker aspects of their rites, eventually even incorporating new dark and bloody practices from renegade Baalim cults, until a new kind of syncretic infernal religion formed. These barbarian tribes typically organize their diverse worship of the fair folk and Baalim under Orcus – the Baalim of terror and torture – as their chief deity, and so most common languages refer to them as 'orcs'.

The Successor Kings

Since the first fall of Aeterna nearly a millennium ago, each of the Successor Kings has aspired to ascend the Imperial Throne. The Holy Pope, as head of the Church, has declared that no claim on the throne secured through wars of aggression will be recognized, and so the Successor Kings mostly fight amongst each other for land and power, in the hopes that one of them might possess enough de facto control over the Empire that the Church would be forced to recognize them.

The Church limits even this activity, declaring excommunicato any Successor King, or their lieutenants, who endanger their subjects through the waging of war. This forces the Successor Kingdoms to limit themselves to diplomacy, espionage, and honor duels.

Diplomatic Relations

Each of the Successor Kings maintains diplomatic ties with the others through the Church, sending envoys to the Holy See of Aeterna on each holy day to maintain relations. The complex web of favors, vendettas, and intrigue generates a never-ending opera of drama and gossip, which delights the peasants and infuriates the Church.

Espionage

Spy-craft, assassinations, and sabotage of industrial capacity have all taken their toll on the Successor Kingdoms' technological capacities, leaving them all a pale shadow of the Old Empire's mighty works. Even after the Plague, assassins and saboteurs from each Successor Kingdom work to undermine the progress of each of the others, despite the Church's admonitions against the practice.

Such is the way of the world that destroying a wonder has always been an easier matter than restoring it; this fact allows the poorer Successor Kingdoms to keep parity with the richer, by devoting their efforts to pulling their more advanced neighbors back down to their level.

Honor Duels

The Successor Wars were only ended by threat of excommunication by the Church. In their place, the Successor Kings and their barons will often claim pretexts of offended honor, in order to stage elaborate duels to the death to seek satisfaction. An honor-duel can be as simple as two barons fighting in an open field in their golem armors while their subjects enjoy the spectacle, or might blossom into full siege warfare, where one baron marches his armies on another baron's keep.

Any siege that lasts long enough to risk the health of the populace is usually responded to quickly by the Church. Without the very real threat of excommunication – and its immediate revocation of protection from unholy threats – history might have unfolded into a much darker, bloodier age.

A feudal lord, by definition, has sworn an oath – an oath sanctified by the full power and faith of the Church – to protect their vassals with their life. If their vassals are besieged, it is their sworn duty to challenge the attacker to single combat to minimize bloodshed, or to accept the attacker's challenge to the same. Warriors that are known to win honor duels through dirty tricks lose the right to have their challenges taken seriously, but if two honorable knights meet on the field of battle, they are expected to fight for the lives of their men, rather than cowering behind them.

A lord can also send a designated proxy in their stead – another warrior who will fight for their lord's honor, whose victory or defeat will be accepted with the same weight as their liege's. Often, two aged lords will each designate a proxy, agreeing to settle the matter through their respective champions.

The common practice is for honor duels between those of genuine noble blood to use golem armor, and fight to the disabling of one armor or the other, with the winner claiming the loser's armor as a war-prize and ransoming the loser back to their liege for gold. Actual fights to the death are typically the sign of a bitter personal vendetta or the undercurrents of deeper political machinations.

Titles of Nobility

One reward that your character might gain for particularly heroic deeds is a title of nobility. Titles of nobility increase in rank, and each rank comes with its own privileges and responsibilities.

Peasant

Those who do not hold a noble title are called peasants or freemen, depending on the local culture and its attitude towards its people. Peasants are always subject to a particular titled noble, who protects them and the land they live on in exchange for taxes and fealty.

Thanks to the Church, the life of a peasant in the Successor Kingdoms is much more pleasant than it otherwise could be - peasants in most kingdoms are taught to read, write, and do basic maths from a young age, and are allowed to buy, sell, and travel as they see fit so long as they pay their taxes.

Taxes are typically distributed upwards from knights to barons to dukes to kings through a tradition called "half-tithe" - half of any taxes collected or other riches gained by a knight are expected to be paid to their baron or marquis, who gets to keep half of the tax collected and must pass the other half (a quarter of the total riches) upwards to their duke or count, and eventually to their king.

These taxes are expected to fund the welfare and safety of the peasantry, by supplying the nobility with arms and armor, training, and military logistics; any remaining taxation is expected to go to public works, which are overseen by the church on behalf of the peasantry. How often this ideal matches reality varies from Successor Kingdom to Successor Kingdom.

Knight

The lowest title that can be bestowed is knighthood. Knighthood elevates a commoner into the lowest ranks of the nobility, where it is "sink or swim".

Knighthood is always awarded along with a keep and its surrounding farmlands, rivers, forests and mines; it is a knight's solemn duty to take up arms to defend the denizens of their keep and the surrounding countryside, as well as to answer the call if their Baron or Marquis marches to war.

Baron or Marquis

Above knights are their barons and marquises. Barons rule over a barony, while marquises rule over a bordermarch. As the name suggests, a bordermarch is typically on the border with a potentially hostile neighboring kingdom, and so marquises will typically be more martially-oriented, while barons can typically afford to be much more politically and economically ambitious.

Count or Duke

Above barons and marquises are dukes and counts. Dukes oversee several baronies within their duchies, while counts oversee several marches within their counties.

In a competently-run kingdom, counts are typically successful military generals, while baronies are more traditional hereditary titles, but Frankish traditions of counts appointing their successors, and invariably choosing their own sons, has removed most of the distinction in Francia.

Prince or King

At the top of the noble hierarchy is the prince or king, who commands an entire kingdom made of multiple duchies and counties. A sovereign is theoretically answerable to the highest levels of the church, but bows to no one else.

Emperor

Coveted by all the Successor Kings is the title of Emperor, heir to the throne of the Old Empire. While some kings might call themselves "Emperor" and call the counts or dukes under them "kings", in order to claim the Imperial laurel each of the other Successor Kings would need to swear fealty to them, and the Church would have to anoint the new Emperor and sanctify their ascension. Such a feat has not happened in nearly a thousand years, since the passing of Charles Magnus, and a new worthy Emperor looks less likely with each passing decade.

The Church

The Church has held an unbroken spiritual dominion over Western civilization since the Constant Emperor decreed its founding three centuries after the death of the Prophet. Before then, the disciples of the Prophet had been a persecuted underground religion, striving to spread their faith under a hostile purge by the Old Empire.

Joining the Faith

Any creature who shows real faith, and desire to aid others in resisting the call of sin, may be sworn into the brotherhood of the Prophet's disciples. For most mortals born within civilization, this oath is sworn upon reaching the age of majority – usually considered to be 12 years of age. Other converts may swear their first oath at any point in life.

Church Dogma

The Constant Emperor attempted to influence his power over the dogma of the church during the Council of Nikai, but the arrival of barbarian hordes pulled him into battle, and dogma was ratified in his absence which neither canonized nor denied his preferred interpretations. The resulting compromise holds that the Prophet himself was the divine and only-begotten Son of God, but not that the Prophet was necessarily identical with the Divine itself.

The modern church considers direct worship of the Prophet as God to be an uncomfortable subject, best avoided in polite company; officially sanctioned worship is encouraged to use the phrase “the Divine Almighty, and his begotten Son the Prophet, and their Holy Spirit that guides us”. In this way, a real and bloody war is avoided between the three primary political sects of the Church.

Communion and Variation

Several variations of this dogma exist, however, some of which are still considered by the church to be in full communion with the Holy See, and some of which are not. Several ex communicate sects are still perfectly capable of performing apparently Divine miracles, however, which sometimes raises uncomfortable questions about the truly “catholic” nature of the Church.

The Trinity of Expression

Church philosophy holds that there are but three essences of the Divine, which can be apprehended by mortal experience:

First, the Divine Principle itself, known by some as “God the Father” or “Yahvah”, that which created the universe – Aether and Matter both - and which laid the course of time and fate for all men.

Second, the Prophet and begotten son of the Divine Principle, who was given wholly to the Divine and made a living seal on all death-sacrifice to atone for the sins of Man,

And third, the Divine Spirit, the shared state of communion with the Divine, whose essence was demonstrated by the life and works of the Prophet and in whom all subjects of the holy Church are invited to participate.

Church dogma holds that the Divine Principle lays out an ideal course for man to follow, but that greed and vengeance and fear tempt men to disobey; that the Prophet, by fully accepting their role as the Lamb of Sacrifice, was made one with the Will of the Divine, thus planting the seed for the Kingdom of Heaven which cleanses the sins of the world, and that obedience to the Divine Principle, as demonstrated by the Lamb of Sacrifice, allows men to participate in the communion of the Divine Spirit, by which the Kingdom of Heaven is built and eternally improved.

Saints and Numina

Below the Divine Principle, the Prophet, and the Divine Spirit are the various Sanctified Souls – mortals and spirits canonically recognized as partaking in the Divine Spirit, and serving as exemplars of the Prophet's callings. While no living mortal can be declared Sanctified, a mortal can be canonized on death, with their ghost often manifesting to render aid in response to displays of sufficient Faith, and in times of dire need.

Numina, in contrast, are Saints that were never strictly “alive” to begin with – usually fey nature spirits or even infernal beings who sincerely repent, and who act as the patron saints of nature or barbarian cultures that have since joined the holy Faith and adopted its ways.

Sects and Heresies

There are three primary sects within the holy Church, which are recognized as maintaining full communion with each other. Other sects exist, but their relationships to church dogma are less clear. Any found to have deviated too far are subject to excommunication, voiding any sanctified oaths made under its aegis.

Patmians

The first sect, called the Patmians, teach that the Prophet and the Divine were in all ways the same being, that any paradoxes in this teaching are a mortal limitation to be ignored, and that the divine sovereignty of the Prophet will be revealed when He physically returns to lead His faithful in battle against the forces of evil. They take most of their teachings from an obscure prophetic manuscript written threescore years after the Prophet's sacrifice, which describes a seven-year tribulation of famines, wars, and plagues followed by the resurrection of all dead and a new Kingdom of Heaven led directly by the incarnate Prophet. Patmian priests often align with the War, Fate, or Death domains.

Qaranahu

The second sect, called the Qaranahu, hold to the teachings of a "final Prophet", who was born in the lands that became the Sultanate 600 years after the Lamb of Sacrifice, and who waged war against the Sultans to break the djinn's hold on their subjects. Many qaranahu still live uneasily within the Sultanate's rule, but more fled Westward into the domain of the Church, where they hold an unsteady alliance with the Patmians to wage holy war against the Sultan's armies. Most Qaranahu priests tend to align with the War, Freedom, or Truth domains, but a few choose Life or Nature instead.

Yeshuits

The third sect, called the Yeshuits, hold that the works of the Prophet are more important than the Prophet's identity or nature, and that all are called to make themselves of service to others and assist in the building of the Kingdom of Heaven. Yeshuit priests tend to align themselves with the Life, Peace, or Beauty domains. A rarer sect nominally aligned with the Yeshuits, calling themselves the Masons of the Temple, align themselves to the Artifice domain.

Ex-Communicado Sects

Certain groups have shown themselves capable of wielding Divine power without being in holy communion with the Church. This fact disturbs the clergy greatly, but it cannot be disputed.

First among them are the Benysreli, a group of Kanahani barbarian tribes that the Lamb of Sacrifice descended from. While much of Church dogma is inherited from their holy books, the Benysreli do not, as a whole, recognize the Prophet as their sovereign Lord. They are permitted to practice their faith as they see fit, given its similarity to Church faith in other respects, and equal abhorrence of the Baalim and other unholy influences.

Various cultural differences have given the Benysreli tribes certain distinct advantages, leading to their frequent appearance in civilization's higher administrative offices. Benysreli craftsmen and money-lenders are renowned for their skill, and they enjoy a very cordial relationship in particular with the Temple-Masons – often joining their ranks despite the lack of holy communion.

The Clergy

While the physical center of a village or city is typically the lord's castle that protects its citizens from physical threats, the moral center of a village is its church and clergy, charged with protecting the congregation from moral and supernatural threats.

As such, the clergy also tend to serve as the functionaries of the civilized world's judicial system, investigating crimes and prosecuting and defending those accused of them. The baron or marquis of a region is expected to oversee all trials in their barony or bordermarch, while the clergy is expected to present the evidence for and against the accused, and advise the noble about the nuances of the law and principles of justice to be upheld.

The Church's hierarchy is seen as parallel to and separate from the Crown's. While the crown is seen as the ultimate seat of worldly power, the church's role is to keep that power in check, and force a transition of power if a sovereign is deemed overcome with avarice or ambition.

Dwarven Strongholds

The Church and the dwarves have an odd relationship. Due to doctrinal similarities, the Church believes that dwarves may be an offshoot of the Benysreli; as such, those who continue to practice their ancestral faith are usually considered to be in full holy communion with the Church, and therefore are fully a part of the Successor Kingdoms' civilization. Unofficially, dwarven custom, technology, and even architecture is different enough from their human brethren that they are often treated as vital but distrusted outsiders.

Dwarven miners, smiths, craftsmen, merchants, and money-lenders are such a vital part of human society that their enclaves can be found within virtually every large human settlement. However, their natural industriousness and insular ways tend to lead humans to regard them with distrust, bordering on outright envy when their prosperity outshines that of their human neighbors. Dwarves in turn tend to be dismissive and distrustful of their human patrons, retreating to their own kind in times of trouble and often ignoring or even circumventing human law and custom.

Dwarven Magic and Religion

Most dwarves do not seem to make a particular distinction between religion, magic, law, or mundane life. Dwarven magic involves rituals for appeasing and honoring their dead ancestors, rituals for craft and labor, and rituals for blessings and oath-binding, but none of these are considered 'magic' as such to a dwarf. They are simply ways of interacting with the world, as straightforward as ploughing a field or mending a torn cloth.

Benysreli dwarven dogma in particular holds that their laws were handed down directly by the Divine when they were guided out of the Tewy-Kemeth Empire in its heyday and into their Kanahan homeland over three thousand years ago. As such, their laws are often seen as religious rituals just as much as they are secular duties.

Dwarven Technology

While none of the successor states are capable of producing new golem armors or other wonders of the Old Empire, many dwarven enclaves still retain the knowledge and skill to repair those wonders that survive to today.

Martial Technology

Dwarf-forged weapons and armor are renowned across the Successor Kingdoms for their superiority; a master dweomersmith can command a king's ransom for a well-forged panoply of armor plus barding. Some dwarves have been kept for generations as the personal armorers of kings and dukes, tending to their inherited golem-armors and personal liveries and occasionally maintaining larger works of necessary civil infrastructure.

Sanitation

Within their own communities, dwarven sanitation and water management are a marvel that rivals the Old Empire for sophistication; this fact alone was responsible for most of the remarkably low death rate among dwarven kaers during the Plague.

Agriculture

Dwarven agricultural technology tends to blend the most sensible parts of dwarven and gnomish know-how, adopting druidcraft wherever it shows a clear benefit over mundane approaches. Their above-ground yield is supplemented by vast underground "mushroom farms", arrayed in vertical columns and fed by composted wood and treated waste. Even here, dwarven sanitation technologies are employed to purge all trace of pathogens from the nightsoil before introducing it into the mulch.

Medicine

Dwarven medical facilities also show themselves superior to what the human world has to offer; most human hospitalier priests, in fact, arrange to spend a year serving under a dwarven dweomersmith medic before taking their vows. The combination of improved sanitation, improved healthcare, and natural dwarven hardiness mean that dwarven communities suffer much less frequently from plagues and epidemics of all kinds, and can survive much longer even under siege or famine conditions.

Dwarven Culture and Architecture

Dwarven kaer are typically divided into two layers – the Surface and the Below.

The Surface

Surface-dwelling dwarves and gnomes typically live in well-kept burrows dug out of hillsides, or clay and brick homes that are half-submerged into the ground. The roofs of their dwellings are typically thickly reinforced and covered with a layer of dirt and sod, often with a vegetable garden or vineyard. Surface-dwelling dwarves and their gnomish allies produce most of the food for a dwarven settlement, and manage commerce and diplomacy with visitors.

The Below

Dozens of feet below them, the proper stronghold stretches across a wide area, dug out of the living bedrock by generations of dwarven miners and masons. The tunnels radiate out from a central column, above which sits the temple-tabernacle that serves as the focal point of the community. The inner ring of tunnels holds the priests and judges of the settlement, followed by the most experienced dweomersmiths and their forges in the next ring, and then spreading out into the common dwellings.

The Mines

Crews of delvers typically work night and day, clearing out new tunnels and uncovering new treasures, alongside their stalwart bodyguards. On each Friday evening, however, the entire community comes to a halt, gathers at their tabernacle, and performs rituals of worship to the Divine before spending until the next sunset in study and ritual prayer. Only a direct and immediate threat to their community will break this tradition.

Relations to Other Races

Dwarves are famously insular, stubborn, and gruff; even so, their peerless skill, dedication to hard work and scholarship, and loyalty to those they have chosen as friends make them highly sought-after allies and trading partners in the Successor Kingdoms. These ties of diplomacy and economics have helped make dwarves a famously wealthy race.

Dwarves and Gnomes

The majority of gnomes that live within civilized communities live among dwarven settlements as farmers, ranchers, and shepherds, and are simply considered fellow-dwarves by their underground cousins. Dwarven gnomes are usually trained as hunters and druids, but still participate in dwarven culture and ritual in full communion with their underground kin.

Thousands of years of intermarriage between dwarf and gnome bloodlines has led to both species readily showing traits of the other. One human rumor says that any dwarvish gnomes raised underground and taught hard labor from an early age will grow to dwarvish stature and robustness, while any dwarf raised above-ground and tasked with lighter duties in adolescence will reach adulthood with a more gnomelike physique. The truth leans more in the other direction; dwarves born with a more gnomish physique and temperament will tend to find life more comfortable above ground, while those more suited to the tunnels eventually find their way there.

Dwarves and Humans

Some dwarven families have dwelled directly within the Successor Kingdoms for generations, working as merchants, craftsmen and laborers for noble human families with sufficiently deep pockets. Their customs and traditions have evolved into a blend of dwarven ritual and Church faith, while generations of intermarrying has reduced some of the more striking dwarven features.

Non-Benysreli Dwarves

Plenty of dwarven communities other than the Benysreli clans exist, some of which take up settlement within the Successor Kingdoms. Most, like the Hansa, are considered in direct holy communion, while a few secretly worship the djinn or the baalim while pretending to communion in order to avoid persecution. It was these latter dwarves who created the original pretext for the Hiberian inquisition, which continues to keep a wary eye on its Benysreli dwarves in the hopes of rooting out idolatry and witchcraft.

Barbarian Tribes

The barbarian tribes are still being slowly integrated into civilization, even twelve centuries after the Old Empire fell. Barbarian druids in more civilized areas often work side-by-side with priests, helping to maintain the balance between the natural world, Faerie, and civilization.

Druids

'Civilized' druids will assist the local clergy in matters related to childbirth, livestock, farming, hunting, and wilderness; in exchange, they are allowed to perform animal (but never mortal) sacrifices in accordance with the Old Ways. Church dogma insists that all numina and fair folk that are so appeased are treated only with the reverence and respect due to a mortal ruler of a domain, and that true divinity is reserved for the Divine Principle alone. Only a few holdouts in the deep wilds still hold fully to the Old Ways, performing mortal sacrifices and directly worshipping the fair folk as wholly divine beings.

As the Old Ways continue to give way to the Church, the role of the village druid is often subsumed by priests dedicated to the Nature domain. Indeed, most such priests still call themselves druids, although their practices are limited to rituals and spellcasting - true shape-changing and partnership with the wisps requires a dedication to wild nature that is incompatible with the kind of fervent Faith in the One that the Church teaches.

'Wild' barbarian tribes tend to mix ancestor and nature worship together, making human and animal sacrifices to both. Their chief deities are typically a mated pair, between some form of ancestral war-god and a Fair Folk fertility-goddess, with other gods in their pantheon representing various aspects of their daily lives. A rarer few worship the Baalim, preserving dark rites and myths from as long ago as the Flood itself.

Hunters and Champions

Most young adults in a barbarian tribe are hunters or champions. Barbarian society is harsher and more demanding than civilization, so there are no dedicated "farmers" or "craftsmen" that are not ultimately also adventurers, with full adventurer class levels. Chieftains and elders are taken from those hunters and champions who survive into old age, while druids are trained from a young age when a particularly precocious child shows a strong knack for deeper fey magics.

Chieftains and Elders

A village chieftain or chieftain council will typically rule a barbarian tribe side-by-side with the local druids, much in the same way that the nobility and the clergy rule side-by-side in 'civilization'.

Without the technological infrastructure to maintain and field Golem Knights, the barbarian tribes typically rely on their druids in times of war or when dealing with large and dangerous beasts. Many barbarian tribes turn to taming and riding large, ferocious fey beasts themselves, giving them an edge in battle that quite matches the capabilities of a Golem Knight - as the Old Empire discovered during its second great war with Qarthast.

Members of the chieftain council who are too old to participate actively in the defense of their village are treated as valued elders by barbarian tribes, but are no longer allowed to make direct decisions on matters of policy unless they can demonstrate their military prowess and vigor. While chieftain councils are typically restricted to warriors, the elder council of a village often includes a mixture of old champions, druids, hunters, and other members of the tribe venerated for their age and wisdom.

Fey Barbarian Tribes

Roughly half of the barbarian tribes remaining in the far wilds are human. The remainder are fey - tribes of elves, fauns and centaurs that have managed to stay hidden from the encroaching tide of Imperial and Successor civilization.

Their innate connection to Faerie allows fey barbarian tribes to elude conversion more easily, despite their lower numbers - questing knights can be pulled into Faerie en masse, or entire forest villages can be pulled from the Material into Faerie to elude capture or destruction. Even so, the fey can tell that they are fighting a losing battle.

The loss of territory and numbers has led to many fey tribes combining into coalitions, with elves, beastfolk and even trolls joining together and learning to cooperate. Some of these tribal confederations manage to rival the Successor Kingdoms for local power, but they and the Church both know that one good Reconquest would put an end to everything. For now, the game is to keep the peace and not be a nuisance, and hope that the Church is too busy reclaiming its losses from the plague to bother with wiping them all out.

The strongest fey barbarian holdout to date is the Misty Isle, a large island to the west of Albion that has stubbornly resisted conquest for centuries. The local coalition includes humans, elves, gnomes, beastfolk, trolls, and even goblins, and has even managed to petition the Church for "communion as equals". While negotiations are ongoing, the Misty Isles already limits the worship of its patron Fair Folk in most of the same ways as Numina, prohibiting all cannibalism and human sacrifice.

Time will tell if it proves enough. Once the fey barbarian tribes are gone, the human barbarians know that they will likely lose their folkways, with any particularly important Fair Folk patron-gods converting first to Numina, then into abstract saints.

Beastfolk Cults

One stubborn holdout of barbarian ways are the animal-warrior cults. Young champions-in-training from human or fey barbarian tribes will abandon their tribe at puberty, and join nomadic warbands dedicated to a particular patron animal. The fiercest of these tribes are led by beastman shapeshifters, leading to legends of werewolves and other terrible half-beasts told to frighten children at night.

As the Church encroaches on their territories, many of these cults turn to Orcus worship to empower themselves against the magics of civilization, learning cannibalistic rites that can even grant human champions the fey powers of their shapeshifting warlords.

The rest have resigned themselves to slow extinction, as their folkways fade from memory within civilization's iron maze. Some "civilized" beastfolk cults offer themselves as mercenaries or even soldiers-at-arms for the successor kingdoms, but prejudice bred from fighting Orcish werewolf cults makes this harder and harder each year.

Gnomish Shires

Unlike other fey, gnomes take readily to civilization, most often joining dwarven settlements as surface-dwelling farmers and beast-herders in exchange for protection from the wilds. A gnomish shire will typically extend down ten to fifteen feet into the earth in a maze of tidy burrows and warrens, with a central marketplace that also opens into the dwarven fortress beneath them.

Dwarves and gnomes each benefit greatly from this arrangement, with gnomes providing the dwarves a needed supply of meat, grain, and competent traders and merchants, while the dwarves provide the gnomes with martial protection, finely crafted goods, and riches mined from the earth.

The Sultanate

The largest sovereign empire to challenge the Church for dominion over the known world is the Sultanate. Called the "Demon-Sultans" by the church, the Sultans are known for their readiness to consort with djinn – powerful elemental Fair Folk who feed on the desires of mortals, and who "grant wishes" to fulfill lesser desires so long as doing so will lead to greater and more desperate desire.

The djinn have always been a force to be reckoned with. Save for a brief gap in the 7th century, when a man called the "last of the Prophets" by the Qaranahu founded a Caliphate based on Divine revelation, the djinn have empowered one Sultan after another in an unbroken chain of debauchery.

Deep within the Sultanate is the City of Ten Thousand Delights, where mortals can bargain with the djinn and their "masters" for their hearts' desire. A vast warren of brothels, slave-pens, merchant stalls and opium dens, the City is a perfect representation of everything in human nature that the Church teaches its subjects to rise above.

At the center of the City are the Sultans' fabled pleasure-palaces. Here, delights from all the ages and all corners of the world have been brought to the Sultans by their djinn and mortal servants. Here, harem-girls and concubines and eunuch slaves dance half-naked for the delight of the noble classes, or find themselves tortured to death for spectacle should they fail to entertain. Here are all the passions of the flesh offered up on one ornately gilded, blood-soaked platter.

The Djinn

The djinn play at "serving" the Sultans, but an examination of history suggests that the true order of things is the other way around. Sultans come and go, invariably undone by their own hubris, but power vacuums are almost immediately filled as a new djinn-backed usurper rises to ascendancy. The qaranahu teach that the djinn are not to be trusted – while some individuals may have been tamed and humbled by Suleman the Wise in the time of the Benysreli kingdom, most live only to feed off the pride and ambition of their mortal "masters".

The Sha'ir

While the Church has its priests, and the Barbarian tribes have their druids, the demon-sultans have their sha'ir. Sha'ir require no formal training, no vows of service, nothing at all to limit them – they need only possess some quality that attracts the djinn to them, and the lack of foresight to accept whatever the djinn first offer.

Thus, most sha'ir have short, brutal careers before their own desires get the better of them. Those that survive tend to be the cleverest, the most patient, or simply the luckiest. Court sha'ir operate formally in the service of the Sultans, where they are trained in logic, history, custom, and law only after they prove themselves capable of "safely" wielding power.

The Merchant Guilds

While the Demon-Sultans are the undisputed ruler of their empire, the merchant-guilds hold enough power that the two exist in an uneasy alliance. Each successive Sultan has decreed that within the walls of the Great City, there shall be but one law: None Shall Interfere With Trade. Without a bound contract of protection, anyone within the city is subject to seizure and enslavement by anyone strong enough to overpower them. A signed contract, however, is ironclad – but only between those whose signatures are on the paper, and witnessed by a court sha'ir.

Navigating the labyrinth of overlapping contracts of protection and vengeance is nigh impossible, and so almost everyone within the Great City can be found guilty of some kind of breach of contract, should the matter be brought to court. Most wealthy citizens simply pay whatever bribes are necessary to stay out of court, while the less fortunate endeavor to never catch the city guards' attention.

The Sultans

The Sultans themselves are a mostly-hereditary line of autocratic despots, although lineages frequently end in coup or assassination. While a Sultan is on top of the heap, however, their rule is absolute and unquestioned – and usually backed up by overwhelming magical force provided by their sha'ir and djinn servants.

The Empires of the Qans

Further east, the travels of Marc of the Million Steps two centuries ago exposed the Successor Kingdoms to an equally vast array of empires, ruled by the disparate grandsons of the great Temujin Chungus Qan.

Most knowledge of the Qan Empires comes from the stories written about Marc of the Million's travels, and considerable license was taken to make an entertaining read. Even so, traders and fortune-seekers trek the dangerous Silk Roads from Byzantios to the Middle Kingdoms, and those who return confirm that many of the wild tales bear a significant kernel of truth.

The Qanate of Ayrahn

Bordering the Demon-Sultanate to the East, Ayrahn is a vast and wealthy empire that somehow manages to trade with the Sultanate while avoiding overt corruption by the Djinn. Qaranahu is the official state religion, but non-qaranahu Faithful may openly worship as they choose so long as they pay a civil tax to the Qanate, called kharajizyah.

The Jade Empire of Yuan Kublai Qaghan

Further Eastward lies the vast Middle Kingdom, an ancient regime as powerful as the Old Empire in its heyday. The Middle Kingdom has frequently split into its own form of Successor Kingdoms over its recorded history, but its current Emperor is the great Yuan Kublai Qaghan. Within the Jade Empire, the writings of the Sage are venerated over those of the Prophet, who is at most seen as a minor footnote in the Sage's history and philosophy. Monasteries and academies dedicated to preserving and teaching the Sage's Four Truths and Eight Journeys dot the landscape, with the most famous being the Zhan-Shaolin war-monastery in the Songshan mountains.

Priests of the Jade Empire are not considered in holy communion with the Church, but are still fully capable of wielding Divine power in a fashion effectively identical to those of the Faith – and while the specifics of their dogmas, strictures, and rituals are very different, their underlying moral philosophy is nearly identical.

Stranger Lands

Beyond the Silk Roads lie kingdoms too strange to be believed, full of untold dangers and wonders. Only the bravest of explorers venture this far off the map in their search for fortune and glory.

The Ruins of Veda

South of the Silk Roads lies the ruins of the ancient Vedan empire, birthplace of the Sage. While the empire itself has been in ruins for over a thousand years, various minor kingdoms rule over swaths of its remains.

To the north, the Delhi Sultanate is one of the richest holdings of the Sultans, occasionally rising to rival the glory of the Old Empire before greed and addiction bring it all crumbling back down. Further south, the Empire of the Nagarajah dragons rules the southern coast, mostly populated by lizardfolk, serpentfolk centaurs, and other dragon-kin. Between them lie vast swaths of unexplored jungles and ancient ruins, undisturbed by mortal hands for centuries.

The Ruins of Kemeth

Kemeth is a haunted desert empire, filled with vast treasures guarded by hordes of the undead. Both the Sultans and the Qaranhu have tried alternately to reclaim the land or plunder its treasures, only to be driven off each time by the lich-pharaohs and their soul-sworn servants.

Still, travellers in the vast Sahar will sometimes tell of encountering ancient, withered monuments to the lich-pharaohs, surrounded only by the lone and level sands of the boundless desert.

The Islands of Yamado

Farthest east are the unconquered islands of the Yamado, home to native priest-kings living in relative harmony with an isolated offshoot of the Zhan-Shaolin warrior-monks.

Exaggerated tales of the Yamado warriors have filtered through the scribes of the Middle Kingdom to reach the ears of the Successor Kings, but few have laid eyes upon them.

The Unexplored

The Legacy of Aztlanteos

When Aztlanteos and Mu nearly destroyed the world, a few prescient dragons and mortals fled to the skies or the seas.

Some of them even survived.

To the far west of Europa, far beyond the Gates of Atlas, there lies an undiscovered continent where the dragon princes of Mu lead their human, fey, and lizardfolk followers in dark sacrificial rituals. Dotted with portals to and from Agarta, the Lost Continent contains a wealth of gold and gems, guarded by vast draconic beasts of burden not seen on earth since the Starfall.

The far north and south of this vast serpentine continent stretch almost from pole to pole, and humans and elves fleeing the tyranny of their draconic masters have colonized these regions with civilizations comparable to those of Europe before the Old Empire. In between, the lush jungles are a blood-soaked paradise for the dragons and their kin, with the mortal races forced to offer daily sacrificial tribute to the dragon-kings' solar cult each sunrise.

Hard technology on the Lost Continent is far inferior to that of modern Europa, let alone that of the Old Empire; without dwarven guidance, the people of the Lost Continent never discovered the secret of iron-working. Instead, the dragons have tutored their mortal slaves in the breeding and cultivation of all kinds of beasts and plants, turning the entire continent unimaginably fertile and lush and green under their stewardship.

Sailing technology, too, is inferior to that of Europa. European sailing ships improve with each generation; within 50 years, the sailors of Hiberas and Aeternum are likely to produce vessels capable of crossing the Sea of Atlas and setting foot on this "new world", while its denizens could not hope to accomplish the same feat for many generations. The fault is not some internal failing of the people of the Lost Continent, but rather a deliberate choice of their draconic masters to keep them too weak to flee or rebel.

The Sky-Raiders of Magonia

In the hyperborean northeast of Europa, the heathen legends tell of an ancient remnant of the Atztlantean civilization called Magonia. When Aztlanteos fell, the Magonians raised a fleet of vast city-fortresses into the sky with lodestone levitation, biding their time until the waters of the Great Flood subsided and they could re-conquer the unsuspecting world at their leisure.

Instead, they found the dwarves of Babilim already rebuilding the Godgate. The ensuing battle nearly wiped out both camps, scattering the dwarves across the fertile crescent and shattering their tribal unity. The Magonians were even less lucky.

Over time, the damage the sustained from the conflict depleted the Magonian civilization's capacity to maintain both their fleet and their population, until one by one they abandoned their city-fortresses altogether. Now only their capital, Lapta, has any residents at all; while a dozen forgotten castles float aimlessly across the sky tended only by construct servants.

Magonian sky-raiders will still appear from the clouds above eastern Byzantium from time to time, swooping down to demand tribute from awe-struck peasants and then returning to their sky-fortress of Lapta. But their raids grow less and less frequent each century, as the Magonian over-reliance on technology slowly but inexorably saps the vitality and will from their race.

Magonian skyships are vast affairs, sometimes as many as 100 paces long, and often carry a crew of up to eighty. Most of their space is taken up by "lifting gas" and vast cargo bays, which hold smaller constructs remarkably similar to golem armor, but dedicated entirely to aerial maneuvering. Anyone examining an Magonian "warhawk" will see the similarities immediately; a warhawk is essentially an armless golem armor with minimal legs, and the arms and shoulders replaced with vast metal wings and propulsion systems.

Capturing even a single functional Magonian warhawk would immediately make any of the Successor Kings the major power of Europa, and a strong contender for the empty Throne.

The Cavernous Depths

Deep below the Hansa's ports and villages lies a subterranean kingdom of orc barbarians that the Hansa call Svartalfheim. A coalition of elf, dwarf, and ettercap barbarian tribes has lived within these caverns, seemingly since before recorded history. Elves and ettercaps maintain a brutal hierarchy in service to their Baalim mistress, a being they call "the Weaver". Exiles and refugees from Svartalfheim say that their dark Goddess is the same as, or a corruption of, the pagan Sisters of Fate, but that her only visage known to the underground kingdom is that of a vast, bloated black spider two mortal arms and three mortal faces.

The Hansa has occasionally tried to negotiate with Svartalfheim for access to the many rich veins of subterranean metal and gems that lie directly beneath their feet, but the dark elves always demand too high a price, and their lust for slaves and sacrificial victims put them at direct odds with the Church and civilization.

Deeper within the subterranean passageways of Svartalfheim, it is said that even darker and older things dwell, untouched and unknown since the dawn of the world.

The Mountains of Madness

At the southern pole of the world is another unexplored continent, too cold and remote to serve as a place of power for anything mortal.

Deep within its interior, jagged mountain ranges lie buried under millennia of ice. Slumbering within are the last remnants of a race older than the world itself, creatures from somewhere else in the cosmos that chose our world as a place to explore and colonize.

They are all dead now, but the hideous things they spawned as their servants still prowl the halls of their ancient cities. In modern times, the yuggothim will occasionally visit their ruins, either to pay respect or to scavenge for technologies that the younger races have not yet learned to make for themselves.

Yuggothi sky-ships occasionally flit across the skies of Europa on their way to established landing sites, appearing most often in the shape of round metal shields that skip across the sky. The Church tends to dismiss such sightings as the ramblings of peasants and drunkards.

The Sunken City

Somewhere beyond even the lost continent, there is a vast ocean. Deep at the bottom of that ocean lies the source of all magic, the Mother of Dragons called Tiamat in the ancient tongue of the Babylonians, and Kutulu in the Sumerian.

It was Tiamat that taught the lizardfolk race the rituals and formulae to become dragons, and it was Tiamat that showed the dragons how to escape the Starfall into the Elemental Chaos that she called home long ago.

Tiamat herself has slumbered deep beneath the waves since the Starfall, waiting for the wheel of the heavens to re-align and grant her the power to merge the material and the abyss into a single, un-marred qlipphotic tapestry.

While she slumbers, the seven Eyes of Tiamat, called by some the Wishing Stones or the Dragon Orbs, lie scattered across the world in the possession of unwitting mortals. Each of these stones allows Tiamat to observe the mortal world through her fitful dreams; when all seven are brought together, they can momentarily rouse her, and it is said that a mortal who speaks the correct incantations as they bring the stones together might ask her for a boon. Those unlucky enough to have been granted such favor say that Tiamat will then rewrite reality itself, but that no mortal mind can conceive clearly enough what they truly wish to be glad of the results.

The Plateau of Leng

Deep in the Jade Empire lies a vast range of mountains, so tall that their tops touch the heavens. Near the highest peak, a portal into Faerie leads to a seemingly pleasant meadow.

Beyond this meadow lies the Dreamlands, a realm of fantasy and madness where Faerie touches the Aetheric Abyss without any of the filtering sanity of the Elemental Chaos. The Dreamlands are said to be the mind-labyrinth of the great Yog-Sothoth itself, wherein all conceivable realities can be reached if one can brave the path.

The most common destination for mortals seems to be the dead city of Karkosh, where the King in Yellow sacrificed his entire world to preserve its corpse forever within the mind of the dead god Hastur.

Faerie

Entering Faerie from the Material is as simple as casting the second-circle ritual Misty Step during sunrise or sunset; returning is more challenging.

Time in Faerie does not flow at the same rate as in the Material. What might seem to be a few hours in the Fey realm might be a few seconds or a few centuries in the mortal world. Druids with a loyal fey wisp to guide them can keep track of time if they remember to ask it, and if it understands well enough to answer accurately, but otherwise the passing of time will seem terrifyingly arbitrary.

This also makes returning much more difficult. Since most portals from Faerie back to the Material only open at sunrise or sunset, and knowing exactly when sunrise or sunset will happen is a nearly impossible task, many travelers that stumble into Faerie end up lost there for centuries, until they happen back through a portal at the right moment.

Navigating in Faerie

The thing that confuses mortals the most about traveling through Faerie is the existence of an extra dimension, perpendicular to the normal directions of up/down, left/right and back/forwards. Scholars call these two extra directions “yangwards” and “yinwards”. Within Faerie, traveling yinwards always brings you closer to material reality, while traveling yangwards always brings you closer to the Elemental Chaos.

It is impossible for mortals to travel yangwards or yinwards directly; this is a good thing, because the entirety of Faerie is thinner than a soap bubble in the yin-yang direction. Instead, various roads and paths will follow ley lines, which gradually descend yinwards or ascend yangwards as they wind along their courses. Faerie itself also “drifts” yinwards and yangwards from the Material with the phase of the moon, ebbing and flowing like the pull of the tides. During the three days around the full moon, travel into and out of faerie is easier, while during the three days around the new moon, travel between Faerie and the Material is harder.

The Fair Folk

Within Faerie are the Fair Folk, terrifying eldritch beings that are the immortal ancestors of the fey. Within Faerie, the Fair Folk can reshape reality to their whim, creating whatever heavens or hells suit their fancy. They can even tear open a portal between Faerie and the Material at any time of day or night, although they are typically much more interested in trapping mortals within Faerie to play with than they are in freeing them or returning them to the Material.

Druids train their minds to resist the Fair Folk’s glamours, and even learn some tricks to bargain with them. As beings of mercurial chaos, the Fair Folk do not understand the power of oaths or promises - a vulnerability that can be used to bind them with their own magics into unbreakable contracts. This is done at great risk, however, as a Fair Folk trapped by a contract will look for any loophole or trick of phrasing to escape it.

Numina

Fair Folk that have maintained oaths and relationships with mortals for a sufficiently long time can become numina, more benevolent fey spirits of nature that dutifully serve as emissaries between mortals and the primordial world. Numina are still mercurial fey beings, however, and it is druids who are tasked with keeping them happy.

Most numina reside in a single location, and become the incarnate spirits of that location. A sacred stone, body of water, tree, statue, or bonfire will serve as their locus of power, and damage to that idol will both harm and enrage them. The area around it will become a sacred grove, where primal magic is more potent and other magics become more difficult, and the numen will use its powers to bless those whom it has sworn its oaths to protect - so long as they uphold their side of the bargain.

A village that keeps its oaths to a numen will find itself with a powerful guardian spirit, while one that breaks its oaths will find itself beset by misfortune. A broken oath can be mended with the proper sacrifices and appeasements, but finding out what those are will be a grueling quest, and it will be necessary to bring a druid along for the ride.

The Fey

Lesser fey beings are simply called the “fey”, and are the origin of most - if not all - of the mortal races in Creation that are not human or dwarven. They are also the origin of most of Creation's fantastic beasts, from the griffin to the gelatinous ooze - all survivors of incursions into the Material, left stranded as Faerie rolled back like a tide of chaos.

Fey beings live within Faerie and are native to it, such as goblins and fauns and fairies. Elves, too, were once native to Faerie, and can survive within it better than most. The most powerful beings within Faerie are the Numina and the Fair Folk, powerful spirits of nature who wield influence over the Primal world in much the same way that Saints and ancestors influence mortal affairs. Most Barbarian tribes worship - or at least respect and revere - the Fair Folk, offering them sacrifices and honors in exchange for aid in their daily lives.

Not all fey beasts can survive in the material. In fact, it is extraordinarily rare that Faerie produces a creature with sufficiently organized internal organs that it can continue to eat and breathe once the tides of Faerie rolls back, let alone with sufficiently functional reproductive organs that it can breed and populate the material plane with offspring. But on the borders between the Material and Faerie, creatures that are almost “real” enough to survive tend to produce such a diverse variety of offspring that at least a few of them can stake a toehold into the mortal world.

Feytide

Strands of Faerie occasionally ‘descend’ yinward into Material reality, creating pockets that hapless mortals can wander into unawares. Wilder places, with ecosystems that have stabilized over thousands of years, tend to ‘pull’ Faerie closer to the Material. The druids of barbarian tribes exploit this tendency to enhance their magics, creating cairns and ley-lines to tap this primal wellspring.

Faerie itself appears as an overgrown mirror of the Material Plane, bursting with life-energy and vibrancy. Colors are brighter, scents and tastes more pungent, sensations more acute. Glamours are more powerful within Faerie, where they are closer to their primal source.

The Elemental Chaos Yangward from Faerie is the Elemental Chaos itself, a realm seemingly made from pure elemental materia. Mortals typically can't live for long within the Elemental Chaos, where the roiling elemental energies tend to dissolve non-Aetheric matter in short order.

Djinn and elementals live within the elemental chaos, vying for control over territory. Scholars are divided as to whether Djinn are ultimately fey-pected elementals, or elemental-pected fey; nonetheless, they are clearly more familiar with the Material Plane than their purely elemental cousins, and so they tend to be encountered first by mortals as one climbs yangward.

The Elemental Chaos is also the source of materia, solidified patterns of elemental energy that sometimes make their way through Faerie into the Material. All Primal and Arcane effects on the Material - whether manifest by a magic-user or a fey beast - are the result of materia interacting with and altering the behavior of base matter. While fey beasts incorporate materia into their very metabolism, wizards and druids must harvest materia from the environment and arrange it into patterns that will cause a specific effect.

Where the Elemental Chaos presses up against the material plane, the pressure “molds” the aether’s clay into distorted mirrors of the material’s shapes. The membrane between the Elemental Chaos and the Prime Material therefore operates as an entire “mirror world”, taking on a distorted appearance of the Prime Material colored by the wild energies of the Elemental Chaos. This mirror world is called Faerie, as are the shapes that coalesce within it.

The more self-aware these shapes are, the more likely they are to form a space around them, and populate it with their “thoughts”. The most powerful of these phantasms manage to form enough of a coherent identity to stabilize, becoming ephemeral eldritch things called the Fair Folk. The less powerful are either eroded by the chaotic whims of Faerie, or drift far enough into the material that its physical laws can stabilize them.

ther Worlds

The Power of the Ancients

During the Age of the Ancients, the dominant civilizations of Aztlanteos and Mu managed to expand their empires to the heavens.

It was known to the Ancients that the wandering stars were worlds much like our own. The two nearest worlds, named Barsoom and Agarta by the Ancients, were just close enough to reach with Ancient technology, albeit at great expense and hardship.

Each posed its own difficulties. Both were barren, lifeless worlds; Agarta was a nightmare of boiling-hot acid and toxic clouds, while Barsoom was a cold, arid desert barely capable of supporting life. After several wars for supremacy in the skies, the Lemurans chose to focus their attention on Agarta, and the Aztlanteans on Barsoom.

The Greening of Agarta

The Lemurans turned to their Draconic allies for aid. Over many centuries, they built vast fleets of ships, transporting the alchemical precursors for breathable air from the outer worlds and into orbit around Agarta. Then, all at once, these ships descended into the atmosphere, burning themselves up to release their alchemical payloads.

The toxic sky boiled and lightning flashed, and then it rained water and soot for the next forty days and forty nights. When the clouds cleared, Agarta was a world of shallow seas dotted with large islands, and a few smallish continents. The Lemurans and their draconic allies spent the next century wielding deep primal magics, shifting Agarta's air towards breathability and importing plants, animals, and other living things — including many species of proto-draconic creatures not seen since before the Starfall — until it had a complete ecosystem.

Then, at the height of the project, the world was cut off. The Great Flood wiped out the Lemuran and Aztlantean civilizations on Terra, leaving the Agartian colonies to fend for themselves. With only a small portion of the world's surface colonized, there simply wasn't enough industry to sustain the Lemuran civilization.

The Conquest of Barsoom

Barsoom, on the other hand, already had both an ecosystem and a civilization — although both were slowly dying long before the Aztlanteans arrived.

Native Barsoomians

The native Barsoomian mortals are tall, lanky beings with pallid green skin, large reflective-golden eyes, curving tusks, and four arms with two “elbows” apiece. They are slightly fiercer and less intelligent than humans, but have a deep and intuitive knack for surviving the harsh Barsoomian mountains and deserts.

The Aztlanteans offered the native Barsoomians technological assistance in restoring their world's atmosphere and oceans, then used their aid as a pretext to conquer their cities and place themselves in a permanent position within Barsoomian culture as inherently superior beings.

At the height of the Aztlantean civilization, there were nearly as many Aztlantean lords on Barsoom as on Terra, with aetheric transmission portals allowing for rapid teleportation between the two worlds. Then, just as the Great Flood struck Terra, an eldritch threat from beyond the blackness of space came to claim Barsoom.

The Yuggothim

The Yuggothim are a strange hive-mind race from beyond the solar system, with unimaginably advanced technology. They have maintained a “listening post” on one of the small, frozen worlds orbiting at the edge of our own sun's celestial sphere, where they have long watched keenly and closely the doings of Terran mortals — scrutinizing and studying us as narrowly as a dwarf with a microfocused scrying-glass might scrutinize the transient creatures that swarm and multiply in a drop of water.

The Yuggothim arrived in vast black cylinder-ships, which impacted into the Barsoomian soil and dug in before disgorging armies of monstrosities. Towering war-machines waded through cities on three spindly legs, firing aetheric beams of raw destructive power to clear out resistance before smaller, scuttling devices came and harvested the survivors to render down into sustenance.

Magic on Other Worlds

The aetheric environments of Agarta and Barsoom are as different as their geographies. Researchers spent centuries studying the differences before the Flood, trying to glean deeper secrets of the aether from its unique manifestations on each world.

Magic on Agarta

On Agarta, the world has not yet had time to develop a Shadow-echo, leaving its connection to the Shadow (and to Divine magic) tenuous at best. On the other hand, its connection to the primal energies of the Elemental Chaos is so strong that its Faerie and Material planes are coterminous – making primal magics absurdly easy to perform. Dragons who remember Terra before the Starfall say that in their time, our world was the same; some even speculate that “Faerie” and “Shadow” as separate worlds might even be a consequence of the Starfall itself.

Regardless of the reasons, primal magic on Agarta is easier, while divine magic is nearly impossible without blood sacrifice. Miracles that heal the injured aren't especially difficult, while other magics require that a priest or warlock injure themselves or another mortal being to “open a channel” between Agarta's Material plane and its tenuous Shadow.

Magic on Barsoom

Barsoom appears to be in the opposite position. Divine magic on Barsoom is easy, while primal magic is much more difficult. Druids from Terra or Agarta find that they can still perform primal magic as rituals, but when attempting to call upon Faerie to perform magic at will, nothing answers. However, druids from Terra find that they can cast divine magic with difficulty, effectively operating as priests of the Nature domain who find it harder to prepare spells at times other than dawn or dusk.

Barsoom has also never had a manifestation of the Baalim. Instead, the Barsoomian Old Ones – ancestor-spirits of the native Barsoomians – appear to serve instead of gods, demons, or fair folk. All Barsoomians become Old Ones on death, and most remain to protect and advise their clans for centuries. So pervasive is ancestor worship that Barsoomian champions invoke particularly revered ancestor-spirits when entering their battle-frenzies.

Entering Barsoom or Agarta

In the heyday of the Ancients, both Barsoom and Agarta had well-maintained networks of aetheric teleportation to transport people and goods between the worlds. A few such devices survived the Flood, and are occasionally stumbled upon by mortals in the modern era.

Lemuran teleportation rings were large circles of feysilver and orichalc alloy, which instantly transported any traveler who walked through them. Many were built into underground cave systems on Terra, with the corresponding portal built into a similar cave complex on Agarta. This has resulted in a strange but understandable misconception in the modern world: those few mortals who have stepped foot on Agarta by passing through a Lemuran portal have typically misunderstood the planet as existing inside our own, as a kind of “hollow earth”. The fact that Agarta's sky is typically a dull golden glow of overcast clouds helps maintain this illusion.

The Aztlanteans began with the same sort of portal technologies, but eventually settled on personal transportation devices, keyed to a network of aetheric “repeater” buoys. By holding the device and speaking a command phrase, the wielder is transported into a particular “way station” portal, either on Barsoom or Earth. Once transported onto Barsoom, it is very difficult to mistake the environment for that of Earth – the sky is a dull salmon-pink, with a small pale sun and two smaller silvery moons, and the air is thin as if the traveler were atop a high mountain.

Humans and dwarves that enter Barsoom or Agarta notice no particular difficulty once their bodies acclimate to the local atmosphere. Fey travelers to Agarta find themselves more healthy and “at home”, while fey who find themselves on Barsoom tend to feel more sickly and tired. Fey who persist in Barsoom for an extended period eventually die, both from lack of access to Faerie's primal energies and from long-term exposure to Barsoom's iron-rich dust and soil.

Referee's Guide

So You Really Wanna Do This

Being a referee for a D20 fantasy game can be an incredibly fun and rewarding experience. It's also a *lot* of work. This book is mostly a collection of guidelines for managing and constructing adventures; as referee, you are free to modify them as you see fit. Keep in mind that more experienced players might be surprised if you change a long-standing rule.

Setting the Theme

Before you get started, it's good to understand the kind of adventures you're going to want to referee for. Theme is a tricky topic to tackle, because it encompasses so many facets of the story. Do you want a light-hearted adventure? Comedy? Romance? Horror? These thematic elements set the 'flavor' of an adventure, and an adventure can shift from one theme to another across the arc of a campaign. One evening might call for cartoon-like hijinks, the next for a nerve-wracking confrontation with terrors from beyond space and time.

A good media library is an excellent place to gather inspiration for the themes of your campaign. Most roleplaying systems will provide you with a list of 'suggested fiction' that capture the moods and aesthetics of their game world; often this list is called

"Appendix N" in deference to Gygas and Arneson's list, placed in the back of the first edition of the forefather of modern fantasy gaming. Our own "Appendix N" is in the back of this book; we heartily recommend sitting down with some of the media listed there if looking for inspiration.

The Talk - It's generally a good idea to sit down with your players and have the talk. "The talk" is a frank discussion of boundaries, concerns, and topics that the players would rather not have to deal with in the campaign. Some players might be uncomfortable with sexual themes; others might have issues with domestic violence, or slavery, or any number of topics. Talking this over before the group begins helps give a healthy orientation towards the goals of the game.

Age Appropriate

This can be a great game for children, but it's important to keep the themes at a level that they are ready to understand and engage with maturely.

Setting the Pace

One of the first things you should decide, as a group, is the real-world pace of your campaign. This will involve juggling schedules until the referee and all the players can agree on a consistent time and place to sit down and play together. The game was written with the idea that the typical pace for an adventure would be a single four to six hour adventure per week, typically on a weekend. This pacing gives your referee enough time to prepare, and the players time to unwind and socialize after the game.

At this pace, a set of first-level adventurers can be expected to reach 10th level at the end of one year of play, assuming that nobody dies. (Someone is definitely going to die.) A solid year for a campaign to go from first-level novices to tenth-level heroes is a good run.

You can accelerate this process by rewarding players who contribute positively to the gaming experience with additional milestones more frequently. A player group that is consistently vibrant, in good spirits, and engaged with the setting is a joy to behold, and actions that support that experience should be rewarded. Don't be tempted into rewarding "good roleplaying" when that roleplaying involves stabbing the group in the back, unless everyone at the table agrees that the sudden but inevitable betrayal actually contributed positively to the group's enjoyment of the game. (It usually doesn't, but there are always exceptions.)

If a player goes out of their way to help a less experienced player out, you should consider rewarding both of them. It takes a lot of courage to sit down at a new table and roll up a level one character alongside a party of seasoned sixth-level adventurers; giving the new kid an extra milestone here and there will ensure they reach parity with the rest of the party sooner rather than later. That said, a first-level adventurer still has plenty to contribute to a sixth-level party, so make sure that everyone is having fun regardless of their difference in power levels.

Setting the Scope

A good low-level adventure (levels 1 to 3) should feel dangerous and exciting, but also personal. The player characters are just setting out in the world, and learning to make their mark in it; they should usually feel like a small part in a much bigger world. Of course, their actions and consequences won't stay small for long.

Most player characters at level 1 will be young and inexperienced, typically between 13 and 21 years of age. An older first-level player character should have a particularly good reason why they are just now setting out adventuring, and with so little life experience and competence to show for it.

Many referees start their party's first three levels in some kind of "training" scenario – either in a school environment or under the tutelage of older, more experienced adventurers – to help manage expectations and guide new players safely through their first adventures. By level 3, the party is just barely competent enough to manage real low-level threats on an even footing; making level three the "transition into the real world" can give new players a valuable sense of accomplishment.

The "magical training academy" trope is a popular young adult fiction genre for a reason; if you choose to start your adventurers at level 1 in some kind of fantasy classroom environment, make sure to choose themes with an appropriate maturity level so that the players' expectations don't feel violated. Another theme for an early-game story is a group of young adventurers forced out of their homes by a disaster, forcing them to venture out into the world and develop competence quickly.

By mid-story (levels 3 to 4), the adventuring party should feel established in their local community, known for solving problems that others can't; by this level, the community and local nobility should be coming to them for help whenever faced with threats too large for the local peacekeepers. All this depends on the relationships and reputations that the players have fostered for their characters, of course; a band of marauding ne'er-do-wells will have to secure their own opportunities.

High-level adventures (levels 4 and 5) tend to affect entire kingdoms; characters with good reputations and relationships with the local nobility have likely gained titles, land, and renown of their own by now, and are firmly entrenched into the politics of their kingdom.

Play doesn't have to stop at level 5, of course. High-end campaigns can be a lot of fun, although the kinds of adventures that high-level characters get up to will be significantly different than those they struggled with as beginning adventurers. High-level play typically has consequences that extend far beyond the player characters themselves, regularly affecting not just their own kingdoms, but the shape of the whole world.

In fact, adventures beyond level 5 could easily become the primary scope of your campaign, with the early adventures simply existing to provide backstory to describe the party's humble beginnings. If you want to engage in this kind of 'epic'-style play, it's probably good to have at least one short "prelude" adventure at each class level before beginning the "real campaign" at level 5.

Setting the Rules

Once everyone has agreed on themes, pace, and scope, it's time to work out the rules that everyone will be expected to play by. The Player's Guide presents the 'core rules' of the game, with Setting Guides sometimes providing optional rules that you and your players might choose to incorporate. Appendix M of this book also gives several examples of alternate rules that the table might want to try.

However, the "rules of the game" are not the only rules that need to be discussed. You should also discuss what kinds of behavior will be encouraged, discouraged, or simply not allowed at your table; etiquette and mutual respect are far more important for a good gaming experience than a good rulebook. As the referee, it's your duty to keep the game flowing smoothly and to deal with any trouble that occurs, and it's the players' collective duty to abide by whatever rules you lay down at your table.

There and Back Again

Setting over Story

In a “dungeon crawl”, the party as a whole creates a collaborative story of their adventures. As the referee, your job is to provide them with the setting where this story takes place. The players will then create the story of the adventure based on their choices and interactions with that environment.

This means that you should never expect events to play out in a particular way, if your players have anything at all to say about it. And your players should always have some say in the unfolding of events - otherwise they’re spectators, not players.

A good setting still has a lot going on in the background, however. The party should enter the story with the sense of a world already set into motion; various NPCs and forces have their own agendas and talents, and may already be well on their way to completing their plans - but the players’ actions have immediate and profound impact on those machinations, forcing NPCs to react to their presence. This helps weave the impression of a living world, where interesting things happen and the player’s choices matter.

The setting you provide your players should have a history and a reason for being the way it is. This history will contain elements that a character might recall or discover during research with a good Lore check, or that a character with sufficient Charm and Wit might discover by chatting up the locals.

Backstory and history are also how most player character parties get hooked into adventures in the first place - a party could spend years wandering the wilderness and hoping to stumble onto something worthwhile, but if the local village elders tell tales to their children about a hidden mine full of treasure deep in the mountains to the East, the party has a place to start looking.

Wilds & Wonder's world has been designed to let you "drop in" most classic fantasy adventures somewhere into the setting. Europa favors political intrigue and dungeon exploration, while Vlahia is for classic horror, the Misty Isles or the Sultanate are for dark fairy tales (depending on whether you prefer "Brothers Grimm" or "Arabian Nights" flavor), Barsoom is for planetary romance, and Agarta is for "Lost World" savagery.

Rulings over Rules

It can be tempting, as a referee, to create specific, detailed rules for various things the players might want to attempt. The game works much more smoothly, however, if you focus on the player’s actions and choices to decide whether a particular action succeeds or fails, falling back on saving throws and task checks (and quickly ruling on appropriate difficulty levels) only when there’s some degree of luck involved.

Deciding Difficulty

As a referee, your job is to simulate the game world. The players’ collective job is to decide how to interact with that game world, to reach the outcomes they desire. They describe their actions, and you determine the consequences of those actions. In determining those consequences, your first tools are common sense and intuition about how the game world works. Your second tools, after common sense and intuition, are the dice and rules.

What this means in practice is that if the players describe an action that will obviously work, and that is obviously doable, just let them do it and move on. There’s no sense in rolling the dice at all. And on the flipside, if they describe an action that simply isn’t logically possible given how the world works, even if the rules imply that they can do it, you have every right to say “no, those rules don’t apply here” and declare that they can’t achieve that outcome with that action. Remember that you need to be fair, consistent, and reasonable with this power, or you will quickly find yourself without very many players who want to play in your games.

This principle is often referred to as “rulings, not rules”. It is said to be one of the cornerstones of “old-school play”, whatever those words mean.

Regardless, once you’ve handled all situations automatic or impossible, what remains is those situations with some probable chance of success. These are the situations that attack throws, saving throws, and task checks are for, and the rules divide them into easy, normal, and hard tasks.

Easier and Harder

Various class feats, equipment, magics, and specific circumstances are explicitly described in the rules as making a particular set of rolls easier or harder. Beyond that, anything that you think should intuitively make an action noticeably easier or harder for the character should do so. Multiple instances of “easier” and “harder” cancel each other out, leaving one or more “easier” or “harder” modifiers stacked onto each other.

Automatic or Impossible

If it seems like the total number of “easier” or “harder” modifiers are overwhelming, use your intuition to decide whether they should combine to make the roll automatic or impossible. As a rule of thumb, saving throws and attack throws should almost never become automatic or impossible; task checks should never become impossible for experts, and should never become automatic for anyone else. A caveat is for actions that are obviously not physically possible under any circumstances, such as a scout attempting to “climb” a volley of crossbow bolts fired at them; as the referee, it's your job to decide whether you want to set the boundaries of possibility based on the real world, the cinematic internal logic of action movies, or the aesthetics of wuxia cinema. If an expert wants to try something that simply doesn't fit the theme of your campaign, feel free to explain that there's impossible and there's impossible, and work with them to come up with a different idea or approach.

Besides external circumstances, another source of difficulty modifiers that referees should track is the collection of innate advantages and disadvantages granted by a character's origin. Small creatures in particular, or creatures with unusual anatomy, will often have an easier or harder time in a wide variety of circumstances compared to an ‘average’ human player character. As the referee, it is your job to think about the environmental circumstances and the character's anatomy, and from there determine what is likely to be easy or hard. Don't go overboard with this, though; small characters or creatures with unusual anatomy are used to their body shapes, and will have spent their whole lives learning how to handle unusual circumstances in their own ways.

Random Encounters, Random Loot

One way to help your own mindset is to use random tables to determine what kinds of dangers and rewards the players encounter, rather than hard-and-fast lists of monsters and treasure. When you roll on a random list, you don't know any more than the players do what they're about to run into - which means that you are forced to improvise.

This doesn't mean abandoning the setting, however! As you roll on random tables, try to come up with plausible explanations for why this particular monster is in this particular room with that particular treasure, and then add small descriptive flourishes to hint at those explanations. As your sense of what's going on “behind the scenes” unfolds, feel free to adjust the results of various tables accordingly, even ignoring and re-rolling certain results, to keep the unfolding narrative consistent - but always allow the dice to have their say, too. Being a referee means learning to paint with a palette handed to you by a fickle universe, but it can be an incredibly rewarding skill to hone.

Having random tables also doesn't mean that you can't have named NPCs with detailed plans and schemes - it just means that those NPC's plans and schemes are just as subject to the whims of fate as your player characters'. Your job as referee is to keep things fair, after all; if the evil sorceress who controls the hordes of undead fails at an important saving throw, she'd better have a good back-up plan! (She almost certainly does; after all, she didn't get to where she is by being a complete slouch at scheming and planning).

You can use the generic tables given in Appendix E, or create your own. Loot and monster tables should represent a coherent theme, but provide sufficient variation within that theme to represent the fickle finger of fate - an encounter with goblin orcs might mean running into a small scouting party while the main force is off looting a village, or the player characters might blunder into the main force unawares. The dice help you by making many of these decisions for you, letting you weave the story together with the pieces they hand you.

Engaging your Players

As your players enter a new area, you need to provide them with descriptions that both describe the ambiance of the area, and provide them with affordances for interaction. Providing “affordances for interaction” simply means that your descriptions should include the objects, creatures, and ongoing events that the player characters could choose to interact with, and that you should describe them in ways that make it clear to the players how they could begin to interact with them.

For example, you might describe the party entering a new room thusly:

As you open the door, sunlight streams in from behind you, illuminating a thin shaft of the patterned stone floor. Your eyes slowly adjust, until you begin to make out the features of the back wall. It's made of rough-hewn stone; it looks climbable, but it would definitely be a hard climb. There's a little alcove at the top of the back wall that looks like it has some kind of statue or ornamentation inside it; you can see something glittering up there, reflecting the sunlight in rainbow sparkles. The wall to your left is smoother stone, cut in odd geometric patterns, with torch braziers jutting out of it at about eye-height for a human. The wall on the right looks almost completely smooth, lined with some kind of polished white stone like marble or alabaster, and carved with runes and ornate painted murals. Something is catching the light and glittering on that wall, too; it looks like maybe the murals are inset with metal or gemstones. The whole room is about 10 paces wide by 15 paces deep.

(You roll the scout's Alertness to see if they detect any traps as they look into the room) – Joyce, as you look down on the floor to prepare to enter the room, you notice that one of the floor's stones right at the entrance looks slightly raised, and doesn't seem to have any mortar around it, as if it might be a hidden pressure-plate.

Okay guys, what do you want to do?

Pre-Made Descriptions

Many adventures and maps will have descriptions ready for you to read to your players as they enter areas; don't be afraid to adjust these to suit your own style, but remember to describe important features with enough detail to invite interaction! Also keep in mind that your descriptions shouldn't give away the consequences of interaction, unless those consequences are obvious at first glance – it's the players' jobs to keep their characters out of trouble, not yours.

Managing Alertness Checks

Alertness checks as the party enters new areas will give you an idea of how much or how little detail to provide. One good habit is to write out what sorts of things are automatically visible to anyone at first sight, what sorts of things require an Alertness check to spot, and what sorts of things are impossible to notice without further detailed inspection of a specific point of interest in the area.

If there are multiple things in the room that could each be spotted with a Alertness check, but each of them are at different difficulties, you can save time by making a single 2d6 Alertness check for each character, and include everything that would be easy to spot if only one of that character's dice succeeds, while including everything that is hard to spot if both of their dice succeed.

Traps and Ambushes

If entering a new area immediately triggers a trap or an ambush, you should describe the situation with more urgency and at a faster pace, to help convey the danger the party finds themselves in. Only focus on the descriptions that the party would automatically notice in these circumstances; anyone who wants to look around and roll Alertness to try to spot subtler details is welcome to spend their combat action doing so.

Describing Ambiance

Describing the ambiance of a dungeon or wilderness area helps set the “tone” of the adventure, and orients the players to their surroundings. You should consider the “ambient” features of a dungeon at least as important as the game mechanics.

Sights, Sounds, and Smells

Your players need to use their imagination to put themselves within the game world. A good referee will describe scenes vividly enough that they provide hooks for the players to follow – an odd smell or sound might be the clue that a particular player needs to ask further questions.

Don’t spoon-feed your players with only the information they need to “guess the right password”; a good description should include several different features available to the various senses, with only a few of them sufficiently relevant to warrant deeper investigation.

Sense of Wonder

This is a world full of ancient historical wonders and eldritch magics; the world beyond the party’s front door should seem vast, strange, and full of surreal beauty. It might take some time to find out what specific aspects of the setting capture your players’ imaginations, but learning to keep them engaged is what makes the difference between an average session and a great one.

Scale is a good tool for producing a sense of wonder. Expansive vistas, impossibly tall cliffs, wide open seas and gently undulating plains all give a sense of a wide-open world, free for the party to go wherever they wish. On the other side, tiny details help reinforce that every square inch of this vast world is filled with more wonders than a lifetime could take in.

Sense of Dread

An adventuring party is, by definition, a group of thrillseekers getting in way over their heads, in situations that most denizens of the world are wise enough to avoid altogether. The party’s sense of wonder should always be mixed with an appropriate amount of fear and dread, especially in uncanny situations where the supernatural holds sway.

Dread and terror produce a far more satisfying experience when their source is the uncanny, rather than the simply dangerous. A massive beast with impressive combat abilities might be frightening, but subtle hints that things are not quite right with a creature or environment can sustain a much more palpable tension for far longer.

Starting with small details of ambiance also gives you an opportunity to slowly build dread over the course of an adventure. The strange details might start off few and far between, and barely worth noticing, but get more blatant and more frequent as the party approaches the source of the disturbance.

Adventures that eventually wind up passing through Faerie or Shadow often start out this way – tiny disturbances in the environment that subtly hint at an incursion, getting more prevalent and more extreme as one approaches the tear in the veil.

Sense of Hope

At level 1, the player characters start off fragile and vulnerable. A first-level adventurer is hopelessly outmatched by the dangers of the world just outside the castle walls. And yet, civilization is recovering. The player characters – or people just like them – should feel necessary to the world’s recovery and improvement, and it should feel just barely possible that they might pull it off.

Wilderness Ambiance

The Open Road

Most roads in the Successor Kingdoms were built by the old empire, and are in various states of disrepair. Rich and prosperous kingdoms will have the resources to keep their main roads fairly well-maintained and well-patrolled, while desperate backwaters are more likely to let their roads and watchtowers fall into disrepair or even ruin.

Small villages, farms, and pastures are typically constructed along roads, so the countryside will be dotted with periodic signs of civilization. These will typically show the same economic conditions as the roads themselves; if they don't, that fact itself says something important about the priorities and taxation policies of the area being passed through.

Forests

Traveling through forests will slow the party down unless there is an obvious path or an experienced guide to help them navigate. Even so, the distance that can be seen ahead is severely limited in the forest, making random encounters far more likely.

The deeper one goes into the forest, the more likely it is that the veil will thin and drop the party into Faerie or Shadow. Even in the Prime Material, a deep virgin forest is full of sufficient predators and hazards to challenge even a group of seasoned adventurers.

Mountains

Mountains slow the party down as well, without obstructing as much of the view. In fact, depending on the terrain, a trek through the mountain might offer a breathtaking vista for miles around – while line of sight is limited to about a league on flat terrain, being at elevation can extend that to up to six leagues in any unobstructed direction.

Natural hazards in the mountains are much more common than in other terrain types – avalanches, crumbling paths, and steep cliffs can all send the party plummeting to their doom with little warning.

Caverns

Traveling underground, of course, combines all the dangers of mountaineering with the limited visibility of a forest journey. Many dwarven villages, mines, and forges still exist underground, some of them still populated and maintained by civilized dwarves. Beyond their reach, however, the caverns stretch deep enough that the veil ceases to hold sway, and Faerie, Shadow, and the Material blend together into a strange place called the Dark.

Within the Dark, the energies of Faerie and Shadow blend together to shape the abundant matter of the Material into eerie and terrifying shapes and creatures. Even denizens from the deep Infernal Abyss can sometimes find their way to the Dark and survive, their “biology” far less encumbered by Material physics than they would be above ground.

Even within the safer caverns of the Prime Material, natural hazards are more common than even in the mountains, exacerbated by the utter darkness and claustrophobically low ceilings.

Most of the Dark is uninhabited, but below the Hansa lies a vast subterranean civilization founded by an Orcish coalition of dwarves, elves, and ettercap centaurs. Their civilization is called Svartalfheim by the Hansa, which occasionally trades with it, despite its brutal Infernal ways. Svartalfen grottoes are eerie but beautiful cathedrals of hewn crystal and semiprecious stone, displaying a most elegant merger of elven and dwarven architectural prowess and aesthetic.

Wetlands, Rivers and Lakes

Wetlands literally bog the party down in thick mud, while exposing them to biting insects and generally unsanitary conditions. The flora and fauna of a wetland seem to compensate by offering unparalleled beauty and diversity, with each square inch of terrain containing some kind of exquisite hidden gem of flora or fauna.

Crossing a river can be its own mini-adventure, as anyone who has played Oregon Trail can attest. The difficulty of fording a river depends on the depth, strength and speed of the current, and whether the party is attempting to cross on foot, mounted, or with a wagon.

Wetlands tend to be some of the most fertile soils available, and rivers and lakes are necessary sources of water for villages, farms, and pastures, so most farmlands will typically be settled nearby, and villages and roads will crop up shortly thereafter. Once a village is sufficiently well-established, the Church will send a priest to consecrate the land, sealing up any inconvenient breaches into Faerie or Shadow that might otherwise be attracted to the moor's ambience.

The flowing water of a river can also be harnessed to run mills, smithies, and other forms of light industrialization, saving labor and making the lives of nearby villagers more convenient. And, of course, sufficiently wide and deep rivers offer convenient trade routes for the transportation of goods and persons.

The Open Seas

Above the water, the open seas are an unbroken expanse of wave and sky, differentiated only by the day's weather or the occasional sea bird. Below the waves, the pelagic depths host all forms of strange creatures among the rock and coral.

Sailing the open ocean is its own kind of adventure, where the ship and her crew become the primary setting, and the ocean itself becomes a mere vehicle to deliver wonders and hazards along the voyage.

Small islands and atolls dot the ocean, of course, and larger ones might cover enough hexes to warrant their own terrain types, but anything smaller than a league across will likely be a small patch of sandbar and vegetation.

As with underground caverns, the vastness of the ocean and the lack of anchoring civilizations thins the veil. Open ocean can shift without warning into Fey or Dark waters, especially in violent weather. Sailors may be prone to tall tales, but they are equally likely to have seen inexplicable marvels and horrors as a fey gale or dark storm tore the veil asunder, pulling their ship partially into the Aether.

Faerie and Shadow

Faerie, Shadow, and even the Dark typically resemble the wilderness terrain that the party just came from - at least at first. As the party advances, the terrain should become more surreal and more ominous, but always with a veneer of plausible deniability - right until it's too late to go back.

It can be difficult to distinguish between a "hazard" and a "trap" in Faerie or Shadow - indeed, it can be hard to distinguish between "terrain" and "denizen". Most of the deeper Realms are shaped by the wills of their inhabitants, such that the terrain can almost be seen as an extension of their imaginations and moods - even creating phantasmal hosts to populate an otherwise barren demesne. Make sure that each slice of Faerie or Shadow has its own personality, whims, and desires.

Dungeon Architectural Styles

Ruins should typically maintain a single architectural style throughout, unless the structure has been adapted and expanded by multiple different cultures over the centuries. Various cultures throughout history have built structures which your player character party might explore as dungeons; the architectural style of a dungeon will give clues about what to expect inside.

Empires of Antiquity

The archetypical fallen empires from our own history are Rome, Greece, Egypt, and Persia. Imperial ruins might tend towards round stone columns holding up square roofs, realistic frescoes of humanoid heroes and gods, and even, regular spacings of 5' paces. Waterworks such as fountains, pools, and aqueducts adorn most public spaces, and many floors are decorated with beautiful tile mosaics of high craftsmanship.

Ancient Hypertechnology

The ruins of ancient Atlantis, or even ancient alien precursor civilizations, should be vast technological marvels that convey a sense of immense scale and power. All such ruins should express strong "science fantasy" ideals, perhaps leaning towards the "crystal spires and togas" style of early 20th century Utopian science fiction.

Even the nature of the damage sustained by these ruins should convey a sense of vastness and dread - giant craters, half-melted buildings, and shadows flash-frozen onto walls by energies released from weapons of unimaginable power.

Draconic

Draconic and Lizardfolk architecture might tend towards what we would call meso-American (Olmec, Mayan, and Aztec), with steppe pyramids and cyclopean walls built from massive, precision-cut but unmortared stones.

The arrogance and narcissism of primordial dragons is usually reflected in their architecture; the dragon's lair will be the obvious centerpiece of any structures built by their worshipers.

Qlippothic

Qlippothic architecture is strange. "Non-Euclidean" is a word that often gets thrown about; qlippothic structures will seemingly bend the laws of physics, producing impossible angles, structures whose insides are larger than their outsides, and curves that somehow seem to converge and diverge simultaneously. Often, qlippothic architecture will have strange organic shapes that seem to combine living and non-living features.

Fey

Fey "architecture" is quite often an illusion, copied from the dreams and nightmares of mortal minds. As such, it will typically look like a more fanciful version of normal structures, with details emphasized based on the significance that the structure is intended to convey - a home will seem more homely, a noble's castle more noble, a dungeon more dark and despairing. Subtle details will be "off" or even nonexistent; Faerie tends to paint in broad strokes.

Even so, a fairy castle or kindly old grandmother's hovel can be quite convincing, especially to weary travellers looking for a rest and a meal. Of course, the less obviously fey the structure is, the more likely it is to be a trap for the unwary.

Orcish

Orcish structures tend to be either brutally functional, or deliberately horrifying. Orcish culture worships power, fear, and violence, and so its architecture is usually designed - when it is designed at all - to inspire these feelings.

Orcish structures that break this mold should give an adventurer pause - whenever orcs have enough time on their hands to devote to something other than pillaging and slaughter, more sinister plots are usually afoot.

Barbarian

The word "barbarian" is always a loaded term. Other cultures, of course, have their own definitions for "barbarian", for which the player characters' culture themselves might even qualify. For campaigns with a medieval western European aesthetic, barbarian architecture typically means pagan Norse gathering halls and monolithic stone temples.

Hazards and Traps

Monsters shouldn't be the only threat that a referee throws at an adventuring party, or even the primary threat. Traps and hazards are any aspect of the environment itself that poses a direct threat to the adventuring party, which requires the party's skill and ingenuity to navigate, but is not under the direct control of an active agency such as a monster or NPC.

Natural Hazards

Natural hazards in the wilderness could be almost anything, from a dangerous whitewater current in a river to a precariously narrow path along a cliff face. Whenever a natural hazard is encountered, think about the description of the terrain provided so far, and then determine the nature of the trap so that it fits into that terrain.

Natural hazards in a dungeon depend greatly on the dungeon itself. Most dungeon ruins are vast technological wonders slowly falling into decay; causeways and scaffolds and pillars designed to be maintained or replaced every few decades have been rusting unattended for over a millennium.

A natural hazard will typically require an Agility check to successfully navigate; clever players might improvise something with ropes, grappling hooks, or the like to lower the difficulty. Deciding to go around might be a Survival or Alertness check to find an alternate route, if one even exists.

Each player will typically need to overcome the hazard individually, unless the party comes up with a clever solution to neutralize the hazard altogether. If any member of the party fails, the entire party is stuck in this hex until they all succeed; if a member of the party rolls a critical failure, think of a suitable mishap and present it to the party to deal with.

Clever Traps

Kobolds and goblins are notorious for taking over a ruin, filling it with traps, and then waiting to ambush the unwary. Many dungeons were even trapped by their original builders, before they fell into ruin; such devices are notorious for their cleverness and lethality.

Hunters, barbarian warbands, and even some clever beasts and monsters might set up deliberate traps in a particular area. If the party stumbles onto a trap, you should consider the Intelligence modifier and crafting proficiencies of the creature that set it; this determines the difficulty of any task checks to detect, inspect, and defeat the trap.

Not all traps are hidden, but if a trap is hidden, then the first step for the party is detecting it. Failure to detect the trap means that it is likely to go off as the group moves through its area.

Detecting a hidden trap means that someone needs to be specifically searching for them. Let each person who is searching for traps make an active Alertness test, with a difficulty based on the trap's detection rating. This d6 roll should be made in secret, so as to not give away to the party that something is afoot.

Once the trap is discovered, disabling it requires a Science test to figure out how it works, followed by a Finesse test to disable it.

A key thing to remember with both traps and hazards is that the logic of the situation trumps any particular rules or rolls. If the party describes something that will reliably disable a trap, let them disable the trap without rolling. If they describe an action that is likely to work, make the roll easy; if they want to try something that is unlikely to work, make the roll hard.

Also remember that the entire purpose of simple task checks is to make the actual dice-rolling part of the game fast and fun, and to avoid bogging down the whole session with needless accounting.

Describing Magic

Magic is usually a core theme in most fantasy games, and managing it properly as a referee requires quite a bit of forethought, imagination, and logic all blended together.

Primal and Divine magic in the default setting comes principally from the yin and yang worlds - Faerie and Shadow - and each of these sources flavors the magic accordingly. Primal magic, which comes entirely from Faerie, grounds itself out through a prepared piece of elemental or fey materia - a solidified 'gem' of pure magical energy that resonates with one of the Elemental Chaos's five pure elemental forms, or (for fey materia) with the pure thoughts, ideas, and fantasies of the Faerie realm itself. On the other side is divine magic, which comes entirely from Shadow; the curses, blessings, and divinations of a miracle-worker typically have no elemental affinities at all, but directly channel the hopes, fears, and memories of the collective unconscious.

Arcane magic, on the other hand, uses the interface between the yin and yang worlds and our own to shape the energies stored directly within the materia itself - thus affording, and requiring, a level of precision and control that Divine and Primal magics lack. Because an arcane spell or magic item must shape and channel these energies directly, the "circuitry" of the spell must be explicitly laid out in the material world - either by painting that circuitry directly on the spellcaster's body (thus creating a Wizard spell or a Dwarven dweomer), or by engraving it into a material object that also serves as a physical focus (thus creating a magic item).

A spell is a sufficiently raw release of energy that its activation completely burns out the materia used to power it - the ink patterns painted on the wizard's body literally burn off in a harmless display of ghostly fire - but most magic items are built to sufficient tolerances that their materia is merely depleted, rather than destroyed, when their effect is activated. Items powered by dragon pearls exploit the pearl's resonant connection with the Elemental Chaos to draw energy back into it, recharging the item over a period of time from a few minutes to a full day.

This resonant connection waxes and wanes over the course of a day - it is strongest at precisely the moment the sun crosses the horizon, at sunrise and sunset - which is why the two-hour window around these moments is ideal for preparing spells and miracles. Another peak happens around noon and at midnight, but these secondary peaks are harder to predict and control.

Elemental magic, whether arcane or primal, manifests into one of five classical 'elements'. These elements are often arranged into a "cross of opposition", with Flame opposing Water and Air opposing Stone, and Wood (or "Life" or "Vitality") unopposed in the center. Other schools of arcane magic attempt to create a "circle of opposition", with Flame opposing Wood and Water, Air opposing Water and Stone, Wood opposing Flame and Stone, and Water opposing Flame and Air. Both arrangements have merit; if players attempt to use elemental oppositions in a particularly clever way, try to think through the actual physical nature of the effects and then do what seems logically consistent and scientifically sound.

Non-elemental arcane magic is either an aetheric or illusion effect, with primal magic combining both these schools into the fey category. Aetheric spells directly manipulate the fabric of time and space, allowing for teleportation, co-location, divination, and other strange effects. Illusion magics directly manipulate the thoughts, emotions, and perceptions of thinking and feeling beings. Fey magics do both, but typically do so through a very different mechanism than their arcane equivalents - an arcane beguilement operates by directly modifying how a mind receives and processes information, while a fey beguilement simply floods that mind with half-shaped energies from Faerie and then lets those energies do the rest of the work. As a result, fey spells typically have a much more 'storybook'-like logic to them, with the referee much freer to innovate or pull the spell's effects in thematically appropriate directions, while aetheric and illusion spells typically give the wizards who cast them exactly what they ask for, no more or less.

When describing a magical spell, a good referee will try to provide a diverse range of visual, auditory, and other sensory cues. Wizard spells in particular tend to manifest in extremely cinematic ways – a divination spell might begin as a drawing of a closed eye on the wizard’s forehead, painted in black and purple magic ink, which ‘opens up’ into an animated third eye that actively turns its gaze to look where directed. An elemental attack spell might begin as a pair of half-circles painted onto the palms of each of the wizard’s hands, encircled with runes, with one rune missing – which is painted on the wizard’s opposite thumbnail. When the wizard places both hands together, palms outwards, the two halves of the circle align into a full conjuration sigil – and when the wizard folds their thumb over to align it with the missing space, the entire sigil alights in ghostly fire (colored per the conjuration’s element) expanding into a large glowing circle suspended and rotating in front of the wizard’s hands, which contracts and fires bolts of elemental energies whenever the mage shouts a command word. The cantrip effect might be activated by holding the hands together and speaking the command word, but without folding over the thumb to complete the runes.

Primal glammers can be just as cinematic, but most of the impressive special effects tend to happen at the location of the spell itself. A druid’s elemental spells will often show echoes of the fey spirits that are helping to shape them – a crashing wave of water might have watery horses manifesting at the wave-peaks, or a blazing inferno might shape itself into a raging, fiery bull for brief moments.

Divine miracles, by comparison, are much more subtle. Other than the glowing prayer strip and the priest’s loudly chanted or quietly murmured prayer, there may be little evidence at all that a first-circle magical effect is even being invoked. Second- and third-circle effects tend to involve some amount of energetic display, but even these miracles typically limit themselves to auras of light, halos shining around the recipients of blessings or flashes of fiery wrath encircling the victims of curses.

Using Magic Creatively

Spells, miracles, and glammers tend to have specifically-defined effects. However, a creative spellcaster should be able to use them for more than their intended purpose. For example, an elemental attack spell that deals fire damage could certainly be used to light flammable substances, or a thunder or aetheric spell that can push or knock creatures over might be used to attempt to move a large object.

Like any creative action, it is your job as the referee to determine whether such an action is impossible, automatic, or requires some kind of task check or saving throw at hard, normal, or easy difficulty. If the task requires fine-grained manipulation of magical energies, it can probably be determined with a Science check. If it requires extensive understanding of natural phenomena, a Survival check might do instead. Tricking intelligent creatures to perform specific actions by generating particularly well-crafted illusions might involve a Wit check, while tricking wild animals in the same manner might necessitate a Survival check. Again, don’t be afraid to decide that a particular attempt is impossible or automatic; actually clever plans should always be rewarded at a higher rate than good dice rolls, and even the best dice rolls shouldn’t save the party from a terrible idea.

Side Effects of Magic

These same creative applications of magic should be allowed to happen accidentally sometimes, as well. Damaging flame spells should absolutely light fragile flammable objects on fire; acid should absolutely mar or even destroy artwork, scrolls or other delicate objects; aetheric manipulations might have strange effects on other ongoing or ambient aetheric effects, especially those involving portals or other interdimensional shenanigans. (Notice the dangers of placing an aetheric blade within a bag of holding to get an idea of what this might mean.)

As the referee, your job is not to regularly punish the players for failing to understand obscure occult lore; instead, your job is to simulate a dangerous world that is also full of potential, and let the players learn how to engage with it creatively.

Managing Exploration

Scale, Distance, and Time

To speed up exploration, you should split the world into different time and distance scales at different phases of the adventure. While traveling over large distances, hours and days are the default measure of time, and three-mile leagues are the default measure of distance. A party traveling on foot can reasonably expect to cross one league of easy terrain per hour, and can maintain this pace without difficulty for 8 hours (or about 24 miles) per day. Most kingdom-scale maps should therefore be split into eight-league hexes, with each eight leagues of road or easy terrain representing a day's travel.

Leagues and Paces

Each eight-league hex should be further divided into one-league sub-hexes, to make it easier to keep track of the party's overland progress from one hour to the next. Crossing eight leagues of road in a day does not require any real rolling or decisions, but traversing difficult terrain should be managed on an hour-by-hour basis.

Leagues with complex terrain or important features should be even further subdivided into half-mile exploration hexes, each of which (if not filled with difficult terrain) can be crossed at a walking pace during a ten-minute exploration turn. Crossing an exploration hex full of difficult terrain will require two turns to cross - one full turn to enter into the hex, and another to exit.

Each exploration hex that contains a dungeon or lookout should refer to a dungeon map, drawn on a square grid that is split into five-foot paces. The 5-foot pace is the smallest unit of distance typically used in the game, with player characters and monsters positioning themselves on the dungeon map grid during an encounter. Encounters measure time in six-second spans, allowing most player characters to traverse five paces during this span without special effort. Diagonal movement across a square grid requires special consideration; every two full paces of diagonal movement counts as three paces of straight movement.

Other Distances

Strategists and tacticians often make maps with three other distances: the 20-pace *field*, the 100-pace *shot*, and the 500-pace *halfmile*.

Making Maps

Standardizing your map-making process can be valuable. It's usually a good idea to create two different maps at each scale. Keep one for your own use, with all of the discoverable secrets and encounter probabilities noted, and provide a second mostly-unlabeled version to provide to the players. Published adventures for *Materia Mundi* will come in four different map scales:

Domain Map

A domain or wilderness map is divided into 24-mile *march* hexes, each of which is further subdivided into eight 3-mile *league* hexes. Remember that the maximum visibility on even terrain is three miles, so the party can, at best, see *into* adjacent league hexes from their current position, but cannot see *through* them.

Exploration Map

An exploration map "zooms in" on a single march hex, dividing it into half-mile exploration hexes. Each exploration hex represents the amount of area that the party can cross, or explore, in a single 10-minute exploration turn.

Battle Map

A battle map typically represents one ½-mile exploration hex, subdividing it into 100-foot (20-pace) "field" hexes. Large-scale battles and sieges will happen on a battle map, to give troop formations, siege weapons, and huge creatures space to maneuver and fire.

Encounter Map

An encounter or dungeon map typically represents a city, village, dungeon, or stretch of wilderness where precise positioning is likely to be important. The smallest encounter maps each represent a single 20-pace "field".

Encounter maps are divided into squares, rather than hexes; each square represents one pace (5 feet). Some larger encounter maps will have 20-pace squares or hexes overlaid onto them, so that they can serve for both large-scale battles and character-scale encounters.

Passage of Time

Scaling time and distance proportionately makes for much easier accounting. The time scale of a particular phase of the adventure is the rate at which the party is invited to make decisions about what to do next and roll dice to determine the result of those decisions.

Days

For example, when operating on the domain or wilderness map with eight-league hexes, you should give the party a minute or two to decide which direction to travel in, and what morning and evening preparations to make. Then the party's navigator can make a Survival check (or another relevant task check) to determine whether the party gets lost or bogged down, has a random encounter, or discovers a feature within the hex that they are entering or leaving.

Hours

If the terrain or special features of a hex indicate the need for more detail, you should begin tracking the party's movement through each league of travel, pausing at the top of each hour to ask the party what preparations they are making, and whether they wish to explore this league-hex more thoroughly or traverse into an adjacent hex. Once each member of the party has chosen their activity for the hour, you can have each of them make a single task check relevant to that activity. Highly detailed interactions or movement indicate that it's time to switch scales to the exploration map with its half-mile (500 pace) hexes and 100-pace sub-hexes.

Turns

Once the party begins exploring the exploration map in depth, you should begin tracking individual ten-minute exploration turns – with each member of the party (and their henchmen) choosing a single exploration action to perform every ten minutes, and then rolling the appropriate task check to determine the outcome of that action.

Rounds

Then, if a combat encounter occurs, or some other event with a "ticking clock" of danger, switch to the combat rules with six-second encounter rounds.

Torches, Lamps, and Light

Outdoors during the day, there is typically enough light for everyone to see clearly. In a dungeon, the party needs to bring their own light to be able to see what they are doing.

A lantern typically casts bright light out to ten paces, and dim light out to another ten paces (twenty paces total), while a torch typically casts bright light out to five paces, and dim light out to another five paces (ten total). A full lamp will burn for roughly an hour, while a torch will burn for 1d6+1 exploration turns. Thus, torches and lanterns provide a natural set of distance time measurements for the party when adventuring in the dungeon: a "lamp" is 20 paces (one field) of length, or one hour of time. Most civilized settlements, and some dungeons, will have braziers or hanging lamps placed at regular intervals along walls to illuminate well-traveled passageways.

Anything bright enough to illuminate is also bright enough to be seen in the darkness, from quite a ways away. Lighting a lamp is thus an excellent way to announce one's presence, and location, to everything within line of sight that might take an interest in the party's activities.

Lanterns are typically sheltered from wind, rain, and minor jostling, while torches are much more exposed. Thus, in inclement weather or when moving quickly in the dungeon, a torch-bearer might need to make periodic Finesse checks to keep their torch from going out.

If the party runs out of torches, new ones can be fashioned from sticks, rags, and lamp oil without the need for a roll. One hour's worth of lamp oil soaked into a rag and wrapped around a forearm-sized stick is sufficient to create a single torch; while this is somewhat less efficient than burning the oil in a proper lamp, sometimes adventurers must make do.

Travel Actions

Exploring the map can take as much or as little time as you and your party want. Some styles of play prefer to spend a good deal of time exploring the uncharted wilderness, while others consider the overland hex-map to simply be a distraction between the party and the dungeon.

Navigation and Maps

Knowing where you are, and where you are going, requires a combination of different talents. Familiarity with terrain and local flora and fauna is governed by the Survival talent, while the ability to read maps and recognize landmarks is governed by Lore. A good navigator will have sufficient proficiency in both talents to keep the party heading in the right direction.

Recognizable landmarks and well-marked maps determine the difficulty for Lore checks to know where the party is, what direction is north when the stars are obscured, and what kinds of dangers are likely to be ahead on the path chosen. Survival checks are more grounded in the party's immediate surroundings, and can give hints about dangers, challenges, or opportunities that might be within the current 1-league hex or its six adjacent hexes.

Characters in unfamiliar territory might wish to create their own maps, both for their own use and to gift or sell to other adventurers. A surveyor or map-maker will usually sketch a crude overview of the local terrain during travel, then revise and enhance it during rest. The general process can be distilled down to three task checks: Survival to notice all the relevant details, Lore to organize them into a readable map format, and Finesse to actually draw the map accurately.

Traversing Difficult Terrain

While Lore and Survival are necessary for knowing the terrain, the ability to traverse it unharmed is a matter for saving throws. Getting bogged down in swamps, treacherous mountain passes, or densely overgrown forests is a common fact of life for wandering adventurers, once the party leaves the well-maintained roads behind and delves into the true unknown.

Managing Supplies

The Finesse talent is also useful while traveling. Finesse is needed to maintain the party's gear, to keep any wagons or pack animal loads balanced and secure across difficult terrain, and to come up with alternate solutions to Agility checks. The party should always be encouraged to come up with clever ways to traverse terrain – a clever solution might lower the difficulty of an Agility or Survival check, or might overcome the need for a roll altogether.

In certain circumstances, a Survival check might be necessary to coax animals through a path they would not normally wish to traverse or to steady their nerves in dangerous situations. The difficulty will depend on both the situation, and the number of animals being managed at once; a large pack might need multiple handlers.

Stealth

A party moving at half speed can make Stealth tests to attempt to cover their tracks, move more quietly, and find less noticeable paths to traverse. Each member of the party must make the Stealth test; the lowest result determines the party's success.

Watching for Encounters

Anyone on watch uses their Alertness to help avoid or prepare for encounters, while the rest of the party focuses on navigation, load maintenance, and terrain management.

Points of Interest

Each league of terrain might have a lookout or watchtower, or even a hidden dungeon worth exploring. Stopping and exploring a sub-hex can take anywhere from an hour to a whole day, depending on the terrain; Survival, Lore, Science and Alertness are all useful talents to apply to the task.

Lookouts and Watchtowers

Finding a lookout or a watchtower allows the party to make Agility checks (or sometimes other task checks) to climb it and get a better view of the surroundings, or possibly take a well-needed rest. While at a lookout, the party's line of sight is increased in various directions, allowing them to make Lore, Survival, and Alertness tests for hexes that they are not yet in or adjacent to.

Vehicles and Mounts

A good riding mount allows a party to carry more gear without encumbrance and ignore some kinds of rough terrain, but does not otherwise increase travel speed. A fast horse might be able to double its overland speed for up to an hour - traveling up to 2 leagues at a full gallop - but would then need a full hour of rest. Pushing a horse past this limit is likely to wound or even kill it.

Hitching a team of horses to a wagon allows that wagon to travel at walking pace (one league per hour / 24 miles per day), while carrying several tons' worth of gear and provisions. Wagons can only traverse roads or smooth ground, and quickly become bogged down in rough terrain. Crossing a river with a wagon typically involves fashioning some kind of raft and floating the wagon across - a task fraught with the potential for mishap.

Particularly inventive Wizards and Dwarves are likely to construct all manner of wondrous self-propelled vehicles, often capable of much faster land speeds.

Seafaring and Flying

Most sizable sailing vessels can reach a cruising speed of approximately two leagues per hour in open water. As on land, inventive Enchanters might construct arcane propulsion systems capable of much higher speeds. Unlike land travel, most ships can sail day and night, giving them 24 hours of travel per day at their rated speed.

Flying mounts (and flying vehicles) can make overland travel almost trivially easy. A flying party ignores terrain difficulty when determining their travel speed, although wind and inclement weather can create conditions roughly analogous to "difficult terrain". The height advantage also gives the party a literal "eagle's eye view", letting them see much farther than when traveling along the ground - although weather might also interfere with this, and smaller terrain features are likely to be overlooked.

During an encounter, most vehicles and flying characters will have a turn radius larger than a one-pace square, with faster movement typically requiring an even wider turn to change directions.

Managing Maps

Wilderness and dungeon maps are a crucial tool for maintaining the consistency of your game world. Maps serve as your "memory" for the world, holding the locations of important landmarks, creatures, and events so that you don't have to keep an entire world in your head at every moment.

Arts & Crafts

Creating and using detailed wilderness, exploration, and encounter maps is an important skill for a referee to learn. Kingdom, wilderness, and dungeon exploration maps can be made physically or digitally, depending on your preference as a referee, but "encounter maps" should usually be physical unless you are using a "virtual tabletop" to run the whole game. A physical encounter map, with physical miniatures (or even chits) to represent each monster and player character, helps the party quickly visualize the flow of an encounter. Even during exploration, these encounter maps are useful for helping the players understand the space that they are exploring and interacting with.

Maintaining maps at different scales can seem arduous at first, but the reward-to-effort ratio is surprisingly high. If you make a keyed "master dungeon map" at a scale of 1/4" per pace, with each room individually labeled, you can then make a separate 1/2"-per-pace "encounter map" for each labeled room or hallway, with the edges of the encounter maps cut to the doorways between rooms. Then, you can lay down individual rooms as the party enters them, and pick up rooms as they leave the party's line of sight - providing a visual representation of the space for the party to orient to, without providing them with easy access to information that wouldn't be immediately available to their characters.

On your master dungeon map, you can use pushpins to denote where the party is, as well as any wandering monsters or other mobile threats. During each exploration turn, you can decide where each monster group moves based on its goals and personality, only checking for encounters whenever a monster group is close enough to the party to risk detection.

Exploration Actions

It's important to remember that many goals might be accomplished through several different approaches, each of which might call for a different task or saving throw.

For example, picking a lock or disabling a trap through fine manipulation of its mechanisms should be accomplished through a Finesse check; noticing that a merchant is lying about their participation in a historical event might involve a Lore test to recall the actual facts of the matter, an Intuition test to notice the gut feeling of dishonesty, or a Wit test to "spot a fellow liar". In all cases, you should have the player describe to you - in detail - what their character tries, then set an appropriate difficulty and then either let them roll an appropriate task check, or declare that their solution is sufficient to succeed without a roll.

Hidden Results

Sometimes the players will attempt actions where the results will not become apparent until some later time. In such cases, it is often useful to make the roll yourself, behind a "dungeon-master screen", and only give the players a vague sense of how well their characters performed at their task until the time of revelation is at hand.

Player vs. Character Knowledge

The philosophy of old-school dungeon crawl roleplaying games tends to favor the players' ingenuity over mechanical dice-rolling based on their characters' abilities and talents when possible. Sometimes this results in the players knowing things that their characters have no real way of knowing, and acting on this "out-of-character" knowledge. In other situations, it might mean the players missing something that their characters would reasonably know or notice.

In general, if the player knows something that their character has any plausible means of also knowing, let them act on that knowledge. If a player knows something that their character is unlikely to know, or if a player is unaware of something that their character would most likely be familiar with, have the player make a relevant task check to see if their character actually knows the information, then tell them what they should know if their roll succeeds.

Which Talent to Use

Whenever a task check is required, one of the twelve standard talents should be chosen:

Agility (*Dexterity*) to climb surfaces, maintain balance, and perform precise athletic actions.

Finesse (*Dexterity*) to pick locks, disarm traps, operate machinery, or craft or repair items.

Stealth (*Dexterity*) to hide from view, move silently without being noticed, surprise or ambush an enemy, or pick pockets.

Lore (*Intelligence*) to understand a language, decipher a code, or recall any knowledge involving history, religion, or culture.

Medicine (*Intelligence*) to brew an elixir or toxin, or diagnose or treat injury, poison, or disease.

Science (*Intelligence*) to brew a potion, enchant or identify a scroll or magic item, or to recall any knowledge involving math, engineering, science, or magic.

Alertness (*Wisdom*) to detect a hidden trap or secret door, to listen or watch for enemies, and avoid being surprised by ambushes.

Intuition (*Wisdom*) to read the emotions and intentions of living creatures, or to get a "gut sense" of danger or extreme foolishness.

Survival (*Wisdom*) to navigate the wilderness, hunt or forage for food, follow others' tracks or hide your own, or set up camp.

Bearing (*Charisma*) to maintain composure, manage hirelings and followers, or improve your allies' morale.

Charm (*Charisma*) to sway another intelligent creature's attitude towards you.

Wit (*Charisma*) to influence another intelligent creature's immediate behavior or beliefs.

Adjusting Difficulty

As a referee, one skill that you will want to develop quickly is the ability to roughly gauge the plausibility of any attempted action. The difficulty system has been divided into 'easy', 'normal', and 'hard' thresholds to make this easier, but you must ultimately use your own common sense.

Skill, Tools, Time, and Approach

A good rule of thumb for any task is to consider the skill, tools, and time given for any given task, as a set of four yes/no questions:

- Does the character have the necessary minimum skill to perform the task at hand?
- Do they have the right tools for the job?
- Does the character have sufficient time to perform the task required?
- Is the character taking a reasonably sound approach to the problem, based on the player's description of their action?

Automatic

If the answer to all four of these questions is 'yes' - the character is sufficiently skilled, sufficiently equipped, has sufficient time, and is trying a reasonable action - then you generally shouldn't make them roll at all. Simply grant them success and move on, unless you have a particular need to determine "how well" they succeed (in which case the actual task you're measuring is the attempt at an exceptional success).

Impossible

If they only have one 'yes' answer, then they need to find some advantage to even some of the odds, to be allowed to make the roll at all. Since they are already at impossible difficulty, a single sufficiently large advantage will cancel out one of them, letting them try a hard roll. Applying multiple advantages might allow them to make a roll at normal difficulty, but without either tools, time, or skill, they shouldn't be able to make the roll easy.

Task Check

If their approach is reasonable, and they have at least two other 'yes' answers - sufficient skill and tools while rushed, or sufficient skill and time but inadequate tools, or sufficient tools and time but insufficient skill - then a task check is called for. Use your intuition to determine the difficulty, based on the likelihood of success of a moderately skilled (4+) character with proper equipment within a 10-minute exploration turn, then have them roll their talent or ability.

Good Idea, Bad Idea

If the character's approach is wrong, let them try whatever they're trying and make a roll, then describe the actual consequences that would logically result from those actions. Once they have dealt with those consequences, let them try to figure out why their approach isn't working and try again if they still can. It is important to give them as much information as they could reasonably glean from each attempt; if you bog your players down in too many obscure situations, they will begin to feel like they need to "guess the referee's password" to proceed, which no one ever finds fun.

Rewarding Ingenuity

Remember that the referee's job is to be fair, neither favoring the party nor the dungeon. If the party comes up with a clever idea that would conceivably work, it is important to let them try it, setting a difficulty based on your estimated likelihood of success and the suitability of their plan to the task at hand. Likewise, if the party comes up with a solution that is clever, effective, and certain or almost to work, don't force them to roll simply because there is a relevant talent or ability that might apply. Just let them succeed and move on to the next turn of exploration.

Managing Negotiations

The player characters will often want to try talking their way out of (or into) situations. This should be encouraged whenever possible; combat is a hazard that sane adventurers should wish to avoid whenever possible.

During Exploration

Most social interactions operate at roughly the same scale as exploration - each round is approximately 10 minutes, and involves a single task check made by each participant. This allows some characters to engage socially while other members of the party perform non-social exploration actions.

As such, each task check performed during a social interaction should determine the consequences of an entire 10-minute conversation. The simplest procedure for the referee is to have the characters performing non-social actions roll their task checks first, and then roleplay out any conversation that's occurring during the same exploration turn.

At the end of that conversation (or at a more relevant point during the exploration turn, if you decide that a non-social interaction interrupts that conversation), you should appraise the goals of each participant, as well as "how the conversation is going", to determine which talents are relevant and whether any rolls should be easy or hard.

During Encounters

It is also possible to use social talents during an encounter. A single encounter round is only six seconds, so each character is limited to a few words or gestures in their attempts to communicate. This is still enough to allow for various attempts to persuade, deceive, intimidate, or otherwise sway the course of the encounter through words rather than bloodshed.

Which Talent to Use

Direct, non-deceptive persuasion typically involves a Charm or Wit check, with the target's current attitude (Helpful, Friendly, Indifferent, Unfriendly, or Hostile) combining with the details of the conversation to determine whether rolls are easy or hard. Charm is generally used to influence attitude, while Wit is generally used to directly influence behavior, although there might be exceptions based on the actual conversation. Above all, the actual conversation that is being roleplayed should always take precedence over any mere mechanical considerations.

Attempts to directly coerce or intimidate will typically involve a Bearing check, while attempts to lie or mislead via "fast-talk" tactics will typically involve a Wit check. Flattery, flirtation and other forms of deceptive manipulation might instead use a Charm check. A direct debate over issues will likely involve both sides rolling Wit, with one side "gaining ground" only if they succeed and the other side fails simultaneously. Discussions over knowledge or technical minutia might even invoke a Lore, Medicine, Science, or Survival roll.

Characters who do not share each other's language will often be at a disadvantage when attempting to communicate with each other. A character's Lore is useful for attempting to learn a new language, and might indicate some basic familiarity with some of those language's words and concepts. Language is typically less of a barrier when using Charm than when using Wit, as non-verbal cues become more relevant. Different cultural rules of etiquette and behavior can also come into play, making various rolls easy or hard as appropriate. As with languages, Lore is useful for attempting to pick up the local customs, and for determining whether a character might already be aware of some of them. Actual familiarity with local languages and customs cuts through all of this, allowing characters to converse and persuade without difficulty.

Managing Followers

Gaining Followers

Each player character can collect a retinue of followers, with a maximum troupe size based on their Bearing.

Bearing	Maximum Followers
6+	1
5+	2
4+	3
3+	4
2+	5

if gaining a new follower causes a player character's retinue to exceed their Bearing, that character finds it harder to manage all their followers until they let enough of them go to fall under the limit.

To recruit a new follower, the player character first presents their case; if the referee deems it sufficiently convincing for that particular creature, the player can make a Charm check with a difficulty based on the appeal of the offer and the prospective recruit's current attitude. If they succeed, the creature decides to join that character's retinue. Demonstrated loyalty and offered incentives make this check easier, while extenuating circumstances will make it harder.

It's a good idea to keep a few personality notes about each follower NPC in your party's retinues; giving each of the party's followers a distinct voice and personality goes a long way towards fostering immersion and engagement.

Directing Followers

Bearing is also used to determine whether followers obey orders when under duress, in dangerous or stressful situations, or when the orders are unclear or complex. A Bearing check can be made in most situations to quickly determine if plans go awry due to lack of coordination; this check will be normal difficulty for naturally Friendly followers, easy for Helpful followers, or hard for Indifferent followers.

Follower Loyalty

Each member of the party's retinue is an NPC under the control of the referee. Helpful followers will obey orders to the best of their ability, while merely Friendly followers might weigh the potential risks and rewards before jumping into a dangerous situation. A Follower whose attitude falls to Indifferent is unhappy with their lot, and is likely to abandon the group at the first opportunity; a follower whose temperament falls to Unfriendly or Hostile will actively mutiny if they see a good opportunity to do so.

A disgruntled follower will typically bring the mood of the entire party down, sowing dissension and distrust among the ranks. The player character leading the retinue finds all tests managing any followers with an attitude other than Helpful harder, as long as at least one follower is actively Unfriendly or Hostile.

Beast Companions

In addition to followers, player characters can gain a second retinue of beast companions - using their Survival instead of Bearing to determine the total hit dice worth of trained animals that they can manage (usually riding mounts or trained hunting dogs). Druids and hunters with expertise in Survival use their Survival to determine the total number of beast companions they can manage, and can even befriend wild animals or fey beasts.

Beast companions are usually under your control. They act on their own initiative, using their own action and movement as normal, to obey the commands of their handler to the best of their understanding and training. It is your job to set limits of what actions are or aren't possible for a given beast companion to perform, based on its intelligence, anatomy, disposition, and training.

One exception is for a well-trained warhorse being actively ridden; the bond between rider and mount is sufficiently strong that they operate effectively as a single unit, using the mount's movement during the rider's turn as if it was his own, leaving the rider to perform their own full action as normal.

Managing Encounters

Starting an Encounter

Generally, an encounter starts whenever one creature initiates hostilities against another, or whenever a trap or hazard activates that requires rapid reactions and decisions. In an encounter, seconds count, and the party is fighting against the clock as much as they are fighting against the dungeon or its monsters.

An encounter starts with a surprise check. If either side was moving stealthily, all creatures on that side roll Stealth. Then, each creature that was on watch on either side makes an Alertness check. (Usually, this happens in the turn just before the encounter begins.)

Creatures who were performing complex or deeply engrossing exploration actions like preparing a spell, repairing an object, or meditating to restore glamour or faith are fully surprised during the first round of combat, and begin the encounter stunned; they must skip the first round of combat.

Any other creature declares its first action, and then all creatures that can act do so in order based on the speed of their actions.

Action speed determines the order that each creature or hazard acts during a six-second combat round. All fast actions go first, followed by all normal actions, and then all slow actions. If two creatures have the same action speed, they act simultaneously unless the precise timing matters, in which case they each make a Dexterity check and the higher result chooses whether to go first or last.

Each creature performs its movement and action during the appropriate phase of the round. Other creatures who may react to the acting creature, if the acting creature's action affects the reacting creature or provokes an attack from the reacting creature.

The currently acting creature can choose to delay their action, if they want to do something directly in response to the action of a slower creature or hazard. They describe the condition they are waiting for and their desired response to it, then wait. When the specified condition occurs, they can interrupt that action with their own to perform the desired response, which may include movement.

Once all creatures that could perform actions have acted, and all creatures that couldn't perform actions have handled any reflexive bookkeeping, the round ends and the next round begins.

Surprise and Ambushes

Certain situations can cause surprise if one side deliberately sets up to ambush the other. The player characters' party is just as capable of ambushing a goblin warband as they are of being ambushed by them.

Even if a party is successfully ambushed, most characters still have some chance to act during the surprise round, which is the first round of a combat encounter when at least some creatures are surprised. Any creature who was on watch and succeeded at their Alertness check gets to act in the surprise round, while any other creature is stunned and must wait until the surprise round is over.

Morale

Most creatures will attempt to retreat from a fight if injured (reduced below half their maximum hit points). An injured monster or NPC must immediately make a saving throw vs. Fear to determine whether they stay in the fight, and must make another saving throw each time they sustain further damage while they are below half their hit points. On a failure, that creature will panic and attempt to flee. Some creatures are immune to morale checks, or have other behaviors that they will perform instead of fleeing.

Player characters are assumed to be made of sterner stuff than this, and will not need to make morale checks unless subjected to some kind of supernatural fear-inducing effect. If you and your players want to play a grittier game, you can require player characters to make morale checks in any circumstance that an NPC would need to make them; a player character that fails a morale check will be limited in which actions they can take, but you should still allow them to decide how their character tries to flee.

Movement in Combat

Characters in combat can walk, sprint, jump, climb, or fly - sometimes all at once! Each mode of movement deserves special consideration.

For simplicity's sake, nearly all creatures have a base movement speed of 5 paces, or 3 paces if hobbled. A character can dash to quadruple that to 20 paces if unencumbered, or merely double it to 10 paces if encumbered. Difficult terrain also reduces a character's total speed for the round to 3 paces (as if hobbled).

Jumping, climbing, and swimming require the character to spend their action and make an Agility test; the difficulty (and consequences of failure) should be based on the nature of the terrain being crossed.

Opportunity Attacks

One situation that you'll need to adjudicate frequently is the opportunity attack. For a high lethality game, most actions that a player character, NPC, or monster could take should trigger an opportunity attack, unless that action is itself a melee attack, the guard action, or the evade action.

If you want a lower-lethality game, you might restrict opportunity attacks to only trigger when a creature attempts to leave a hostile creature's reach, or attempts to make a ranged attack or cast a ranged spell.

An interesting compromise is to allow fighter classes an opportunity attack on any action other than guard, evade, or melee attacks, while non-warriors only gain opportunity vs. creatures leaving their reach or attacking at range.

Ongoing Conditions

Various kinds of ongoing conditions can be inflicted on a creature due to damage. The most common source of these conditions is when an attack's damage die rolls a '6'. Weapon attacks will usually inflict bleeding, stun, or sundering damage, while elemental attacks will inflict conditions based on their element. A creature gets a saving throw to avoid any ongoing condition inflicted by an attack, and some conditions allow a creature to spend their action to make another saving throw to attempt to end them.

Petrification and cold attacks will usually hobble a creature first, then restrain them if they are already hobbled, then immobilize them if they are already restrained. Hobbled and restrained creatures can attempt to break free with a saving throw, but an immobilized creature can only be freed with outside help.

Sharp weapons, acid, poison, and fire will all inflict the ongoing damage effect, which is applied at the end of each round of combat until the creature takes an action to deal with the condition, and makes a successful saving throw or task check, depending on how the player describes their action.

Radiant and thunder damage can blind or deafen a creature, which lasts until the affliction is magically removed; resting and recovering hit points might allow a saving throw vs. Doom to recover a temporary condition at the referee's discretion.

Blunt weapons, elemental lightning, and psychic damage usually stun a creature, although psychic attacks can also cause various curse or beguiling effects. These effects will usually be unique enough that they must be handled on a case-by-case basis.

Finally, aetheric damage represents any purely magical attack with no mundane equivalent; any ongoing effect from aetheric damage will need to be handled on a case-by-case basis.

Adjusting Difficulty

Combat encounters are one of the places where referee's rulings to adjust difficulty are trickiest, and most important. Players will want to try all sorts of things to try to make their attacks hit harder or land more easily. Your job is to encourage this without breaking verisimilitude or bogging down play.

In terms of statistical probabilities, remember that easy and hard difficulties do not change the maximum or minimum possible rolls that a character could achieve for a given task – they simply move the 'middle' of their dice roll probabilities upwards or downwards, making average rolls more or less likely to achieve the upper end of their potential.

Cover and Concealment

Cover and concealment are two of the more common adjustments to attack difficulty. Both cover and concealment can be partial or total.

Partial concealment means that at least half of a character's silhouette is obscured, or that their form is indistinct. It might also mean that they are only visible for brief moments during the combat round. Dim light counts as partial concealment, as do certain illusion magics such as the blur spell. Partial concealment will make ranged attacks harder, and prevent most melee attacks from being made easier.

Full concealment means that the target is effectively invisible to the attacker. This makes melee attacks harder, and ranged attacks impossible unless they have some other way of precisely guiding their attack to the target. Full concealment also makes it easier for a concealed creature to attack anyone that cannot see them.

Partial cover makes all attacks against the covered creature harder (just like a shield), and makes most of their saving throws easier. Full cover, on the other hand, is one of the few things that can make an attack impossible, but this requires that the creature is fully protected by cover for the entire round.

Crazy Stunts

The players need to be rewarded for creativity in combat, but rewards without risk will quickly make for a dull adventure. If a player wants their character to try some kind of stunt in combat that isn't directly handled by the rules but seems vaguely plausible, by all means let them - figure out a talent or ability and difficulty, and have them roll. Remember that task checks performed during encounters only have six seconds or less to complete, so the kinds of actions that can be performed in an encounter should be much more limited than those that can be performed during a full ten-minute exploration turn.

Defensive Stunts

Dodging and parrying are the two most common stunts used to defend against an attack, but sometimes the players will come up with a clever idea that isn't really either. Other defensive stunts can be handled as saving throws or task checks; just have the target make a saving throw or roll whatever talent or ability seems appropriate to determine whether it succeeds.

Attack Stunts

Stunts performed as part of an attack need to square up against the standard attack rules. If the player has come up with an idea that genuinely isn't handled by the rules, use your judgment to determine whether the stunt should make their attack easier or harder, make their opponent's saving throw harder or easier, or cause some other effect - such as knocking the opponent down or knocking them back, stunning them, bypassing their armor, or distracting them enough to allow an ally an immediate opportunity attack. The key is to make sure the players feel rewarded for their ingenuity, but aren't being given an 'easy win' just for thinking of something new.

Often, you can use an attack's damage roll to decide what happens - a special effect might happen if one or more damage dice roll '6'; if a talent seems relevant to the attempt, you can compare the attacker's talent threshold to the attack's highest or lowest damage die, as if the damage roll was a task check: if the attack hits and the "task check" succeeds, the additional effect happens. (The target might get a saving throw depending on the effect.)

Improvised Magic

Stunts performed as part of a spell or miracle can be the most challenging, and the most fun, situations to rule on. It helps to have a reasonable understanding of real-world science, a reasonable sense of why the game's magic systems work the way they do, a fair grounding in mythology and fairy-tales, and a good imagination when going "off the rails" with magical effects: the situation should 'feel' physically and magically appropriate to the situation. Feel free to push back if you don't feel like you can accommodate the stunt; magic is fickle and unpredictable, and "you try it but it just doesn't work" is a fine response to trying something weird with magic.

A good rule of thumb here, as everywhere, is to balance risk against reward - a good idea on the part of a clever player should let them take a moderate risk with a substantial payoff, while a bad idea that they still really want to try should be high-risk, with an appropriate reward if the die rolls work out in their favor. Remember that as the referee, your job is to be a fair adjudicator of the rules and the situation at hand; let the players do what they want to do, then use their actions and the result of the dice to decide fairly how to describe the consequences of their choices.

Magical Mishaps

With magic, especially, "trying something weird" should give you as the referee an opportunity for creative exploration. Magic is notoriously tricky and seems to delight in ironic outcomes - a player attempting something strange might get exactly what they were asking for, only to discover that "exactly what they asked for" has unforeseen but annoyingly predictable consequences.

In other situations, a player attempting an unusual magical effect might get the opposite of what they wanted, or might even cause a seemingly unrelated phenomenon to manifest - there is a long-standing tradition of rolling "wild magic" mishap effects in the fantasy role-playing genre.

Managing Monsters

During each 10-minute exploration turn, the various monsters in a dungeon are also actively going about their day. Each monster performs its own exploration actions, including moving, wandering and resting.

Monsters that are wandering the dungeon have a chance of running into the player characters, starting a random encounter. Injured monsters that are resting to restore hit points tend to have a specific room, called their lair, that they retreat into to do so. If the player characters stumble on an injured monster in its lair, they interrupt its rest, but a monster in its lair almost always finds its attacks and defenses easier due to its home-ground advantage, and a cornered monster typically fights with unexpected ferocity.

Monster Abilities

Each monster's hit dice and abilities determine its attack throw thresholds and saving throw thresholds identically to a player character's level and abilities. Note that a monster's abilities can have a much wider range than a player character's; even so, no monster's saving throw or attack throw should ever be worse than 17+ or better than 5+.

Monster abilities can vary from individual to individual, just like a player characters'. A "typical" monster will have the abilities listed, while the referee might choose to roll or assign adjustments to one or more abilities for any unique or recurring NPC monster. Monster abilities tend to vary somewhat less than mortals, so usually only a single d6 should be rolled per ability — a '1' indicates an ability one lower than typical, or a '6' indicates an ability one higher than typical.

Finally, a monster's Intelligence should be reflected in its behavior. Any monster with an Intelligence below -3 is non-sapient, possessing only animal levels of intelligence; any monster with an Intelligence of -3 or higher can reason as well as a player character with the equivalent Intelligence.

Monster Attitudes

All monsters and NPCs have a default attitude towards the party, which guides their behavior in lieu of more detailed information. A monster or NPC's attitude can be one of five levels:

A **helpful** monster or NPC will aid the player characters without hesitation, and will do as the player characters ask unless doing so is obviously harmful. Even harmful orders or requests may be followed, depending on the details of the creature's relationship to the player characters.

A **friendly** monster or NPC will be disposed to trusting and aiding the player characters if doing so isn't out of its way, or if it has sufficient incentive. It won't risk its own safety or well-being for the player character's sake.

An **indifferent** monster or NPC has no particular interest in the player characters one way or the other, and behaves as its wariness, curiosity or boredom guide it to.

An **unfriendly** monster or NPC is fearful, annoyed, or distrustful of the player characters, and might seek to harm them if it thinks it can get away with doing so without too much trouble.

A **hostile** monster or NPC is actively aggressive towards the player characters, and will likely attack them on sight.

Bearing, Charm and Wit can be used in an exploration turn to engage with monsters that aren't actively hostile; success or failure on task tests with these talents might move a monster's attitude up or down one level, while exceptional success or failure might move a monster's attitude up two levels at once. Other talents might aid this process, depending on how they are used. For more rapid adjustments, various mind-altering magic spells can quickly influence a creature's attitude, but often result in a similar adjustment in the opposite direction when they wear off.

Monsters in Combat

In a game about heroes exploring ancient dungeons, the party is eventually going to wind up having to fight some monsters.

Monster Hit Dice

Monsters measure their overall toughness and experience using hit dice, just like player characters. Powerful monsters can exceed the threat level of even a fifth-level character, so monsters can range from half a hit die up to ten hit dice.

To figure out the total 'threat budget' of a monster encounter, add up the players' total class levels, including the class levels or hit dice of any retinue. The total monster hit dice in the encounter should approximately equal the total party hit dice, if you intend a roughly "fair fight". Large monsters count as twice their hit dice, while small monsters count as half their hit dice.

In the real world, of course, fights are rarely fair – feel free to create monster encounters procedurally, and then allow the party a relevant task check to see if they notice which side has the upper hand.

Monster Powers

Many monsters have various 'budgeted' powers, which they can activate a certain number of times per encounter. Monsters with higher hit dice will typically have more uses of their per-encounter powers; typical monsters are able to use their powers once per hd. Some monsters might have powers that cost two or even three "power points" per use, such as a magic-using monster that can cast second- or third-circle spells.

Monster Behavior

Most monsters will have a default behavior, which is usually determined by rolling a d6. The possible behaviors for unintelligent monsters are fearful, wary, indifferent, curious, and aggressive. Fearful monsters will attempt to escape combat as soon as possible, and their save vs. fear rolls become harder once they become injured. Aggressive monsters will attempt to attack whenever possible, and their saves vs. fear when injured are easier. Monsters with the frenzy ability automatically succeed at their saving throws vs. fear, becoming enraged instead.

Looting and Harvesting

Certain NPCs will have magic items that can be taken from them when they are defeated, and elemental or fey monsters will typically leave a corpse that can be harvested for materia. Any loot gathered from a monster or NPC should be scaled to that monster or NPC's power level (represented by their hit dice). Thus, a 2 hd NPC will typically have a Common magic item, while a 3-4 hd NPC will typically have two common items or one uncommon item, and a 5 hd NPC might have three common, or one common and one uncommon, or one rare item.

It is possible, of course, for a 1 hit die NPC to be in the possession of a rare item or even a priceless artifact, but such circumstances don't typically last very long. A 1 hit die NPC bristling with rare items might put up quite a fight at first, but their lower saving throws and hit points means that they will eventually run out of luck.

Magical monsters will typically provide raw materials for crafting, rather than finished magic items, although exceptions are certainly possible (such as a magic sword embedded in the hide of a basilisk, or an entire cache of undigested weapons stuck inside of a gelatinous ooze). The most common treasure that can be harvested from a magical monster is raw materia; any monster with elemental powers will usually yield 1d6 charges of elemental materia per level when properly harvested. Harvesting materia from a monster is either a Survival check or a Science check; use whichever talent has the better threshold.

Designing Your Own Monsters

A monster's basic threat level is measured by its hit dice, but a referee should strive to make each of their monsters memorable. Always start with an idea that you find interesting, and then work from there towards something that fits into the hit die rating system.

Hit Points

A monster's hit points are determined by its Constitution, hit dice, and size. A medium-sized, 1 hit die monster has hit points equal to 6 + its Constitution, while a monster with two or more hit dice rolls all of its hit dice together (adding its Constitution to each die, to a minimum of 1 per roll) and adds the results to determine its base hit points.

Small creatures have half the hit points per hit die of medium creatures — compute their hit points as normal, and then halve that value (round up). Large creatures, on the other hand, have twice the hit points per hit die as medium creatures — again, compute their hit points as normal, and then double that value to determine maximum hit points. Huge monsters have roughly five times the hit points per hit die as medium creatures.

Structure Points

Vehicles, constructs, and monsters such as dragons with magically-reinforced scale plating might have structure points in addition to or instead of hit points. One structure point is approximately equivalent to 5 hit points, and if a creature has both hit points and structure, all of its structure must be depleted before any hit point damage can be dealt, unless a critical hit is scored.

When an attack that normally deals hit point damage hits a structure, each damage die that rolls a '6' inflicts one structure point. If an attack that normally deals structure damage hits a creature or object with hit points, each D6 of structure damage becomes 5d6 hit point damage, and each +1 structure damage becomes +1d6 hit point damage.

Vehicles and Constructs

Vehicles and constructs should generally be entirely made of structure points rather than hit points, and any 'critical hit' against them should use some kind of table to determine what part of the vehicle or construct is damaged. The golem armor rules are a good example of this; just about any vehicle could be made using the golem armor crafting system as a starting point.

Giant Monsters

If a monster is Huge sized or larger, and has 100 or more hit points, consider splitting it up into multiple "sections", each with its own hit points. Assign each of these sections to a number on a die, with larger sections being assigned multiple die results; each section gets one 'share' of hit points based on the number of die results it takes up. Consider giving each section an effect that happens when its hp are reduced to zero, and have one "main body" section that receives spillover damage.

For example, a 100 hp ogre could have five sections out of a d20 hit location roll - body (1-8), legs (9-12), left arm (12-15) right arm (16-19), and head (20). Each 'roll' would have 5 hit points; since the body takes up eight d20 'positions', it has 40 hp; since the legs and each arm takes up four d20 'positions', each limb (or set of limbs) has 20 hp. The head has 5 hp, since it only takes up a single d20 'position'. Whenever a hit lands against the ogre, the player rolls a d20 to determine which pool of hit points is depleted - or picks a section, if they rolled a hit with two d20s on an 'easy' attack roll.

If you use a d20 for the hit location roll, then you can make computing this split easier for yourself or other referees by halving the monster's base hit dice and using this "base hp" with a multiplier for each section. Since a huge monster's hp is 5x a medium creature, halving this gives you a "base hit points" of one-tenth the total; by multiplying this value by the number of hit chances on the d20 and then dividing by 2, you can quickly allocate its total hit points with a minimal margin of error.

Monster Attacks

Monsters should deal damage that makes sense based on their size and shape. A creature with fangs like daggers should have a dagger-like attack, while a creature with claws like shortwords should have a shortword-like attack. Large creatures deal double damage per attack, while Huge creatures deal five times their rolled damage. If a creature wields actual weapons with its hands, always use the attack statistics for that kind of weapon, adding more damage dice if the creature is large and wielding a weapon appropriate to its size.

A monster should be able to deal 5 points of damage per challenge rating on an average hit. You can adjust this upwards or downwards somewhat, but for every 5 full points of damage that a monster can consistently land above its challenge rating, consider reducing its total hit points by 15. Likewise, if a monster deals remarkably low damage, consider raising its hit points accordingly. Make this last choice sparingly; low-damage, high-hp “sponge” monsters are notoriously boring to fight.

Most monsters with a roughly animal body plan should have two ‘natural’ attacks - often one ‘bite’ attack and one ‘claw’ attack. These attacks should have slightly different accuracies and slightly different damage probabilities, with the higher-damage attack usually also being the lower-accuracy one. Monsters with five hit dice or more should usually also have one ‘multiattack’, where they use all their natural attacks at once against a single target.

Special Powers

Supernatural creatures with three or more hit dice should have a ‘special power’, either an attack or a spell-like ability that gives them tactical options in an encounter. Supernatural creatures with five or more hit dice should have two such powers, and creatures with nine or more hit dice should have three - with one of those three powers being significantly more potent than the other two. Feel free to assign powers based directly off of Wizard, Druid, or Priest powers, re-flavoring them as necessary to match the desired theme.

Non-supernatural creatures that are 3 hit dice or higher can also have a ‘special power’, but that power shouldn’t be particularly supernaturally “flavored”. Generally, creatures below human intelligence should have more Champion- or Hunter-like powers - but there will certainly be exceptions.

Appendices & Tables

A. Random Tables: Wilderness Terrain

The party will occasionally find itself beyond the borders of your campaign map. If you need to generate wilderness terrain on the fly, these tables will help. Of course, as with all the rules presented in this book, dice should always take a backseat to plausibility and fun.

Believably filling in a map with new terrain requires that adjacent terrain types have some plausible connection to each other. This can be achieved through the following method.

First, note the type of terrain that the party is currently on. Then, for each adjacent hex that the party has not yet explored, roll a d20 and consult the following table.

New Terrain (D20)	Plains	Forest	Rough	Current Terrain Desert	Hills	Mountain	Wetlands	River
1	Settled	Road*	Road*	Road*	Road*	Road*	Road*	Road*
2	Road*	Plains	Plains	Plains	Plains	Plains	Plains	Plains
3	Road*	Plains	Plains	Plains	Plains	Forest	Plains	Plains
4	Plains	Plains	Plains	Plains	Forest	Rough	Plains	Plains
5	Plains	Forest	Forest	Plains	Forest	Rough	Forest	Forest
6	Plains	Forest	Rough	Rough	Rough	Desert	Forest	Forest
7	Plains	Forest	Rough	Rough	Rough	Hills	Rough	Forest
8	Plains	Forest	Rough	Rough	Desert	Hills	Hills	Rough
9	Plains	Forest	Desert	Desert	Hills	Hills	Wetlands	Desert
10	Plains	Forest	Desert	Desert	Hills	Mountain	Wetlands	Hills
11	Plains	Forest	Hills	Desert	Hills	Mountain	Wetlands	Mountain
12	Plains	Forest	Hills	Desert	Hills	Mountain	Wetlands	Wetlands
13	Forest	Forest	Hills	Desert	Hills	Mountain	Wetlands	Wetlands
14	Rough	Forest	Hills	Desert	Hills	Mountain	Wetlands	Wetlands
15	Desert	Rough	Hills	Hills	Mountain	Mountain	Wetlands	Wetlands
16	Hills	Hills	Mountain	Mountain	Mountain	Mountain	River	Wetlands
17	Mountain	Mountain	Mountain	Mountain	Cliffs	Cliffs	River	Shore
18	Wetlands	Wetlands	Wetlands	Oasis	Wetlands	Cliffs	Shore	Shore
19	River*	River*	River*	River*	River*	River*	Shore	Shore
20	Shore	Shore	Shore	Shore	Shore	Shore	Shore	Shore

When you come across a road or river, immediately roll a d6 to determine its direction, then roll a d20 for each subsequent river or road hex along the indicated direction:

D20	River or Road Direction
1-2	2 hexsides counter-clockwise
3-6	1 hexside counter-clockwise
7-14	straight
15-18	1 hexside clockwise
19-20	2 hexsides clockwise

For each new hex, you can also roll a d6 to determine whether it should have a particular point of interest. On a '6', the hex has some kind of point of interest appropriate to the terrain - hills and mountains will likely have lookouts, but might also have a cave, barrow, or even a mine; plains, rivers, roads and oases are more likely to have settlements or ruins, and wetlands and forests are likely to have monster lairs or faerie inhabitants. You should create your own d6 table for each terrain type, that reflects the kinds of encounters and ruins that you want your campaign to focus on.

Resource Value

If the player characters decide to build a domain on a hex, you will need to determine the fertility value of each hex, as well as whether there are any useful mineral deposits.

Fertility

The base fertility of each half-mile sub-hex within a 24-mile domain hex should be rolled when it is first surveyed. Roll a d6:

Terrain Type / Fertility (D6)			
River	1-2 abundant	3-5 fertile	6 marginal
Wetland	1 abundant	2-5 fertile	6 marginal
Forest	1 abundant	2-4 fertile	5-6 marginal
Plains	1 abundant	2-4 fertile	5-6 marginal
Rough	1-4 fertile	5 marginal	6 barren
Hills	1-4 fertile	5 marginal	6 barren
Mountain	1 fertile	2-5 marginal	6 barren
Cliffs	1 fertile	2-5 marginal	6 barren
Desert	1-2 marginal	3-4 barren	5-6 blighted
Oasis	1 abundant	2-5 barren	6 blighted

Feel free to adjust these rolls based on the lay of the land and actual geographical sense; for example, ‘abundant’ hexes in an oasis will tend to clump together near a single body of water, while ‘abundant’ hexes along a river will typically be closer to the riverbanks.

Surveying a sub-hex is a one-day project, requiring a Science check, a Lore check, and a Survival check. If at least two checks succeed, the surveyor accurately assays the land.

Once a farm is established within a half-acre hex, its yield is determined by a fertility roll (assuming all goes well through the year):

Land Quality	Fertility Value
Blighted	0
Barren	1d6-1
Marginal	2d6
Fertile	2d6+3
Abundant	2d6+8

The amount rolled is months of food supply produced at harvest per acre of farmed land; a single half-mile sub-hex has 100 acres, of which 60 are typically farmed at any one time. Thus, for a properly managed subhex, the fertility roll measures the number of years of food produced for a family of five.

Ore Deposits

To determine whether a 24-mile domain hex has any useful mineral deposits, roll a d6 as it is surveyed:

Terrain Type	Ore Deposits (D6)
Mountain	1-3 none, 4 poor, 5 some, 6 rich
Hills	1-4 none, 5 poor, 6 some
Other Terrain	1-5 none, 6 poor

Finding actual minerals within a domain hex requires prospecting the various sub-hexes within that hex to find mineral veins, then constructing mines once they're found. Prospecting a sub-hex is a one-day project requiring a Science check.

On a success, roll 2d6 to determine whether a mineral vein is discovered, and if so what type. Roll 3d6 and add the lower two in a poor hex, or roll 3d6 and add the higher two in a rich hex.

D6	Type of Ore Deposit	Output per crew
2-9	None	N/A
10	Iron	3d6 x 200 lb
11	Stone	3d6 x 100 tons
12	Metal (roll 1d6):	
	1-5 Copper	3d6 x 500 lb
	6 Precious Metal (roll 1d6):	
	1-4 Silver	3d6 x 50 lb
	5 Gold	3d6 x 5 lb
	6 Gemstones	3d6 x 10 carat

If the roll indicates no deposits, the answer is definitive. Otherwise, a mine or quarry can be established to begin extracting the mineral from the ground. Digging a mine or quarry is an extended construction project.

Once a mine is dug, roll 4d6 and add the lowest two dice together. This is the mine’s total sustainable labor capacity, measured in 100-man (or 20-dwarf) work crews. Each crew that works the mines for a month outputs a certain amount of resource, which is measured in tons, pounds, or carats of finished material. A roll of ‘18’ on a gold, silver, or gemstone mine indicates a rare deposit of materia or magical metals:

Type of Ore Deposit	Materia Found per Crew	
Silver	feysilver	(1d6 lb)
Gemstones	materia	(3d6 x 10 charges)
Gold	orichalc	(1d6 lb)

B. Random Tables: Dungeon Generation

There are thousands of beautifully illustrated dungeon maps to download on the internet, many of which are completely free to use. You can also sit down and create your own, if you are so inclined.

Whenever you need to generate a dungeon procedurally, you can do so via the following tables.

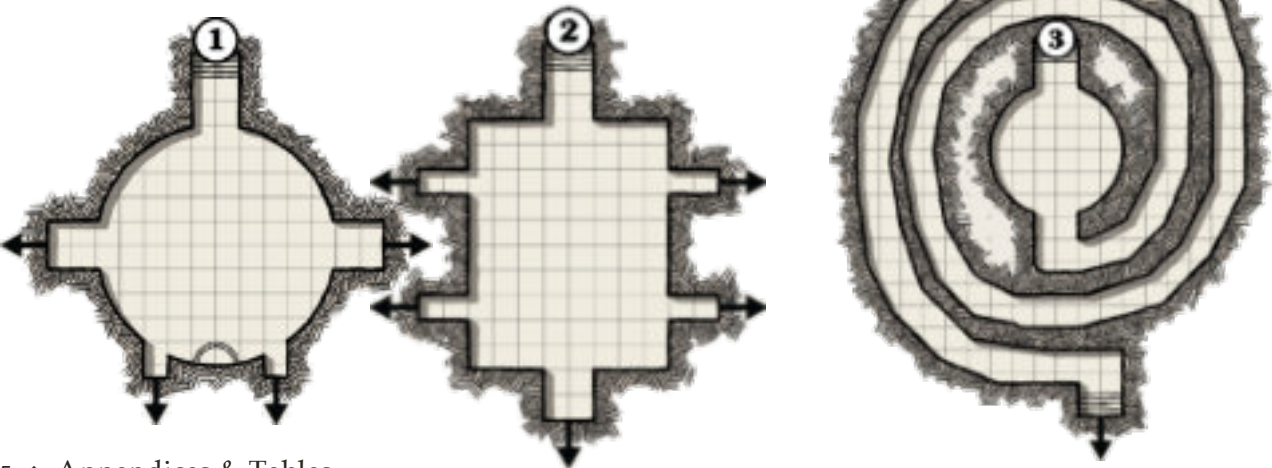
The Entrance

Before the party even enters the dungeon, they must find the entrance from the wilderness. Some dungeon entrances are well-hidden, while others are conspicuous. The architecture of the entrance should usually match the architecture of the dungeon itself, unless the dungeon has been renovated by more recent inhabitants. If you haven't decided, you can roll a d6 and choose randomly, ignoring or re-rolling any result that doesn't fit the theme of the local environment:

D6	Dungeon Type
1	Imperial Ruins
2	Atlantean / Lemurian Ruins
3	Draconic Temple
4	Qlippothic Incursion
5	Fey Demesne
6	Orcish War Camp

The Antechamber

The first real room of the dungeon should set the tone for what's to come. If you don't have any ideas, you can roll a d6 and choose one of these options:



Rooms and Corridors

Rooms and corridors can also be determined by a die roll, if necessary. A corridor will typically extend $2d6+3$ paces forward before another decision point needs to be made. You can roll a $d20 + d6$ at each decision point:

d20	Corridor Direction
1-6	90 degrees left
7-12	90 degrees right
13-17	Open into larger chamber (d20)
18-20	Continue straight for $1d6$ paces further

d6	Corridor Doorway
1-2	No door
3	Open door
4-5	Closed door
6	Locked door

d20	Chamber Shape and Size
1-4	Square ($2d6+3$ paces per side)
5-6	Rectangle ($2d6+3 \times 2d6+3$ paces)
7-8	Rectangle ($d6+2 \times d6+2$ paces)
9-10	Circle ($2d6+3$ paces diameter)
11-12	Circle ($d6+2$ paces diameter)
13-14	Oval ($2d6+3 \times 2d6+3$ paces)
15-16	Oval ($d6+2 \times d6+2$ paces)
17-20	Cave or unusual shaped room

If the dungeon path would loop back on itself, you can instead use the doorway d6 to decide whether to end at a secret door (1), or stairs going down to the next level (2-6).

Hidden Secrets

You can also create tables for whether each area of a randomly generated dungeon contains secret traps, hazards, or hidden treasure. Trap and hazard rolls can vary wildly, based on how dangerous you want the dungeon to be; the following d20 charts are simply examples of possibilities.

d20	Room Secrets
1	Door is trapped, requiring a Dexterity save to avoid some kind of damaging attack
2	Door is trapped, requiring a Constitution save to avoid a poisonous gas
3	Door is trapped, requiring a Strength save to avoid a pitfall.
4-5	There is a secret cache hidden in the room, which hides some form of treasure; roll $1d6$ to determine if the cache is trapped (on a 1-3, use this table for the trap type; on a 4-6, there is no trap).
6	There is a treasure cache prominently displayed somewhere in the room; roll $1d6$ to determine if the cache is trapped (on a 1-3, use this table for the trap type; on a 4-6, there is no trap).
7	There is a secret floor panel somewhere in the room that activates a room-wide trap; roll $1d6 \div 2$ on this table to determine the nature of the trap (on a '1', reroll two dice and apply both trap types).
8	There is a secret door somewhere in the room that leads to a nearby area of the dungeon; roll $1d6$ to determine if the door is trapped (on a 1-3, use this table for the trap type; on a 4-6, there is no trap).
9-18	The room contains no secrets
19	Roll a d6 and consult this chart twice
20	Roll a d6 and consult this chart three times

C. Random Tables: Encounters

Wandering Monsters

In a dungeon, tight corridors and enclosed spaces mean that there are far fewer places to be than in an open wilderness environment. Monsters and monster groups wandering through the dungeon should have routine patrol paths, which are sequences of rooms that a given monster might show up in, along with the percentage of their time that they spend in each room.

A given monster group's location can then be determined with a single table, to determine which room they are in – if a monster group winds up in the same room as the party, an encounter occurs, while if the group winds up in an adjacent room, an approaching encounter occurs. Most patrol paths can be broken into 5% increments, lending themselves easily to a single d20 table.

In addition to their patrol path, note each room that the monsters are likely to notice loud noises or bright lights, based on how close the patrol path passes by those rooms. These awareness zones will give you a 'chance of noticing' Alertness difficulty whenever the party gets careless with its stealth, to see which (if any) monsters notice the party's shenanigans and show up to investigate.

Having monster groups with patrol paths and zones of awareness also helps you manage more general monster behavior. For example, if a monster breaks off and flees an encounter with the party, you can make a zone of awareness roll to see whether the fleeing monster finds another group of monsters to report to, and which group. This brings us to the third aspect: monsters in a dungeon should have default attitudes not just to the party, but to each other. This will help determine which groups will tend to reinforce each other, which are likely to snack on, bully, or otherwise predate each other, and which will mostly leave each other alone.

Once each of your monster groups has its patrol paths, zones of awareness, and attitudes and alliances worked out, you can reverse-engineer their tables into dungeon room tables with the equivalent statistical outcomes if you choose – or you can simply track the position of nearby groups in real-time on your own dungeon map, rolling each exploration turn to determine whether each nearby wandering monster group moves into a new room, and if so which one.

Here is an example patrol path for a monster group made up of 2d6 goblins, in a dungeon with a ring of rooms that link A-B-C-D-E-A, and an alternate path from B to D:

Goblin Patrol starting location (d20)		
1-4	Room A (move to: E 8-13, B 14-20)	
5-8	Room B (move to: A 9-12, B 13-16, D 17-20)	
9-12	Room C (move to: B 8-13, D 14-20)	
13-16	Room D (move to: B 9-12, C 13-16, E 17-20)	
17-20	Room E (move to: D 8-13, A 14-20)	
Goblin Patrol Alertness difficulty		
Room A: Hard	Room C: Hard	Room E: Hard
Room B: Normal	Room D: Normal	

This will result in a patrol that stays in its current room about 33% of the time, and otherwise has an equal chance of moving into any adjacent room. If room C is a kind of dining hall or rest area, where the goblins are more likely to spend their time than in the other rooms, you could adjust it like so:

Goblin Patrol starting location (d20)		
1-3	Room A (move to: E 8-13, B 14-20)	
4-6	Room B (move to: A 9-12, B 13-16, D 17-20)	
7-14	Room C (move to: B 15-17, D 18-20)	
15-17	Room D (move to: B 9-12, C 13-16, E 17-20)	
18-20	Room E (move to: D 8-13, A 14-20)	
Goblin Patrol Alertness difficulty		
Room A: Hard	Room C: Automatic	Room E: Hard
Room B: Normal	Room D: Normal	

Monster Lairs

Various monsters and monster groups should have lairs, which are areas that they are familiar with and connected to. A wandering monster will spend a good deal of its time in its lair, and will usually retreat to its lair when injured.

A monster in its lair should find most of its attacks and defenses easier, and will typically have various special maneuvers or feats that it can only perform within its lair. Some of these will be at-will, but especially powerful lair feats should use a lair pool equal to the monster’s hit dice. Monsters that already have an encounter pool for their personal feats can use their lair pool for both their lair powers and their personal encounter powers while in their lair.

If you’re having trouble designing a monster lair, you can use the following d20 table for inspiration:

Monster Lair Features (D6)	
1-2	Natural Hazard - whether through fey magic or some other means, the monster controls its environment sufficiently to exploit natural elemental hazards, such as lava, floods, earthquakes, grasping vines, or the like. The monster can use its lair pool to activate or control these hazards at various opportune moments.
3	Hiding Spots - the monster has one or more tunnels, hidden passageways, or ambush locations that it can use to quickly become hidden, then reappear at another hiding spot to ambush the party.
4	Clever Traps - the monster or its minions have set up various mechanical or magical traps through its lair, which can be activated or controlled with the monster’s lair pool.
5	Rejuvenation - the monster has a feature that allows it to heal hp and regenerate its lair pool while it occupies its lair.
6	Roll twice and add both features.

Boss Fights

A “boss fight” is a centerpiece monster of a particular dungeon; these creatures usually have much higher hit dice than the dungeon’s average wandering monster, and often will have hit dice that rival or surpass even the toughest monster groups taken together.

It can be tempting to build each dungeon around a boss fight, but it can also be rewarding to have dungeons where the primary danger comes from a trap or hazard, or an unending swarm of identical creatures. If you do decide to focus your dungeon around one or more ‘boss monsters’, be sure that they fit the theme and tone of the dungeon, and consider what kind of lairs they might set up.

A boss will often define the entire ‘theme’ of a dungeon; randomly deciding on a boss is often a good starting point to build a dungeon encounter around, should you find yourself bereft of ideas.

Dungeon Boss (2D6)	
2	Eye of Yog-Sothoth with a random assortment of magically mutated minions
3	Primordial Dragon with lizardfolk and serpent-centaur minions.
4-5	Fair Folk with various fey beast, natural animal, and enthralled mortal minions
6-7	Ogre with various goblin minions.
8-9	Revenant with zombie and skeleton minions
10	Vampire with various undead and enthralled mortal minions
11	Baal-Malak with a mix of infernal and mortal cultist minions
12	Two different bosses, either fighting for control of the dungeon space, or working together towards some unknown end.

Wilderness Encounters

The following charts are examples to get a new referee started, or can serve as a stand-in for terrain that does not have a more detailed encounter list.

To use each of these tables, first roll a d6 Encounter Chance die. If this die rolls a '6', an encounter occurs; on a '5', an approaching encounter occurs.

Some environments might have a higher or lower chance of an encounter than normal; for these environments, roll two d6 and choose the higher or lower die. Roll a d20 next to see what kind of encounter or approaching encounter is indicated; the Alertness and Stealth rolls of either side's watch determine whether either party surprises the other.

D6	Open Field Encounter	High Chance
2	Undead (Stealthy)	
3-5	Wild Animals	
6-7	Wild Animals (Stealthy)	
8-9	Mortal NPCs	
10	Mortal NPCs (Stealthy)	
11	Fair Folk	
12	Hazard (Obvious)	

D6	Settlement/Road Encounter	High Chance
2	Undead (Stealthy)	
3-5	Wild Animals (Stealthy)	
6-8	Mortal NPCs	
9-10	Mortal NPCs (Stealthy)	
11	Fair Folk	
12	Hazard (Obvious)	

D6	Watchtower/Ruin Encounter	High Chance
2-3	Undead (Stealthy)	
4-5	Wild Animals (Stealthy)	
6-7	Mortal NPCs (Stealthy)	
8-9	Fair Folk (Stealthy)	
10	Hazard (Obvious)	
11-12	Hazard (Hidden)	

D6	River/Lake/Shore Encounter	Normal Chance
2-3	Wild Animals (Stealthy)	
4-5	Mortal NPCs	
6-7	Mortal NPCs (Stealthy)	
8-9	Fair Folk	
10	Fair Folk (Stealthy)	
11	Hazard (Obvious)	
12	Hazard (Hidden)	

D20	Forest Encounter	Normal Chance
2	Undead (Stealthy)	
3	Wild Animals	
4	Wild Animals (Stealthy)	
5	Mortal NPCs	
6	Mortal NPCs (Stealthy)	
7	Fair Folk	
8-9	Fair Folk (Stealthy)	
10	Hazard (Obvious)	
11-12	Hazard (Hidden)	

D20	Wetlands Encounter	Normal Chance
2-4	Undead (Stealthy)	
5-6	Wild Animals (Stealthy)	
7	Mortal NPCs (Stealthy)	
8	Mortal NPCs	
9	Fair Folk (Stealthy)	
10	Hazard (Obvious)	
11-12	Hazard (Hidden)	

D6	Mountains Encounter	Low Chance
2-3	Undead (Stealthy)	
4	Wild Animals	
5-6	Wild Animals (Stealthy)	
7	Mortal NPCs	
8	Mortal NPCs (Stealthy)	
9	Hazard (Hidden)	
10	Hazard (Obvious)	
11	Fair Folk (Stealthy)	
12	Fair Folk	

D6	Blue Water Encounter	Low Chance
2-3	Wild Animals (Stealthy)	
4	Wild Animals	
8	Hazard (Hidden)	
9	Hazard (Obvious)	
10	Fair Folk (Stealthy)	
11	Fair Folk	
12	Mortal NPCs	

D6	Underground Encounter	High Chance
2-3	Mortal NPCs (Stealthy)	
4-6	Undead (Stealthy)	
7	Wild Animals (Stealthy)	
8-9	Hazard (Hidden)	
10-11	Hazard (Obvious)	
12	Fair Folk (Stealthy)	

Monster Groups

The party will rarely meet a single monster or NPC alone. Encounter group tables are a way for the referee to organize groups of monsters into troupes, mobs, or swarms, which are likely to appear together during an adventure with a frequency that depends on the environment.

When you design an adventure, you can use the following encounter group tables as presented, or use them as inspiration to build your own.

Wild Animals

By far the most common creatures to encounter are wild animals. Different kinds of terrain will have different frequencies of animals; by default, roll 2d6 to determine what kind of animals the group encounters: 2-6 Wolf Pack, 7 Dire Wolf Pack, 8-9 Bear, 10-12 Beast Herd.

Wolf Pack

A wolf pack will contain 2d6 wolves, which will engage in pack tactics to harass the party if they are hunting and the party seems weak or poorly defended.

Dire Wolf Pack

A dire wolf pack will contain 1d6 dire wolves and 1d6 dire wolf pups (treat as wolves), which will engage in pack tactics to ambush the party unless the party's total challenge rating exceeds their own.

Bear

Roll 1d6 to determine species: 1-3 black bear, 4-6 grizzly bear. On a '1' or '6' the bear is accompanied by 1d6 cubs (treat as small bears of the same species with 2 hit dice). A lone bear will likely be wary of travellers, while a bear with cubs will be ferocious and unpredictable.

Beast Herd

A beast herd will consist of 2d6 creatures of the same species, determined by rolling a d6: 1-2 elk, 3-4 ox, 5-6 horse.

The Undead

Areas where atrocities have occurred sometimes become haunted with the yin emanations of the Shadow. Unless cleansed and hallowed by a priest, creatures that die in these unholy lands will eventually become animated by these eldritch energies, becoming undead abominations. You can roll 2d6 to determine the composition of an undead horde (2-6 Skeleton Pack, 7-9 Zombie Horde, 10-11 Feral Revenants, 12 Vampire),

Skeleton Pack

A skeleton platoon will typically contain 1d6 2 hd Medium skeletons with pikes, shields, and chainmail, + 1d6 1 hd skeletons in leather with longbows and shortswords.

Shambler Horde

A shambler horde most often contains 2d6 1 hd Medium humanoid shamblers. Roll an additional d6; on a '6', the pack contains a 3hd Large creature, such as a bear or a dire wolf.

Feral Revenants

A single 1d6+2 hd feral revenant will usually be accompanied by a skeleton pack, plus an additional 3 hd Large zombie or skeleton mount.

Vampire

Vampires are best constructed as unique NPCs, each with a backstory and a place in a larger web of intrigues.

To make a random vampire NPC, roll up its abilities as if creating a new character, but roll 4d6 and drop the lowest die for each ability, then arrange them in any order that best suits their role as an antagonist.

The Fair Folk

By far the most dangerous and terrifying encounters involve the supernatural. Of those, Fey beasts are the most likely entities that a party might encounter in the wilderness. Without direct inspiration, you can simply roll 2d6 to determine what manner of fey creature is encountered (2-6 Fey Beast, 7 Fey Beast herd, 8-11 Fairy Circle, 12 Wild Hunt).

Fey Beast

The party stumbles across a fey beast, or a mated pair or small herd of them. Roll a d20 to determine the type of fey beasts encountered:

2D6	Fey Beast
2	Keryne
3	Treant
4	Barrow-Cat
5	Hippogryph
6	Leogryph
7	Ursagryph
8	Pegasus
9	Unicorn
10	Landshark
11	Roc
12	Phoenix

Fey Beast Herd

The party may encounter a small herd or pack of creatures; roll 1d6 twice and choose the lower result to determine the number encountered, then roll a d6 to determine the type of fey beast that comprises the herd:

D6	Fey Beast Herd
1	Treant
2	Hippogryph
3	Leogryph
4	Ursagryph
5	Pegasus
6	Unicorn

Fairy Circle

The first sign that the party has crossed a Fairy Circle in the wilderness is a circular border of mushrooms surrounding the grove, but fairy magic often conceals this marker; the party must save vs. illusion to determine whether they notice that they are passing out of the Material and into Faerie.

Choose an appropriate inhabitant based on the terrain, or roll a d20 to determine the inhabitants of the fairy circle at random, re-rolling any inappropriate choice (for example, a Naiad in an environment without water):

2D6	Fairy Circle Inhabitants
2	Leannán-Sí
3	Leannán-Sí and 1d6 unicorn guardians
4	Dryad and 1d6 treant guardians
5	Auriad
6	Hestaiad
7	Dryad
8	Naiad
9	Oreiad
10	Treant
11	Unicorn
12	Wild Hunt

Wild Hunt

The party might stumble onto the Wild Hunt, an eldritch Fair Folk ritual incursion into the Material. The Wild Hunt will consist of a Keryne being hunted by a hunting party of 1d6+1 Dire Wolves led by a Horned Hunter riding a Nightmare. The party might stumble onto any one of these creatures alone or together, at which point the entire Wild Hunt will reconfigure itself with the party as the prey, and the Keryne attempting to lure or trick them into the Hunter and Dire Wolves' clutches.

The Horned Hunter's legendary knife and greatbow will resize to fit any medium or small creature that survives being its prey by defeating it in single combat. Each weapon may be wielded by such a creature without penalty, but will still deal doubled damage as if they were wielded by a large creature.

D. Random Tables: NPC Creation

Sometimes you find yourself needing to quickly generate a party of adventurers for a pick-up game, or rapidly creating an NPC during an adventure.

The following method reduces the entire character creation process to a single d20 roll. Set any Prime abilities to +1, and all other abilities to +0.

D20	Class	Origin	Prime(s)
1-3	Warrior	Human	Str
4-6	Scout	Human	Dex
7-8	Wizard	Human	Int
9-10	Priest	Human	Wis
11	Champion	Human	Str
12	Hunter	Human	Dex
13	Druid	Human	Wis
14	Stalwart	Dwarf	Con and Str
15	Delver	Dwarf	Con and Wis
16	Dweomersmith	Dwarf	Con and Int
17	Hunter	Elf	Dex and Wis
18	Druid	Elf	Dex and Wis
19	Hunter	Gnome	Dex and Cha
20	Champion	Beastfolk	Dex and Str

If you have four players and want to begin even faster, simply create a warrior, a scout, a wizard, and a priest, assigning their prime requisite to +1 and each of their other abilities to +0. This particular combination is probably the most classically stereotypical starting party, with a well-rounded set of feats and proficiencies for whatever challenges you want to throw at them.

Gear

A PC or NPC should generally have the necessary gear to do their job, unless lacking it is part of the unfolding story. If you want to equip an NPC with magic items, you can roll on the Random Magic Item table and see if anything looks appropriate. A noteworthy 2-3 hd NPC will likely have at least one common magic item, while a 4-6 hd NPC might have an uncommon item, and a 7-9 hd NPC might have two uncommon items or even a rare item.

Background and History

Populating your world with entertaining and believable non-player characters can be challenging for some referees. You can always start with inspiration from various media (Appendix N is a useful resource here), then make sufficient changes to suit the story and setting.

Many important NPCs even begin life as minions who manage to distinguish themselves somehow in an encounter. Don't be afraid to use an amusing mishap or circumstance to promote a random goblin thief from an extra in a warband into a recurring nemesis for the party.

Personality and Attitude

If you're feeling uninspired or just want to create a personality randomly, you can use lists like the following whenever a new NPC shows up. You can roll a D6 to determine which trait column to use, then roll a second D6 to determine the trait from that column to apply. If you want more traits, you can roll again to pick a new column, stopping once you roll a column that has already been rolled.

D6	Trait 1	Trait 2
1	Forgiving	Naive
2	Kind	Optimistic
3	Honorable	Hopeful
4	Cowardly	Doubtful
5	Cruel	Pessimistic
6	Vindictive	Cynical
D6	Trait 3	Trait 4
1	Selfless	Humble
2	Generous	Encouraging
3	Fair	Respectful
4	Shrewd	Condescending
5	Selfish	Boastful
6	Greedy	Arrogant
D6	Trait 5	Trait 6
1	Cowardly	Bitter
2	Wary	Stern
3	Prudent	Reserved
4	Honorable	Excitable
5	Courageous	Gentle
6	Foolhardy	Sweet

Random Tables: Treasure and Loot

If you want to pick a magic item at random, start by rolling 2d6 to determine the general kind of item, and 2d6 to determine its rarity.

Random Magic Items

2D6	Item Type	2D6	Item Rarity
2	Siege Weapon	2	Cursed (reroll)
3	Elemental Weapon	3	Common
4	Melee Weapon	4	Common
5	Ranged Weapon	5	Common
6	Focus or Wandrous Item	6	Common
7	Armor	7	Common
8	Boots	8	Uncommon
9	Belt	9	Uncommon
10	Amulet	10	Rare
11	Crown	11	Rare
12	Ring	12	Legendary

Magic Item Curses

Cursed magic items can have all manner of strange effects, depending on the type of item. By far the most common is a straight reversal of the item's normal intended effect – bonuses become penalties, and healing becomes damage. Rarer effects can be generated by rolling 2d6 and consulting the following table:

Curse Type (2d6)

2-7	Effect reversal
8	Slow mental corruption
9	Hostile Illusion (friends appear as enemies)
10	Ability loss (one point per day at random)
11	Rapid Aging (one year per week)
12	Weapon: attacks always strike self or allies
Healing item: reverse aging (1 year per week)	
Other item: random hostile activation	

Feel free to use this table as a starting point for your own curse effects.

After rolling for type, rarity, and any curse effects, you can roll on one of the following tables based on the kind of item to determine the actual item found, rerolling if the item shown is not available at the rolled rarity:

Elemental Weapon (2D6)

2	Earthbreaker (Maul)
3	Frostbrand (Greatsword)
4	Venom Scythe (Glaive)
5	Earthbreaker Maul (Mace)
6	Frostbrand (Longsword)
7	Healer's Staff (Quarterstaff)
8	Flametongue (Longsword)
9	Thunderhammer (Mace)
10	Sparkwhip (Chain Whip)
11	Flametongue (Greatsword)
12	Thunderhammer (Maul)

Melee Weapon (3D6)

3	Keen Blade (Glaive)
4	Keen Blade (Halberd)
5	Keen Blade (Battleaxe)
6	Keen Blade (Greatsword)
7	Keen Blade (Ax)
8	Keen Blade (Shortsword)
9	Keen Blade (Dagger)
10	Keen Blade (Longsword)
11	Relic Weapon (Shortsword)
12	Relic Weapon (Longsword)
13	Relic Weapon (Greatsword)
14	Relic Weapon (Mace)
15	Aetheric Blade (Dagger)
16	Aetheric Blade (Shortsword)
17	Aetheric Blade (Longsword)
18	Luckcatcher (Dagger)

Ranged Weapon (2D6)

2	Flying Blade (Hand Axe)
3	Flying Blade (Chakram)
4	Flying Blade (Dagger)
5	Windbow (Greatbow)
6	Windbow (Longbow)
7	Windbow (Shortbow)
8	Firearm (Pistol)
9	Firearm (Revolver)
10	Firearm (Musket)
11	Firearm (Blunderbus)
12	Firearm (Hand Mortar)

Siege Weapon (D6)

- | | |
|-----|--|
| 1 | Cannon (1d6: 1-3 Light, 4-5 Medium, 6 Heavy) |
| 2 | Sunlance |
| 3-5 | Thunderlance |
| 6 | Thunder Rattler |

Armor (2D6)

- | | |
|----|----------------------|
| 2 | Flying Shield |
| 3 | Bracers of Shielding |
| 4 | Dwarven Apron |
| 5 | Thornweave Hide |
| 6 | Mage Robes |
| 7 | Feysilver Chainmail |
| 8 | Orichalc Plate |
| 9 | Robes of Splendor |
| 10 | Living Armor |
| 11 | Flying Shield |
| 12 | Mirror Shield |

Amulet (2D6)

- | | |
|----|---|
| 2 | Amulets of Friendship (1d6+1 matched set) |
| 3 | Amulets of Friendship (matched pair) |
| 4 | Amulet of Dedication |
| 5 | Foreigner's Amulet |
| 6 | Amulet of Protection |
| 7 | Amulet of Water Breathing |
| 8 | |
| 9 | Cloak of Shadows |
| 11 | Cloak of Invisibility |
| 12 | Gull-Wing Cloak |

Belt (D6)

- | | |
|-----|----------------------------|
| 1 | Bag of Holding |
| 2 | Belt of Feral Might |
| 3-4 | Quiver of Elemental Arrows |
| 5-6 | Quiver of Elemental Bolts |

Boots (D6)

- | | |
|-----|----------------------------|
| 1 | Boots of Stability |
| 2 | Boots of Swifttness |
| 3-4 | Boots of Traceless Passage |
| 5 | Grip Boots |
| 6 | Seven-League Boots |

Crown (2D6)

- | | |
|----|----------------------------|
| 2 | Goggles of Arcane Sight |
| 3 | Spectacles of True Seeing |
| 5 | Goggles of Distant Vision |
| 6 | Darkvision Goggles |
| 7 | Radiant Diadem |
| 8 | Diadem of Splendor |
| 9 | Puppeteer's Crown - Silver |
| 10 | Puppeteer's Crown - Gold |
| 11 | Crown of Command |
| 12 | Stone of Aion |

Ring (2D6)

- | | |
|-----|--|
| 2 | Aetheric Glove(s) |
| 3 | Grip Gloves |
| 4 | Rings of Companionship (matched pair) |
| 5 | Ring of Warding |
| 6 | Ring of Protection |
| 7-8 | Ring of Disguise |
| 9 | Ring of Elemental Power (D6 for element) |
| 10 | Ring of Elemental Power (Aether) |
| 11 | Ring of Guidance |
| 12 | Ring of Regeneration |

Focus (2D6)

- | | |
|-----|-------------------------------|
| 2 | Aether Pearl |
| 3 | Dream Pearl |
| 4-6 | Wondrous Item |
| 7 | Dragon Pearl (D6 for element) |
| 8 | Healer's Staff |
| 9 | Magic Staff |
| 10 | Magic Wand |
| 11 | Lantern of Revealing |
| 12 | Holy Relic |

Wondrous Item (2D6)

- | | |
|----|---------------------------|
| 2 | Magnificent Mansion |
| 3 | Flying Carpet |
| 4 | Mirror of Distant Visions |
| 5 | Mapmaker's Kit |
| 6 | Ornithoptoculus |
| 7 | Enchanted Crockery |
| 8 | Replenishing Decanter |
| 9 | Golem Armor Component |
| 10 | Civic Works Component |
| 11 | Revealing Mirror |
| 12 | Portable Hole |

Arcane Spells and Scrolls

Arcane spell scrolls and spellbook pages can also be found within the dungeon. To randomly determine the contents of a spell scroll or spellbook page, first roll 2d6 and pick the lower to determine the spell's circle:

D6	Spell or Scroll Rank
1	First Circle Spell
2	Second Circle Spell
3	Third Circle Spell
4	Fourth Circle Spell
5	Fifth Circle Spell
6	Spellbook

If a spellbook is rolled, roll 2d6 and pick the lower to determine which spellbook is found:

D6	Spellbook
1	Ars Aether ① Arcane Bolts ④ Dimension Door ① Shield ⑤ Disintegrate ③ Sheltering Dome ⑤ Resilient Sphere
2	Ars Momentum ① Feather Fall ② Levitate ① Floating Hand ③ Fly ② Arcane Lock ③ Hold Person ② Knock ⑤ Giant Fist
3	Ars Materia ① Elemental Cone ③ Lightning Bolt ② Elemental Ray ④ Elemental Wall ③ Cloud of Daggers ④ Weave Element ③ Cone of Cold ⑤ Flesh to Stone ③ Fireball ⑤ Summon Elemental
4	Ars Lux ① Arcane Mark ② Locate Object ① Continual Light ③ Circle of Protection ① Darkness ③ Clairvoyance ① Subtle Weave ③ Darkvision ② Arcane Sight ③ Dispel Magic ② Invisibility ④ Arcane Eye
5	Ars Mentis ① Beguile ② Sending ① Silent Image ② Thoughtshield ① Sleep ③ Suggestion ② Comprehend ④ Confusion ② Phantasm ④ Dominate ② Read Thoughts ⑤ Telepathic Bond
6	Custom Spellbook

A custom spellbook contains 1d6 random spells, +2 each time 'spellbook' is rolled again.

Otherwise, roll on that spell circle's chart to determine which specific spell the scroll or page contains:

Spells by Circle

D20	First Circle Spells	
D6	Group A (Odd)	D6 Group B (Even)
1	Arcane Bolts	1 Feather Fall
2	Arcane Mark	2 Floating Hand
3	Beguile	3 Shield
4	Continual Light	4 Silent Image
5	Darkness	5 Sleep
6	Elemental Cone	6 Subtle Weave

D20	Second Circle Spell	
D6	Group A (Odd)	D6 Group B (Even)
1	Arcane Sight	1 Levitate
2	Arcane Lock	2 Locate Object
3	Comprehend	3 Phantasm
4	Elemental Ray	4 Read Thoughts
5	Invisibility	5 Sending
6	Knock	6 Thoughtshield

D20	Third Circle Spells	
D6	Group A (Odd)	D6 Group B (Even)
1	Cloud of Daggers	1 Circle of Protection
2	Cone of Cold	2 Clairvoyance
3	Fireball	3 Darkvision
4	Fly	4 Dispel Magic
5	Hold Person	5 Sheltering Dome
6	Lightning Bolt	6 Suggestion

D6	Fourth Circle Spell
1	Arcane Eye
2	Confusion
3	Dimension Door
4	Dominate
5	Elemental Wall
6	Weave Element

D6	Fifth Circle Spell
1	Disintegrate
2	Flesh to Stone
3	Giant Fist
4	Resilient Sphere
5	Summon Elemental
6	Telepathic Bond

Prices

Prices should vary according to the local economy and the availability of specific goods. A good rule of thumb is to look at the modern cost of an equivalent good or service in US dollars or Euros, and then multiply by 100 to roughly gauge its cost in drakhs.

The following costs are listed in silver pieces; remember that 1 silver piece is 10 copper, and 1 gold piece is 10 silver. These costs are roughly standard, but might adjust up or down by a factor of 2 depending on the local economic conditions. Custom-made gear will be, on average, two to five times more expensive than something bought “off the shelf”, but will be higher quality. If in doubt, use a multiplier of $(2d6+3) \times 10\%$ for an off-the-shelf item, or $(3d6 \times 25\%)$ for a piece of custom work. If the player wants to haggle, you can apply a price adjustment in the winner’s favor after a Wit or Charm contest of somewhere between 10% and 25%, depending on how the haggling plays out.

Weapons

Club	1
Quarterstaff	5
Dagger	10
Other light weapon	15
Other medium weapon	25
Other heavy weapon	50

Armor

Light	15
Medium	50
Heavy	500
Light Barding	200
Medium Barding	500
Heavy Barding	2000

Other Gear

Dungeoneer’s Kit	5
Notebook (100 blank pages)	5
Basic Clothes	5
Expensive Clothes	50

Services

Basic meal at an inn or stall	1
Horses fed and stalled at an inn	2
Fancy meal at an inn	5
Night’s stay at an inn	20

Livestock and Mounts

Pack Mule	100
Horse (nag)	50
Horse (workhorse)	250
Horse (warhorse)	1000
1 day’s food & maintenance	0.5
Ox	500
1 day’s food & maintenance	0.2

Alchemical Potions

Bottle of magic ink	1
Common elixir of health	25
Other common potion	50
Uncommon elixir of health	100
Other uncommon potion	250
Rare potion	1000
Legendary potion	5000

Magic Items

Common weapon or shield	2500
Uncommon weapon or shield	10,000
Rare weapon or shield	50,000
Legendary weapon or shield	250,000
Common armor	10,000
Uncommon armor	50,000
Rare armor	250,000
Legendary armor	1,000,000
Common amulet, belt, or boots	1000
Uncommon amulet, belt, or boots	5000
Rare amulet, belt, or boots	25,000
Legendary amulet, belt, or boots	100,000
Common other item	5000
Uncommon other item	25,000
Rare other item	100,000
Legendary other item	500,000
Common blueprint or formula	1000
Uncommon blueprint or formula	5000
Rare blueprint or formula	25,000
Legendary blueprint or formula	100,000
First-circle scroll or talisman	500
Second-circle scroll or talisman	1,000
Third-circle scroll or talisman	2,500
Fourth-circle scroll or talisman	5,000
Fifth-circle scroll or talisman	10,000
Arcane Spellbook (Ars Aether)	10,000
Arcane Spellbook (Ars Momentum)	15,000
Arcane Spellbook (Ars Materia)	20,000
Arcane Spellbook (Ars Lux)	25,000
Arcane Spellbook (Ars Mentis)	30,000

F. Domain Management

The medieval world is dominated by feudal societies. In feudalism, the land of a kingdom is held by a king or queen, who grants noble titles to those who pledge to defend it. A noble title corresponds to a portion of land, called a fief, which that noble is expected to defend - so a county is given to a count, a barony to a baron, a duchy to a duke, a bordermarch to a marquis, and so on.

By 5th level, an adventurer will have made enough of a name for themselves that they might plausibly be granted a title of nobility, a royally recognized coat-of-arms for their heraldry, and a small fiefdom to rule. Alternatively, barbarians or outlaws might have amassed enough power that they can simply take control of an area by force, acting as its *de facto* rulers if not recognized *de jure* by the king.

Noble Rank

The lowest title of nobility is the knight. Anyone who shows particular merit on the battlefield can be knighted by a king, regardless of their station of birth; upon knighthood, they enter into the nobility and all its attendant expectations. Knighthood is not directly hereditary, but most knights train their sons to follow in their footsteps, so it is customary for the crown to grant a son their father's title when the time comes.

Above the knight in rank is the baron or marquis. These titles are typically hereditary, passing down from father to son, although a particularly loyal and skilled knight might be granted a barony or bordermarch if one becomes available. The distinction between baron and marquis is chiefly one of geography and expected duty; a bordermarch is simply a martial barony on the border of two potential hostile kingdoms, and so a marquis can expect to see more trouble than a comparatively peaceful baron. Above the barons and marquises are the counts, and above the counts are the dukes, and above the dukes are the king or queen - the true sovereign of the entire kingdom.

Oath of Fealty

A newly-minted noble will enter into service by immediately swearing an oath of fealty to their sovereign, typically sanctified directly by an attending priest. Various pagan kingdoms might swear a *geas* before a druid instead, binding the health of the lord directly to the health of the land - and vice versa.

Noble Privileges

A feudal vassal is only answerable to their lord and the Church; their lord, in turn, is only answerable to their lord, with the Successor Kings only truly answerable to the High Father himself. Knights are expected to uphold their barons' laws and keep the peace within their fiefdoms; their baron in turn is expected to answer to their duke and ultimately to their prince or king. The church takes matters of abuse of power quite seriously, but still grants secular rulers a good deal of latitude in ruling over their subjects.

Knights are also granted a small fief of land from their baron or marquis, from which they are expected to collect the half-tithe that all peasants and vassals pay to their immediate superiors. A questing knight that comes upon treasure can keep half of what they find or take by conquest, paying the remainder to their duke as part of their half-tithe.

While most of the taxes collected from the half-tithe go towards defense and welfare of the realm, dukes and counts and princes still tend to find a way to enrich themselves substantially. Signs of luxury are signs of prosperity, after all, and it is unwise for a ruler to appear weak to his neighbors. Knights, similarly, are seen as a reflection of their rulers, so particularly wealthy barons will expect their knights to dress and comport themselves appropriately so as to avoid besmirching their lord with a beggarly reputation in the sight of his peers.

Noble Responsibilities

The ruler of a domain and their knight retainers have many obligations to their subjects, beyond the basic military defense of the domain. The Church maintains its own formal hierarchy, separate from the nobility, in order to keep watch over kings and their lieutenants and confirm that they are fulfilling their sacred oaths.

Marriage and Succession

One of the greatest obligations that a ruler has to their subjects, according to the Church, is to reassure those subjects of the stability of their rule. A happy and prosperous kingdom, ruled over by a wise and benevolent ruler, can be brought down in short time by a despotic usurper or descendant. Further, as the chief duty of a noble lord is to take up arms and protect their subjects on the field of battle, a cowardly or weak ruler is obviously unworthy of their fiefdom.

To that end, it is the duty of every noble of marquis rank or higher to marry a wife of suitable skill and cunning, and designate a legitimate heir, and dutifully train that heir in the defense and administration of the domain.

Each Successor Kingdom interprets this duty slightly differently. In some areas of Iberas and Gauhl, gender and breeding are seen somewhat inflexibly; a Lord must be a strong male of noble birth, and his Lady must be a trained courtesan from an allied noble house. Further north and west, these strictures are interpreted much more loosely – in most Northman kingdoms, the “Lord” of the fief is whichever of the married pair takes up the chief duty of defense, and the “Lady” is whichever has taken up the chief duty of clerical administration; same-sex pairings are reasonably common, and many heirs are produced through a concubine or acquired through adoption.

Regardless of the biological details, it is the duty of the Lord to defend the fiefdom in wartime, and it is the duty of the Lady to attend to and nurture its spiritual health in peacetime. To that end, a proper Lord will be some form of warrior class, and a proper Lady will be some form of magic-user, with various expert-class viziers and attendants to advise them both in matters of state.

Courts and Justice

As the ruler of a domain, a feudal noble is expected to preside over matters of law, and adjudicate disputes between subjects. Typically, priests are appointed judicial duties for most minor matters, leaving the noble to focus on pressing matters of state. Crimes committed by or against entitled servants of the noble are themselves matters of state, and so are typically presided over personally by the noble and judged by a council of peers.

The Church holds certain principles of justice to be sacred, and so withholds communion from any feudal lord who denies these rights to their subjects.

Right to Life - all mortal subjects, regardless of station, have the right to live, and shall not be deprived of life, limb, or health by another except in immediate defense when in genuine mortal danger.

Right to Freedom - no mortal subject, regardless of station, shall be enslaved, imprisoned, or otherwise prevented from free travel or association for a span of more than seven years without their consent.

Right to Justice - A mortal subject aggrieved by another shall be entitled to restitution, and a mortal subject who transgresses against the law or his fellow shall be punished proportionate to the severity of the offense.

Right to Mercy - A mortal subject shall have the right to repent of their transgressions against the law and their fellow, to be judged by the sincerity of their repentance and amends, and restored to communion.

Right to Property - A mortal subject shall have the right to the fruits of his own labor, subject only to those reasonable taxes due to the sovereign who protects these rights on his behalf, and that sovereign’s properly appointed servants. No taxation shall exceed the half-tithe, except in dire need; and all taxes in excess of the half-tithe shall be recompensed to those from whom they were taxed.

Right to Trust - Any mortal subject who gives their sworn word to another, witnessed before the law and the Church, shall be held to proper account for their promise by the Church and the Law.

Domain Size

A knight will typically hold a fiefdom that is approximately 10 square miles in area - about the size of one league hex - although larger holdings might also contain up to the six surrounding hexes. A baron or marquis might control thirty such hexes in their own private demesne (the area of their domain that does not include the fiefs administered by the knights under their command), while a count might command a hundred or more.

Building a Domain

A knight is expected to build a keep, or castle, in a position so that their entire fief can be seen from atop the castle's towers; a baron is expected to be able to at least see the tops of the towers of their nearest vassal knights from the highest tower of their own keep.

Most keeps are built in a motte and bailey structure - the motte is the castle proper, where the knight and their retinue live and train. Surrounding the motte is a bailey of farmlands, houses, and shops, all living under the protection of the keep. In times of trouble, the subjects of the bailey can retreat to the motte, pull the motte's draw-bridge, and try to wait out a raid or siege in relative safety.

When a new fief is awarded to a newly-titled knight, the domain will often be completely uncultivated and unprotected. It will be the knight's first duty to survey the land, break ground, build their keep, and attract subjects that will plough the fields, work the forges, tend to the shops, and so on. A knight and their keep are the basic unit of civilization, so the founding of a new keep is sure to attract those hoping for safety and stability.

Of equal importance to the keep itself is the chapel. While the knight tends to the physical safety of their subject, the priest tends to their spiritual safety. Spiritual dangers are well-known and well-feared, not least of which are the undead, the infernal, and the fair folk. A priest and his clergy will spend most of their time tending to the moral and psychological health of the knight's subjects, but when unholy forces threaten their flock, their lord will call upon them to aid in the fight directly.

Gathering Supplies

Constructing a proper keep requires wood, stone, iron, and labor — but chief among these is labor. Labor must be paid, or otherwise provided for; Church-enforced law and custom dictate that a laborer receive no less than one silver denarius per day of labor. This sets a cost per month of 3 gold per unskilled laborer.

Skilled laborers expect to be paid approximately twice this amount, or 6 gold per month, while true craftsmen, engineers, and overseers typically expect to be paid around 10 gold per month per experience level. A famous architect or artisan might regularly command twice this amount. Haggling for a bargain with each laborer is more trouble than it's worth, so most projects simply pay the going rate for anyone below the master architect.

Breaking Ground

The first step in building a keep is to clear the ground. Workers come and set up camp, and begin clearing stone, chopping down trees, pulling up their roots, and smoothing and compacting the soil. Stone, wood, and earth from the clearing are stockpiled for later construction, but the key at this stage is to create a solid, smooth, open foundation to build upon.

While the area is being cleared, the attending high priest will begin to ritually consecrate the ground. This involves performing the hallow ritual at each sunrise and sunset for a full lunar month, until the blessing 'weaves into' the earth itself and becomes permanent.

Once the ground is suitably blessed, and the foundations properly laid, craftsmen can begin constructing the keep itself. Most keeps are designed by a Science-trained architect, who uses their understanding of engineering to determine the ideal shape and materials for the walls, floors and ceilings.

The outer defenses of the motte come first, then the castle and chapel proper, and finally the supporting buildings. Peasant and freeman subjects will typically begin arriving at this time, both to help with construction and to help establish the bailey village that will support and maintain the new keep.

Designing The Keep

The keep, chapel, and motte walls are each split into various individual rooms and buildings, each of which can measure up to 100' on a side. The material costs listed are per 5' section of wall; locally gathered material instead costs labor wages equal to half its gp value. For each room, the referee should determine the quality of the materials gathered.

For each room, the architect rolls a Science check; this is made easier with high-quality materials and labor, or harder with low-quality supplies. On a success, each 5' section of wall has full structure points. On a failure, multiply each wall section's structure in that room by (1d6-1), then divide by 5.

Materials	per 5' Wall	Other Features
Wood	1 SP / 0.2gp	vulnerable to fire
Earth	2 SP / 0.3gp	
Stone	4 SP / 1.0gp	
Cement	5 SP / 1.5gp	
Iron	10 SP / 5gp	resists fire damage
Feysilver	10 SP / 100gp	resists all damage
Orichalc	25 SP / 150gp	resists all damage

At minimum, a proper keep requires a great hall to receive guests, a chapel to house religious services, quarters for the lord and guests to retire to, stables to tend to their horses, an armory to store weapons, and workshops to maintain them.

The Great Hall serves as the centerpiece of a keep, and can comfortably entertain one person of importance per 500 square feet of space. A well-designed great hall speaks to the majesty and wealth of its occupants – if the architect achieves an exceptional success during design and construction, and the facilities maintain the highest quality decorations and supplies, the hall is considered to be exceptional - making all Charm, Wit and Leadership checks that the lord or his lieutenants make easier while hosting within the halls.

The Chapel is where the clergy attends to their congregation. A chapel can comfortably host one person for every 50 square feet of space, and typically devotes extra space to private studies, a reliquary, and the living space of the clergy. Hundreds of treatises on the proper design of chapels have been written, emphasizing the effect of architecture on the mindset of those who worship within. If the architect achieves an exceptional success during the design and construction of the chapel, and the clergy maintain its blessings and stock it with the highest quality decorations and supplies, the chapel is considered to be exceptional - making all Divine miracles, rituals, and saving throws performed within it easier.

A chapel will often contain an infirmary, where the sick or injured can rest and heal while attended to by priests and healers. An infirmary can comfortably house one patient for every 500 feet of space, while giving their doctors room to move and work around them.

Quarters - A knight and his family typically take up 500 square feet of space per person. Additional spaces are also often devoted to guest rooms, trophy halls, dining rooms, and various other leisures and luxuries.

The lord's retinue and men-at-arms will typically live within separate barracks structures, so that they can work and train together. Workers' and soldiers' quarters typically house one medium mortal for every 200 square feet of space, with a communal sleeping room, a separate communal washroom, a large kitchen, and a dining area and meeting hall. More luxurious quarters will offer up to 1000 square feet of space for nobility and their guests, with their own private washrooms and dining areas.

Stable - Domesticated animals require stables to house and train them. A stable can hold one Large animal or two Medium animals for every 200 square feet of space, so long as there is an equal amount of fenced open-air area attached to the stables for exercise, sunlight, and grazing. Stables will frequently have a second story to store feed and supplies, as well as a few small barracks-like quarters for the stable attendants to sleep.

Armory - An armory stores armor, weapons, ammunition, and other gear necessary for martial defense. Typically, every 25 square feet of space is sufficient to store enough gear to outfit one medium sized man-at-arms, and keep that gear organized and ready so that a soldier can outfit themselves with it within a single exploration turn. Weapons are typically stored on racks, so that they can be chosen and wielded with a single combat action.

Denser storage is possible for gear that is not intended to be immediately accessible; every 25 square feet of space can hold enough non-magical gear for 10 medium sized creatures.

Library - A properly stocked research library can contain 200 books for every 25 square feet of space. Space may also be dedicated to various other objects, including writing desks, alchemical laboratories, museum displays, an astronomical observatory, or the like. An exceptional workshop may dedicate its supplemental features to a specific Lore or Science task when designing the workshop.

Larder - Larders store food and other perishable supplies; every 25 square feet of larder can hold enough food for 5 Medium creatures to eat comfortably for a month.

Workshops - Alchemist's laboratories, blacksmith's forges, and other crafting workshops can be built to accommodate the needs of any artisans on staff. The size of a workshop depends on the type of craft practiced within it; a jeweler's workbench only needs 100 square feet, while a woodshop or an iron smithy needs at least 500.

An architect sufficiently versed in Science might design an exceptional workshop with an integrated power source, such as a windmill or a water-wheel.

Other Facilities - Additional halls and chambers may be constructed for specific purposes - a gaming hall for gambling and indoor tournaments, or a council room for discussing matters of state.

Exceptional Facilities - An architect may choose to design a workshop, library, infirmary, or stable so that it supports a specific task. For workshops, this is a specific Finesse task; for libraries, this is a specific Lore, Science, or Medicine task; for a stable, this is usually a specific kind of animal. All Great Halls, Chapels, and Infirmarys are automatically considered specialized facilities, since each is dedicated to a specific task by design.

If the architect succeeds at each of a hard Science and Lore check during the design and construction of a specialized facility, and the facility maintains the highest quality of supplies, it is considered to be exceptional - making all task checks easier within the purview of the task it was designed for.

Designing The Bailey

After the work crew has finished with the construction of the castle, their services will typically be offered to the villagers of the surrounding bailey, to build their homes and shops and stables. Each such structure is blessed and consecrated by the village priest. Libraries, quarters, stables, and workshops are built as needed, until the entire town settles into its final shape.

Fields are also laid out at this time, with the keep's lord giving each farmer a parcel to farm, and informing them of the taxes they will be expected to pay come harvest-time. Druids or priests devoted to the Nature domain will usually bless these fields to increase their yields, and then the farmers will get to work ploughing and sowing. Smaller indoor greenhouses can also be built, to house more delicate plants and fungi that need a controlled environment to thrive.

Each half-mile subhex of sufficiently fertile land can be divided into up to 100 acres, each of which is a single field capable of producing enough crops to feed one or two persons for a year. Most farmland must be ploughed and sowed in spring, and harvested in late summer to early fall; farmers typically rely on the ritual calendars maintained by their priests and druids to sow and reap with the seasons. Adequate larder and silo space must be devoted to crops, to ensure that the harvest is available year-round to feed the domain.

Populating the Domain

Most domains are established by a particular set of peoples, who desire to live within a specific place and who have chosen their ruler to protect them. These people form the backbone of the new domain's community, which will hopefully then expand through birth and recruitment.

A knight commissioned to establish a new domain will typically be given vassals to travel with them and help build their keep; those vassals will then stay and become the core of the new population. Further expansion can then be accomplished through recruitment, which means sending heralds out to find suitably skilled commoners and entice them to move into the domain.

Laborers

The majority of a domain's population will be peasant farmers, who provide the back-breaking labor needed to turn arable land into food. Without them, everyone else in the domain would starve.

Craftsmen

Craftsmen form the next economic tier above the laborer. Blacksmiths, woodworkers, healers, tailors, and leatherworkers are all needed to keep a domain working, and can all earn a fair living working their trade within the domain.

Merchants

The food produced by farmers and the wares produced by craftsmen are bought and sold by merchants, who travel from domain to domain to buy things where they are in abundance and sell them where they are needed.

Soldiers-at-Arms

Knights and mercenaries make up the defense and police force of a domain; they represent the will of the nobility among the common people, and so are usually held in grudgingly higher esteem.

Clergy and Nobility

At the very top of the hierarchy are the clergy and nobility, who set the pace of the domain's activities from month to month.

Unusual Domains

Dwarven and fey domains are typically built to somewhat different standards than human domains. Dwarves prefer to build most of their structures underground, leaving the terrain above for farming and hunting. Fey domains build their structures into the living forest, enchanting trees to grow into the desired shapes of dwellings and civic infrastructure.

Dwarven knowledge did not suffer the setbacks of the Successor Wars to nearly the extent of the Successor Kingdoms, and so most Dwarven settlements can manage to maintain mines and fortresses underground without unduly affecting the fertility of the land above. Any land that is undermined by a dwarven settlement reduces its fertility rating by one step during initial construction, but its fertility is not further reduced by active mining or excavation. A dwarven chapel is also their community's primary workshop, and is typically placed near to the mines, smelters and refineries — a layout that speaks volumes about the values, beliefs, and practices of dwarven culture.

Fey settlements are typically built around a central sacred grove, with the land around it enhanced through magic until it suits the inhabitants' desires. This process raises the fertility of the land by one step while the fey tribe dwells within it and actively maintains their fertility rituals. The sacred grove serves as the settlement's chapel, while the great hall is typically constructed nearby.

Fey settlements will often contain various small gates into and out of Faerie, maintained by druids through repeated use of the misty step ritual. These gateways may not even be noticeable to human or dwarf visitors, leading to a disorienting experience of stepping in and out of Faerie as one wanders from landmark to landmark.

Domain Administration

A feudal lord has the right to command the subjects living within the protective aegis of their keep, either recruiting them directly into their retinue or issuing proclamations and orders. A lord who is too demanding or inept can expect the attitude of their subjects to worsen as they suffer under their rule; if the general of their attitude becomes unfriendly or hostile, the lord can expect to be replaced by their sovereign, censured by their own clergy, or might even suffer a tragic accident in short order.

Domains are managed on a month-to-month basis. Once per 30 days, you may issue orders to each of the keep's facilities, and to the overseers of each vassal living in the bailey. They will then carry out those orders to the best of their abilities, but if orders are consistently nonsensical or burdensome when times are already lean, your vassals' attitudes are likely to degrade.

Each facility can be issued its own orders:

Recruitment

Recruitment orders direct your staff to send heralds to nearby settlements, looking for people with the desired traits that are willing to come and take up residence in the keep or its bailey. Recruitment can be specified in terms of specific talents and abilities. Your heralds roll their Charm and Wit once each to determine whether someone with the correct attributes and willingness is found; the difficulty of each check is based on the rarity of the traits desired, the attitude of your heralds, and your reputation in the areas canvassed.

You can also recruit en masse if you only specify a single, common trait, such as "a good, strong back" or "a sharp mind" or "experience handling a weapon" - if you do, then the lower of each herald's Charm or Wit roll result determines the number of hirelings recruited by that herald during the month.

Crafting

Crafting orders command the artisans in your direct employ to begin producing goods for your use. You may also hire any of the bailey's craftsmen to assist, negotiating a fair wage for each and supplying them with the necessary facilities and materials. As with domain construction, skilled craftsmen typically expect an amount of gold per month equal to ten times their experience level, plus the cost of any necessary tools and raw materials.

Magic Items - A single enchanter with two assistants can attempt to produce a single Common magic item within the month, if given blueprints and all the necessary supplies. A 5 hd or better enchanter with two 3 hd or better assistants can produce 1d6 identical Common items, or attempt to make a single Uncommon item, which will take $1d6+2$ months to complete (round up). A 9 hd enchanter with five 3 hd or better assistants can begin work on a single Rare magic item, which will take 2d6 months to complete.

Alchemy - Each alchemist in your employ can be directed to brew stable alchemical potions during the month. At the end of the month, each alchemist rolls Medicine or Science to determine the total number of usable potions that they produced, each producing 1d6-1 on failure or 2d6 + their Intelligence on success.

Arms and Armor - Any craftsmen trained in blacksmithing may produce weapons and armor for the keep. A blacksmith can produce 5d6 serviceable weapons or shields per month, and a 5 hd or better blacksmith can produce 1d6 masterwork (+1) weapons. Making armor is somewhat slower; a blacksmith can produce 3d6 serviceable light armors or medium shields, 2d6 serviceable medium armors or shields, or 1d6 serviceable heavy armors. Commissioning masterwork armors from a master blacksmith means $1d6+2$ shields or medium armors per month, or a single heavy armor.

Farming and Ranching

Most domains can sustain some amount of farming; sufficiently fertile land can even support itself while providing surplus to store or sell. Different crops and livestock have different land and labor needs, which any experienced peasant will know by heart.

Each half-mile sub-hex of land within a six-mile hex will have its own fertility value, which is a d6 dice formula (such as 3d6) that determines how much food it can yield without being depleted. One “unit” of fertility is equal to one month’s worth of food for one person, produced from one acre of land area.

Land Quality	Fertility Value	Difficulty
Blighted	0	Impossible
Barren	1d6-1	Hard
Marginal	2d6	Normal
Fertile	2d6+3	Normal
Abundant	2d6+8	Easy

Each half-mile sub-hex of farmland divides into approximately 200 acres, which can then be apportioned among the domain’s farmers. Standard farming practice across most of the Successor Kingdoms rotates through land use on a three-year cycle, with each ten-acre field growing grain one year, then legumes the next, and finally being left fallow for the grazing of livestock on the third. A single half-mile sub-hex will typically be divided between six peasant families, each of which manages thirty acres of farmland; the final twenty acres are typically given over to a local druid or nature priest who advises each family, treats any injury and illness, and negotiates with local fair folk when needed.

Different kinds of crops and livestock have different harvest seasons, which determine when the land actually produces food or other supplies (such as leather or wool). Harvest is typically conducted as a domain-wide ritual, overseen by priests or druids. The overseer of each sub-hex makes a Survival check come harvest; on a failure, the fertility value of the hex has been reduced by 1 during the year. Then, roll the sub-hex’s fertility value – this is the total amount of food that the sub-hex produces, measured in person-years of consumption. The lord takes the halftithe; then, each family needs five person-years to survive, with the rest going to market.

Hunting and Fishing

Fertile land that is kept wild may be hunted or fished to provide supplemental foodstock and alchemical ingredients. Each month, the warden must decide whether to harvest lightly, normally, or heavily, with a yield of 1d6, 2d6, or 3d6 months of supply per parcel. Then the local warden must make an easy, normal, or hard Survival roll; failure indicates that the land has become depleted and must be left fallow for a time to replenish itself.

Mining and Quarrying

Domains that are rich in mineral resources may direct their vassals to mine or quarry them out of the ground, producing a steady revenue stream at the cost of damaging the land’s capacity to sustain wildlife or agriculture. Different kinds of mines or quarries will yield different kinds of resources, from precious metals and gems, to stone and iron for building, to materia and other rare alchemical ingredients. The maximum labor capacity of mineral veins will be determined by the referee when the domain is established.

Each month, a (2d6+3) roll is made to determine the mine’s yield, multiplied by the number of 50-man (or 25-dwarf) work crews assigned to the mine. As always, the lord is entitled to their halftithe.

Type of Ore Deposit	Output per 50-man crew
Iron	(2d6+3) x 75 lb
Stone	(2d6+3) x 75 tons
Copper	(2d6+3) x 250 lb
Silver	(2d6+3) x 20 lb
Gemstones	(2d6+3) x 4 carat
Gold	(2d6+3) x 3 lb

The process of mining and refining riches from the earth is invariably detrimental to the fertility of the land, blighting a mine’s sub-hex and reducing the fertility of each surrounding sub-hex by two steps for each month that the mine is operational. Sufficient irrigation and runoff control force the problem downstream, automatically blighting the downstream sub-hex and reducing the fertility of each further downstream sub-hex by one step for 2d6 miles. Druids, numina and fair folk will tend to find this process horrifically disgraceful, and are likely to mount armed retaliation if the runoff begins to affect their sacred groves.

Merchant Activities

Crafted goods, food produced by farms, game captured through hunting and fishing, and riches produced from mining and quarrying can all be used or stored up to a point, but selling them at market (and purchasing any wares or resources that the domain is experiencing a shortfall in) is often much more lucrative. Merchants purchase goods at one price and sell at another; usually, this involves traveling from domain to domain and purchasing goods where they are in plentiful supply, to sell later where they are in higher demand.

As such, it is often difficult for the lord of a domain to determine exactly how to apply the halftithe to a merchant's profits. The usual custom is to simply demand a small tax at the point of sale, recorded and tallied and paid monthly from the merchant to the lord who graciously hosted their shop or stall; merchants who travel on a quicker schedule will need to square their books and pay their taxes each time they enter or leave a domain.

To ease calculations, most taxes are collected from the seller at a rate of 10% of the gross earnings of each sale, less purchases made while within the domain; if proper records cannot be produced, then 10% of the merchant's total cash reserves are confiscated instead.

Minting Coin

Gold, silver, and copper mined from the domain can be minted into currency. In most of the Successor Kingdoms, strict laws prevent anyone below a baron from commissioning the minting copper coins, anyone below a duke from commissioning the minting of silver, and anyone below a prince or king from commissioning the minting of gold. Thus raw gold, silver, and copper ingots filter their way up through the halftithe, are minted into coins at the appropriate level of the feudal hierarchy, and then enter circulation where they filter back down to the populace.

In a mint, each pound of copper or silver ingot is pressed into 16 coins, and each pound of gold ingot is pressed into 32 gold coins, after assaying and alloying to the proper ratios of metal.

Research

Research orders assign a team of qualified scholars and craftsmen to discover historical information, or to help design a new arcane spell, magic item blueprint, or alchemical formula.

Player characters can spend a good portion of their downtime researching ancient lore and arcane secrets, and parties with a suitably furnished domain can direct their vassals to perform research on their behalf. The first step for any research project is to establish the core domain of the research, which determines the talent used to gather the raw data:

Science - designing a new arcane spell or ritual; designing a new alchemical potion based on an arcane spell effect that isn't a poison or elixir; determining the cause and nature of an unknown supernatural event; designing a new magic item that duplicates a known spell effect or that implements a known scientific principle; developing a new architectural or metallurgic technique; expanding the frontiers of scientific knowledge..

Medicine - diagnosing a rare disease, discovering the vectors that spread it, and developing a treatment and prevention plan; designing a new alchemical elixir or poison based on an understood arcane spell effect; using already-understood arcane and fey energies to produce a new species of fey beast; working out a nutrition plan for a city under siege whose supplies are dwindling.

Lore - Uncovering the lineage of a founding prince; finding the original cause of a generational feud between two houses, finding an obscure clause or loophole in a centuries-old contract with the local Numina; translating an ancient text written in a long-dead language; inventing a new art style.

Survival - determining why the local peasants' crops are wilting; understanding the impact of introducing or eradicating a species from the local ecosystem; breeding a new plant species through hybridization.

Once the domain of research is determined, available research materials are gathered. Useful tomes, handwritten notes, and eyewitness anecdotes all add to the volume of information that must be sorted through, categorized, and filtered for accuracy and relevance. The total amount of information gathered, and the obscurity of the relevant facts within that information, set the base difficulty of the task.

Most research is theoretical, only requiring that the research team pours through their collected information and come to the right conclusion. Certain forms of research, however, require active experimentation, often exposing the research team to genuine danger. The referee will determine whether a particular research project requires experimentation or not, but Science and Medicine projects almost always require research, while Lore and Survival projects almost never do.

At the end of each week of research, each member of the research team rolls their talent vs. the difficulty determined by the referee, to determine whether that researcher manages to make useful sense of the relevant information. Each researcher that succeeds then rolls 1d6 + their Intelligence modifier, adding to an accumulating pool of research points; a particularly disastrous failure instead indicates a magical mishap or wildly inaccurate deduction that sets back the whole project, subtracting that researcher's research point roll from the accumulated research point pool.

The referee will determine how many research points are necessary before success is reached. Success means the creation of a new work, summarizing the research team's findings - for a Science or Medicine research project, that new work might be a spell, blueprint, or alchemical formula ready to be copied into a spellbook.

Gaining Experience

The professionals and experts of a village will typically gain experience as they perform their duties, albeit at a much slower rate than adventurers. Each year that a professional with class levels spends managing an aspect of your domain, they gain one experience. If a particular arduous emergency occurs during a particular year, which they personally attended to, that professional might earn two experience during that year.

Professional NPCs gain class levels at the same experience rate as player characters. If brought along on an adventure, they gain experience at the rate of one per adventure, just like a player character.

Defense and Siege

During a siege, all other activity ceases, as the occupants of the bailey retreat to the motte and guards man the towers. Any professional NPCs with combat-appropriate class levels, such as priests, druids, scouts, or warriors, can be directed to aid in the defense of the domain as needed. Peasants, merchants, and other denizens without class levels will either be placed into logistic roles, or mustered into pike formations and placed under the supervision of a trained warrior.

Most keeps will construct various defenses to use in the event of a siege, from battlements and defense towers to siege weapons like ballistae or cannons. Design and construction of these defenses is handled using the artifact construction rules.

Mass Combat

Scale

The mass combat rules presented here are designed to operate at a base scale of 100' x 100' fields. When heroes engage each other within a single 100' x 100' field (or 100' diameter hex field), the referee might decide to provide the party a single 20-pace x 20-pace map for that specific melee, but otherwise movement and combat within each field is abstracted. A single half-mile sub-hex will typically serve as an entire battlefield, which is 25 fields across along each axis, ideally divided into approximately 600 field hexes.

Damage in mass combat is always delivered as structure damage. Large and huge creatures always move as individual units, while medium creatures that are not player characters or heroic NPCs are grouped into ranks of up to 10 creatures, all typically outfitted with the same armor and weapons.

Ranks

A rank effectively operates as a single unit that has the equivalent of one structure point per hit die among its constituent creatures. They attack as a single unit, using their leader's attack throw value to determine hit or miss. Any members of the rank with weapons that normally inflict hit point damage roll their damage dice without bonus or penalty, inflicting one sp of damage per '6' rolled.

Each time a rank suffers damage that reduces its total hits below 10, it must save vs. Fear to resist breaking. A broken rank cannot make attacks, and can only flee towards safety at the end of each round. If two allied broken ranks occupy the same field, they may combine into a single new rank (adding their total hd together), and then make a new save to rally. A rank that rallies can rejoin the battle.

A broken rank that is attacked must make a new save each time it sustains further damage; it does not rally on a success, but is completely destroyed on a failure. The referee can determine the survival of each NPC in a destroyed rank after the battle; any player characters in a destroyed rank are reduced to zero hit points and must cling to life each round until they stabilize.

Movement

As its action, a creature or rank may dash into any adjacent field. If either its current square or the new square contains difficult terrain, or if the creature or rank are encumbered, the unit must roll Agility to not become bogged down and stuck in their current field. Flying units never bog down.

Units with a dash speed of 30 paces or greater (designated as fast or very fast in the bestiary) may cross one field per 20 paces of dash movement that they possess. Moving into or out of a field with any difficult terrain takes 30 paces of dash movement. If such a creature attempts to move into a space when it has fewer paces of movement remaining than required, but still at least ten paces of movement, it may roll Agility to attempt to move through one additional field, becoming bogged down on a failure. A unit may only attempt this once per round, at the end of its movement on its turn.

If you are using a map delineated with squares rather than hexes, each field of diagonal movement costs 30 paces of dash movement, while diagonal movement through difficult terrain takes 40 paces.

Attacks

Any creatures or ranks that occupy the same field are capable of engaging in melee combat with each other. Any unit may freely use its movement to engage with another unit in its field, forcing those two units into melee combat; an already-engaged unit may attempt to disengage, prompting an opportunity attack from any enemy unit that it was previously engaged with. If a unit without reach (or with shorter reach) engages a unit with longer reach than it, the unit with longer reach may make an interrupting opportunity attack.

Units in the same field that are not engaged with each other may instead perform ranged attacks against each other without range penalties. Un-engaged units may make ranged attacks against units in other fields; count each field as 100' of range (counting every other diagonal field twice, as normal for combat on a square grid).

Special Units

Mounted Cavalry

A knight mounted on a warhorse counts as a single unit with a size equal to that of the larger creature, with sp equal to the combined hit dice of the knight and mount. The warhorse uses its action each turn to dash, freeing the knight's action to attack – this gives the unit a total effective speed of 30 paces, allowing it to move freely and attack at will. A cavalry unit finds it easier to avoid being bogged down, and when it engages another unit, it resolves it as a charge attack. Up to five mounted knights may form a single cavalry rank, adding their hit dice together.

A polearm-equipped rank that does not move during its turn may choose to brace against cavalry charges; bracing allows the polearm rank to make an easy interrupting opportunity attack against any unit that attempts to charge it, and doubles the damage roll for the opportunity attack.

A cavalry unit that is damaged by an attack must make a saving throw vs. Hold to stay in the saddle. On a failure, the rider is knocked off their mount and falls prone.

Field Cannon

A field cannon and its crew count as a single rank, with minimum hd equal to the crew requirement of the cannon. Aetheric cannon require additional crew trained in Science with total hd equal to their power draw. If the cannon rank's structure points are reduced below its minimum crew size, the rank automatically breaks, and the cannon itself is destroyed. Any critical hit against the rank also destroys the cannon and breaks the rank.

A field cannon must track its position in 45 degree increments, using its action each turn to either load or charge the cannon, aim the cannon at a new 90 degree arc of fire, or fire the cannon at a target within its current arc of fire. All field cannon use the crew's Science to load and fire.

Hero Units

Player characters, magic-user NPCs, and important named NPCs are hero units. Each hero unit moves independently on the battlefield, unless it chooses to join ranks with another allied unit. A hero unit that joins ranks adds its current sp and hd to the rank, and automatically survives and falls out of rank whenever its unit breaks ranks, suffering 1 sp of damage and continuing on as a solo hero unit unless it decides to form up with another rank.

A hero unit that is reduced to 0 sp is reduced to 0 hp and must immediately cling to life, following all the normal rules for tracking injury. If a hero unit stabilizes, it regains 1 sp and may rejoin the battle if conscious. After the battle, each 1 sp of damage that a hero unit suffered is converted into 1d6+2 hp damage.

Any hero unit that attacks a huge creature with an easy attack and hits with both d20s may choose the hit location; if the hero unit achieves a critical hit, it may also negate that creature's Duck reaction.

Large and Huge Creatures

Each large or huge creature counts as a single unit on the battlefield. Each of its location's hit points are divided by 10 to determine its effective structure points, to a minimum of 1 sp per section. A creature that has both sp and hp divides its hp by 5 and adds it to its sp.

A medium creature or rank that attacks a huge creature must re-roll any head hits that it achieves, unless it flies or has sufficient reach with its weapon to reach the head. Each die of damage inflicted by a rank must roll a separate hit location.

Formations

Multiple units within the same field can use their movement to align themselves into a formation. Each unit in a formation declares and performs the same action each round.

H. Step-by-Step: Travel

Each one-league hex of wilderness travel usually takes approximately one hour, using the following procedure.

Step 0 - Describe the Road Ahead

Decide what landmarks are visible and describe them to the party, along with the weather, signs of life, and any other relevant features.

Step 1 - Stealth or Speed

The party first decides whether they are going to move normally, stealthily, or attempt to force march through a hex. If they choose Stealth, have each character immediately make a Stealth check and note if anyone fails; if they choose to force march, each character makes a save vs. Doom to fend off fatigue.

Step 2 - Assign Roles

Have the party decide who is going to navigate, who is going to keep watch, and who is going to tend to any animals and gear.

Step 3 - Task Checks

Each member of the party makes a task check appropriate to their assigned role:

- Navigators roll Survival
- Guards roll Alertness
- Other characters roll any talent or ability that the referee deems appropriate.

Step 4 - Encounter Check

Make a Random Encounter roll for the new hex that the party is entering. If there is no random encounter, move onto the next league of travel and repeat this process. If there is, determine what appears and choose an appropriate encounter map.

Step 4a - Surprise Check

If either party was successfully moving stealthily, then they will automatically surprise the other party that they have encountered. If at least one member of a party failed their Stealth check, though, then the other party has an opportunity to see them coming if any of their guards succeeded at their Alertness checks.

J. Step-by-Step: Traps and Locks

Dungeon traps, locked doors, and hazards need to be detected, inspected, and disarmed.

Step 1 - Detecting the Trap or Lock

Each player that is actively looking for traps or secret doors rolls an Alertness check, rolling two d6's. Treat the two d6's as an easy roll if the player is looking in the right place or in the right way, or as a hard roll if they aren't.

Step 1a - Inspecting the Mechanism

Once a trap has been detected, an inspecting player can roll their Science vs. the lock or trap's inspect difficulty (easy, normal, or hard). If they fail, they are mistaken about the lock or trap's mechanism; if they succeed, then they understand the basics of how it works. Various specific ideas for how to inspect the trap might make the trap's Inspect difficulty easier or harder. If the Science check fails, the inspecting player must make a Finesse check to avoid setting the trap off with the inspection attempt.

Step 2 - Disarming

A player who thinks they understand how the trap or lock works can attempt to pick or disarm it with a Finesse check. If their Finesse check fails, or if they describe their attempt to disarm a trap in a way that's likely to set it off, the referee might call for a second Finesse check to see if the trap goes off.

Step 3 - Activation

If a trap activates, it will usually perform an attack – often an area attack, but sometimes a single-target ranged or melee attack vs. the person who activated the trap. If the trap has a more elaborate mechanism that operates over multiple combat rounds, then an encounter begins.

K . Step-by-Step: **Combat**

In 99% of cases, arbitrating combat should be straightforward and intuitive. When things get complicated - usually due to multiple actions "stacking up" on top of each other - the referee should slow down and walk through the whole round step-by-step.

Step 0 - Declare Actions

At the start of the round, each creature that can act declares its action and determines the speed of that action. Each creature that is attacking declares what weapon they are attacking with, but doesn't have to declare who they are attacking yet. Each creature that is attempting to perform magic must declare what spell, miracle, glamour, or other effect it intends to cast.

Step 0a - Determine Speed

Each weapon attack uses that weapon's size to determine its speed; claws and other innate melee attacks are always fast, and breath weapons and the like are always slow. Magic is always slow, and evading and guarding are always fast.

Step 0b - Resolve Conflicts

If there are any conflicts in the order of events because two different creatures each want to see what the other one wants to do before deciding what they want to do, whichever creature is lower level declares its actions first. If both creatures are the same level, then neither can declare their action in response to the other.

Step 1 - Fast Actions

All fast movement and attacks happen first. If two creatures both have a fast action and the order of their actions matters, they both make a Dexterity check, with the higher roll choosing whether to go first or second.

Step 1a - Movement

An attacking creature that can also move can decide how much of its movement to perform before or after its attack.

Step 1b - Opportunity Attacks

If at any time it attempts to move away from a creature that could make an opportunity attack against it, that creature can interrupt its movement to make its attack; if it hits, the interrupted creature loses the rest of its movement and any other actions it hasn't taken yet. The opportunity attacker uses its action for the round making the opportunity attack, unless it was guarding.

Similarly, if a creature tries to make a ranged attack while another creature could make an opportunity attack against it, that creature can interrupt its attack with its own attack.

Step 2 - Normal Actions

All normal actions and movement happen next, with the same sub-steps as fast actions.

Step 3 - Slow Actions

All slow actions and movement happen next, with the same sub-steps as fast actions and normal actions.

Step 4 - Bookkeeping

Any end-of-round bookkeeping happens after any slow actions, such as saving throws, ongoing damage, and the like. Then, if there are still any active combatants, the next round of combat begins.

L. Variant Rules Options

Variant Dice Mechanics

The following set of rules are optional ways to change the core dice-rolling system of the game. Some of these are faster than the systems presented in the Basic Rules, while others are slower; as the referee, you should pay close attention to the complexity of the systems you are using, and try to avoid "bogging down" play with too many unnecessary or tediously complex dice rolls.

In general, if the players want to try anything that seems straightforward or just fun, you should probably simply let them get away with it, having them perhaps roll a single d6 or a d6 ability check to answer any numerical questions (such as "how many swords do I manage to forge this week?" or "how many feet do I manage to dig into this rock with my pickaxe?"). Remember that keeping the pace and flow of the game is critical to keeping your players' engagement, attention, and enjoyment; you should only call for dice rolls with a chance of failure when the stakes of failure or success are meaningful to the adventure.

Dice Probabilities

As a referee, it's a good idea to have a fundamental understanding of how dice probabilities work. When you roll a single die, you have an equal chance of rolling any of the die faces - so a d6 has a 1 in 6 chance of rolling each of 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 or 6; while a d20 has a 1 in 20 chance of rolling each of the numbers 1 through 20.

When you add two or more dice together, however, the results tend to "clump together" in the middle - so rolling 2d6 has a much higher chance of rolling a 7 (the middle between '2' or '12'), but a much lower chance of rolling a '2' or '12'. Likewise, easy and hard rolls effectively cause the distribution to 'clump' at the top or bottom of the possibilities, without changing the highest or lowest possible values. Finally, adding a static bonus or penalty to a die roll "slides" the probability curve up or down, without affecting the range.

Removing D6 Task Checks

It's entirely possible to use d20 saving throws, instead of d6 task checks, to determine the success or failure of talent actions. Each talent uses its corresponding ability's saving throw as its d20 threshold, with expertise acting similar to weapon and armor proficiency.

Using 1D6 For Attack and Saving Throws

You can also go the other way, rolling a single d6 for attack throws and saving throws in the same manner as a task check. Simply divide each attack or saving throw's d20 threshold by 3 (round down) and add one to determine the d6 throw threshold. For attacks, a critical hit happens whenever the attack die rolls a '6' and at least one damage die rolls a '6'.

Base:	*-2	-1	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10+
D20	17+	16+	15+	14+	13+	12+	11+	10+	9+	8+	7+	6+	5+
D6	6+	6+	6+	5+	5+	5+	4+	4+	4+	3+	3+	3+	2+
2D6	11+	10+	10+	9+	9+	8+	8+	7+	7+	6+	6+	5+	5+

*base = (level + ability modifier)

Using 2D6 for Attack and Saving Throws

You can also make attack throws and saving throws using a 2d6 roll. Simply divide the d20 attack throw threshold by 2 (round up) and add 2 to get the equivalent 2d6 threshold - the result will be within 10% of the equivalent d20 statistical probability. Critical hits in this variant occur on a '12', and easy and hard 2d6 rolls are made by rolling 3d6 and dropping the highest or lowest die.

Since various referee tables use the d20, you'll need to construct your own d6-based tables if you want to abandon the d20 completely. A "d36" table can be made by rolling two d6s one after the other, to determine a row and a column on a 6 x 6 grid of options.

Not Rolling Abilities

If you want, you can completely remove the randomness of character creation by replacing the 3d6 ability rolls with an "array" of ability values. All characters created in this system start with one +2, one +1, three +0, and one -1 ability; non-humans must assign their +2 and +1 to their enhanced abilities, and their -1 to their deficient ability.

Exceptional Success

Characters with exceptional talent levels (3+ or 2+ thresholds) might be able to perform actions more quickly or more successfully. When a character with such skill makes a task check where time or quantity of result are important (such as crafting multiple items), you can use the following chart to determine their success multiple; the player can then choose whether to multiply the amount produced by the result, or divide the time spent on the task check by the result.

Talent	D6 result:	2	3	4	5	6
6+	-	-	-	-	-	1x
5+	-	-	-	-	1x	1x
4+	-	-	1x	1x	1x	2x
3+	-	1x	1x	2x	2x	2x
2+	1x	1x	2x	2x	3x	3x

Attack Matrices

Older versions of the game would often use an "attack matrix" to determine whether a character could hit a target, based on the attacker's level and the target's armor and Dexterity. Armor and Dexterity in the default rules do not affect the difficulty of hitting a target.

You can incorporate the target's Dexterity passively into the attacker's difficulty to hit by using the following attack matrix, rather than simply using the saving throw threshold as the attack threshold:

Base*	Target's Dexterity:	+0 or less	+1 to +2	Higher
-2		17+	18+	19+
-1		16+	17+	18+
0		15+	16+	17+
1		14+	15+	16+
2		13+	14+	15+
3		12+	13+	14+
4		11+	12+	13+
5		10+	11+	12+
6		9+	10+	11+
7		8+	9+	10+
8		7+	8+	9+
9		6+	7+	8+
10		5+	6+	7+
11		5+	5+	6+
12+		5+	5+	5+

*base = (level + ability modifier)

"Zero to Hero"

This variant allows characters to begin at level zero. Each time they gain an experience, they gain one of their class's expertise talents or martial training. Once all expertise talents and martial training have been learned, fighters and experts reach their first class level at their next experience; magic-users require two experience to gain their first class level after gaining both their expertise talents.

No Hit Points

One way to simplify combat is to replace "hit points" with "hits". In this system, monsters can withstand a number of solid weapon blows equal to their level, while mortal NPCs and player characters have a number of hits based on their class, level, and Constitution.

A mortal begins play with 3 hits; Constitution of -2 or lower reduces a mortal's total hits to 2, while a Constitution of +2 or better increases their total hits to 4. Bonus hit capacity from Constitution is a one-time deal, and does not increase with class level. Fighters gain a hit at levels 1, 3, 5, 7, and 9; experts and magic-users gain a hit at levels 3, 6, and 9

Weapons and armor require adjustment to fit into this system. Damage dice in this variant are always rolled against an armor threshold: unarmored creatures have a threshold of 2+, while light armor provides a threshold of 3+, medium armor gives a threshold of 4+, and heavy armor gives a threshold of 5+. Master-work armor increases this threshold by one step, and piercing weapons treat armor as one threshold lower when rolling damage. A '6' always inflicts a hit, while a '1' never does; spell and other elemental damage dice always inflict a hit on a 4+.

Light weapons roll one die for damage, while medium weapons roll two dice, and all heavy weapons roll three. A critical hit in this system simply inflicts an additional d6 hits, and all structure damage is directly equivalent to hits.

When a creature would roll its hit dice to heal, each hit die that rolls a '4' or better heals one hit. A hit die result of '6' always restores a hit, while a hit die result of '1' never does. Rest and recuperation times for healing severe injuries are in weeks, rather than days.

Maiming Injury Rules

The following table provides a detailed description of injury. You can roll on this chart whenever a character or important NPC suffers a critical hit or becomes injured.

D20	Maiming Injury
1-10	none
11-13	-1 to a random Ability (d6)
14	left leg
15	right leg
16	left arm
17	right arm
18	head (d6: 1-4 face, 5 left eye, 6 right eye)
19	roll (d6+12) twice on this table
20	Permanent - roll (d6+12) once on this table

Leg - a creature with a maimed leg is hobbled, while a creature with two maimed legs is unable to rise from the prone position. Leg injuries will also make dodging, Agility checks, and many Strength-based tests and saving throws harder.

Arm - a creature with a maimed arm cannot wield weapons or tools, carry items, or perform actions with that hand. A creature with two maimed arms cannot wield weapons or tools at all. Arm injuries also make many Strength-based tests and saving throws harder, and might also make some Finesse tasks harder or even impossible to perform. A literate character whose dominant arm is maimed will need to re-learn how to write; a wizard whose dominant arm is maimed will also need to re-learn how to prepare spells.

Face - a creature with a maimed face finds all social reactions harder, and suffers a severe speech impediment when attempting to communicate or cast magic with a verbal somatic component.

Eyes - a creature with a maimed eye finds ranged attacks and Alertness tests harder; a creature with two maimed eyes is blind.

Permanent - a permanent maiming won't heal when you recover all your hit point damage; nothing but a restoration, a potion of regeneration, or healing magics of similar potency can heal it. Luckily for most adventurers of means, golem prostheses exist in the Successor Kingdoms for those with the resources to commission their construction.

Healing a Maiming Injury

If a character suffers a non-permanent maiming injury, it will linger until their hit points rise above their injured threshold (half their maximum hp). If they perform any strenuous activity during this time, they risk making the maiming injury permanent unless they successfully save vs. Doom.

Permanent maiming injuries can only be healed by a restoration spell, an elixir of regeneration, or magic of equal power. An alternative to healing the injury is replacing lost functionality with a golem prosthesis or similar magic item.

Coup de Grace

When someone attacks a helpless creature in melee, the hit should probably be automatic unless there are extenuating circumstances. Use the normal called shot rules to determine whether the attack is a critical hit; if it is, the attacker can decide whether to maim or kill, and has a good degree of control over the nature of the maiming injury they inflict.

Deliberately killing, maiming, or torturing a helpless or surrendered mortal captive is against the Church's doctrines, and will render a player character excommunicado until they confess to a priest, repent, and sincerely atone for their cruelty. Extenuating circumstances and pragmatic necessity will make atonement easier, but do not sufficiently justify acts of cruelty in the eyes of the Faith. Creatures who surrender in bad faith, the intelligent undead, and infernal beings forfeit their right to not be executed, but not their right to not be tortured.

The cult of Orcus, on the other hand, considers such depraved acts to be the purest form of devotion to their Baalim masters. Orc raiders will often deliberately capture prisoners alive in order to mutilate them and return them to their homes, forcing their communities to care for them as constant reminders of the tribe's ferocity.

M. Design Philosophy

These rules were crafted to streamline the experience of old-school dungeon crawling, while staying as close as we could reasonably get to old-school game design aesthetics. The setting provided is intended to work together with these rules, to present a world of danger and opportunity even for high-level characters.

Classes are simple, and only go up to level 9. This keeps the hit points and magic level of player characters at a low enough level that monsters still continue to present a threat to them; players are expected to attack high-level monsters either by raising an army and using the mass combat rules, or by wielding powerful magic weapons and armor that are designed to level the playing field (such as the golem armor and artifact siege weapons that were designed to be the signature of Wights and Wonders' high-level play).

Talents are simple, generic, and universal, and there are three per ability so that the -3 to +3 ability spread can map cleanly to providing simple -1 or +1 adjustments to each talent's starting thresholds. (Since all talents are d6-based, adding more than a single +1 or -1 to a threshold based on an attribute overwhelms the probability spread of the d6.) Talents in these rules are really more like trainable "sub-abilities" than skills, hence the generic names. Any particular class feature that improves across class levels should be mappable to one of the talents provided.

The decision to make d6 talents start at 5+, rather than 6+, was not made lightly. It ensures that first-level characters aren't completely inept at basic tasks, while the expertise system lets scouts, hunters, and delvers truly shine when performing their core competencies. A character with below-average ability scores might still need a 6+, but anyone who isn't genuinely disabled deserves at least a one-in-three chance of doing "normal" task actions.

Expertise was made deliberately simple, without breaking the spirit of how Thief proficiencies worked in the original game. It also means that many more actions become automatic for an expert, which keeps the pace of the game flowing quickly and smoothly.

The magic system is designed to present a coherent "physics", with concepts such as form, substance, arcana, soma, and materia hinting at a structure that should be mostly comprehensible to a studious researcher. Magic that is within the reach of a player character should be powerful enough to be useful, without instantly solving all of their problems with a single action or dice roll.

Having progression stop at 9th level means that magic-users lose access to "sixth circle" spells. The spell lists take this into account, by pulling some of the original B/X spells from 6th circle down to 5th. Since certain fifth-circle spells like Animate Dead, Contact Higher Plane and Magic Jar were less appropriate for the default setting, they were replaced with spells like Anti-Magic Shell, Disintegrate, and Flesh to Stone. A few spells, such as Growth of Plants, Geas, Move Earth, and Reincarnate, were handed over to the Druid as well, before all the spells got a look-over for aesthetic and mechanic adjustments to fit the setting.

Monsters are also designed to present a sense that these creatures exist within a believable ecosystem, and aren't just bags of hit points, experience, and treasure magically placed on a map by a referee for the players to kill. A referee should keep monsters on the move, following their own motivations and routines when the players' party isn't there to disrupt them. The referee should think in terms of ecosystems and balance when building a dungeon or a wilderness area; if monsters are too populous or too scarce there should be some background reason why, even if the players never find out that reason.

I. Inspiration and Educational Reading

Being a good referee is a multidisciplinary skill. In addition to imagination and social awareness, what separates an excellent referee from a merely good one is a wealth of self-taught knowledge. A solid grounding in both the sciences and humanities will provide you with an endless supply of themes and ideas filters that you can use to construct a world.

Don't let the sheer scope of this endeavor scare you off, especially if you are young and just beginning your journey - exploring these topics at your own pace and discovering which of them light a fire within you will serve you far better than treating this compilation as some kind of immense homework assignment. What's more, the skills and ideas hidden in these books and other media will prepare you for much more than refereeing a roleplaying game; they provide a valuable foundation for a lifetime of learning and imaginative problem-solving.

Non-Fiction Books

This book presents a world on the cusp of a scientific revolution, where the technological secrets of the Old Empire wait to be rediscovered by a new Renaissance. Since the physics of this world fundamentally mirror our own (before magic gets involved, anyways), it behooves a savvy referee to understand the fundamentals of mathematics, physics, chemistry, and biology.

Douglas Hopfstadter's *Metamagical Themas* and Gödel Escher Bach serve well as a sample of the kinds of deep mathematical weirdness that define the rules of the Aether.

Randy Monroe's *What If?* and *Thing Explainer* provide simple and entertaining physics lessons, while Richard Feynman's *Feynman Lectures on Physics* is quite possibly the highest-recommended book of physics among physicists themselves, so we would be remiss to not include it here.

For a deeply Primal understanding of ecology, Aldo Leopold's *A Sand County Almanac* is an evocative masterwork, and is an excellent real-world companion to Diane Duane's fantasy series.

Fiction Books

While JRR Tolkien's books are an obvious inspiration for the entire genre, there is also a wealth of material available from CS Lewis, his brother-in-arms. The *Narnia* series, the *Screwtape Letters*, the *Great Divorce*, and *Mere Christianity* offer an excellent window into the philosophical underpinnings that guide the holy Church in the default setting.

For more direct fantasy inspiration, the works of the early 20th century writers Edgar Rice Burroughs, Robert E Howard, and HP Lovecraft provide much of the foundational "spirit" of the setting. The writing circle around Lovecraft, in particular, created the foundational texts of the cosmic horror genre that inspires the setting's qliphothic evils.

The second half of the 20th century also provides a good selection of offerings. Diane Duane's *Young Wizard* series is probably the best possible description for a referee to understand the ethics and philosophy of Druid characters; the various "translations" and variations of her Wizard's Oath would serve well as the initiatory vows of Church-allied Druidic orders. Equally insightful are the *Discworld* novels of Sir Terry Pratchett., especially when Granny Weatherwax or Tiffany Aching is talking.

Peter S Beagle's *The Last Unicorn* is an incredible classic, whether read as a book or watched as anime, while Michael Moorcock's *Elric* saga provides an excellent peek into the downward spiral of all who follow the Baalim, even if they try to do so with honor. More modern fantasy offerings, such as George RR Martin's *A Song of Ice and Fire*, JK Rowling's *Harry Potter* series, Patrick Rothfuss's *Kingkiller Chronicle*, and Stephen King's *Dark Tower* epic are also good inspiration.

Movies and Television

Hayao Miyazaki's Studio Ghibli provides the best vision of this game's world - Nausicaa of the Valley of the Wind, My Neighbor Totoro, and Princess Mononoke are all excellent views of a world of mortals living side-by-side with fey magic and spirits.

Other fantasy anime with aesthetics that inspired the setting include The Vision of Escaflowne, FullMetal Alchemist, GATE (Thus the JSDF's Battle), Frieren, Little Witch Academia, Knight's & Magic, and Berserk. Fullmetal Alchemist especially deserves a look for its magic system, which provided much of the inspiration for how Wizard spells work (with materia as a less ethically dubious source for "equivalent exchange" than philosopher stones).

From the other side of the world, the American series Scavengers Reign by Bennett and Huettner provides an excellent example of the kind of surreal beauty that can be found within both Faerie and Shadow, and even within the Material when the supernatural spills across the veil. Jim Henson's Labyrinth and The Dark Crystal, too, give a sense of a world full of strange life that has found its own weird ecological balance.

While books are especially useful for the referee to read before preparing a campaign, visual media can be an excellent way to inspire an entire table. Many of the earliest playtest campaigns began after a group sat together and watched an anime, then began working out how to incorporate its aesthetic into our adventures.

Video Games

Square ENIX's Secret of Mana and Final Fantasy series provide much of the aesthetic and mechanical inspiration for the magic system, while the Legend of Zelda series (especially the Breath of the Wild and Tears of the Kingdom) give a good sense of the "open world adventure" aesthetic. The world should feel vast, old, and mysterious; Breath of the Wild is especially good at conveying exactly this sense of hidden wonder and opportunity.

The classic roguelike gaming genre has existed for many decades, with many variations - even arcade games like Gauntlet and PC games like Diablo can be considered descendants of the style. In a roguelike, death is permanent, and resource management and clever problem-solving are necessary to advance. Roguelikes often have a risk-vs-reward balance around information gathering, where finding out the optimal strategy for a situation is itself a risky action with different possible approaches.

Religious Works

CS Lewis wrote many nonfiction theological texts alongside his fiction. GK Chesterton also provides excellent commentary, as does Baruch Spinoza. Of course, the actual Christian Bible is the primary source that these theologians are commenting upon, but keep in mind that the text is a product of history, and this setting's history diverged quite early from that of our own world - incorporating far more insights from eastern Buddhist texts, the Torah, and the Quran. Even various pagan sources survived and were incorporated more reliably than in our world, due in part to this world's emphasis on redemption and reconciliation over erasure and conquest.

Buddhism in our world has a much more diverse collection of foundational texts than Christianity, with less sharp of a line between canon and commentary. Most of the setting's Buddhist influences come from the Chan (or Zen) school; The Awakening of Faith in the Mahayana Doctrine is probably the closest to a relevant canon here, although the Pali Canon is useful to compare how religious practices diverge over distance and time.